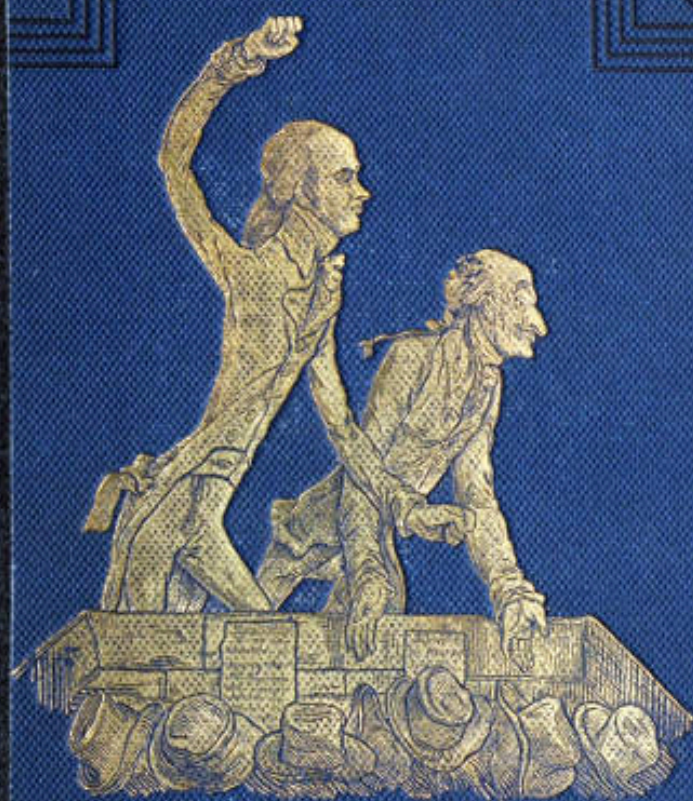




*PARLIAMENTARY
ELECTIONS
IN THE OLD DAYS*



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“THE RIGHTS of WOMEN” or the EFFECTS of FEMALE
ENFRANCHISEMENT

A HISTORY
OF
PARLIAMENTARY ELECTIONS
AND ELECTIONEERING
IN THE OLD DAYS

*SHOWING THE STATE OF POLITICAL PARTIES AND PARTY
WARFARE AT THE HUSTINGS AND IN THE HOUSE OF
COMMONS FROM THE STUARTS TO QUEEN VICTORIA*



CANDIDATES ADDRESSING THEIR CONSTITUENTS.
*ILLUSTRATED FROM THE ORIGINAL POLITICAL SQUIBS,
LAMPOONS
PICTORIAL SATIRES, AND POPULAR CARICATURES OF THE
TIME*

BY

JOSEPH GREGO

AUTHOR OF "JAMES GILLRAY, THE CARICATURIST: HIS LIFE, WORKS, AND TIMES"
"ROWLANDSON, THE CARICATURIST: HIS LIFE, TIMES, AND WORKS," ETC.

London
CHATTO AND WINDUS, PICCADILLY
1886

[The right of translation is reserved]

“I think the Tories love to buy
 ‘Your Lordships’ and ‘Your Graces,’
By loathing common honesty,
 And lauding commonplaces....
I think the Whigs are wicked Knaves
 (And very like the Tories)
Who doubt that Britain rules the waves,
 And ask the price of glories.”

W. M. PRAED (1826).

“A friend to freedom and freeholders—yet
 No less a friend to government—he held
That he exactly the just medium hit
 ’Twixt place and patriotism; albeit compell’d,
Such was his sovereign’s pleasure (though unfit,
 He added modestly, when rebels rail’d),
To hold some sinecures he wish’d abolish’d,
But that with them all law would be demolish’d.”

LORD BYRON.

PREFACE.

Apart from political parties, we are all concerned in that important national birthright, the due representation of the people. It will be conceded that the most important element of Parliaments—specially chosen to embody the collective wisdom of the nation—is the legitimate method of their constitution. Given the unrestricted rights of election, a representative House of Commons is the happy result; the opposite follows a tampering with the franchise, and debauched constituencies. The effects of bribery, intimidation, undue influence, coercion on the part of the Crown or its responsible advisers, an extensive system of personal patronage, boroughmongering, close or pocket boroughs, and all those contraband devices of old to hamper the popular choice of representatives, have inevitably produced a legislature more or less corrupt, as history has registered. Bad as were the workings of the electoral system anterior to the advent of parliamentary reform, it speaks volumes for the manly nature of British electors and their representatives that Parliaments thus basely constituted were, on the whole, fairly honest, nor unmindful altogether of those liberties of the subject they were by supposition elected to maintain; and when symptoms of corruption in the Commons became patent, the degeneracy was not long countenanced, the national spirit being sufficiently vigorous to crush the threatened evils, and bring about a healthier state of things.

The comprehensive subject of parliamentary elections is rich in interest and entertainment; the history of the rise, progress, and development of the complex art of electioneering recommends itself to the attention of all who have an interest in the features inseparable from that constitution which has been lauded as a model for other nations to imitate. The strong national characteristics surrounding, in bygone days, the various stages of parliamentary election—peculiarly a British institution, in which,

of all people, our countrymen were most at home—are now, by an improved elective procedure, relegated to the limbo of the past, while the records of electioneering exist but as traditions in the present.

With the modifying influence of progress, and a more advanced civilisation, the time may come when the narrative of the robustious scenes of canvassing, polling, chairing, and election-feasting, with their attendant incidents of all-prevailing bribery, turbulence, and intrigue, may be regarded with incredulity as fictions of an impossible age.

It has been endeavoured to give the salient features of the most remarkable election contests, from the time when seats began to be sought after until comparatively recent days. The “Spendthrift Elections,” remarkable in the annals of parliamentary and party warfare, are set down, with a selection from the literature, squibs, ballads, and broadsides to which they gave rise. The illustrations are selected from the pictorial satires produced contemporaneously upon the most famous electoral struggles. The materials, both literary and graphic, are abundant, but scattered; it is hoped that both entertainment and enlightenment may be afforded to a tolerant public by the writer’s efforts to bring these resources within the compass of a volume.

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A HISTORY OF PARLIAMENTARY ELECTIONS IN THE OLD DAYS.

CHAPTER I.

CONCERNING EARLY PARLIAMENTS AND ELECTIONS OF KNIGHTS AND BURGESSES.

The subject of elections being so indissolubly bound up with that of parliamentary assemblages and dissolutions, it will not be out of place to glance at the progress of that institution. John was the first king recorded to summon his barons by writ; this was directed to the Bishop of Salisbury. In 1234 a representative parliament of two knights from every shire was convened to grant an aid; later on (1286) came the parliament of Merton; and in 1258 was inaugurated the assembly of knights and burgesses, designated the *mad* parliament. The first assembly of the Commons as “a confirmed representation” (Dugdale) was in 1265, when the earliest writ extant was issued; while, according to many historians, the first regular parliament met in 1294 (22 Edw. 1), when borough representation is said to have commenced. From a deliberative assembly, it became in 1308 a legislative power, without whose assent no law could be legally constituted; and in 1311, annual parliaments were ordered. The next progressive step was the election of a Speaker by the Commons; the first was Peter de la Mare, 1377. A parliament of *one* day (September 29, 1399), when Richard II. was deposed, is certainly an incident in the history of this institution; the Commons now began to assert its control over pecuniary grants. In 1404 was held at Coventry the “Parliamentum Indoctum” from which lawyers were excluded (and that must have offered a marked contrast to parliaments in our generation). In 1407 the Lords and Commons assembled to transact business in the Sovereign’s absence. Reforms were clearly then deemed expedient: in 1413 members were obliged to reside at the places they represented,—this enactment has occasioned expense and inconvenience in obeying “the letter,” but appears to have otherwise been easily defeated as regards “the spirit;”¹ in 1430 the Commons adopted the forty-shillings

qualification for county members. A parliament was held at Coventry in 1459; this was called the *Diabolicum*. The statutes were first printed in 1483; in 1542 the privilege of exemption from arrest was secured to members; and in 1549 the eldest sons of Peers were admitted to sit in the Commons. With James I. commenced those collisions between the Crown and the representatives of the people which marked the Stuart rule. The Commons resisted those fine old blackmail robberies known during preceding reigns as “benevolences,” under which plea forced contributions were levied by the Crown, especially during Elizabeth’s reign. James I. pushed these abuses too far, in his greed for money.

The parliament of 1614 refused to grant supplies until grievances were redressed; James dismissed them, and imprisoned several members. This short session was known as the “Addled Parliament.” The “Long Parliament” assembled in 1640, and the House of Peers was abolished by it in 1649; and later on, a Peer sat in the Commons. This parliament, proving intractable, was dissolved by Cromwell in 1653. Under Charles II., with the restoration of monarchy, the Peers temporal resumed their functions, and in 1661 the Lords spiritual were allowed to resume their seats, and the Act for triennial parliaments was unwisely set aside by the Commons. The relations between the Crown and the Commons were again becoming strained in 1667, when an Act excluding Roman Catholics from sitting in either House was forced through the legislature. From this point the narrative of electioneering incidents may commence, the more appropriately since it was at this time there arose the institution of the familiar party distinctions of Whig and Tory.

The orders for the attendance of members and the Speaker were somewhat curious; for instance, among the orders in parliament regulating procedure, the following are noteworthy:—

Feb. 14, 1606.—The House to assemble at eight o’clock, and enter into the great business at nine.

May 13, 1614.—The House to meet at seven o’clock in the morning, and begin to read bills at ten.

Feb. 15, 1620.—The Speaker not to move his hat until the third *congé*.

Nov. 12, 1640.—Those who go out of the House in a confused manner before the Speaker to forfeit 10s.

May 1, 1641.—All the members that come after eight to pay 1s., and those that do not come the whole day to pay 5s.

April 19, 1642.—Those who do not come to prayers to pay 1s.

Feb. 14, 1643.—Such members as come after nine o'clock to pay 1s. to the poor.

March 21, 1647.—The Speaker to leave the chair at twelve o'clock.

May 31, 1659.—The Speaker to take the chair constantly every morning by eight o'clock.

April 8, 1670.—The back door in the Speaker's chamber to be nailed up during the session.

March 23, 1693.—No member to take tobacco into the gallery, or to the table, sitting at committees.

Feb. 11, 1695.—No news-letter writer to presume to meddle with the debates, or disperse any in their papers.

Orders touching motions for leave into the country:—

Feb. 13, 1620.—No member shall go out of town without open motion and licence in the House.

March 28, 1664.—The penalty of £10 to be paid by every knight, and £5 by every citizen, etc., who shall make default in attending.

Nov. 6, 1666.—To be sent for in custody of the serjeant.

Dec. 18, 1666.—Such members of the House as depart into the country without leave, be sent for in custody of the serjeant-at-arms.

Feb. 13, 1667.—That every defaulter in attendance, whose excuse shall not be allowed this day, be fined the sum of £40, and sent for in custody, and committed to the Tower till the fine be paid.

That every member as shall desert the service of the House for the space of three days together (not having had leave granted him by the House, nor offering such sufficient excuse to the House as shall be allowed), shall have the like fine of £40 imposed on them, and shall be sent for in custody, and committed to the Tower; and that the fines be paid into the hands of the serjeant-at-arms, to be disposed of as the House shall direct.

April 6, 1668.—To pay a fine of £10.

A few words of explanation regarding technicalities will be found in place, since the qualifications of voters have a distinctive language of their own, used to indicate their various degrees of electoral privilege. The terms, “burgage tenures,” “scot and lot,” “pot-wallopers,” “splitting,” “faggot votes,” etc., occur constantly, and it may be desirable to indicate in advance the meanings attached to these enigmatical expressions.

Burgage tenures consist of one undivided and indivisible tenement, neither created, nor capable of creation, within time of memory, which has immemorially given a right of voting; or an entire indivisible tenement, holden of the superior lord of a borough, by an immemorial certain rent, distinctly reserved, and to which the right of voting is incident.

Another qualification determined the right of voting “to be in such persons as are seized in fee, in possession, or reversion, of any messuage, tenement, or corporal hereditament within the borough, and in such persons as are tenants for life or lives, and, for want of such freeholds, in tenants for years determinable upon any life or lives, paying scot and lot, and in them and in no other.”

Potwallers—those who, as lodgers, boil the pot. Pot-wallopers, or Pot-boilers.

The word Burgess extends to inhabitants within the borough.

The right of election being generally vested “in inhabitants paying scot and lot, and not receiving alms or any charity,” these terms require explanation. What it is to pay scot and lot, or to *pay scot* and *bear lot* is nowhere exactly defined. According to Stockdale’s “Parliamentary Guide,” compiled in 1784, it is probable that, from signifying some special municipal or parochial tax or duty, they came in time to be used in a popular sense, to comprehend generally the burdens and obligations to which the inhabitants of a borough or parish were liable as such. What seems the proper interpretation is, that by inhabitants “paying scot and lot,” those persons are meant whose circumstances are sufficiently independent to enable them to contribute in general to such taxes and burdens as they are liable to as inhabitants of the place. In Scotland, when a person petitions to be admitted a burgess of a royal borough, he engages he will *scot and lot*, i.e. *watch* and *ward*; and by statute (2 Geo. 1, c. 18, s. 9) it is ascertained that in the election of representatives for the city of London, the legislature understood *scot* and *lot* to be as here explained.

As to the disqualifications, *alms* means parochial collections or parish relief; and *charity* signifies sums arising from the revenue of certain specific sums which have been established or bequeathed for the purpose of assisting the poor. There are further nice distinctions in the latter; for on election petitions persons receiving certain defined charities were qualified to vote, while other charities disqualify for the identical return. The burgage tenement decision which defines the nature of this qualification as set down, arose on a controverted election in 1775 for Downeton or Downton, a borough in Wilts, the right of voting being admitted by both sides to be “in persons having a freehold interest in burgage tenements, holden by a certain rent, fealty, and suit of court, of the Bishop of Winchester, who is lord of the borough, and paying reliefs on descent and fines on alienation.” Thomas Duncombe and Thomas Drummer were the sitting members; and the counsel for the petitioners, Sir Philip Hales and John Cooper, objected to some twenty votes recorded for the candidates elected. “It was proved

that the conveyances to some were made in 1768, *i.e.* the last general election, but that the deeds had remained since that time in the hands of Mr. Duncombe, who is proprietor of nearly two-thirds of the burgage tenements in Downton; so that the occupiers had continued to pay their rents to him, and expected to do so when they became due again, considering him as their landlord, and being unacquainted with the grants made by him to the voters; and that there were no entries on the court rolls of 1768 of those conveyances, nor of the payment of the alienation fines. The conveyances to others appeared to have been *printed* at the expense of Mr. Duncombe, and executed after the writ and precept had been issued, some of them being brought *wet* to the poll. The grantees did not know where the lands contained in them lay, and one man at the poll produced a grant for which he claimed a vote, which, on examination, appeared to be made to another person.” The practice of making such conveyances about the time of an election had long prevailed in the borough; the votes so manufactured were known by the name of *faggots*; and the petitioners contended such votes, although pertaining to obsolete “burgage” immunities, were “colourable, fraudulent, and void,” both by the common law of parliament, and the statute of William III. aimed at abuses, and commonly called the *Splitting Act*. Besides the general objection of “occasionally,” a proportion of the votes for the sitting members was impeached for reasons drawn from the nature of burgage tenements, as set forth in the definition of these terms. Whence it was decided that Mr. Duncombe had done his spiriting so clumsily that neither he nor his colleague could be considered duly elected as burgesses to serve in the parliament in question, and the petitioners ought to be returned in their places.

In 1826 the Earl of Radnor was patron of this same borough of Downton, Sir T. B. Pechall and the Hon. Bouverie being its representatives, and the votes being vested in the persons having a freehold interest in burgage tenures and held of the Bishop of Winchester; the number of voters is not given—possibly J. J. Stockdale (election agent), who compiled the “Election Manual,” was unable to discover any.

It seems that, while they were permitted to exist, those qualifications which surrounded burgage tenures were founded on shadowy premises; for instance, Horsham (Sussex) was summoned to send burgesses to parliament

from the 28th of Edward I. According to Bohun, the Duke of Norfolk, as lord thereof, held the entire election in his own hands, the bailiffs, chosen by the duke's steward in the court-leet held at Michaelmas, having been the principal officers which returned members to serve in parliament; while as to the constituents and their suffrages, the qualifications for these add a fresh and startling paragraph to the subject:—

“The house or land that pays twelve pence a year to the Duke, is called a whole burgership; but these tenancies have been splitted into such small parts, that he who has only so much land, or part of a house, as pays two pence a year, is now by custom entitled to vote for members to serve in parliament; but it is the tenant of the freehold, though not resident in the place, or occupier of the house, or land, that has the right to vote.”

The outlines of an election, when the state of “villainage,” approximating to feudal serfdom, was the condition of the labouring classes, have been sketched by Sir Francis Palgrave. From the pages of his “Truths and Fictions of the Middle Ages” we obtain a vivid picture of the manner of the quest for representatives to serve the king in parliament, as it might have presented itself to the faithful lieges in the fourteenth century, at the three annual seasons for summoning the chamber.

The sheriff, Sir Roger de Swigville, mounted on a noble steed worthy of so stout a knight, rides up to the county court, the scene of the elections of the period, where is gathered a goodly assemblage of mounted gentry; the sheriff's javelin-men about him, his silken and brodered banner waving in the breeze; and forthwith is displayed the sacred scrap of parchment, the “king's writ,” informing the estates of the realm in the learned Latin tongue, that a parliament is to be holden at Westminster, Winchester, York, or elsewhere. The baronage and freeholders are bidden to choose a worthy and discreet knight of the shire for the county, to aid the king with his advice,—duly providing for his expenses during the term while parliament may sit, and for his charges going and returning; but first taking due care to ascertain if the great baron of the county—De Clare or De Bohun—has not already signified, through his steward or attorney, whom he would have chosen. The name of Sir Fulke de Braose is mentioned—yonder handsome

“chivaler” who, hawk on wrist, is watching the proceedings; but that gay knight preferreth the excitements of war or sport, and at the Words “election” and “parliament,” he hastily withdraws from the crowd, and spurreth off as fast as his good horse may carry him. The “Chiltern Hundreds” was a sanctuary where knights, anxious to avoid the honour of being sent to the senate, frequently sought refuge.

It was Elizabeth who took a practical course with her faithful Commons, and in businesslike fashion admonished them not to waste their time in long and vain discourses, but to apply themselves at once to their function—that of voting supplies, and, on occasions, of granting “benevolences,” that is, forced loans to the Crown.

According to some writers, the earliest recorded instance of corruption in electioneering matters occurred under date 1571, but the incident hardly comes under the description of bribery. In the “Parliamentary History” (i. 765), it is stated from the journals of 1571, that one Thomas Long was returned for the borough of Westbury, Wilts, who, “being found to be a very simple man, and not fit to serve in that place, was questioned how he came to be elected.” It seems that extreme simplicity was so unusual in the House that its presence was easily detected; in any case, Thomas Long acted up to his reputation, and replied with a frankness not commonly exhibited in the admissions made before election committees and their perquisitions: “The poor man immediately confessed to the House that he gave to Anthony Garland, mayor of the said town of Westbury, and one Watts of the same, £4 for his place in parliament.” This was certainly a modest consideration for a seat, when it is considered that famous electioneering tacticians, like the Duke of Wharton, in a later generation, exhausted ample fortunes in the traffic of constituencies. Moreover, this simple purchaser of a place in parliament, though he forfeited his bargain, did not lose his money; “an order was made that the said Garland and Watts should repay unto the said Thos. Long the £4 they had of him.” Although the actual briber escaped scot-free, the inquiry terminated with the infliction of a severe penalty on those who had been convicted of venality, “a fine of £20 being assessed for the queen’s use on the said corporation and inhabitants of Westbury for their scandalous attempt.” This precept was not without its use, and in the future history of this species of corruption it will be found that mayors and

corporations—in whose influence once rested that “merchantable property,” the right of selecting representatives—grew more experienced in iniquitous ways, and exacted the highest tariff for the saleable commodity they offered, besides making choice of more cunning purchasers, and, moreover, generally managed to get not only the best of the bargain, but contrived to avoid being forced to disgorge their ill-gotten gains; the proverb still remains, a relic of the days in which it had its origin, “Money makes the mayor to go.”

The privilege of parliament which protected the persons of members was already sought after in Elizabeth’s days for its incidental advantages; thus, John Smith, whose name is mentioned in the “Parliamentary History,” presented himself to be elected for Camelford, for the purpose of defrauding his creditors—a *ruse* which was allowed to succeed by a tolerant chamber,—privilege, however, and the continuance of his seat were voted by 112 to 107.

Mr. Norton, in 1571, speaks of “the imperfection of choice, too often seen, by sending of unfit men;” and he notices as one cause, “the choice made by boroughs, for the most part of strangers.”

Interference in elections by the territorial lords, or by the Church, was resented about this time:—

“A penalty of £40 proposed upon every borough that should elect at the nomination of a nobleman, one great disorder, that many young men, not experienced, for learning sake were often chosen. Proposed that none under thirty years of age should be returned.”

From the “Parliamentary History” we secure the account of a disputed return for Buckinghamshire in the year 1603, set down by the sheriff as returning officer:—

“About eight o’clock he came to Brickhill; was there told by Sir George Throckmorton and others that the first voice would be given for Sir Francis Goodwin; he answered ‘he hoped it would not be so,’ and ‘desired every gentleman to deal with his freeholders.’ After eight went to the election.... After the writ was read, he first intimated the

points of the proclamation, then jointly proposed Sir John Fortescue and Sir F. Goodwin. The freeholders cried, first, ‘A Goodwin, a Goodwin!’ Every Justice of the Peace on the bench said, ‘A Fortescue, a Fortescue!’”

Election proceedings began early in those days, and parliamentary hours were equally matinal. From the pamphlets, tracts, and broadsides of the Stuart era it may be noted that the Speaker took his place in the House at eight o’clock in the morning.

“The knights girt with swords by their sides,” as returned for the shires of the counties, were important personages, the influential families retaining this prerogative in their houses for generations; the names of the great county families may be traced, according to their respective localities, for more than a century in uninterrupted succession as the county members, as may be observed in the compendious lists of the knights, citizens, and burgesses of parliaments summoned in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries. Chaucer relates of his Frankleyn—

“Ful ofte tyme he was a knight of the schire.”

It was, as Hannay has expressed it, the great gentry who seem to have accepted the girding of the sword, in something like turns, as both a dignity and a duty. “From such men the House of Commons took that high, that *gentle* tone, which has often been so justly boasted of by its great men, and which it is to be hoped it will retain, through whatever changes are destined for it.” The dignity of representation in the earlier stages of parliamentary history does not appear to have extended beyond the knights of the shires; those of this select order might, if they had the ambition, contest among themselves, but it is difficult to imagine electoral contests among the representatives of a less exalted class—the citizens and burgesses, whose election was at first very much at the discretion of the sheriffs. When the real parliamentary strength lay in the baronage, the worthies who came up from the cities and boroughs to advise about taxation were not much regarded originally, and seem to have conducted themselves, during their brief visits to the Commons House, with a docility of demeanour, supposed

to be in keeping with their native obscurity; as, for the most part, they were but nominees or placemen of Peers and Lords of parliament, of ecclesiastical hierarchs, of officers of State, or put forward by lords of manors, influential families, and dispensers of preferment of one kind or another, a retiring and deferential line of conduct was due from these mere parliamentary “pawns” to their patrons. This state of subjection appears foreign to the independence by presumption associated with the character of a member of parliament, and might be taken as belonging only to a feudal epoch; but with rare intervals of self-assertion on the part of the people, such as happened during the civil wars—when the equipoise of society was unsettled for a space—it must be admitted that at least a considerable portion of the Commons under the boroughmongering and patronage-monopolizing days, which reached to 1831, was not far removed from the condition of semi-vassalage as described, until the revision and extension of the representative system assimilated the constitution of the Commons in earnest to what by a plausible fiction it was “on trust” for generations assumed to be.

It is shown that in the early days of the representative system the high obligation of sending members to parliament was regarded as a burden instead of a privilege by many boroughs, and that exemption from this duty was a boon for which sacrifices were cheerfully made; moreover it was a “right” which constituencies managed to leave in abeyance, intermitting in many instances for a century or more. By the same rule, electoral bodies were relieved to get rid of their responsibilities, before the days of sordid trafficking, and while venal boroughmongering was still an undeveloped branch of gain: it was at first accepted by the cities and boroughs as a kindly service on the part of a great man to choose the citizens and burgesses for parliament; “influence” was not considered “undue” when it was exercised in dictating the choice of what by a traditional figment were considered the popular representatives. Thus, in Elizabeth’s reign, quite as a matter of course, Devereux, Earl of Essex, was busying himself in providing such nominees as he thought fitting for various places, as appears from the following letter, addressed to Richard Bagot, of Staffordshire, and printed with the “Memorials of the Bagot family,” 1592:—

“After my very hartie commendacions. I have written several letters to Lichfield, Stafford, Tamworth, and Newcastle for the *Nomination* and *Election* of certain Burgesses for the Parliament to be held very shortlie; having named unto them, for Lichfield, Sir John Wingfield and Mr. Broughton. For Stafford, my kinsman Henry Bourgcher, and my *servant* Edward Reynolds. For Tamworth, my *servant* Thomas Smith. For Newcastle, Dr. James. Whom because I do greatlie desire to be preferred to the said places, I do earnestlie pray your furtherance by the credit which you have in those towns.”

The mere dealing in “parliamentary interest” was still undeveloped as regarded its monetary aspect, but party strengthened its ranks by nominating candidates, first, because it was the “will and pleasure” of those who held the influence; secondly, when the possessor of several boroughs began to realize he could utilize his seats in many ways, electioneering science took a new departure, and boroughs and “burgage tenures” began to be cultivated for the market like any other trafficable commodity.

“Formerly,” says Waller, “the neighbourhood desired the member to sit, and there was an end; but now it is a kind of empire. Some hundred years ago, some boroughs sent not; they could get none to serve; but now it is a fashion, and a fine thing they are revived.”

The ancient system was shaken in the early Stuart days: under Charles I. we find ministers still writing of those “seats which were safe,” and where, such as in the “Cinque Ports,” patronage could secure the election of placemen; but opposition was ripe in the land, and when the stand was to be made against the Crown “in many places the elections were managed with much popular heat and tumult.” The strength of the Church was matched against dissent—“that incredible heresy;” then began Puritan corporations which exhibited a “factious activity” in the boroughs, and thus raised to white heat the indignation of territorial magnates; thence did lords of the manor bestir themselves for the assertion of traditional privileges, by easy degenerations swollen into prescriptive rights and oppressive tyrannies. Hence attempted coercions; “certain lord-lieutenants of the counties were accused of making an improper use of the Train-bands,” the beginning of

the system of electioneering intimidation. Thus we are informed that, in the year 1639:—

“In many places the elections were managed with much popular heat and tumult by the countenance of those English nobility and gentry of the Scottish faction. At the County election for Essex, for instance, the Earl of Warwick made good use of his lord-lieutenancy, in sending letters out to the captains of the Train-bands, who having power to charge the people with arms, durst not offend, which brought many to his side. Those ministers who gave their voices for my Lord of Warwick, as Mr. Marshal and others, preached often out of their own parishes before the election. Our corporation of Essex, consisting most of Puritans, and having had their voices in electing their own burgesses, and then to come to elect knights, is more than the greatest lord of England hath in their boroughs; the multiplicity of the people are mean-conditioned, and most factious, and few subsidy-men; and therefore in no way concerned in the election.

“A man having but forty shillings a year freehold hath as great a voice in the election as any; and yet this man is never a subsidy-man, and, therefore, no way concerned in the election for his own particular; and when the statute was made two centuries earlier (in 1430) forty shillings, it was then twenty pound in value now. And it were a great quiet to the state if it were reduced to that; and then gentlemen would be looked upon, and it would save the ministers a great deal of pains, in preaching from their own churches.”

About 1640, although absolute intimidation was not common, it at least was resorted to in the case of one candidate, who suffered therefrom, and evidently entered a subsequent protest. In Nalson's papers it is recorded:—“A paper sent to the Secretary of State by Mr. Nevil, of Cressing Temple, the unsuccessful candidate, whose life was threatened. ‘It was said among the people that if Nevil had the day they would tear the gentleman to pieces.’” Walpole, otherwise unscrupulous in his resort to corruption of various kinds, appears to have avoided downright violence; it was reserved for the Pelhams and the Duke of Grafton to bring armed force to the hustings by way of intimidating opposition—an unsatisfactory state

of affairs which reached its most unconstitutional proportions under the administration of William Pitt, when those Court candidates selected from the two services received the support of both army and navy; when the guards and sailors surrounded the hustings, and menaced such as were prepared to record votes for candidates other than their employers. Much might be written of the struggles in which envenomed adversaries were led into personal encounters; and rival factions, as between the Cavaliers and Roundheads, went to great lengths in their hostilities: but when the excitement cooled down, the honour of sitting for a borough did not, as a rule, excite fierce competition, at least, anterior to the Revolution which dismissed the Stuarts; members were proposed and accepted in a half-hearted way, and the burgesses sent to Parliament seemed little ambitious of the honour.

The method in which a member was selected in the middle of the seventeenth century for the city of Bath, even then a place of importance,² which a short while after became a celebrated centre for election contests and ministerial and party intrigues, may be studied with all its simple minutiae among the “*Nugæ Antiquæ*,” (vol. ii.) prepared from the family papers of the Harringtons, landed proprietors in the locality, who, from father to son, had represented the citizens in successive sessions:—

“To our much honoured and worthie Friend, J. Harrington, Esq., at his house at Kelston, near Bathe.

“WORTHIE SIR,

“Out of the long experience we have had of your approved worth and sincerity, our Cittie of Bathe have determind and settled their resolutions to elect you for Burgess of the House of Commons in this present Parliament, for our said Cittie, and do hope you will accept the trouble thereof: which if you do, our desire is you will not fail to be with us at Bathe on Monday next, the eighth of this instant, by eight of the morning at the furthest, for then we proceed to our election. And of your determination we entreat you to certifie us by a word or two in writing, and send it by the bearer to

“Your assured loving friends,

“JOHN BIGG, *the Mayor*.

“WILLIAM CHAPMAN.

“Bathe.”

There is some obscurity as to the dates; according to Willis, John Harrington sat for Bath 1658-9.

The progress of these negotiations is set down in the diary of the worthy gentleman selected to serve:—

“A NOTE OF MY BATHE BUSINESS ABOUT THE PARLIAMENT.

“Dec. 26.—Went to Bathe and dined with the Mayor and Citizens; conferred about my election to serve in parliament, as my father was helpless and ill able to go any more; went to the George Inn at night, met the Bailiffs, and desired to be dismissed from serving; drank strong bear and metheglin; expended about iijs.; went home late, but could not get excused, as they entertained a good opinion of my father.

“Dec. 28.—Went to Bathe; met Sir John Horner; we were chosen by the Citizens to serve for the city. The Mayor and Citizens conferred about Parliament business. *The Mayor promised Sir John Horner and myself a horse apiece when we went to London to the Parliament*, which we accepted of....

“Thursday, Dec. 31.—Went to Bathe; Mr. Ashe preached [this was before the members, probably in state at the Abbey]. Dined at the George Inn with the Mayor and 4 citizens; spent vjs. in wine.

“Laid out in victuals at the George Inn xjs. 4d.

“Laid out in drinking vijs. iid.

“Laid out in tobacco and drinking vessels iijs. 4d.

“Jan. 1.—My father gave me £4 to bear out my expenses at Bathe.”

The members were salaried at this time, being allowed from two shillings to three shillings and fourpence, and in exceptional cases five shillings, per day during the sessions of the Commons, although in many instances no more than two shillings was the recognized fee;³ these wages were generally raised by the town, and paid in a lump sum at the close of the sessions.

The writ directs two knights to be chosen out of every county, two citizens out of every city, and two burgesses out of every borough. The counties were well known, and had long been ascertained; but the sheriffs had it left to their discretion as to the cities and boroughs. They were the *dominicæ civitates* and *burgi regis*, viz. such as had charters from the king and paid a fee-farm rent in lieu of the customs and other advantages and royalties that belonged to the Crown; but these not being named in the writ, the sheriffs took great liberties, either by summoning such as had no right, or omitting others, who ought to have been summoned: this arose from the nature of the institution.

“The representation of the nation in parliament was then a burden to the people, the elected being paid by their electors; nor doth it appear that the representatives at that time had any advantage more than their wages. Cities and boroughs were, therefore, not fond of returning representatives to Parliament, and it was reckoned a privilege to be exempted, and to obtain which there are more instances than one of petitions having been presented. Sheriffs would frequently act in a very partial and arbitrary manner, and out of pique return many *poor boroughs*, who were not able to pay their representatives, and omit others who were able, *in order to show favour towards them*.”

This became a veritable grievance, and, in 5 Rich. 2, a law was made to hinder these arbitrary proceedings, and several boroughs were, by charter from the Crown, exempted from what they would have esteemed a hardship and burden upon them.

Colchester returned members to Parliament 23 Edward 1; as endorsed upon the writs in 7 Edward 4, only five burgesses, named in the return, chose for that Parliament. At that time, service was thought a burden, and exemption was allowed by way of reward for loyal services rendered; thus Richard II., in consideration of the burgesses of Colchester rebuilding and fortifying the walls of their town against the king's enemies, granted them an exemption for the space of five years.

Beyond the very modest wages allowed by constituencies to their representatives during their sojourns in London at the three sessions of parliament, it was generally held a matter of courtesy to present the two representatives with a horse apiece to help them on their way; and expenses by the road, at the allowances stipulated, were added in with the fixed pay of so much per day for the duration of parliament, which sum was generally allowed to accumulate, and redeemed at the close of the session, when the members came back to report themselves to their constituents and give an account of their stewardship.

In respect of Middlesex, which has been represented in parliament from the first general summons of the knights of the shire in the reign of King Edward I., a reservation was made. The city of Westminster, where parliament was usually held, being within this county, the knights had only their fees for attendance, and no allowance for coming and going, as in other counties. "In the second year of King Henry V. (1414), the Bishop of London complained that his tenants of Fulham were taxed towards the expenses of the knights of the shire for this county, upon which a writ was issued for discharging the said tenants, in case it should appear they had not been formerly taxed."

The sums paid to members were in all cases very moderate; but these allowances appear to have varied even for the same place. The interesting "Extracts from the Proceedings of Lynn Regis, 1430 to 1731," as printed in *Archæologia* (vol. xxiv.), supply evidence of the dealings of that corporation with their parliamentary representatives, as set down in the "Hall Books." The parliamentary warrant was read in the mother-tongue, and sealed after the election of burgesses to serve in the Commons. The manner of election by a committee on the jury principle seems to have

prevailed; thus, in 1433, the king's writ was publicly read for electing members of parliament. "And for electing them the Mayor called two of the twenty-four (the court of Livery) and two of the common council, which four chose two more of the twenty-four, and two of the common council, and they chose four others, who all unanimously chose John Waterden and Thomas Spicer, to be Burgesses in Parliament."

The year previous, the burgesses went to parliament in May, and returned in July, when, as was customary, a report was submitted before the mayor as to the manner in which the corporation had been represented, and how far its interests had been promoted by the members; when accounts were compared and a settlement was agreed upon for wages due, to be raised by a special rate, thus:—

"July 23. John Waterden reported the transactions of Parliament, at which time was granted by the Corporation half a fifteenth, to be paid in at two several payments; viz. at Martinmas next, and at Martinmas then next following. That ye Parliament held from ye 12th day of May to Thursday next before ye feast of St. Margaret, on which day ye Parliament ended, and so ye Parliament held for 70 days. And so there is owing to them, for their appearance for 73 days, 6s. and 8d. for each day, of which they received before their journey or passage one hundred shillings, and there remains £19 6s. 8d."

From this entry it seems evident that these members received 3s. 4d. each. Ten years later, January 10, 1442, two burgesses were chosen, but, for some unexplained cause, the fees were lowered.

"And it was ye same day ordered, by ye assent of ye whole congregation, that ye Burgesses chosen for Parliament shall be allowed each of them two shillings a day and no more."

At the same time, various instructions were given touching renewal and confirmation of the Charter; and the burgesses on their return to Lynn—

"did well and discreetly declare those things which were substantially done and acted for ye Mayor in ye Parliament."

“April 18, 1442. The Burgesses of ye last Parliament ingeniously and seriously related several transactions of ye said Parliament.”

As a qualification to serve, it was, as a rule, deemed essential that the member should be “an individual either bearing office or being resident in the borough,” and persons residing elsewhere were held inadmissible; thus:

“Feb. 1664. Two letters, one from Sir Robert Hitchin, Kt., ye other from Sir Henry Spelman, Kt., desiring to be elected Burgesses for ye next Parliament; forasmuch as ye Statute of ye 1st of Henry 5 (1413) doth appoint that Burgesses should be men residing and free in ye Borough at ye time of their election, it is agreed to answer their letter that ye corporation is minded to chuse according to ye Statute.”

In March, the mayor and recorder were straightway elected burgesses for the next parliament, and enacted under “June 20. The mayor to have ten shillings per day for serving in parliament.” This specially high allowance was possibly due to the extra state which the mayor of a corporation like King’s Lynn would be expected to support in the metropolis, to impress the citizens with the consequence and honour of the borough. The fee speedily dwindled again, and, in 1642, when the kingdom was in a state of ebullition, during the Long Parliament, a general prescript appears to have been instituted as to the fees due to members, and the possible difficulties of collecting them. It is thus noted:—

“Oct. 15. An order from ye House of Commons to ye Mayor, Aldermen, and Common Council, to require them to pay to Mr. Toll and Mr. Percivall, their Burgesses in Parliament, the same allowance as formerly per day, being 5s.”

“1643, Jan. 3. In answer to ye above order to ye House of Commons to acquaint them that heretofore no Parliamentary wages have been paid before ye Parliament ended, nor then out of ye town stock, but by ye freemen and inhabitants, saving of late of mere bounty ye Burgesses were diversely rewarded by ye representative body. Also ye impossibility of performing ye said order, there being no town stock, ye revenues not being sufficient to defray ye necessary charges

in common; besides, extraordinary expenses unavoidably fall upon us daily for ye safety of this town and ye kingdom.”

The Rump Parliament, 1649, had abolished the House of Peers, but some of the Upper Chamber became burgesses to parliament, and this secured admission to the Commons. Lynn Regis came forward hospitably on this emergency, and the head of the proud house of Salisbury had reason to feel grateful for the privilege of being sent to parliament at a time when the order of Peers was abolished through the spontaneous suffrages of the people.

“Jan. 16, 1649. Ordered that a letter be written to ye Right Honble. ye Earl of Salsbury, by ye Mayor from this house, to give him knowledge that this house have granted him ye freedom of this Burgh, and that the *comonalty* of this Burgh hath elected him a Burgess of ye Parliament of England.”

This honour, which had rarity to recommend it, elicited a graceful and earnest letter from the new member.

“THE EARLE OF SALSBURY’S LETTER.

“GENTLEMEN,

“As ye precedent you have made in choosing me to be your Burgess is unusual (I believe), if not ye first among you, so do it lay ye greater obligation upon me, neither is that favour a little heightened by my being so much of a stranger to you as indeed I am; and as you have here an open and free acknowledgment from me of your kind and good affections in so unanimous an election of me to serve you in Parliament, as your letter doth express, so cannot they merit or you expect more thanks than I do really return unto you for them. You have been pleased cheerfully (as you say) to confer your freedom upon me. I shall ever be zealous in maintaining yours, and, as I am not ignorant of the great trust you have placed in me, so shall you never be deceived in it; for ye addresses you are to make me (as your occasion shall require) they shall not be so many as cheerfully received, and

whatsoever may concern the public good or yours, shall ever be pursued with all faithfulness by him that is

“Your very loving friend,
“SALSBURY.”

CHAPTER II.

PARLIAMENTARY LIFE UNDER THE STUARTS; PAID MEMBERS.

The days of the Long Parliament were fruitful in frank out-of-door expressions of opinion under the rule of Charles I. and the Commonwealth; but, although political feelings were embittered, it does not appear that the franchise was exposed to any undue influence worth recording. A certain amount of governmental favour was reckoned of use in isolated instances; this patronage was considered safe to return nominees for such places as the Cinque Ports. But few election squibs, pure and simple, can be discovered before the Restoration. Ballads are less rare; these for the most part deal with the broader party relations, and are confined within discreet limitations, for “privilege of parliament” was rigorously enforced under Cromwell. On the disappearance of the Commonwealth, the spirits of the Cavalier wits and rhymsters revived, with all the more liveliness for their long-enforced repression. As an animated and characteristic example of the ballads produced at the close of the stern conventicle *régime*, we include the *jeux d’esprit* written upon the moribund parliament, when it was no longer formidable,—dissolution having, for the time being, shorn its far-reaching and vengeful claws, while a changed head of the State had rendered its return to a lease of power extremely problematical. It is fair to say that, for the most part, the disappearance of this straight-laced and tyrannical House of Commons was hailed as a national relief: the theory of flying “to ills we know not of” had yet to be realized with the gradual development of the Merry Monarch’s selfish and ruinous system, the most iniquitous ever tolerated.

“A GENERAL SALE OF REBELLIOUS HOUSEHOLD STUFF.

“Rebellion hath broken up House,
And hath left some old Lumber to sell;
Come hither and take your choice—
I'll promise to use you well.
Will you buy th' old Speaker's chair,
Which was warm and easy to sit in,
And oftentimes hath been made clean,
When as it was fouler than fitting?
Will you buy any Bacon-flitches
They're the fattest that ever were spent;
They're the sides of th' old Committees
Fed up with th' Long Parliament.
Here's a pair of bellows and tongs,
And for a small matter I'll sell 'em;
They're made of the Presbyters' lungs
To blow up the Coals of Rebellion.
Here's the besom of Reformation,
Which should have made clean the floor;
But it swept the wealth out of the nation,
And left us dirt good store.
Here's a roll of States tobacco
If any good fellow will take it;
It's neither *Virginia* nor *Spanish*,
But I'll tell you how they do make it;
'Tis *Covenant* mixt with *Engagement*,
With an *Abjuration Oath*;
And many of them that did take it,
Complain it is foul in th' mouth.
A Lantern here is to be bought,
The like was scarce ever begotten,
For many a plot 't has found out,
Before they ever were thought on.
Will you buy the *Rump*'s great saddle
Which once did carry the nation?
And here's the Bit and the Bridle,
And Curb of Dissimulation.
Here's the Breeches of the *Rump*

HERE'S THE BREECHESS OF THE KAMP
With a fair dissembling cloak,
And a *Presbyterian* Jump
With an *Independent* Smock.
Here's Oliver's Brewing vessels,
And here's his Dray and slings;
Here's Hewson's awl and his bristles,
With divers other odd things.
And what doth the price belong
To all these matters before ye?
I'll sell them all for an old song,
And so I do end my story."

From the pages of Pepys we are reminded that members of parliament were paid for their services up to Charles II.'s reign.

It might be expected that the secretary's "Diary" would contain some pertinent observation upon elections; he has set down a good deal upon parliamentary matters that is curious and enlightening, but the diary ceases in May, 1669, and the more remarkable election contests commenced later.

Samuel Pepys was evidently as indifferent as were the courtiers of his day to the relatively vital importance of the Commons to the State. While accompanying the reforming member William Prynne, who had accused Sir G. Carteret of selling places,⁴ from Whitehall to the Temple, the diarist in return for the hospitality of his coach, endeavoured to obtain some information by the way as to the manner of holding parliaments, and whether the number of knights and burgesses were always the same. To which Prynne replied—

"that the latter were not; but that, for aught he can find, they were sent up at the discretion, at first of the Sheriffs, to whom the writs were sent to send up generally the Burgesses and citizens of their county, and he do find that heretofore the Parliament-men, being paid by the country, several boroughs have complained of the Sheriffs putting them to the charge of sending up Burgesses."

This conversation was in January, 1668; in March, Pepys describes his dining with certain counsel retained by creditors of the navy, the secretary having been to Cursitor Street to arrange assignments on the Exchequer to the tune of £1,250,000 in favour of these creditors. The counsel were pleased to flatter Mr. Secretary upon a recent performance of his in the Parliament House, and, finding himself with four learned lawyers, Pepys, with his dinner, enjoyed what he calls “a great deal of good discourse about parliament”—

“their number being uncertain, and always at the will of the king to increase, as he saw reason to erect a new borough. But all concluded the bane of the Parliament hath been the leaving off the old custom of the places allowing wages to those that served them in Parliament, by which they chose men that understood their business and would attend it, and they could expect an account from, which now they cannot, and so the Parliament is become a company of men unable to give account for the interest of the place they serve for.”

Andrew Marvell, member for Hull, who had enjoyed much experience of men and measures, found fit subject for satire among the corrupt comrades who now surrounded him in parliament.

C. That traitors to th' Country in a brib'd House of Commons
Should give away millions at every summons.

W. Yet some of those givers such beggarly villains
As not to be trusted for twice twenty shillings.

C. No wonder that beggars should still be for giving,
Who, out of what's given, do get a good living.

W. Four Knights and a knave, who were burgesses made,
For selling their consciences were liberally paid.

C. How base are the souls of such low-priced sinners,
Who vote with the country for Drink and for Dinners.

W. 'Tis they that brought on us this scandalous yoke,
Of excising our cups, and taxing our smoke.

C. But thanks to the Harlots who made the King dogg'd,
For giving no more the Rogues are prorogued."

(ANDREW MARVELL, 1674: *A Dialogue between Two Horses*.)

From his "good discourse on parliament," Mr. Secretary Pepys, by a happy coincidence, straightway betook himself to that palace, where he had the privilege of being well received, and in which, under the Stuarts, more curious scenes were witnessed than falls to the lot of even the average of princely abodes:—

"Thence to Whitehall, where the Parliament was to wait on the King, and they did: and he did think fit to tell them that they might expect to be adjourned at Whitsuntide, and that they might make haste to raise their money: but this, I fear, will displease them, who did expect to sit as long as they pleased."

A truly regal reception, and a most unceremonious mode of dismissing the "chosen of the people." The wits of the day thus tersely summed up the

situation of affairs:—

“I’ll have a long parliament always to friend,
And furnish my treasure as fast as I spend,
And if they will not, they shall have an end.”
(A. MARVELL: *Royal Resolutions*.)

Perhaps the most felicitous sallies were due to the pen of that gifted reprobate, the Earl of Rochester, at times the *alter ego* of the Merry Monarch, but who finally, after enjoying boundless favour by diverting the king at his own royal expense as often as at that of his subjects, pointed a shaft with too galling a barb, and flitted away from a Court whose vileness he both exposed and shared in equally liberal measure:—

“A parliament of knaves and sots,
Members by name you must not mention,
He keeps in pay, and buys their votes;
Here with a place, there with a pension.
When to give money he can’t cologue ’um,
He doth with scorn prorogue, prorogue ’um.

But they long since, by too much giving,
Undid, betray’d, and sold the nation;
Making their memberships a living
Better than e’er was sequestration.
God give thee, Charles, a resolution
To damn the knaves by Dissolution.”

Later, Pepys is in conference with the king and the Duke of York (April, 1668) upon no less a subject than “about the Quakers not swearing, and how they do swear in the business of a late election of a Knight of the Shire of Hertfordshire in behalf of one they have a mind to have,” which diverts the monarch mightily.

We have seen how the juris-consultists who lived contemporaneously with the system of “paid members” considered the impartiality of representatives was protected from outside influences by the receipt of a small independence; later on we find that, owing to a dispute between the two Chambers, the impression was arrived at by the Peers that no salaried judges can be deemed impartial, and that hereditary legislators are the only reliable tribunals whence unimpeachable justice could be secured.

On a question of privilege between the Lords and Commons (May, 1668), when the latter took upon themselves to remedy an error of the Upper Chamber, Lord Anglesey informed the Commons that the Lords were “*Judices nati et Conciliarii nati*, but all other Judges among us are under salary, and the Commons themselves served for wages; and therefore the Lords, in reason, were the freer Judges.”

The circumstance of receiving a salary does not appear to have compromised the independence of members, but to the contrary, as they were thus enabled to keep their honesty the purer, by resisting the venal attacks of the Court. The integrity of members seems to have suffered when their fees were no longer recognized. The “Pensioner Parliament” came into existence precisely at the epoch when representatives remitted “their wages;” a significant circumstance, but indicative of the times; when selfishness usurped the place of patriotism, members sacrificed the modest retainers designed to keep them honest, that they might be the less fettered to bargain in their own interests.

“The senate, which should head-strong Princes stay,
Let’s loose the reins, and gives the Realm away;
With lavish hands they constant tributes give,
And annual stipends for their guilt receive.”

(ANDREW MARVELL: *An Historical Poem.*)

The proverbial incorruptibility of Andrew Marvell is a case in point. This example of a true patriot is erroneously said to have been the last member who received wages from his constituents. He died in 1678, M.P. for Hull.⁵ Others, his contemporaries, maintained the right, and suffered their arrears to accumulate, as a cheap resource at the next election. Marvell more than once, in his correspondence, speaks of members threatening to sue their boroughs for pay.⁶ Lord Braybrooke, in his notes to Pepys’s “Diary,” refers to a case, noticed by Lord Campbell in his “Life of Lord Nottingham,” where the M.P. for Harwich, in 1681, petitioned the Lord Chancellor, as that borough had failed “to pay him his wages.” A writ was issued “De expensis Burgensium levandis.” Lord Campbell adds, “For this point of the People’s Charter [payment of wages] no new law is required.”⁷

Pepys’s later allusions concern the constantly threatened dissolutions; in November, 1668, he records, “The great discourse now is that the Parliament shall be dissolved and another called, which shall give the King the Dean and Chapter’s lands, and that will put him out of debt,” concluding with a hint that the subtle and “brisk” Duke of Buckingham, at that time the actual ruler of the kingdom, “does knowingly meet daily with Wildman and other Commonwealth-men,” the while deceiving Charles into the belief that his intrigues were of a more tender nature.

At Whitehall, the same month, Pepys acquires some fresh and rather significant information upon the subject of the Commons; it is imparted to him that—

“it was not yet resolved whether the Parliament should ever meet more or no, the three great rulers of things now standing thus:—The Duke of Buckingham⁸ is absolutely against their meeting, as moved thereto by his people that he advises with, the people of the late times, who do

never expect to have anything done by this Parliament for their religion, and who do propose that, by the sale of the Church lands, they shall be able to put the King out of debt: my Lord Keeper is utterly against putting away this and choosing another Parliament, lest they prove worse than this, and will make all the King's friends, and the King himself, in a desperate condition: my Lord Arlington [being under suspicion, owing to his mismanagement of money in Ireland] knows not which is best for him, being to seek whether this or the next will use him worse. It was told me that he believes that it is intended to call this Parliament, and try them for a sum of money; and, if they do not like it, then to send them going, and call another, who will, at the ruin of the Church perhaps, please the King with what he will have for a time."

These passages need no comment, the accepted ideas upon representative government under the House of Stuart were such as to fill constitutional minds with amazement. This view is endorsed by a popular ballad of the day:—

"Would you our sov'reign disabuse,
And make his parliament of use,
Not to be chang'd like dirty shoes?
This is the time."

The inconsistency of the king's behaviour, and the triviality of his mind—when applied to matters of business, and especially that of parliament—is happily held up to ridicule by one of his contemporary wits, who has thus parodied the expected speech from the throne:—

"HIS MAJESTY'S MOST GRACIOUS SPEECH TO BOTH HOUSES OF PARLIAMENT.

"MY LORDS AND GENTLEMEN,

“I told you at our last meeting the Winter was the fittest time for business; and truly I thought so, till my Lord Treasurer assured me the Spring was the best season for salads and subsidies: I hope, therefore, that April will not prove so unnatural a month as not to afford some kind showers on my parched Exchequer, which gapes for want of them. Some of you perhaps will think it dangerous to make me too rich; but I do not fear it, for I promise you faithfully whatever you give me I will always want; and altho’ in other things my word may be thought a slender authority, yet in that you may rely upon me, I will never break it.

“My Lords and Gentlemen, I can bear my straits with patience; but my Lord Treasurer does protest to me, that the Revenue, as it now stands, will not serve him and me too; one of us must pinch for it if you do not help me. I must speak freely to you, I am under circumstances, for, besides my Harlots on service, my reformato Concubines lie heavy upon me. I have a passable good estate, I confess; but, Gads-fish, I have a great charge upon’t. Here’s my Lord Treasurer can tell, that all the money design’d for the next summer’s guards must of necessity be apply’d to the next year’s cradles and swaddling clothes. What shall we do for ships then? I hint this only to you, it being your business, not mine. I know by experience I can live without ships; I liv’d ten years abroad without, and never had my health better in my life; but how you will be without I leave to yourselves to judge, and therefore hint this only by the by; I don’t insist upon it. There’s another thing I must press more earnestly, and that is this. It seems a good part of my revenue will expire in two or three years, except you will be pleased to continue it. I have to say for’t, Pray why did you give me so much as you have done, unless you resolve to give on as fast as I call for it? The nation hates you already for giving so much, and I will hate you too if you do not give me more; so that if you stick not to me, you must not have a friend in England. On the other hand, if you will give me the revenue I desire, I shall be able to do those things for your Religion and Liberty that I have had long in my thoughts, but cannot effect them without a little more money to carry me through. Therefore look to’t, and take Notice that if you do not make me rich enough to undo you, it shall lie at your doors,

for my part I wash my hands on't. But that I may gain your good opinion the best way is to acquaint you what I have done to deserve it out of my royal care for your religion and your property. For the first, my proclamation is a true picture of my mind: he that cannot, as in a glass, see my zeal for the Church of England, does not deserve any farther satisfaction, for I declare him wilful, abominable, and not good. Some may perhaps be startled, and cry—how comes this sudden change? To which I answer I am a changeling, and that's sufficient, I think. But to convince men farther that I mean what I say, there are these arguments. *First*, I tell you so, and you know I never break my word. *Secondly*, my Lord Treasurer says so, and he never told a lie in his life. *Thirdly*, my Lord Lauderdale will undertake it for me, and I should be loth by any act of mine he should forfeit the credit he has with you.

“I must now acquaint you, that by my Lord Treasurer's Advice, I have made a considerable retrenchment upon my expenses in Candles and Charcoal, and do not intend to stop there, but will, with your help, look into the late embezzlements of my dripping-pans and kitchen stuff; of which, by the way, upon my conscience, neither my Lord Treasurer nor my Lord Lauderdale are guilty. I tell you my opinion, but if you should find them dabbling in that business, I tell you plainly I leave 'em to you; for I would have the world know I am not a man to be cheated.

“My Lords and Gentlemen, I desire you to believe me as you have found me; and I do solemnly promise you, that whatsoever you give me shall be specially manag'd with the same conduct, trust, sincerity, and prudence, that I have ever practised since my happy Restoration.”

The commencement of party warfare as now recognized in parliamentary life may be dated from the Stuarts, and to account for the designations of Whig and Tory it is necessary to glance back at the parliamentary troubles of Charles II., 1679-1680, when that monarch, acting

under the encouragement of Louis XIV., was inclined to make a misguided attempt to govern without a legislative chamber. In 1679 the monarch refused a Speaker to his Commons, finding that functionary obnoxious; and between this date and 1681 parliament was prorogued seven times: in fact—as a summary of Charles II.'s parliaments discloses—the discords of the previous reign were revived; the “town and country party” petitioned zealously for the reassembling of parliament, while the Court party counter-petitioned “to declare their *abhorrence* of the late tumultuary petitioning.” Those who were urging on the struggle for popular representation and freedom were designated *Petitioners*, the king’s “friends” were voted “betrayers of the liberties of the people, and abettors of arbitrary power,” and expressively stigmatized as *Abhorrrers*;⁹ from these two parties, which were ready to exterminate one another, arose the nicknames of Whigs and Tories, as is explained in Tindal’s “Rapin.”¹⁰

The “Abhorrrers,” who were the mainstay of Charles’s utterly unconstitutional procedure, although as courtiers they hoped for their reward from the king, did not get much tolerance from the Commons: when the parliament at last reassembled, several members were expelled from the House on this pretence alone, and they consigned to the Tower that Sir Francis Withers who had been knighted for procuring and presenting the loyal address from the city of Westminster; the majority at the same time recording, as a gage of battle to their opponents, the resolution (October, 1680), “That it is the undoubted right of the subject to petition for the calling of a parliament, and that to traduce such petitions as tumultuous and seditious is to contribute to the design of altering the constitution.” The Tories at that time and long after maintained the doctrines of “divine hereditary indefeasible right, lineal succession, passive obedience, prerogative, etc.”

That a determined attitude was felt to be fitting is exhibited in the protests of the House, printed for circulation, like the following:—

“Wednesday, October 27, 1680.

“Two Unanimous votes of this present Honourable and Worthy Parliament concerning the subjects’ rights in Petitioning.

”Resolved, Nemine Contradicente,—

That it is and ever hath been the undoubted Right of the subjects of England to petition the King for calling and sitting of parliaments, and redressing of Grievances.

“Resolved, Nemine Contradicente,—

That to traduce such Petitioning is a violation of duty, and to represent it to his Majesty as Traitorous and seditious, is to betray the Liberty of the Subjects, and contributes to the design of subverting the ancient, legal Constitution of this Kingdom, and the Introducing Arbitrary Power.

*”Ordered—*That a Committee be appointed to enquire of all those Persons as have offended against these Rights of the subject.

“London: Printed for Francis Smith, Bookseller, at the Elephant and Castle, near the Royal Exchange in Cornhill.”

Francis Smith was the publisher—

“who suffered a Chargeable Imprisonment in the Gaol of Newgate, in December last, for printing and promoting Petitions for the Sitting of this present Parliament.”

He is referred to with acrimony in the ballads by Tantivy and courtier bards, among the “pestiferous crew of republican scribes.”

Charles’s first parliament was, amid the confusion of the time (the revolution subverted and royalty restored), barely constituted; it lasted from April 25, 1660, to December 29th, and, being assembled without the king’s writ, was, with customary royal ingratitude for “past favours,” considered by Charles as the *Convention* Parliament.¹¹ The long *Cavalier Parliament*, some portion of which, like the king, was in the pay of Louis XIV., is stigmatized to posterity as the “Pensionary” Parliament; it met May 8, 1661, and lasted until January 24, 1679; the members were doubly corrupt,

accepting money-bribes or lucrative offices from the Court, or being, according to Barillon's clear declarations, in the pay of France and Holland, as regarded the patriotic members, who fiercely denounced the venality of the Court. In 1675 the oath against bribery was opportunely inaugurated, providing against corruption either from the Crown or from any ambassador or foreign minister. The Pensionary Parliament, which began its career by servile loyalty, and was merciless against Republicans, towards its close opposing the unreasonable extension of prerogative became factious and insubordinate, arrogating to itself the control of legal procedure, and, according to the opinions of extreme Royalists, generally proving itself a "scourge."

The popular view of this venal legislature is given in the following version:—

"A PENSIONER PARLIAMENT:

ANSWER TO THE BALLAD CALLED 'THE CHEQUER INN.'

"I.

"Curse on such representatives!
They sell us all, our bairns and wives,
(Quoth Dick with indignation);
They are but engines to raise tax,
And the whole business of their acts
Is to undo the nation.

"II.

“Just like our rotten pump at home,
We pour in water when ’twon’t come,
And that way get more out,
So when mine host does money lack,
He money gives among the pack,
And then it runs full spout.

“III.

“By wise Volk, I have oft been told,
Parliaments grow nought as they grow old,
We groan’d under the Rump,
But sure this is a heavier curse,
That sucks and drains thus ev’ry purse,
By this old Whitehall pump.”

Another warning note is struck in the following ballad, aimed at the reprobated Pensionary Parliament:—

“THE PARLIAMENT HOUSE TO BE LET.

“1678.

“Here’s a House to be let,
For Charles Stuart swore
By Portsmouth’s honour
He would shut up the door.

“Enquire at the Lodgings
Next door to the pope,
At Duke Lauderdale’s head
With a cravat of Rope,

“And there you will hear
How next he will let it,
If you pay the old price
You may certainly get it.

“He holds it in-tail
From his Father, who fast
Did keep it long shut,
But paid for’t at last.”

Charles II.’s third, or *Habeas Corpus* Parliament, showed a determination to exceed its predecessor in opposing the Court, and seemed ambitious of imitating that of 1640, the reminiscences of which were still of a portentous character, and filled with dread as regarded the survivors of those uncompromising times:—

“The *Habeas Corpus* act is past,
And so far we are safe;
He can’t imprison us so fast,
But straight we have relief;
He can’t deny us aught we ask,
In so much need he stands;
And before that we do money give,
We’ll tie up both his hands.”

Charles very naturally found this parliament beyond his control, so it was prorogued May 27, 1679, to the 14th of August, but dissolved on the 10th of July. The whole country was in commotion during August and September in electioneering contests, preparing for the fourth parliament. It is to be regretted that electioneering broadsides have, as a rule, been allowed to perish; they would prove a mine of curious information.

The following is a pertinent allusion to the eventualities of the “poll:”—

“But most men did think
He had not so much chink,
Nor could pay for the poll of the County,
And therefore did fear
It would cost them too dear
Should they accept of his Bounty.”

(The Worcestershire Ballad.)

The opprobrious terms of Whigs and Tories were freely exchanged. Here is a Whig’s view of the “king’s men:”—

“As Rascals changing rags for scarlet coats,
Cudgell’d before, set up to cut Whig throats.”

The wit lay rather with the Cavaliers, though it must be confessed their opponents had the best of the argument when reasoning on facts.

The definition of the nickname *Tory*, as it originally arose, is given in “A New Ballad” (Narcissus Luttrell’s Collection):—

“The word *Tory*’s of Irish Extraction,
'Tis a Legacy that they have left here,
They came here in their brogues,
And have acted like Rogues,
In endeavouring to learn us to Swear.”

By way of answer, the Tories exulted in their loyalty:—

“Let Tories guard the King,
Let Whigs on halters swing.”

The Court party denounced—

“Visions, Seditions,
And railing Petitions.”

The designs of the various factions were thus summed up:—

“Sir Tom would hang the *Tory*,
And let the *Whig* go free:
Sir Bob would have a Commonwealth
And cry down Monarchy.”

The Tories retaliated upon their antagonists with interest, though they feared the zealots not a little, as the following ballad illustrates:—

“What! Still ye *Whigs* uneasie!
Will nothing cool your brain,
Unless Great *Charles*, to please ye,
Will let ye drive his Wain?
That *Peer-less* House of Commons,
So zealous for the Lord,
Meant (piously) with some on’s
To flesh the Godly sword.”
(*A Tory in a Whig’s Coat.*)

One of the most popular “counter-blasts” to the Whig pretensions is embodied in the following parody, which enjoyed considerable favour, though not equal to Andrew Marvell’s diatribes “on the other side:”—

“A LITANY FROM GENEVA,

IN ANSWER TO A LITANY FROM ST. OMER.

“From the force and the fire of th’ Insolent Rabble
That would hurl the Government into a Babel,
And from the nice fare of the Mouse-starver’s table,
Libera nos Domine.

“From a surfeit occasion’d by Protestant feasts
From Sedition for sauce, and Republicks for guests,
With Treason for Grace-cup, or Faction at least,
Libera nos.

“From the blind Zeal of all Democratical tools,
From Whigland, and all its Anarchical rules,
Devisèd by knaves and imposèd by fools.
Libera nos.

“From Parliamentarians, that out of their Love
And care for his Majesty’s safety, would prove
The securest way were his Guards to remove.
Libera nos.

“From a Protestant Church where a Papist must reign,
From an Oxford Parliament call’d in vain,
Who because Fitz-Harris the plot would make plain,
Was dissolv’d in a fit and sent home again.
Libera nos.”

The newly elected parliament, the materials of which were equally unpalatable to the Court party, was summoned to meet in October, 1679, but, prorogued during the royal pleasure, it did not actually meet until October 21, 1680. The interval was marked by the presentation of loyal addresses and petitions for its reassembling. Further prorogued on the 10th of January, it was dissolved on the 18th, to be followed by the “Oxford Parliament” of eight days, which was dissolved on March 28, 1681. The nation saw itself on the verge of civil war, and, remembering what it had suffered—while opposing the encroachments of the Crown and autocratic

exactions—from the opposite extremes of anarchy and fanaticism, the people were resigned to temporize, and thus Charles was allowed to rule without a parliament until his death.

The following satire is well-founded, and pertinent to the prevalent state of affairs:—

“THE STATESMAN’S ALMANACK.

Being an excellent new Ballad, in which the qualities of each month are considered, whereby it appears that a parliament cannot meet in any of the old months; with a proposal for mending the Calendar. Humbly offered to the packers of the next parliament,”

—which, as it fell out, never reassembled during the reign of the Merry Monarch. The rhymster, after rehearsing the sufficient reasons why every month, from January to December, is unfitted, according to the royal inclinations, for the assembling of a parliament, concludes with a prayer by way of—

EPILOGUE.

“Ye Gypsies of Rome
That run up and down,
And with miracles the people cozen,

By the help of some saint
Get the month which you want
And make up a baker’s dozen.

“You see the old Year
Won’t help you ’tis clear,
And therefore to save your Honour,
Get a new Sun and Moon,
And the work may be done,
And ’fore *George* it will never be sooner.”

The political squibs of this time are chiefly written by Cavaliers, and give a one-sided view, from which, however, much may be gathered. Though not actually election addresses, they refer to the claims which the electors of the kingdom found themselves constrained to address to the throne.

Among the collection of “Bagford Ballads,” so capably edited and illustrated by J. W. Ebsworth, M.A.,¹² is a group of parliamentary election ballads, apparently of the date 1679-80, and relating to Essex, Buckinghamshire, Wiltshire, and the Universities. The Titus Oates plot; the Duke of York and his threatened exclusion from the succession; the impeachment by the Commons of a secretary of State, of Lord Danby, lord-treasurer; with the opposing designs of the Papists and the rabid Dissenters; and, above all, the petitions and the counter-petitions, seem the leading topics of these satires: but they do not contain much enlightenment upon elections, pure and simple. “The Essex Ballad,” humorously explains the *modus operandi* of the “abhorred” petitions.

“In Essex, much renowned for Calves,
And giving verdicts in by halves,
For Oysters, Agues, and for Knaves
Of Faction,

One Peer, and men of worship four,
With gentlemen some half a score,
Did draw in ten Dutch Ells of Bore
To Action.¹³

The Squire, whose name does famous grow
As Marcus Tullius Cicero,
And keeps true time with Sir A. Carew
And Ashley.¹⁴

As freely gave himself his hand,
As once his voice to rule the Land
By such as should not understand
Too rashly.

The Rout, that erst did roar so loud,
A Mildmay and a Honeywood,¹⁵
Are of their choice now grown so proud
You’d wonder:

And these State-Tinkers must be sent
To stop the leaks of Government,
Grown crazy now, and almost rent
In sunder.

His Honour first set all his hands,
Each member next in order stands;
The rabble, without ‘ifs and ands,’
Sub-scratch it.

The Cause, not obsolete, though old,
Like Insects lay in winter cold,
And warm Petitions (they were told)
Would hatch it.

Corn bore a price in Cromwell’s days,
Nor did we want a vent for bays;
Nay, even calves were several ways
Advanced.

And then we fear’d not wicked plots —

And then we fear a hot-winded plot,
The Godly serv'd to cut our throats,
Though agents for the Pope, as Oates

And Prance¹⁶ said.

Those reasons did so much prevail,
That they petition'd tooth and nail,
To have the Sovereign strike sail,

And stand by:

While th' Parliament had sate some years,
To drive out Pope with Presbyteers,
And try the Babylonish Peers

And Danby."¹⁷

The grievances of the petitioning constituencies are farcically rehearsed, the king is prayed that he will not "quite forget the Senate," and the writer goes on to describe the signatories of this "Anti-Popish Bull." When all hands had been set to the roll, it was found that—

“Several yards of fist,
 Were wanting to complete the list
Sans scruple.
 Those scholars that could write, they bribe
 To prompt and proxy every side;
 And these did personally subscribe
Centuple.
 But now the time draws on apace,
 And member itches for his place,
 The knights and gentlemen five brace
Assemble;
 And brought the muster-roll to Court
 Tho’ Charles did hardly thank ’em for’t;
 But made ’em with a sharp retort
To tremble.
 Now God preserve our King and Queen
 From Pyebald Coats and ribbons green,
 Let neither knave nor fool be seen
About ’em.
 And those that will not say *Amen*,
 Let ’em petition once again,
 For every one, the Shire has ten
To rout ’em.”

“Ribbons green,” were the badges of the Protestant Association, at the head of which was Shaftesbury, “the popular favourite,” or “Sejanus,” as his enemies designated him. *Vide* “A Litany from Geneva:”—

“From Saucy Petitions that serve to inflame us,
 From all who for th’ Association are famous,
 From the *Devil*, the *Doctor*, and the d——d *Ignoramus*,
Libera nos Domine.

The obstinate and infatuated zealots, who would insist on keeping up the pretence that parliaments were essential to the constitutional government of the kingdom, were, with the suspected association, treated to all the witticisms Cavalier balladists could bring to bear against preposterous attempts to assail the royal prerogative, and enforce the just balance of the State:—

“’Tis to preserve his Majesty,
That we against him rise,
The righteous cause can never die
That’s manag’d by the wise.
Th’ *Association*’s a just thing,
And that does seem to say,
Who fights for us, fights for the King,
The clean contrary way.”
(“*A Hymn exalting the Mobile to
Loyalty.*”)

The members representing Buckingham town in the fourth parliament of Charles II., 1679, were Lord Latimer and Sir Richard Temple.

“Of thirteen men there were but six
Who did not merit hemp well,
The other seven play their tricks
For Latimer and Temple.”

The Buckingham ballad, “The Sale of Esau’s Birthright,” which relates to these members, is interesting from an electioneering point, as proving bribery, and as showing there were only thirteen electors of this limited constituency concerned in this particular return. Six voted, according to a list at the end of the ballad, “for their king and country,” and seven for Lord Latimer and Sir *Timber* Temple (the Earl of Danby, in another version), “for popery and their Town Hall” (“Sir R. T. his Timber, Chimney-money and Court,” according to another version). It seems certain that Sir Richard

Temple had offered a present of timber for the Town Hall—in fact, some years later he is called “Timber Temple” (“State Poems”)—which was regarded as a bribe; it also appears that some delay had arisen in its payment.

“Our prating Knight doth owe his call
To Timber, and his Lady;
Though one goes longer with Town-Hall,
Than t’other with her baby.

“The Bailiff¹⁸ is so mad a spark
(Though h’ lives by tanning leather),
That for a load of Temple’s bark,
He’d sacrifice his father.”

The other electors were a barber, two maltsters, a baker, and a farmer; the peppery ballad castigates the former, and concludes with a groan against the members returned:—

“Thus Buckingham hath led the way
To popery and sorrow;
Those seven Knaves who make us slaves,
Would sell their God to-morrow.”¹⁹

“The Wiltshire²⁰ Ballad,” also belonging to this so-called “group of election ballads,” professes to be—

“A new Song, composed by an old Cavalier,
Of wonders at Sarum by which doth appear,
That th’ old Devil came again lately there,
To raise a Rebellion
By way of Petition.

“From Salisbury, that low Hous’d Town,
Where steeple is of high renown,
Of late was brought unto the Crown
A Lesson:

’Twas drawn up by three worthy wights,
Members they were, and two were Knights,
Great trencher-men, but no one fights
Mompesson.²¹

Through discontent his Hand did set
First to the scroll without regret,
Then pilgrim-like travel’d to get
Some others,
From house to house, in Town and Close,
Our zealous Preservator goes;
Tells them of dangers and of Foes;

But smothers
The true intent of what they bring,
Who beg’d the House may sit; a thing
Which only can preserve the King,
When nothing
Destroys him more; for should he give
Consent, he’d never that retrieve,
But part with his Prerogative;

A low thing
Make himself by ’t, the rabble get
Into his high Imperial seat
They’d make him Gloriously Great!
We trow it.

They serv’d his Father so before,
These Saints would still increase the store
Of Roval Martyrs, Hum! no more,

We know it.
 The herd of zealots long to see
 A monarch, but in effigie,
 A project which appears to be
 Most witty;
 And they at helm aspire to sit,
 There govern without fear or wit,
 King and un-king when they think fit;
 That's pretty.
 To see ('twould make a Stoic smile)
*Geneva Jack*²² thus moil and toil
 To Lord it in our British Isle
 Again, Sir;
 And 'Pulpit-Cuff' us till we fight,
 Lose our Estates and lives outright;
 And when all's done, he gets all by 't,
 That's plain, Sir.
 But this, I hope, nor make no mars
Charles knows what's meant by all these jars,
 And these domestic paper-wars,
 Conceive it;
Tom of Ten Thousand,²³ is come in,
 Sure such a hero much will win,
 On skulls as thick, as his is *Thin*,
 Believe it
 The people would have power to call
 Parliaments, and dissolve them; all
 Regalias possess; what shall
 The Saint, Sir,
 Not have the power of Peace and War?
 Religion steer? Holy we are,
 And rich, the King shall we (be 't far)
 Acquaint, Sir?"

The Court party lost no opportunity of abusing their opponents of the
 Constitutional and Protestant party; they not only did the Whigs the favour

to hate them cordially, but, as their own satires abundantly demonstrate, they also dreaded and feared them not a little.

The more sober-sided attacks came from the opponents of overstrained prerogative and those who upheld the popular rights of representation against absolute monarchy; witness the following:—

“PLAIN DEALING,

Or a Second Dialogue between Humphrey and Roger, as they were returning home from choosing Knights of the Shire to sit in Parliament.

(PRINTED FOR T. B.)

Roger. Well overtook, neighbour. I see you are not a man of your word; did you not promise me, when we last met, that you would vote for our old members, that sat in the last Parliament, to be Knights of the Shire, to sit in the parliament at Oxford.

Humphrey. I thought to do so, but, by my brown cow, I have been over-persuaded to the contrary by my Landlord and his Chaplain, *Mr. Tantivie*, and a pestilent fine man, I think they said he was a courtier, that lay at my Landlord's house; and what with arguments and wine, they drew aside my heart, and made me vote against my conscience.

Roger. 'Twas ill done, neighbour *Numps*, but all their artifices would not do, we have carried it by some hundreds for our old members, that stood so bravely for their country.

Humphrey. I am glad of it with all my heart, for, to tell you truly, tho' my landlord had my voice, the old members had my heart, and I'll never do so again.

Roger. I hear most of the Counties in England are of the same mind, and all the Burgess Towns, Cities, and Corporations; but what arguments could they use to alter thy mind?

Humphrey. First, I say, they made me continually drunk, and then my Landlord asked me so very civilly, and gave me so many good words, and fine promises what a kind Landlord he would be, that I forgot all your instructions; and methought he had invincible arguments to persuade me.

Roger. What were they?

Humphrey. Nay, I have forgot them; but I thought no Counsellor-at-Law, nor any Bishop, could have contradicted them: I now remember one argument that took with me; you know I was ever for the King, and he told me the King did not love the old Parliament-men, and therefore I should not vote for them; but I, being bold, asked him how he knew that.

Roger. What said he then?

Humphrey. Why he laid me as flat as a flounder, that is, he fully convinced me, for, said he, if the King had loved them he would not have dissolved them. I think that was demonstrable.

Roger. 'Tis no matter, tho' the King did not love them, they lov'd you and your country, and you should so far have loved yourself, as not to have betrayed your own interest. What said the Courtier?

Humphrey. 'Faith he said not much to me, but I suppose he had said enough to my Landlord.

Roger. And was this all your Landlord said to you? Had you nothing to say for yourself? You spoke rationally the last time we were together.

Humphrey. Nay, I was forward enough to speak I'll assure you; and I told them I was sure our old members would be for the rooting up of Popery, and would stand stiffly against Arbitrary Government.

Roger. What said they then?

Humphrey. My Landlord laughed at me, and told me I had been among the *Presbyterian Whigs*, and bid me have a care of being cheated into Rebellion, by those two words *Popery* and *Arbitrary Government*. Then he showed me a printed paper, I think he called it *The Mistress of Iniquity*, which showed as plain as the nose on my face, that in '41 they did as we do now, and by that means they brought one King to the block, and so they would now do by our present Sovereign, God bless him.

Roger. Alas! alas! and that frightened you, did it?

Humphrey. Frighted me, ay marry did it, and I think 'twould affright any honest man; you know I was always a King's man, and I would be taught to join with those, or give my Voice for such, who, under the notion of crying against Popery and Arbitrary Government, would pull down the King and the Bishops, and set up a Commonwealth again.

Roger. Well, *Numps*, I believe thee to be an honest man, and there be many in this land of thy condition, that are not of any great reach in policies and tricks of State Mountebanks, and so may be easily persuaded, upon false grounds, to betray your country, your liberties, your lives, and religion.

Humphrey. Nay, that was not all; he then read another printed paper, with a hard name, I think it was *Hercules Rideing*, or something of jest and earnest which I laughed heartily at, and methought there were some things called '*Querks*,' which made a jingling and noise in my ears, that I thought there was some spell in it, for it seemed to join with *Mistress Iniquity*, to make all the Presbyterians traitors, and most of the people of England mad and factious.

Roger. There is as much heed to be given to these pamphlets as to the jingling of Morrice-bells. They are hired to set the people together by the ears, and are Papists in masquerade; things set up to affright the people out of their senses, with the buy leave of '41; wise men see through them, honest men are not affrighted at them, and fools and knaves only are led aside by them.

Humphrey. But don't we do now as formerly, before the late wars? don't we run in just the same steps as they did, who caused all the late bloody doings, as those pamphlets would make us believe?

Roger. I cannot tell what they mean by roads and highways; pray Hodge, we are now riding in the High-road to the next market-town; before the last Assizes, in this very road three or four Highwaymen rode in it too, and robbed several persons, and committed many

villainous murders, and were at last caught and hanged for it; now therefore, because we are riding in the same Highway, must we honest men be accounted thieves, robbers, and murderers, and all others who travel this road? that's a hard case.

Humphrey. You say right, neighbour Hodge, tho' the gallows stand in the highway, we need not run our Heads against it, nor do anything to deserve it.

Roger. Shall not the people who feel the burden and groan under the oppression, and, having no other way of redress but a parliament, desire and petition for one, and cry out against such illegal and unjust proceedings, but presently they must be termed by these fellows seditious, factious, and such as would dethrone the King, and pull down the Bishops? Then all men must hereafter be afraid to speak, to vote, or to petition against grievances, lest they should be termed rebels, villains, and traitors.

Humphrey. O neighbour, my heart trembles! what a rogue was I to vote at random, when our all lies at stake! I did not think we had put such a trust into the hands of our Parliament-men; I thought, alas, as many do, that we chose only for form-sake, and that they were only called to Parliament to give the King money, and to do what he would have them; and we have paid so many taxes already, and given so much money, that I wished in my heart there would be no more parliaments in my days.

Roger. You see you were mistaken; 'tis the greatest trust that can be put into the hands of men, when we send to the parliament our representatives, for we entrust them with our religion, lives, liberties, and property, all we have; for they may preserve them to us, give them from us, and therefore, neighbour, we ought to be careful in whom we put this great trust, and not be persuaded by our Landlord or any flattering Courtier, or '*horn-winding Tantivie*' of them all, to choose

those whom we know not, and are not well assured of, and that we dare not confide in.”

Equally sound in argument is the following:—

“A SPEECH WITHOUT DOORS MADE BY A PLEBEIAN TO
HIS NOBLE FRIENDS.

(PRINTED FOR B. T. 1681.)

Parliaments have been wont to take up some space at the first Meetings to settle the House, and to determine of unlawful elections, and in this point they never had greater cause to be circumspect than at this time: For by an abuse lately crept in, there is introduced a custom, which, if it be not seen and prevented, will be a great derogation of the honour, and a weakening of the power of your House, where the law giveth a freedom to Corporations to elect Burgesses, and forbiddeth any indirect course to be taken in their Elections, many of the Corporations are so base-minded and timorous, that they will not hazard the indignation of a Lord Lieutenant’s letter, who, under-hand, sticks not to threaten them, if he hath not the Election of the Burgesses, and not they themselves.

And commonly those that the Lords recommend are such as desire it for protection, or are so ignorant of the place they serve for, as that there being occasion to speak of the Corporation for which they are chosen, they have asked their neighbours sitting by, whether it were a sea or a land town?

The next thing that is required is *Liberty of Speech*, without which Parliaments have little force or power; speech begets doubts, and resolves them; and doubts in speeches beget understanding; he that doubts much, asketh often, and learns much; and he that fears the worst, soonest prevents a mischief.

This privilege of speech is anciently granted by the testimony of Philip Cominus, a stranger,²⁴ who prefers our parliaments, and the

freedom of the subject in them, above all other Assemblies; which Freedom, if it be broken or diminished, is negligently lost since the days of Cominus.

If Freedom of Speech should be prohibited, when men with modesty make repetition of the grievances and enormities of the kingdom; when men shall desire Reformation of the wrongs and injuries committed, and have no relation of evil thoughts to his Majesty, but with open heart and zeal, express their dutiful and reverent respect to him and his service; I say, if this kind of Liberty of Speech be not allowed in time of Parliaments, they will extend no farther than to Quarter-Sessions, and their Meetings and Assemblies will be unnecessary, for all means of disorder now crept in, and all remedies and redresses will be quite taken away.

As it is no manners to contest with the King in his Election of his Councillors and servants (for Kings obey no men, but their laws), so it were a great negligence, and part of Treason, for a subject not to be free in speech against the abuses, wrongs, and offences that may be occasioned by Persons in authority. What remedy can be expected from a prince to a subject, if the enormities of the kingdom be concealed from him? or what King so religious and just in his own nature, that may not hazard the loss of the hearts of his subjects, without this Liberty of Speech in Parliament? For such is the misfortune of most princes, and such is the happiness of subjects where Kings' affections are settled, and their loves so far transported to promote servants, as they only trust and credit what they shall inform.

In this case, what subject dares complain? or what subject dares contradict the words or actions of such a servant, if it be not warranted by Freedom of a Parliament, they speaking with humility? for nothing obtaineth favour with a King, so much as diligent obedience.

The surest and safest way betwixt the King and his people, which hath the least scandal of partiality, is, with indifference, and integrity, and sincerity, to examine the grievances of the Kingdom, without touching the person of any man, further than the cause giveth the occasion: for otherwise, you shall contest with him that hath the

prince's ears open to hearken to his enchanting tongue, he informs secretly, when you shall not be admitted to excuses, he will cast your deserved malice against him, to your contempt against the King; and so will make the prince the shield of his revenge.

These are the sinister practices of such servants to deceive their Sovereigns; when our grievances shall be authentically proved, and made manifest to the world by your pains to examine and freedom to speak. No prince can be so affectionate to a servant, or such an enemy to himself, as not to admit of this indifferent proceeding: if his services be allowable and good, they will appear with glory; if bad, your labour shall deserve thanks both of Prince and country.

When justice shall thus shine, people will be animated to serve their King with integrity; for they are naturally inclined to imitate their princes in good or bad.



If any man shall pervert this good meaning and motion of yours, and inform his Majesty, *'Tis a Derogation from his Honour to yield to his subjects upon Conditions*, his Majesty shall have good cause to prove such men's eyes malicious and unthankful, and thereby to disprove them in all their outer actions; for what can it lessen the reputation of a Prince whom the subject only and wholly obeyeth, that a *Parliament* which his Majesty doth acknowledge to be his highest Council, should advise him, and he follow the advice of such a Council? What dishonour rather were it to be advised and ruled by one Councillor alone, against whom there is just one exception taken of the whole Commonwealth?

Marcus Portio saith, that that Commonwealth is everlasting, where the Prince seeks to get obedience and love, and the subjects to gain the affection of the Prince; and that Kingdom is unhappy where their Prince is served out of ends and hope of reward, and hath no other assurance of them but their service."

The substitution of Oxford, “the hot-bed of Toryism,” for Westminster as the place of assembly for what proved Charles II.’s last parliament, was violently opposed by the members, who naturally resented this royal manœuvre of cutting off the representatives from the protection of the citizens. A petition remonstrating against the change was presented by Essex and sixteen other Peers; this darkly set forth dangers to the Crown, and reminded the king of the disasters which had always followed similar departures from the rule of London parliaments. Charles frowned, but took no heed. The parliament, forced into submission, attended at Oxford, Shaftesbury and other adherents taking with them a body-guard of armed retainers, citizens of London, wearing the Association green ribbons, with the legend, “No Popery: no Slavery!”

“Who was ’t gave out, that a thousand Watermen
Had all conspir’d to Petition, when
The parliament to Oxford were conven’d,
That they might sit at Westminster for them;
But ne’er were heard of more than Smith and Ben?²⁵
Who was ’t endeavour’d all that preparations
To guard the City Members in their stations
To Oxford; which look’d far more Arbitrary
Than *Forty-One*, or absolute Old Harry.”

The doctors were dispossessed from their seats to make way for the legislators:—

“The safety of the King and ’s Royal Throne
Depends on those five hundred Kings alone.”

Parliament met March 21, 1681. Of its short existence of eight days, three were consumed in formalities, the choice of a Speaker, and other preliminaries. The course of the action of the members was predetermined. They were to insist on the banishment and exclusion of the Duke of York from the succession. The impeachment was to be proceeded with of Fitz-

Harris, who was imprisoned and awaiting trial, on an information of Everard, for being the author of a treasonable libel; it was understood, or at least expected, that the Duchess of Portsmouth and others of the Court would be implicated in his confession. The Lords voted that he should be proceeded against at Common Law, by which decision the Commons were craftily involved in a struggle for privilege and power with the Peers, who were also less impatient than themselves to carry the Exclusion Bill, the Lower House resolving that “it is the undoubted right of the Commons in parliament assembled to impeach before the Lords in parliament any Peer or Commoner for treason or any other crime or misdemeanour; and that the refusal of the Lords to proceed in parliament upon such impeachment is a denial of justice and a violation of the constitution.”²⁶

This squabble between the two branches of the legislature exactly answered the king’s occasions; he made this a pretence for again dissolving the parliament, thus saving his brother and the Duchess of Portsmouth from the designs of the Commons. As it was, Charles coolly dismissed them as impracticable and useless, telling them, “he perceived there were great heats between the Lords and Commons, and their beginnings had been such as he could expect no good success of this parliament, and therefore thought fit to dissolve them.” This was on the 28th of March. On this point the Rev. J. W. Ebsworth, M.A., who has edited the “Bagford Ballads,” which illustrate the last years of the Stuarts, remarks—

“Had they been in London, there can be no doubt they would have resisted, calling the City to support them, and voted themselves permanent, to the defiance of the King and a commencement of civil war. He saw their plan, and conquered them.”

It was the lesson of “forty-one” to be taught again, as was prophetically hinted by “the ghost of the late Parliament to the New One to meet at Oxford.” In reference to the tyranny of the Commons, as opposed to the absolutism of the Crown, we find a *Loyal Poem*, entitled—

“THE PARLIAMENT DISSOLVED AT OXFORD.

March 28, 1681.

“Under five hundred kings Three Kingdoms grone:
Go, Finch,²⁷ Dissolve them, Charles is on the throne,
And by the grace of God, will reign alone.

“The Presbyterians, sick of too much freedom,
Are ripe for Bethle’em, it’s high time to bleed ’em,
The Second Charles does neither fear nor need ’em.

“I’ll have the world know that I can dissipate
Those *Impolitick Mushrooms of our State*,
’Tis easier to *dissolve* than to *create*.

“They shan’t cramp Justice with their feigned flaws;
For since I govern only by the Laws, (!)
Why they should be exempt, I see no cause.”

The actual “Oxford Poem” in the Bagford Collection is addressed:—

“ON PARLIAMENT REMOVING FROM LONDON TO OXFORD.

“You London lads be merry,
Your Parliament friends have gone
That made us all so sorry
And would not leave us alone.”

“THE WHIGS’ DOWNFALL.

“To perfect which, they made their choice
Of parliaments of late,
Of members that had nought but voice,
And Megrimms in their pate.
Wi Williams he the Speaker was,
And is’t not wondrous strange;
The reason’s plain, he told it was,
Because they would not change;
He told you truth, nor think it strange;
He knew well their intent,
They never meant themselves to change,
But change the Government.
For now cry they ‘The King’s so poor,
He dares not with us part;
And therefore we most loyally
Will break his royal heart.’”

For a fine, ancient, divine-right-of-kings effusion commend us to the following full-flavoured High Tory manifesto:—

“TO MR. E. L. ON HIS MAJESTY’S DISSOLVING THE LATE
PARLIAMENT AT OXFORD.

“An Atheist now must a Monster be,
Of strange gigantic birth
His omnipotence does let all men see,
That our King’s a God on earth.

“*Fiat*, says he, by proclamation,
And the parliament is created:
He repents of his work, the Dissolution
Makes all annihilated.

“We Scholars were expell’d awhile,
To let the Senators in;
But they behav’d themselves as vile,
So we return again:

“And wonder to see our Geometry School
All round about be-seated,
Though there’s no need of an Euclid’s rule
To demonstrate ’em all defeated.

“The Commons their Voting Problems would
In Riddles so involve,
That what the Peers scarce understood,
The King was forc’d to solve.

“The Commons for a good omen chose
An old consulting station:
Being glad to dispossess their foes
O th’ House of Convocation.

“So Statesmen like poor scholars be,
For near the usual place
They stood, we know, for a great Degree,
But the King deny’d their Grace.

“Though sure he must his reason give,
And charge them of some crime:
Or else by course they’ll have relieve

Or else by course they'll have reprieve
For this is the *Third time*.

"It was because they did begin,
With insolent behaviour:
And who should expiate their sin
The King himself's no Saviour.

"Their faults grew to a bulk so high,
As mercy did fore-stall:
So Charter forfeited thereby,
They must like Adam fall.

"It is resolv'd the Duke shall fail
A Sceptre to inherit:
Nor right nor desert shall prevail,
'Tis Popish to plead merit.

"Let the King respect the Duke his brother,
And keep affection still,
As duly to the Church his mother:
In both they'll cross his will.

"They would Dissenters harmless save,
And penalties repeal;
As if they'd humour thieves, who crave
A liberty to steal.

"Thus he that does a pardon lack
For Treason damn'd to dy.
They'd tempt, poor man, to save his neck,
By adding perjury.²⁸

"The Nobles threw th' Impeachment out²⁹
Because, no doubt, they saw
'Twas best to bring his cause about,
But not to th' *Commons Law*.

"But hence 'twas plaguily suspected,

Nay, 'tis resolv'd by vote,
That th' Lords are popishly affected,
And stiflers of the plot.

“The Commons' courage can't endure
To be affronted thus:
So, for the future to be sure,
They'll be the Upper House.

“But by such feverish malady,
Their strength so soon was spent
That punning wits no doubt will cry—
Oh, Weeked Parliament!”

CHAPTER III.

PARLIAMENTS AND ELECTIONEERING UNDER JAMES II., WILLIAM III., AND QUEEN ANNE.

With the accession of James II. a fresh era of parliament commences. It was the first object of the newly proclaimed king to secure a liberal allowance, settled for life, such as would make him independent of “his faithful Commons.” His late brother having attempted to govern without that section of the legislature in which is vested the control of supplies, was, towards the close of his reign, getting to the end of his resources, derived from foreign pensions for the most part. Evelyn records that within a month of Charles’s death a parliament was summoned, and “great industry used to obtain elections which might promote the Court interest, most of the Corporations being now, by their new charters, empowered to make what return they pleased.” These liberties were, however, restored in the nature of bribes, the new charters granted by the Court being held as considerations for the election of such as were reckoned in the interests of that faction. Evelyn himself discloses this damaging fact: “It was reported that Lord Bath carried down with him into Cornwall no fewer than fifteen charters, so that some called him the ‘Prince Elector.’” This was an “electioneering job” on a gigantic scale, and the new parliament seems to have been returned on these corrupt principles where it was possible. On the same authority, we are enlightened concerning another piece of electioneering strategy, which proves that, as Praed has wittily told in verse, expediency has ever been proved the ruling policy on both sides. Under the 8th of April, 1685, the diary records—

“This day my brother of Wotton and Mr. Onslow were candidates for Surrey against Sir Adam Brown and my cousin Sir Edward Evelyn, and were circumvented in their election by a trick of the Sheriff’s,^{[30](#)}

taking advantage of my brother's party going out of the small village of Leatherhead to seek shelter and lodging, the afternoon being tempestuous, proceeding to the election when they were gone, they expecting the next morning; whereas before and then they exceeded the other party by many hundreds, as I am assured. The Duke of Norfolk led Sir Edward Evelyn's and Sir Adam Brown's party. For this Parliament very mean and slight persons (some of them gentlemen's servants, clerks, and persons neither of reputation nor interest) were set up; but the country would choose my brother whether he would or no, and he missed it by the trick above-mentioned. Sir Adam Brown was so deaf that he could not hear one word. Sir Edward Evelyn³¹ was an honest gentleman, much in favour with his majesty."

On the 22nd of May, 1685, the new king met his parliament (with his crown on his head), and the Commons being introduced to the House of Lords, read his speech, to the effect that he resolved to call a parliament from the moment of his brother's decease, as the best means to settle all the concerns of the nation; that as he would invade no man's property, so he would never depart from his own prerogative; and that as he would take care of *their* religion and property,—

"so he doubted not of suitable returns of his subjects' duty and kindness, especially as to settling his revenues for life, for the many weighty necessities of government, which he would not suffer to be precarious; that some might possibly suggest that it were better to feed and supply him from time to time only, out of their inclination to frequent parliaments; but that that would be a very improper method to take with him, since the best way to engage him to meet oftener would be always to use him well, and therefore he expected their compliance speedily, that this session being but short, they might meet again to satisfaction;"

a speech which, in spite of its palpable duplicity, was received with acclamation by the House. "So soon as the Commons were returned, and had put themselves into a Grand Committee, they immediately put the question, and unanimously voted the revenue to his Majesty for life." This

ready subserviency is explained, as it transpires, from Evelyn's account, that the new members were not all that could be desired:—

“Mr. Seymour made a bold speech against many of the elections; and would have had those members who (he pretended) were obnoxious, to withdraw, till they had cleared the matter of their being legally returned: but no one seconded him. The truth is, there were many of the new members whose elections and returns were universally censured, many of them being persons of no condition, or interest in the nation, or places for which they served, especially in Devon, Cornwall, Norfolk, etc., said to have been recommended by the Court, and from the effect of the new charters changing the electors, as in Lord Bath's famous western tour, when that nobleman is said to have quietly put down the names of all the officers of the Guards into the charters of the Cornwall boroughs; whence Seymour told the House in his speech that if this was digested, they might introduce what religion and laws they pleased, and that though he never gave heed to the fears and jealousies of the people before, he was now really apprehensive of Popery.

“By the printed list of members, of 505 there did not appear to be above 135 who had been in former Parliaments, especially that lately held at Oxford.”

Under the same date, 1685, Burnet mentions that complaints came up from all parts of England of the injustice and violence used in elections.

James II. got on no better with his parliaments than his predecessor; on his abdication at the Revolution, a convention parliament was assembled, which ratified the late changes, and offered the sovereignty to William of Orange and Mary his consort. The political squibs upon this topic are not wanting in point:—

“ON THE CALLING OF A FREE PARLIAMENT.

JANUARY 15, 1668-9.

“A Parliament with one consent
Is all the cry o’ th’ nation,
Which now may be, since Popery
Is growing out of fashion.
The Belgic troops approach to Town,
The Oranges come pouring,
And all the Lords agree as one
To send the papists scouring.”

The Whigs, who had effected the Revolution which placed William III. on the throne, were now in the enjoyment of place and power, to the mortification of the discomfited Tories, whose vexation on the aspect of affairs, which gave them no prospect of a return to office, found expression in satirical attacks upon their more successful adversaries.

“THE WHIGS’ ADDRESS TO HIS MAJESTY.

“We who were never yet at quiet,
Lovers of Change, Disorder, Riot,
Old Sticklers for a Common-wealth,
(If you believe us) wish you Health,
A long, a safe, a prosperous Reign.
(The wicked *Tories* think we feign.)
We, who all Monarchy despise,
Hope to find favour in your eyes;
Think you a Protestant so hearty
As not to disoblige our Party,
And humbly beg, at any rate
To be Chief Ministers of State,
Or else your person we shall hate;
For tho’ *Religion* bears the name,
It’s GOVERNMENT is all our aim.
We’ll be as faithful and as just
As to Your Uncle, Charles the First;
Grant this request, your Cause we’ll own,
And ease the burden of the Crown;
Make it the easiest e’er was worn,
You’ll scarcely know you’ve any on.
But if (Great Sir) we find you slight us,
Ourselves can tell which way to Right us;
And, let you know, by sad disasters,
Tho’ you are Lord, yet we are Masters.
This truth you cannot choose but know,
We prov’d it sixty years ago;
Yet shall you find us now on Trial,
Your faithful subjects, OR WE LIE ALL!”

Disappointment, and a long spell of disfavour at Court, embittered the Tory wits, and lent a barb to those satirical shafts which they freely launched at their powerful opponents, the Whigs in office and in parliament.

“THE PATRIOTS. 1700.

“Your hours are choicely employ’d,
Your Petitions all lie on the Table.
With Funds insufficient
And Taxes deficient,
And Deponents innumerable.
For shame leave this wicked employment,
Reform both your manners and lives;
You were never sent out
To make such a rout,
Go home, and look after your wives.”

A poetic effusion, one of the relics of a parliamentary election in the reign of William III., was printed in 1701. It is entitled “The Election, a Poem,” and evidently describes an election for the city of London; the scene of the incident is the Guildhall, where the electoral struggle was fought out beneath the shelter of the civic guardians, Gog and Magog. This production, redolent of the savour of the seventeenth century, is interesting as displaying the nature of “election squibs” under an early guise. The poem opens with a brief introduction of the principal performers, and alludes to the scene of the contest.

“The day was come when all the folks in furs
From sables, ermines, to the skins of curs,
In great Augusta’s Hall each other rub’d
And made it but one common powd’ring tub;

Ne’er was that Hall so throng’d in days of yore,
Ne’er were there seen such numerous crowds before.
From end to end the warm Electors thrust,
And move like ants in heaps of straw and dust.
Each busy mortal does his forces rally,
And from one nook to t’other quarter sally.
So close they prest, with such inhuman twitches;
The *Civit Hogo* did arise from breeches,
Which thro’ the air increas’d into a breeze
Made e’en the mighty Giants cough and sneeze.
Here a fat spark could scarce his tallow save,
And there a fool was jostled by a knave.
Came to sweat out their venom ’gainst the State,
Old feuds revive, and mischiefs new create.”

The bard describes the “City Godmother,” an obsolete mistress, whose traditions were with the Tories of the past:—

“She saw the temper of the noisy Hall,
And wept the Churches’ stars that downwards fall.”

In vain does the antique beldame recall the “bad old times” of fanaticism and oppression (when in a former reign the civic charters were taken away perforce), and exhort the sympathies of the crowd to turn from Whiggism and embrace the abuses of the Stuarts:—

“Poor I, the city Sybil of renown,
Am disrespected by the nauseous Town:
Of Innovations daily I complain,
But, like Cassandra, prophesy in vain.”

Next comes the hustings:—

“When on the *Rostra*, as upon a stage,
The Candidates their partizans engage;
You’d think the Hall an Amphitheatre
And these the furious Gladiators were.”

The author first introduces the candidates who were obnoxious to him, and he certainly roasts them royally, and serves with a right pungent sauce. Priso, the first candidate to appear before the freeholders, had degraded himself as a tool of the late Court, and when in possession of the chair had basely surrendered the liberties of the city corporation.

“First Priso mounts the stage, and shows himself;
The crowd unanimous did hiss the elf,
And vow’d no Representative they’d have,
Who to a Tyrant their old Charter gave.”

Candidate number two, Child, was, it is hinted, in the interests of the “prince over the water,” whom he was hopeful of converting from popery.

“Next him an infant comes, a Babe of Grace,
And steps into his abdicated place,
Where from his throne he, lisping out aloud,
In words like these bespoke the noisy crowd.
‘You’re govern’d, sirs, but by uncommon rules,
If you elect such men as are not fools.
In hopes of this, this doubtful stage I enter,
And at much cost on an election venture.
I hope you’ve read the letter which I sent,
Design’d each silly sot to circumvent.
Tho’ I’m a Child,³² my parts are come to age,
And for my sense the monied men engage:
Both kings and people have esteemed it fit,
That those who have most money have most wit.
Men they are pleas’d with great and manly toys,
But baubles are the true delight of boys.
I hate of Barons the renownèd Tales
And recommend you to the Prince of Wales.
Who in the Senate I will move to come
Into our Church from the curst See of Rome;
Where he shall hector like the Son of Priam,
And be as wise a Protestant as I am.’”

The sentiments put into the mouths of the candidates contain enlightenment upon city matters, as well as upon prominent citizens, both under the reign of William III. and his predecessors from the Restoration. Another candidate is thinly disguised under the nickname of “the Czar.” He is made to thus candidly address the “medley voting crowd:”—

“This City fam’d for Aldermen and Mayors,
The best intrusted with the public cares,
In former ages have obtained renown,
Great as the deeds our Ancestors have done.
I, tho’ of mean descent, and void of fame,
My ancestors obscure in birth and name,
By gold ennobl’d, am come here to serve ye
As once I did my master—that’s to starve ye.
E’er I a representative commence,
I’ll make confession here of all my sins;
I *Judas* first for my just pattern took,
Betray’d my master, and his cause forsook.
This made me rise, as other courtiers do,
T’ attempt high Crimes, and Villainies pursue.
Jemmy a special Banker had in me,
His coin lay safe as in his Treasury:
It was no cheat his money to purloin,
He knew not how, alas, to use his coin.
My breach of promise is so small a fault,
That no wise man can wonder at.
But that you might not of my wit complain,
I’ve been a cheat in every monarch’s reign.
When paper was equivalent to gold,
And paper-skulls their paper-credit sold,
I, by my cunning and my wise designing,
Soon got the modern art of paper-coining.”

The poetaster has nothing but good repute to shower on the late representatives of the city of London; he bids his Muse—

“Tell to *Augusta*’s sons, the worth disclose
Of those good patriots whom they lately chose.
In front of these the aged Clito place,
A better man did ne’er the City grace:
Generous and brave, and true in former time,
When Honesty was thought the highest crime.
He in the *Oxford* Senate bravely stood,
Like some tall tree, the Giant of the Wood,
O’ertopping all in courage and address,
Invaded-Rights and Freedoms to redress;
Brought in a Bill t’ exclude a Popish prince,
The want of which we have lamented since.
And when the Chair he did most justly fill,
And tempted was to serve a Tyrant’s will,
Would not his fellow-citizens disarm,
But boldly did withstand th’ impending storm.



He in the Senate sits unbrib’d, and knows
No cause—but where the common interest goes.
He, unconcern’d, the dangerous path doth tread,
Where Faction shakes its dire envenom’d head.”

Another favourite and patriotic candidate is “Asto,” who—

“early did his country’s cause embrace
And opposed villains even to their face.
The Charter he would not consent to yield,
But did defend it in th’ open field.
Gold never could his interest engage,
The common vice of this polluted age;
Whereby they villains into office vote,
Such as would cut their King’s and country’s throat.”

The other candidates—“friends to their country all,” according to the bard—are christened “Witho,” “Hethban,” and “Pastor.”

With the death of William III. the Tory prospects revived, and their attacks became bolder. In alluding to the accident which caused the king’s end, the party lyrists showed no compassion for “a fallen foe.”

“Let’s ’em mourn on, ’twould lessen much our woe
Had *Sorrel* stumbled thirteen years ago.”
(B. HIGGONS, 1702: *The Mourners*.)

One of the ballads in the Bagford collection applies to the elections which took place in Queen Anne’s reign (the first parliament dissolved April 5, 1705); this High Tantivy effusion of the Tory Alma-Mater is rather long-winded, and we must be content with a brief extract:—

“THE UNIVERSITY BALLAD; OR THE CHURCH’S ADVICE
TO HER TWO DAUGHTERS, OXFORD AND CAMBRIDGE.

“I have heard, my dear daughters, a story of late,
Told for truth to the Commons, by a Minister of State,
That the ‘Scotch Act’ was extorted; O England’s hard fate!

“If Whigs at this distance so terrible are,
Such men in our bosom may make us all stare,
And extort what they please, if we do not take care.



“If this be the case, pray what can you think?
But that Church and State are now at the brink
Of ruin, destruction, and ready to sink.

“But we have yet a time to save this poor nation,
From fire and sword, and all desolation,
By choosing such members as hate Decollation!

“And hence I take leave, both my daughters to press
To give good examples, you can do no less,
When the Church and the State are in so great distress.

“The eyes of the nation are fix’d upon you,
Every city and borough will observe what you do,
And if you’ll choose good members they’ll do so too.

“Each member that’s chose, serves for th’ whole nation,
For that end you’re intrusted to vote in your station,
Without any respect to friend or relation.

“The question before you is both plain and short—
Who is the best man, Church and State to support,
From designs of the Whigs, and schemes of the Court?

“And in your next choice lay your hand on your heart,
As if upon Oath, for if you do start
From the rule above-mention’d, your conscience will smart.

“A good man is steady, and with safety may
Be trusted with our Rights; he no tricks will play,
He loves Church, and the Queen, and’s the same every day.

“But if a man be bred up a notorious Whig,
Who because he was neglected begins to look big,
And swears for old Friends he cares not a fig:

“O trust not to such in time of great danger;
Who to mother Church is yet but a stranger,
If Dissenter prevail he may vote for to change her.

“And as to the Tackers³³ that have tack’d the right way,
For the Church and the Laws; to such I do say,
I will give them my blessing, and for them I’ll pray.



“You are two great props of the Church and the Crown,
Then be not like buckets, one up, t’other down,
To expose your dear mother all over the Town.

“O no! Pray consider, this is the last squeak,
Then choose we such men, as can both write and speak,
Since all that we have, now lies at the stake.

“And when by your Daughters such patriots are chose,
I may venture to say, that ‘under the Rose,’
You will spoil the new scheme, and wipe the Whig’s nose.”

One of the forty-nine verses of which “The University Ballad” consists contains an allusion to an important collision between the two Chambers upon disputed elections, which came about in Queen Anne’s reign:—

“O! how were we blinded with what some do write,
Concerning the story of Ashby and White,
Till Sir H[eneage] laid before us the fallacy, in sight.”

The names first given refer to the disputants, while Sir H—— in all probability is one of the University’s parliamentary representatives, Sir Heneage Finch, son of Finch, Lord Keeper and Chancellor. He was returned in 1678, 1688, 1695, and also in 1701 and 1702. The important dispute in question, which is not without interest, as it bears a special reference to election practices which were at one time prevalent, arose between the Lords and Commons on the occasion of the Aylesbury returns, and the case

came before parliament in 1703-4. It seems to have been the tactics of those persons whose party held a majority in the House, to decide all disputed elections so as to strengthen their own side. "The majority," meaning the government, legislated thus partially, conveniently ignoring the energetic protests against such flagrant injustice—the condonation of direct bribery and downright perjury, according to the allegations of the minority; who, it is said, when the turn of the wheel came which raised them to power, invariably endorsed the policy of their predecessors by repeating the same evil practices. The investigation brought to light the illegitimate nature of election returns, proving that it had long been the habit of constables and similar officials to secure for such candidates as would pay them sufficiently, their return for parliament by obtaining a majority of votes for the person who purchased their connivance: thus, after the seat was, in advance, put up to the highest bidder, pains were taken to ascertain in whose favour each vote was likely to be given; those burgesses who were not to be cajoled or bribed into voting for the candidate adopted by the constables were prevented from voting otherwise, under various pretexts by which they were disabled or disfranchised,—an oppression which reduced representative government to a mere pretence. Yet, although these glaring illegalities were patent, they had offered such temptations as to have been condoned successively by either party in power.

At length the evils of this system were forced upon the attention of the legislature, as certain burgesses of Aylesbury (Bucks) resisted the authority of the venal officers which had prevailed unchallenged hitherto, and at length brought a criminal action against William White and other constables of the borough. One Matthew Ashby had been permitted to vote at previous elections, but on the recent occasion was denied the privilege, as his vote happened to be in favour of the candidate who had not secured the official interest. The trial came on, and proved a complicated affair. The constables lost the day at the assizes, being cast in damages. Brought before the Queen's Bench, a majority of two judges supported the constables, although the third, Chief Justice Holt, was opposed to them. The House of Lords reversed this judgment, confirming the award of the assizes. The Commons grew indignant with the Peers at threatened encroachments, and voted that Ashby, in prosecuting his action, had committed "a breach of privilege"—that delicate offence so swiftly and severely visited with condemnation.

Lastly, the Lords fulminated their censures on the Commons for crying injustice; at their order the Lord Keeper sent “a copy of the case and of their resolutions to all the Sheriffs of England, to be communicated to all the Boroughs in their counties,” enlightening all concerned upon prevailing malpractices, and serving as a caution for the future—a proceeding highly provoking to the Commons, who were powerless to hinder it. They turned their indignant wrath upon the five burgesses of Aylesbury, who followed suit to Ashby, against White: when their actions were brought against the borough constables, as returning officers, for the refusal of their votes, “the House of Commons, on plea of breach of privilege, committed the five to Newgate, where they lay imprisoned three months.” By a curious turn of the tables, when their trial came on at the Queen’s Bench, Chief Justice Holt declared they ought to be discharged, but, being remanded, the prisoners were removed into the custody of the serjeant-at-arms, and the Commons were covered with disgrace by the after-proceedings. The dilemma was obviated by the queen interfering with a prorogation, followed by a dissolution on the 5th of April, 1705, which thus concluded the last session of Queen Anne’s first parliament.

The “loyal Tackers,” who fought so hard to get their own way under the easy sovereignty of their “gracious Anna,” were occasionally treated to hard rubs by their opponents, the stedfast Whigs, whose prospects again brightened at the close of Anne’s reign.

“THE OLD TACK AND THE NEW.

“The Tack³⁴ of old, was thought as bold
As any Tack could be, Sir;
Nor is the Age yet void of Rage,
As any man may see, Sir.

“The Tack before was THIRTY-FOUR,
Besides an even Hundred;
But now, alas! So low it was,
That people greatly wonder’d.

“If Tacks thus lose, It plainly shows,
The Spirit of the Nation;
That we may find, For Time, behind,
They’ll lose their Reputation.

“Before the JACKS³⁵ were said to Tack
Our loyal fine Pretences;
But here folks say, The Humour lay
To bring us to our Senses.

“Religious Laws, was then the Cause,
OCCASIONAL CONFORMING;
Did not agree with true Piety,
And set the Church a storming.

“But now ’tis come, they Tack in fine,
After a great Consumption;
And therefore thought to have it brought
In, by way of Resumption.

“Thus Projects, and thus Patriots chang’d,
The House appear’d so civil;
Both Tacks, which cost such Pains were lost,
And thrown out to the Devil.”

In 1695, the legislature passed a severe act against bribery and treating, the first of a series of similar preventative measures which have been found requisite from time to time down to our own day.

That this act was needed is proved by the records of the immense sums expended in corrupting the suffrage. Addison's patron, Thomas, Marquis of Wharton, is calculated to have spent eighty thousand pounds of his own fortune in electioneering. This spirited nobleman, who was one of the most energetic Whigs, and largely instrumental in bringing over the Prince of Orange, has been regarded as the greatest adept at electioneering which England ever saw, and, says Hannay, "may pass as the patriarch of the art in this country." It is certain that his abilities were admirably adapted to the purpose of exercising this control. It was his policy "to forward the designs of an oligarch by the attraction of a demagogue," a branch of higher art, which has had imitators in this age. He managed to return from twenty to thirty members, at an expenditure of thousands, backed by a happy persuasive knack of carrying all before him. Nor did he stop at an occasional duel by the way. In the general election of 1705 alone, he spent twelve thousand pounds. But cash, pluck, enterprise, and activity would have been less conspicuous had they not been supplemented by what has been called a "born genius for canvassing," as is proved from the "Memoirs" which appeared shortly after his death in 1715. Wharton's biographer introduces the subject of an electoral contest for the borough of Wiccombe, at the beginning of Anne's reign. His Whig lordship having recommended two candidates of his own choice, the staunch Church party, in a flutter of indignation, put up two High Tory candidates, and money was freely spent on both sides. A friend of one of the High Church candidates being desirous of witnessing the progress made by this canvasser, was invited down to Wiccombe to watch the proceedings, and it was he who imparted the details to the compiler of the "Memoirs."³⁶ The "Tantivy" party arrived to find my Lord Wharton before them, accompanied by his two *protégées*, going up and down the town securing votes for the Whig interest. The Tory candidates and a very few followers marched on one side of the street, Lord Wharton's candidates and a great company on the other.

"The gentleman, not being known to my lord or the townsmen, join'd with his lordship's men to make discoveries, and was by when

my lord, entering a shoemaker's shop, asked 'where Dick was.' The good woman said 'her husband was gone two or three miles off with some shoes, but his lordship need not fear him—she would keep him tight.' 'I know that,' says my lord, 'but I want to see Dick and drink a glass with him.' The wife was very sorry Dick was out of the way. 'Well,' says his lordship, 'how does all thy children? Molly is a brave girl I warrant by this time.' 'Yes, I thank ye, my lord,' says the woman: and his lordship continued—'Is not Jemmy breeched yet?'"

This conversation convinced the witness that his friend's chances were hopeless in opposing a great Peer who could display such an intimate knowledge of the electors and their families. To the said marquis does Dr. Percy attribute the famous Irish ballad of "Lillibulero," which is said to have had effects more powerful than the philippics of Demosthenes or the orations of Cicero, and certainly contributed not a little towards the revolution in 1688.

In the days of Queen Anne, the arrival of a popular candidate of the High Tory type was welcomed in a stately manner by the supporters of the "Church" cause, as appears from "Dyer's Letters."

"May 5th.—From Exon, we have an account of the honourable reception there of John Snell, Esq., one of the representatives in the late parliament, an honest, loyal, and brave *Tacker*, who arrived from London on the 1st inst., having been met some miles out of town by above 500 horse and some 1000 foot, composed of the neighbouring gentry, with the clergy, aldermen, and principal citizens; who conducted him to his own house with the city music playing before him, the streets echoing with these acclamations—'GOD BLESS THE LOYAL TACKERS, AND SEND THE SNEAKERS MORE HONESTY AND COURAGE.'"

According to the Tories, all who were opposed to the "Tackers" of their order must be stigmatized to the public as "Sneakers."

The Whigs were equally unscrupulous in the audacity of their assertions; the fatally damaging effect of a startling calumny, no matter how improbable, so that it be bold enough, exploded on an opponent by way of

surprise—a resource much relied upon when matters looked desperate at these times of unsparing warfare—is illustrated in the next extract:—

“May 15th.—The Lord Woodstock, son of the Earl of Portland, has carried it at Southampton against Fred Tilney, Esq., a loyal and worthy gentleman, which was done by this trick:—that gentleman happening to pay his reckoning in that town with about 70 Loudores, which he had received there, *the Whig party immediately gave out he was a French pensioner, which calumny answered their purpose.*”

“May 29th.—Since my last, we have had an account of several elections, which I leave to the Gazette to enumerate: only the management of some of them is worth notice, particularly for the county of Worcester, where Sir John Packington and Mr. Bromley carried it gloriously against Mr. Walsh, who was set up by the Dissenters. Sir John Packington had a banner carried before him, whereon was painted *a church falling*, with this inscription—‘*For the Queen and Church, Packington.*’ It was observable, that while they were marching through the Foregate-Street, they met the Bishop’s coach, in which was a *Non-Con. teacher*, going to poll for Capt. Walsh, but the horses (at the sight of the church, as ’twas believed) turned tail, overturned and broke the same, and very much bruised the *Holder-Forth’s* outward man; and this raised no small admiration that the Bishop’s horses should be afraid of a church.”

The commotion which in the days of Queen Anne was manifested in the public thoroughfares at an electioneering epoch is incidentally pictured by Dean Swift, in his “Journal to Stella:”—

“Oct. 5, 1710.—This morning Delaval came to see me, and went to Kneller’s, who was in town. On the way we met the electors for parliament-men, and the rabble came about our coach, crying, ‘A Colt! A Stanhope! etc.’ *We were afraid of a dead cat, or our glasses broken, and so were always of their side.*”

Among the lost illustrations of the humours of elections is the ballad, “full of puns,” which Swift mentions having produced on that said Westminster election; for any trace of which we have vainly searched

among the political pamphlets and poetical broadsides of the Queen Anne era.

It is Swift who relates the untoward catastrophe which awaited his friend, Richard Steele, the improvident “Tatler,” who, having a design to serve in the last parliament of Queen Anne, resigned his place of Commissioner of the Stamp Office in June, 1713, and was chosen for the borough of Stockbridge, in Hampshire, one of the snug constituencies swept away by the Reform Bill a century or so later. The Dean writes of Dick’s adventures on this errand:—

“There was nothing there to perplex him but the payment of a £300 bond, which lessened the sum he carried down, and which an odd dog of a creditor had intimation of and took this opportunity to recover.”

Steele’s parliamentary career was brief. He had not been long in the House before he contrived to get expelled, and gave deadly offence to the queen, by writing “The Englishman” and “The Crisis” against the Jacobite Tories. With the advent of his “Protestant hero,” George I., Steele secured patronage, knighthood, and a seat in the first parliament, where he sat for the since-notorious Boroughbridge, Yorkshire.

A deeply designed stroke of electioneering policy is credited to Sarah, Duchess of Marlborough, who excelled in the subtle tactics invaluable in these emergencies, which raised her to the level of Wharton in election fame, while promoting the success of her nominees. Lord Grimston happened to oppose her grace’s candidates. Now, Lord Grimston, as is related by Johnson, had written a heavy play, “Love in a Hollow Tree,” having become ashamed of which bantling, he did his best to suppress it:—

“The leaden crown devolved on thee,
Great poet of the hollow tree.”

“But the Duchess of Marlborough had kept one, and when he was against her at an election, she had a new edition of it printed, and

prefixed to it, as a frontispiece, an elephant dancing on a rope; to show that his Lordship's writing comedy was as awkward as an elephant dancing on a rope."³⁷

It was so much a matter of course that everything in a man's life should tell against him, if he had the temerity to stand for parliament, that Johnson, when interrogated by Boswell, "whether a certain act of folly would injure a friend of theirs for life?" replied, "It may perhaps, sir, be mentioned at an election,"—the duchess's feat probably presenting itself to Johnson's mind at the time.

Hannay, in his sparkling essay on "Electioneering," also relates the following:—"Mamma," said a young candidate to his parent in deep confidence, one nomination day, "tell me truly, is there anything against my birth?"—an ingenious precaution in view of eventualities which the youth not imprudently employed to prepare himself for the worst, and that he might not be taken by surprise at the hustings.

The Tories were forced, after their failure to proclaim the Pretender as successor to Queen Anne, to subscribe their loyalty on the accession of George I. This they did with a reservation, as hinted by their opponents, who now held the good things of the administration:—

"Your fathers, like men, who had thoughts of a Heaven,
Took the Oaths in the Sense in which they were given;
But you, like your Brethren the Jesuits, can find
A way to evade all the ties of mankind,
So that nothing but Halters your faction can bind."

It was not without reasonable suspicions of the Jacobite party that the ministers of George I. deemed it prudent to keep the Commons they had, rather than face a fresh election, since a general mistrust was abroad. From an effusion upon the bell-ringing in 1716, on the anniversary of Queen Anne's coronation, it appears this tribute of respect to the memory of the late sovereign was regarded as a Tory manifesto:—

“’Tis Nancy’s Coronation Day
By whom ye hop’d to bring in play
 Young George, the Chevalier.
But Fate, who best disposes things,
And pulls down Queens and sets up Kings,
 A better George sent here.”

According to the lyrist, the papists were tired of praying for Walpole’s abrupt end; but the conclusion exhibits the feeling then prevailing—and which was justified by after-events,—that the prolonged sessions of parliament under the new Septennial Act offered some defence against the schemes of their opponents; in fact, the tables were turned, and the Whigs of this parliament dreaded the machinations of the Tories, much as the Abhorrrers and courtiers detested and feared the Whigs under Charles II.

“But now they utter loud complaints,
And curse all male and female saints,
 Walpole still lives, their curb;
And four long years, at least, must come,
Ere French pistoles, and friends to Rome,
 Our Liberties disturb.”

The Pretender, whose cause looked hopeful at the time of his “dear sister’s” decease, was treated by the Whig satirists with all the ridicule their pens could command:—

“A FULL AND AMPLE EXPLANATION OF ONE KING
JAMES’S DECLARATION.

“Had my dear Sister still been living,
I might have hop’d for (the Crown) of her giving;
But she, alas, is gone, and all
Her latest servants—I should call
My friends—disgrac’d and out of power,
Nay some committed to the Tower,
Impeach’d! Who then but must resent,
To see a British parliament,
With all the power of Arms and Laws,
So zealously oppose my Cause,
Pay Dutch, raise English troops and seamen,
And may, perhaps, bring more from Bremen.
Can my good subjects bear this still,
And thus *be sav’d against their will?*
However, if you’ll still consent,
To damn that thing call’d *Parliament*,
Burn *Magna Charta*, bring confusion
On all things since the Revolution,
Be governed by no other measure,
But our own sovereign will and pleasure,
I’ll pardon all, and what I’ve promis’d, grant ye,
All ‘Oaths of Coronation’ *non obstante.*”

Whatever prospects the Pretender and his good friends the Tories might have cherished on the accession of George I., were abruptly put to flight after the abortive rising in 1715; this ill-advised attempt, and the consequences of its utter failure, are wittily set forth in the ballad:—

“THE RIGHT AND TRUE HISTORY OF PERKIN.

“Ye *Whigs*, and eke you *Tories*, give ear to what I sing;
For it is about the *Chevalier*, that silly would-be King!
He boasts of his nobility, and when his race began,
Though his *arms* they are two *trowels* and his Crest a *warming-pan*.
When first he came to Scotland, in ‘Our Dear Sister’s’ reign,
He look’d, but did not like the Land, and so went home again.
Soon after, ‘Our Dear Sister’ did make a peace with France,
And then the *Perkinites* did laugh to see the Devil dance.
And then to please the growling Whigs, who Perkin could not brook,
That slim young man was sent to graze as far as Bar-le-Duc.
But yet when *D’Aumont* hither came, to tie the League full close,
Young Perkin tarry’d in Lorrain, or came to Som’set House.
The Lords then did Address the Queen to do what she deny’d,
Until Sir *Patrick* and the *Prigg* were safe on t’other side.
Then came a proclamation out, to give five thousand pound
To any one who Perkin took upon the English ground.
Soon after *Semper Eadem*³⁸ this Mortal life departs
Which thing almost broke *Chevalier*’s, and *Bona Fides*’s hearts.
Then Royal George of Hanover to happy Britain comes,
With joyful noise upon the Thames, of trumpets, and of drums.
The trait’rous Tory Tools then did cringe to seek for grace,
And swore to be most loyal lads, if they were kept in place.
But when the leaders found the King their Treason did espy,
Away with speed they fled to France, the traitor’s sanctuary.
This made the High-priest cry aloud,—the Danger of the Church,
Because those pillars from her slipt, and left her in the lurch.
Then *Bungay*³⁹ and his gang, harangu’d the senseless mob to win ’em;
And rous’d ’em up to serve the Lord; as tho’ *the De’il was in ’em*.
They ‘listed thieves, and jail birds, and rogues of ev’ry town,
The Ladies chaste of Drury Lane, and *the w—— of Babylon*.
Depending on this pious crew of ‘Non-Resisting’ Saints,
They thought by plund’ring of the Whigs to make up all their wants.
Then to begin the show,—Lord Mar,—that never was upright,
To summon all his Bag-pipe-men, to Scotland took his flight.
He sent his *baillie* Jockey round to summon all his clans,
With a concert of Bag-pipes—it should been *Warming-pans*!
He told ’em they might all for mighty Honours look

For he that was before a Lord, was now become a Duke.
 They all (he said) should great men be, which was the way to win 'em.
 So he got an army of captains all, and scarce a soldier in 'em.
 And finding of his numbers great, he sent a brigadier,
 To join a band of Fox-Hunters, that were near Lancashire.
 These march'd into Preston town, the women for to frighten,
 And there they show'd their talent lay, in marching, not in fighting.
 They challeng'd Gen'ral Carpenter to run with them a race,
 And troth they beat him out and out, he could not keep 'em pace.
 But Wills with expeditious march these foot-pads did surround,
 And then they look'd like harmless sheep coop'd up within a pound.
 Then Forster got a posset, and gave his priest the Tythe,
 But posset could not make the priest nor general look blithe.
 Then Forster and his perjur'd crew surrender prisoners,
 And show'd they were no Whigs, for they did not delight in wars.
 Then as they march'd to London, Oh! 'twas a gallant show,
 The Whigs bid the music play '*Traitors all a-row.*'
 About this time the said Lord Mar (depending on his number)
 March'd up against the brave Argyle, and thought to bring him under.
 But tho' he had full four to one (which you may say is odds)
 Of Highland Loons dress'd dreadfully, with Bonnets, Dirks, and plads.
 Yet bold Argyle, with Britons brave, engag'd him near Dunblane,
 And soon with loss made him retire much faster than he came.
 Then Mar sent to the Chevalier, to hasten o'er to Scoon,
 And said, 'He should not want a crown, tho' the Ale-wives pawn'd their
 spoon.'
 But Mar's design was plainly, when next they went to fight,
 Only to show a *dismal thing* which would like Death's-head fright.
 At length the *pale-fac'd Hero* came, and like an Owler lands,
 Indeed he had much reason, for the goods were contrabands.
 As soon as he arrived, a Scottish ague took him,
 And tho' he swallow'd *Jesuit's Bark*, Good Lady! how it shook him.
 The non-resisting Damsels believ'd the omen bad,
 When at first speech the *Baby* cried, which made his Council mad.
 But when he heard Argyle approach'd with army in array,
 As Perkin came in like a thief, so again he stole away.
 So there's an end of Perkin, and thus I end my Lays,

With God preserve our Glorious George, and all his royal race!”

CHAPTER IV.

ELECTIONEERING AND PARTY TACTICS UNDER GEORGE I. AND II.

A fair representation of a chairing scene is given as the second of a series of eight plates which, under the title of "Robin's Progress," satirically delineates the career of Sir Robert Walpole. The newly elected member is seated, tranquilly enough, in a capacious arm-chair, raised aloft by his supporters; there are a few "bludgeon-men" among his followers. Hats are thrown into the air, and a general sense of satisfaction is shown to prevail. One of the party, evidently a person of influence, is made to exclaim, "No bribery, no corruption!" A group of more distrustful persons is pictured in the foreground; an elector observes, "I wish we mayn't be deceived," while his confederate is declaring, "I smell a rat!" Whatever "undue influence" might have been hinted on this occasion, Walpole had not at that early date (1701) developed the arts of corruption and electioneering, then synonymous; his proficiency in these branches was of later growth. Although not strictly a contemporaneous picture of the event, the engraving which represents the chairing of Sir Robert Walpole on his election for Castle Rising, Norfolk, in 1701, is the earliest of our election illustrations as regards the date of the incident depicted. Walpole, in succession to his father, sat for Castle Rising, in the last two short parliaments which preceded the death of William III., and at once distinguished himself as an active and able ally of the Whig party, then holding the power of administration. In 1702, he was chosen member for King's Lynn, and represented that borough in several successive parliaments. After, with the interest of George, Prince of Denmark, filling the posts of secretary at war, 1708, and treasurer of the navy, 1709, the Tory advisers of the latter part of Queen Anne's reign dismissed Walpole from all his posts. The Commons in 1711 voting him guilty of a high breach of trust and notorious corruption in

his office as secretary at war, it was resolved to expel him from the House, and that he should be committed to the Tower. Under this vindictive persecution, he was, by his party, regarded as a martyr to the cause, nor does there appear sufficient proof to justify this severity. Encouraged by Walpole's energetic tactics, his constituents remained firm, and he was re-elected by the burgesses of Lynn in 1713-14, and, though the House declared the return void, yet the electors persisted in their choice, and Walpole took a decided part against the queen's Tory ministry, until "the turn of the wheel," which raised the Elector of Hanover on the English throne as Queen Anne's successor, threw back the power of administration into the hands of Walpole and the Whigs, and once more reduced the Tories to vent their mortification in unscrupulous attacks and misrepresentations, while they were themselves exerting all their abilities for the subversion of the House of Hanover and the restoration of the exiled Stuarts. The bitterness of party warfare was mostly manifested at election times. A burlesque "Bill of Costs" was printed in the *Flying Post* (Jan. 27, 1715), "for a late Tory election in the West," in which part of the country the Tory interest was strongest:—



WALPOLE CHAIRED. 1701. (From "Robin's Progress.")
(Dr. Newton's Collection.)

	£ s. d.
<i>Imprimis</i> , for bespeaking and collecting a mob	20 0 0
<i>Item</i> , for many suits of knots for their heads	30 0 0
For scores of huzza-men	40 0 0
For roarers of the word "Church"	40 0 0
For a set of "No Roundhead" roarers	40 0 0
For several gallons of Tory punch on church tombstones	30 0 0
For a majority of clubs and brandy-bottles	20 0 0
For bell-ringers, fiddlers, and porters	10 0 0
For a set of coffee-house praters	40 0 0

For extraordinary expense for cloths and lac'd hats on show days, to dazzle the mob	50 0 0
For Dissenters' damners	40 0 0
For demolishing two houses	200 0 0
For committing two riots	200 0 0
For secret encouragement to the rioters	40 0 0
For a dozen of perjury men	100 0 0
For packing and carriage paid to Gloucester	50 0 0
For breaking windows	20 0 0
For a gang of alderman-abusers	40 0 0
For a set of notorious lyars	50 0 0
For pot-ale	100 0 0
For law, and charges in the King's Bench	300 0 0
	<u>£1460 0 0</u>

It will be observed in this "bill" that bribery is not put down as one of the prominent features of an election at this period; violence was, as yet, found to be more effective than corruption.

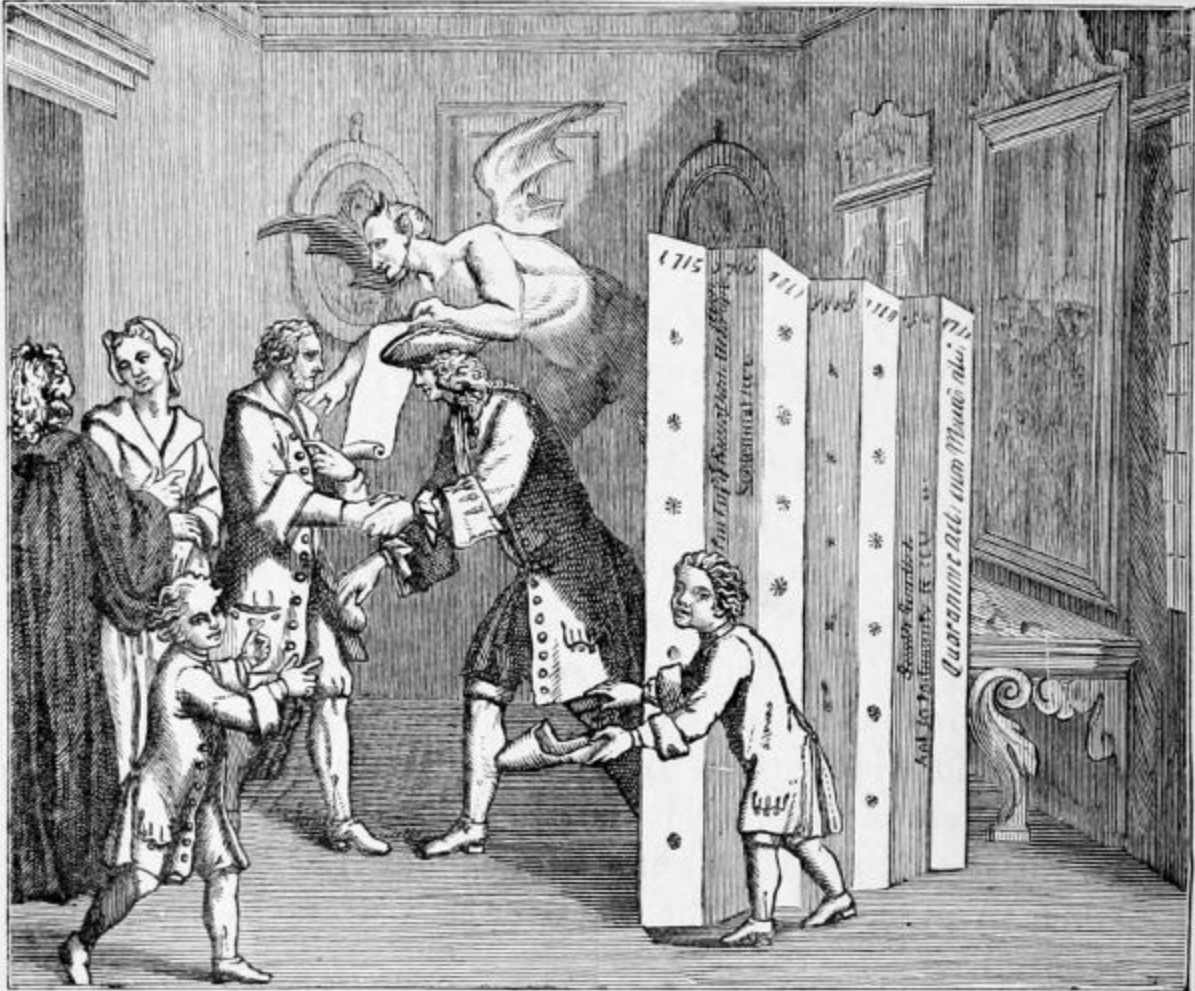
In March, 1721, when the first of the succession of triennial parliaments dissolved, the country was already in a state of fermentation at the prospect of the coming contest. Violence was now utilized in new methods, such as beating off voters of opposition candidates; while hostile electors were surrounded by mobs hired for the purpose, and cut off from the polling-booths; and in some cases voters were carried off forcibly, and locked up until the election was over.

In country boroughs much agitation was manifested, and in several places, such as Coventry, formidable riots took place.

The metropolis shared the general excitement. It was on this occasion that the Westminster contest began to be regarded as of the first consequence, it being a point of ambition with the rival parties to return their candidates for this constituency, the results of which conflict were expected to exercise an influence upon other places. The election for this

city set in uproariously in 1721, and, as the progress of these electioneering memorials will demonstrate, it continued the same throughout its history, even when in other places the elections were tranquil and uneventful.

The Tories did not allow Walpole to triumph without a struggle for the ascendancy, although, by his foresight, and a lavish employment of his universal salve—gold, he managed to diminish the influence both of his opponents and of the mobocracy; and in the new House the Government secured a powerful majority, leaving the Tory organs, towards the close of the elections, when the results were no longer doubtful, to vent their spleen in political squibs and caricatures. Thus, on the 31st of March, the *Post Boy* announces two satirical prints—one, “Britannia stript by a Villain, to which is added, the True Phiz of a Late Member,” which seems to have disappeared completely; and the other, “The Prevailing Candidate; or the Election carried by Bribery and the D——l;” which, according to all accounts, is the earliest existing contemporary caricature upon the subject of electioneering; and is, moreover, one of the best examples of these productions as published in the reign of George I.



THE PREVAILING CANDIDATE; OR THE ELECTION CARRIED BY
BRIBERY AND THE D—L.
(Dr. Newton's Collection.)

The candidate, it is implied, is a Court nominee; the screen is used to conceal the true movers of the wires, who are at the back of the canvasser; their reflection is shown in the mirror behind, above the console-table, on which bags of money are in readiness to be used for bribery. The wooden shoes symbolize a threatened relapse to slavery. The screen is to typify the seven years of the last parliament—the first of the septennial parliaments; the year 1716 is marked “Septennial Act”—“Part of the Succession Act repealed;”—1720 registers the “South Sea Act,”—“Act to indemnify South Sea Villains;” and 1721 the “Quarantine Act, *cum multis aliis*,” the other years are blanks. The accompanying verses explain the meaning intended to

be conveyed by the principal figures. The personage bribed is the mayor of the place. These functionaries for a long time held the elections in their power, and were amenable to corrupt treatment; in fact, they were expected to make the bargain most advantageous for the court of livery or aldermen, in whom the votes were generally vested. Hence the old saying, "Money makes the mayor to go."

"Here's a minion sent down to a corporate town,
In hopes to be newly elected;
By his prodigal show, you may easily know
To the Court he is truly affected.

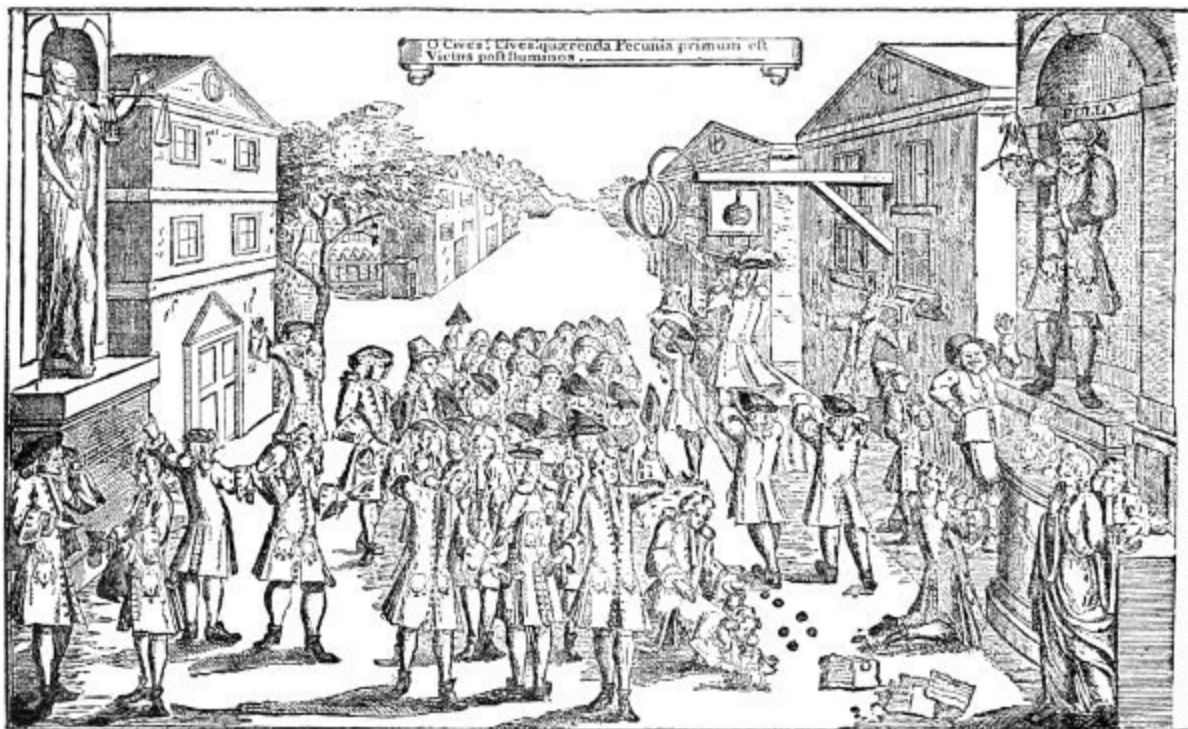
"He 'as a knave by the hand, who has power to command
All the votes in the corporation;
Shoves a sum in his pocket, the D——l cries 'Take it,
'Tis all for the good of the nation!'

"The wife, standing by, looks a little awry
At the candidate's way of addressing;
But a priest stepping in avers bribery no sin,
Since money's a family blessing.

"Say the boys, 'Ye sad rogues, here are French wooden brogues,
To reward your vile treacherous knavery;
For such traitors as you are the rascally crew
That betray the whole kingdom to slavery.'"

The elections of 1727, in spite of the exertions of Bolingbroke and Pulteney in the *Craftsman*, and the intrigues of the former with the Duchess of Kendal, mistress of George I., were a disappointment to the Tories and "patriots," i.e. Jacobites. On the death of George I. their prospects were even less promising. Queen Caroline, the consort of George II., was the steadfast friend of Walpole, and although the Bolingbroke faction paid their court to the mistress of the new king, as they had done in the last reign to that of his predecessor, they gained nothing by their motion, as George II. was governed by his wife in political questions. The hopes placed by the

O Cives! Cives! quærenda Pecunia primum est Virtus post Nummos.



READY MONEY, THE PREVAILING CANDIDATE; OR, THE HUMOURS OF AN ELECTION. (Dr. Newton's Collection.)

[Page 84.

A copy of verses sets forth the morality of this plate:—

“The Laws against Bribery provision may make,
Yet means will be found both to give and to take;
While charms are in flattery, and power in gold,
Men will be corrupted and Liberty sold.
When a candidate interest is making for votes,
How cringing he seems to the arrantest sots!
‘Dear Sir, how d’ye do? I am joyful to see ye!
How fares your good spouse? and how goes the world wi’ ye?
Can I serve you in anything? Faith, Sir, I’ll do’t
If you’ll be so kind as to give me your vote.
Pray do me the honour an evening to pass
In smoking a pipe and in taking a glass!’
Away to the tavern they quickly retire,
The ploughman’s ‘Hail-fellow-well-met’ with the Squire;
Of his company proud, he ‘huzzas’ and he drinks,
And himself a great man of importance he thinks:
He struts with the gold newly put in his breeches,
And dreams of vast favours and mountains of riches.
But as soon as the day of Election is over,
His woeful mistake he begins to discover;
The Squire is a Member—the rustic who chose him
Is now quite neglected—he no longer knows him.
Then Britons! betray not a sordid vile spirit
Contemn gilded baits, and elect men of merit.”



THE KENTISH ELECTION, 1734.

A realistic version of the hustings appeared under the title of “The Kentish Election, 1734.” The locality of the gathering here represented is probably Maidstone in Kent. A large open space on the outskirts of the town is the scene of action. The candidates and their numerous supporters are raised above the multitude, and standing on the hustings. Round this erection is a great crowd of electors, many of whom are on horseback.

In the foreground, a mounted clergyman is at the head of a procession of his flock, all wearing favours in their hats, and professing themselves supporters of the “Protestant Interest,” *i.e.* Whigs; two of them carry staves and books; the “gauges” in their hands seem to indicate that they are gaugers or excisemen, *i.e.* placemen: it must be noted that the chief grievance against Walpole and his administration at this time was the attempt to tax tobacco and wines. The Opposition party-cry is “No Excise,” with the names of “Vane and Dering,” the successful candidates, in whose honour, with that of the “Country Interest,” *i.e.* Tories, which they had pledged themselves to promote, the followers of their party wear sprigs of oak in their hats—a memorial of the Restoration of the Stuarts. The party-cry of their antagonists is for “King and Country,” and “Middlesex and Oxenden.” Sir George Oxenden had voted for the Government and in favour of the Excise Bill; he sat for Maidstone before the dissolution, April, 1734. The Earl of Middlesex was not a member of the former Parliament. These gentlemen finally threw up the poll, the victory of their opponents being assured, May 16, 1734. Of the successful candidates, Viscount Vane and Sir Edward Dering, the former had voted against the Excise Bill, and the latter was absent on the division. Something in the way of influencing suffrages seems to have been done on a large scale by Viscount Vane. Two hogsheads of French brandy were sent down to his seat in Kent (according to the *Daily Post*), together with sixty dozen of knives and forks, in preparation for the entertainment his lordship offered the freeholders. *The Grub Street Journal* devotes some attention to the treats with which the successful candidates regaled their constituents at an early stage of their canvass, and these hospitalities were returned in kind.

“At a meeting lately at the *Swan Tavern* in Cornhill, of about 100 substantial worthy citizens of London, freeholders of the County of Kent, the Right Hon. the Lord Vane and Sir Edw. Dering, Bart., candidates in the Country Interest, were entertained in an elegant manner by the freeholders,” etc. It is further stated that “these candidates were met at about two miles from Westerham, in Kent, by 300 freeholders on horseback, and dined at the *George Inn*, where healths were drunk to the glorious 205”—this being the number of members whose votes placed the Government in a minority upon the Excise Bill. Nor was wanting what later statesmen have termed “the fine old English Institution” of parading the Minister in effigy.

“The populace, to show their zeal on this occasion, dressed up a figure of a certain Excise gentleman (Sir Robert Walpole to wit) with blue paper round his shoulders (intended for the riband of the Garter, always alluded to with spite by the prime minister’s adversaries), a pipe in his mouth (Tobacco Bill), and several Florence flasks about his neck (referring to the proposed duty on wines), then mounted him upon a mule, and led him round the town in procession.” (*The Grub Street Journal*.)

On the same authority (No. 230), under date Wednesday, May 23, 1734, is announced the sudden demise of the leading candidate: “On Monday, about five in the afternoon, the Right Hon. the Lord Visc. Vane dropt down dead of an apoplexy, just as he was taking leave of a gentleman, at his seat at Fairlawn in Kent” (*Daily Post*).

An early design upon bribery at elections is attributed to Hogarth. This plate was produced during the canvass in 1734, just twenty years before the commencement of the famous “Election” series by the same artist. The print is a small etching, and represents Sir Robert Fagg, an old baronet, seated on horseback, holding a purse in one hand, and offering a bribe of money to a young woman who is standing by his horse’s head; on her arm is a basket of eggs; she is laughing at the canvasser. Sir Robert Fagg was member for Steyning, Sussex. Concerning the baronet it is written, in “The Art of Politicks”—

“Leave you of mighty Interest to brag,
And poll two voices like *Sir Robert Fagg*.”

“The Humours of a Country Election,” of which the first version appeared in 1734, beyond the light it offers upon the subject in question, is curious and interesting, as Mr. F. G. Stephens is inclined to suggest⁴⁰ that Hogarth may have borrowed the idea of illustrating the chief incidents of an election from the “Humours” therein described. The plate is in three divisions, and forms the frontispiece to the collection of songs published under the title of “the Humours of a Country Election” in 1734, at which time there was a general election; it was republished in 1741,⁴¹ under

similar circumstances. The print is sufficiently described by the original advertisement, inserted at the time of its publication in the *Grub Street Journal* (No. 233), June 13, 1734. “*This Day is publish’d* (Price One Shilling), Neatly printed, and *stitched in blue paper*, ‘The Humours of a Country Election.’”

“Being mounted in their best array,
Upon a steed, and who but they?
And follow’d by a world of tall lads
That merry ditties, frolics and ballads,
Did ride with many a Good-morrow,
Crying, Hey for our Town, thro’ the Borough.”
(*Hudibras*.)

“A motley mixture! in long wigs, in bags,
In silks, in crapes, in Garters, and in rags;
From Drawing-rooms, from Colleges, from Garrets,
On horse, on foot, in Hacks, in gilded Chariots.”
(*Grub Street Journal*, No. 268. Also in the Poems
Edition.)

“With a curious frontispiece explanatory of the same in the following particulars:—

“I. The candidate welcomed into the town by music and electors on horseback, attended by a mob of men, women, and children. The candidates saluting the women, and amongst them a poor cobbler’s wife, to whose child they very courteously offer to stand God-father. II. The candidates are very complaisant to a country clown, and offering presents (a bag marked 50*l*.) to the wife and children. The candidates making an entertainment for the electors and their wives, to whom they show great respect; at the upper end of the table the parson of the parish sitting, his clerk standing by him. III. The place of electing and polling, with mob attending. The members elect carried in procession in chairs, upon men’s shoulders, with music

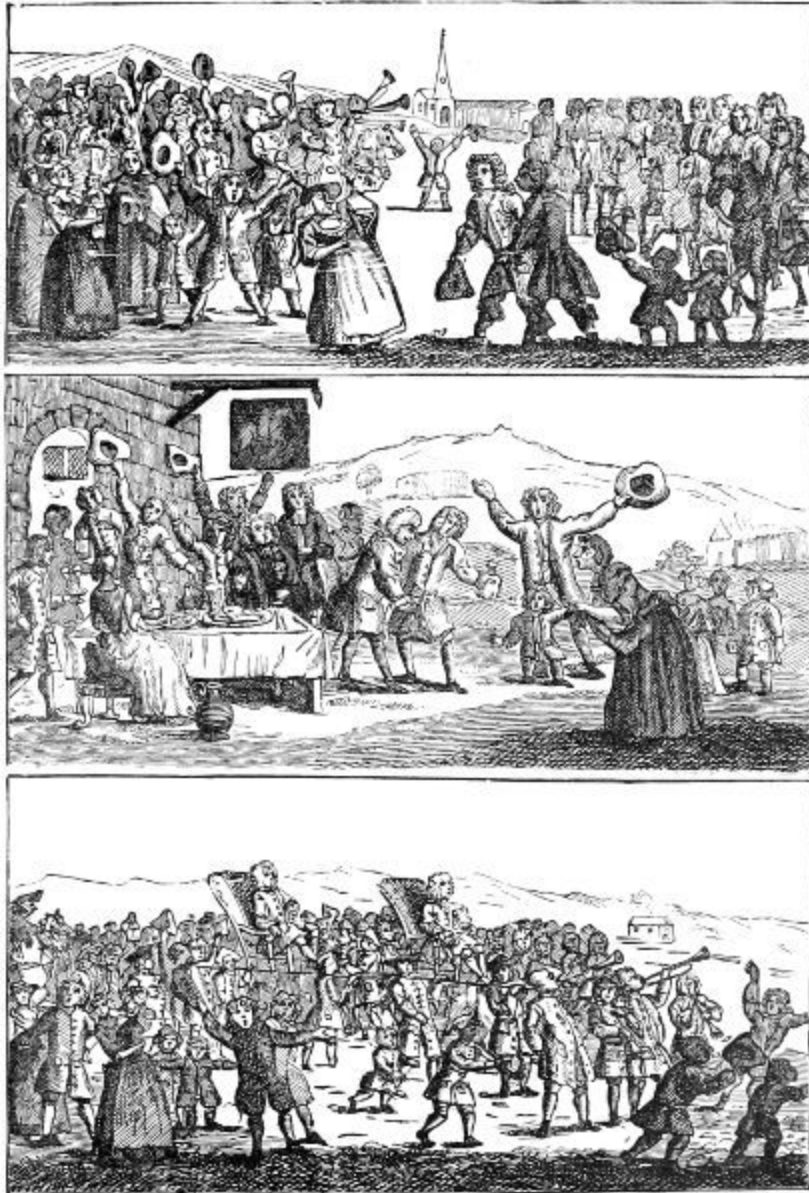
playing before them; attended by a mob of men, women, and children huzzaing them. To which is added the character of a Trimmer in verse, &c.”

“A new Year’s Gift (for the year 1741) to the Electors of Great Britain,” contains the information that “The Oath imposed upon Electors—the only preservative of public Liberty from the secret and fatal attacks of Bribery and Corruption,” was as follows:—

“I, —— ———, do swear, I have not received, or had myself, or any person whatsoever, in Trust for me, or for my Use and Benefit, directly or indirectly, any sum or sums of money, Office, Place, or employment, gift, or reward, or any promise, or security for any money, office, employment, or gift, in order to give my vote at this Election, and that I have not been polled before at this Election,

‘So Help me God.’

“Let every man of common sense judge whether an oath so wisely framed and strictly worded can possibly admit of any equivocation, to cover the base villainy of taking a bribe to his country’s ruin; and what shall we think of those men who dare tempt others to the breach of a duty so sacred! Ought they not to be stoned, or hooted out of society, as the destroyers of public Faith, Virtue, Religion, and Liberty? Do not such agents for the Devil compass his ends most effectually, by seducing men from the indispensable duties they owe to God and their country, to themselves and their posterity?



THE HUMOURS OF A COUNTRY ELECTION. 1734.

[Page 90.]

“Wisely, therefore, hath that good Law annexed the shameful penalties of the pillory to the breach of that Sacred Oath, with a large Fine of Five Hundred Pounds; and justly excluded all base perjurers from the most valuable Rights and Privileges of *Englishmen*, in the following paragraphs:—

“And be it enacted, That whosoever shall be convicted of false swearing, shall incur and suffer the Pains and Penalties as in a case of wilful and corrupt Perjury.

“And whosoever shall receive or take any money or other reward, by way of Gift, Loan, or other device, or agree or contract for any Money, Gift, Office, or Reward whatsoever, to give his vote, shall for every such offence forfeit the sum of Five Hundred Pounds, and be *for ever* disabled to vote in any Election of any Member to Parliament, and be for ever disabled to hold any public office.’

“Will any man, pretending to common honesty, thus basely forfeit his Birthright, his most glorious privilege as an Englishman, by a shameful perjury for the Lucre of a Bribe? Can such a Bribe make him and his posterity happy in the midst of his country’s ruin, and the just contempt and abhorrence of all his neighbours? No, surely: but when the small wages of his iniquity are spent, he must, like the Traitor Judas, hang himself, or starve to death; because no man can either pity, or deal with such a perjured abandoned wretch.

“Artful corruptors of the present times may flatter weak minds with hopes of being admitted to vote without taking the Oath; but it is a vain delusion; since the Law allows the *Candidates or any two of the Electors* to put the Oath to whomsoever they please; and surely there are at least *Two Honest Men* in every Borough of the Kingdom, who will think it their duty to bring Corruption to the Test of this just and necessary Oath, to the eternal infamy of all Corruptors, and the Corrupted.”

The oath thus explicitly explained was in sober earnest administered by the lawyers retained in the respective interests, as illustrated by Hogarth in his “Polling Booth,” 1754. It is rather alarming to think of the huge amount of perjury which has followed electioneering. The general elections of the spring of 1741 were a trying ordeal for Walpole; all the well-worn clamours were revived, the “Convention” was once more torn to shreds, and fresh attacks upon the “excise projects” were turned to bitter political account. Amidst a shower of squibs, both literary and pictorial, we find the caricature, “Dedicated to the worthy Electors of Great Britain,” of “The

Devil upon Two Sticks,” in which Walpole, as the “Asmodeus” of the situation, is represented as being supported upon the shoulders of two of his bought-majority to ford the “Slough of Despond,” already crossed by some of his followers, who, though in safety on the bank, bear evident marks of the dirty ordeal through which they have been compelled to struggle upon “Robin’s” account. Britannia and her patriotic friends(?) remain high and dry on the other shore; below the satire appears a pointed indication of the unpopular Walpolians, as “Members who voted for the Excise and against the Convention.”



To the worthy Electors of Great
Britain. Walpole carried through the
“Slough of Despond.”

THE DEVIL ON TWO STICKS.
1741.

“A Satire on Election Proceedings” was given to the public in pictorial guise on the occasion of the appeal to the constituencies in May, 1741; the specific part of this squib was aimed at Walpole’s unpopular taxes and similar enactments, and the whole was dedicated to “Mayors and Corporations in general.” A dying elector—who, from the evidence of a paper inscribed “£50,” and seen in his pocket, has sold himself to party—is in the hands of a ministerial candidate and the personage of Evil; who are, between them, dragging the moribund and venal voter towards a precipice, “the Brink of Despotism, poverty, and destruction, inevitable if such courses are continued.” The candidate or agent is apparently heedless of the precipice at his feet; he is waving his hat in exultation, and shouting, “A vote, a vote, a dead vote for us!” The devil, who is the deepest of the party, is asserting with plausibility, “I’ll have the Majority, I warrant you!” His pocket contains the measures which had destroyed Walpole’s popularity and at that time foreshadowed his fall—fancifully supposed to have had their suggestion in the brain of the arch-fiend himself: “Standing Army,” “Lotteries,” “Cyder” (tax), “Stamp Act,” “Bribes,” and “Address.” The demon is expelling “False reports against the City of London—all wind”—patriotism having at that era its head-quarters in the corporation; his hoof has trampled upon the shield of Britannia, crushed down by “Press-warrants,” “Council of Satan,” and the ministerial policy—“Neglect the seamen till the moment they are wanted, lest my beloved press-warrants should be forgot—my friends shall boldly call them lawful.” Walpole, whose tenure of office notoriously depended on the results of the elections in progress when this violent squib was launched, is further indicated in “The Foundation we go upon;” “we” being by implication the prime minister and the devil; the foot of the latter rests upon these “Ways and means—Public Money, Promises, Titles, Contracts, Pensions, Preferments, Places—and by threatening to displace,” etc., besides current coin for corruption. A further instance of Walpole’s disfavour is embodied in a paper concerning the army: “My Majority shall vote for a numerous Land Force in time of Peace; to be established with a double proportion of officers!—the best proof of my influence:”—the source of that vaunted influence is shown in a bag of money, marked “Sinking Fund,” from whence pours the stream of corruption—in the shape of broad pieces—upon which the prime minister placed a reliance he did not attempt to disguise, but, on the contrary, of which he cynically boasted.

Beneath is a coat of arms, a favourite figure with the satirists, as if designed for the sign of a tavern; the bearings are, 1. A fox running away with a goose. 2. “Checquy,” *i.e.*, as in the sign of the Chequers; the words, “Time-servers Intire;” behind appear a bottle and two glasses, tobacco-pipes, and bribes. “£100, £50, £40, £2,”—to suit all appetites; on a riband above the shield is the legend:—“Votes are sold for Wine and Gold.” The crest of the card would be a suitable escutcheon for Hogarth’s comprehensive election satires which appeared in the contest of 1754.

Another coat of arms, also aimed at the credit of the prime minister, was reissued as appropriate to this season:—“To the glory of the Rt. Honble. Sir Robert Walpole,” “A great Britt.,” alluding to the motto of “S(ir) R(obert) W(alpole)’s Arms,” supplies an ironical and explanatory text:—

“There is another Device at the Base, the *Arch*, in the shape of a *Coat of Arms*, which is bound round with a *Garter*, and hath these words inscribed upon it:—*Honi soit qui Mal y pense*; ‘Evil be to him, that evil thinks.’ What is most remarkable in this *Coat* is, that it bears *three axes* on one side, and that the crest is a *Man’s Head*, with a strange sort of *Cap*, which hath a Ducal Coronet at the bottom by way of Border;”

—thus suggesting that Walpole deserved decapitation, while the ballads of the day were all for finding a gibbet for “false Bob.” As to the print itself, it is said:—

“I am glad to hear that it hath already met with the approbation and encouragement of a *very great Family*; and I hope shortly to see it displayed in the richest colours upon Fans, and wrought into *Screens* and *Hangings* for the use and ornament of the Palace of Norfolk;”

—referring to Houghton Hall, the seat of Sir Robert Walpole, a residence well known to fame.

The popular interest excited by the Westminster contest generally seemed to make that election the most prominent in every appeal to the country. On the dissolution of parliament, April 28, 1741, when the fate of

Walpole's Administration was known to depend upon the aggregate return of his nominees, the ministers expected to bring in their friends who had previously sat for Westminster; the first great opposition to the Government had its rise there, where the Court was supposed to possess an unbounded influence. In the "Memoirs of Sir Robert Walpole" the circumstances of the contest are thus summarized:—

“The representatives in the last Parliament were Sir Charles Wager, First Lord of the Admiralty; and Lord Sundon, a Lord of the Treasury; and it was supposed they would have been rechosen, as usual, without opposition. But Lord Sundon was very unpopular; he had been raised from a low condition to an Irish Peerage through the interest of his wife, who had been favourite bed-chamber woman to Queen Catherine, wife of George II. The other candidate, Sir Charles Wager, was unexceptionable, both in his public and private character; but his attachment to the Minister was a sufficient objection. Some electors of Westminster proposed, very unexpectedly, Admiral Vernon, then in the height of his popularity, and Charles Edwin, a private gentleman of considerable fortune. The opposition, at first despised, became formidable; and Sir Charles Wager being summoned to convoy the King to Holland, the management of the election was entrusted to ignorant vestrymen and violent justices. The majority of the electors were decidedly in favour of the Ministerial candidate; but Lord Sundon was imprudently advised to close the poll, to order a party of Guards to attend, and, while the military power surrounded the hustings, the High Bailiff returned him and Sir Charles Wager. This imprudent conduct highly exasperated the populace, the Guards were insulted, Sundon was attacked, and narrowly escaped with life. The example of the opposition at Westminster diffused a general spirit throughout the kingdom, and violent contests were excited in all quarters. Large sums of money for supporting the expenses were subscribed by Pulteney, the Duchess of Marlborough, and the Prince of Wales, who contracted great debts on this memorable occasion, and the managers of the opposition employed this money with great advantage.”

This account, by W. Coxe, epitomizes the situation. George (Bubb) Dodington was active on this occasion, directing the manœuvres of the Leicester House faction, on behalf of the heir to the throne, in opposition to the ministers of his father, the king. Naturally the view taken by Walpole's biographer is favourable to that minister, who was at this time looked upon as the under-hand enemy of his country. He was accused of favouring Spain and France; and the taking of Porto Bello by Admiral Vernon, which was not, after all, a brilliant affair, but chiefly due to the cowardice of its defenders, was regarded as quite as much of a victory over the prime minister as over England's foes. These sentiments characterize the spirit abroad on the Westminster contest of 1741, which gave rise to many songs, broadsides, and pictorial satires uniformly unfavourable to the minister and his adherents.

The kind of influence or coercion brought to bear is described in an "Address to the Independent and Worthy Electors," which was issued by the "patriotic party," May 5th:—

"Notwithstanding the extraordinary methods used by some of the Burgesses of the Westminster Court, the select vestries of several of the parishes, and the High Constable; who has in his own name, and by his own power, taken upon him to summon the inhabitants to give their Poll *against* Admiral Vernon and Mr. Edwin; we have been already so successful in our endeavours to retrieve the *independency* of this City and Liberty, in the Election for the next Parliament, that the old members have but a very inconsiderable majority (if any) of Good Votes against

The Glorious ADMIRAL VERNON,
And CHARLES EDWIN, Esq.,

who stand upon the Country Interest.

Therefore, Gentlemen, now is the time for completing what we have so successfully begun; since it is certain that almost the *whole* of the Interest on the other side is already near poll'd, and not one-fourth of ours. And considering the great and perhaps decisive turn that the Election of this City and Liberty may give to the Elections all over the

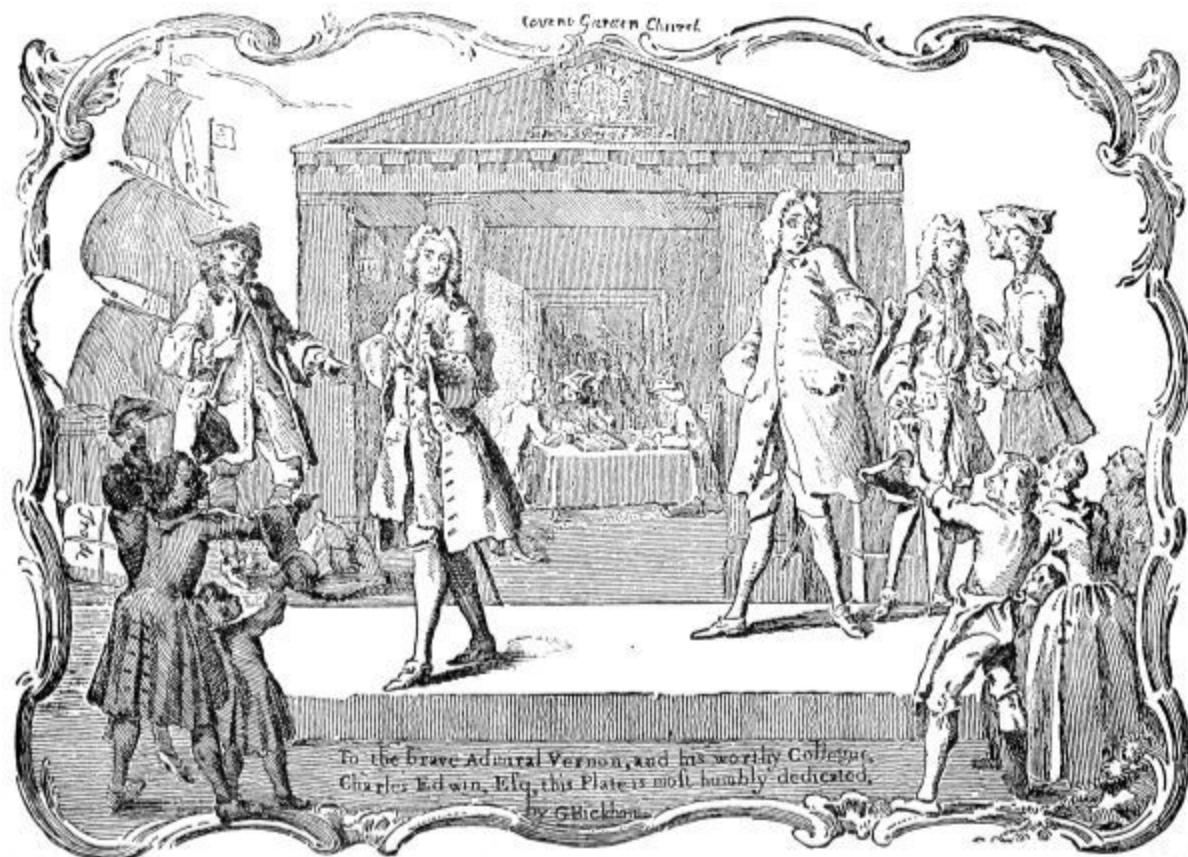
kingdom, it is hoped that no man who has a regard for the Liberties of his Country, and the Independency of Parliament, will lie by or remain neuter upon this occasion.

Therefore your Votes and Interest in favour of

ADMIRAL VERNON, and
CHARLES EDWIN, Esq.,

who have no other views than the good of their country and the prosperity of this ancient City and Liberty.”

The contest thus stood: the king, Duke of Cumberland, and the ministers,—with all their patronage, but overburdened with unpopularity, especially as regarded certain acts touching the navy, the standing army, and excise and other new taxes disliked by most,—supporting candidates looked upon with disfavour, on the one side; opposed by the Prince of Wales and his active friends of the “patriotic party,” with a popular naval commander and “a friend of his country” as candidates, and the voice of the multitude, on the other; the arena being the hustings at Covent Garden, supposed to be regarded expectantly by all the constituencies in the country.



TO THE INDEPENDENT ELECTORS OF WESTMINSTER. VERNON AND EDWIN. 1741.

[Page 97.]

A pictorial version of the scene of the Westminster Election, 1741, dedicated “to the brave Admiral Vernon and his worthy colleague, Charles Edwin, Esq.,” appeared with a copy of verses “To the Independent and Worthy Electors of this Ancient City of Westminster.” The candidates are exhibited before the front of Covent Garden Church; in the pediment is shown a dial, with the motto which at that time caught the eye of the moving crowd, “So Passes Ye Glory of Ye World.” Seated at a table in the portico beneath, are the poll clerks, with the returning officer casting up the votes: one clerk is directing a list to be set down in the “Poll Book” for “Vernon and Edwin;” while the representative of the other side says, “Few for my Lord.” Vernon’s ships, and the benefit of increased commerce in the shape of bales of merchandise, are shown in the distance; the favoured admiral himself, with laced cocked hat and a staff in his right hand, is

declaring, "For the Glory of Britain, down with the Spaniards." In front of the platform, and next the popular favourite, stands Charles Edwin, who is declaring his sentiments to be for "My King and my Country." The candidates of the opposition are received with enthusiasm: "Vernon for ever, no dribbers here;" "Edwin at home, Vernon abroad," is shouted by the persons to the left of the picture. The results of the election were undetermined when this engraving appeared, so the engraver has anticipated the ultimate results of the petition, and made the ministerial candidates unsuccessful. Sir Charles Wager, in a dejected state, is exclaiming, "I don't know where to put up next." Lord Sundon, represented as a mere "fribble," is in conference with Justice De Veil, who had a large share in the control of the Westminster election, and being in the Government pay and a powerful partisan, was, together with the returning officer, on these accounts the object of popular indignation. Lord Sundon is declaring for "The Excise and another place:" the duties on "cyder" and fermented liquors gave extreme offence to the multitude. The magistrate is made to exclaim, "I, Justice De Veil, say so, and will justify it." The good folks on the right are hissing, and crying, "No pensioners!" A female is pronouncing for the gallant admiral, "Vernon among the women to a man;" and a voter is denouncing "Spithead Lights,"—in reference to the reviews and home displays of the Admiralty, represented by Sir Charles Wager.

Below the design are the lines—

"O, put it to the public voice
To make a free and worthy choice;
Excluding such as would in shame
The Commonwealth. Let whom we name
Have Wisdom, Foresight, Fortitude,
Be more with Faith than Place endu'd,
Whatever great one it offend;
And from the embraced Truth not bend.
These neither practised force, nor forms,
Nor did they leave the helm in storms;
These men were truly Magistrates;
And such they are make happy states."

Towards the close, the state of the poll stood thus:—

Sir Charles Wager, 3686.

Lord Sundon, 3533.

Admiral Vernon, 3290.

Charles Edwin, 3161.

At this stage of the proceedings, when the independent candidates claimed to have many votes in reserve, while the ministers had exhausted every subterfuge and all their resources, Lord Sundon very injudiciously appealed to an armed intervention, forcibly closed the poll, and ordered a body of grenadiers to surround the hustings, and prevent any further voting; while the high bailiff countenanced these high-handed illegalities, and made his return accordingly. This proceeding ruined the chances of the Government in this contest of 1741: a petition was presented against the return of Wager and Sundon, and, although Walpole fought with all his influence, the subject was made a party question; in the new session, a warm contest arose in the Commons, which reassembled June 25, 1741, and the return of the sitting members was decided against by a majority of four, the numbers told being 220 to 216. The circumstance of “the election being declared void,” is alluded to in a letter from Horace Walpole to Sir H. Mann, December 10, 1741: “Mr. Pulteney presented an immense piece of parchment, which he said he could but just lift; and was the Westminster Petition, and is to be heard next Tuesday, when we shall all have our brains knocked out by the mob.” A new election ensued; Charles Edwin and Lord Perceval were returned without opposition. Vernon had been chosen for several places, and had already taken his seat for Ipswich. The admiral was regarded by the populace as a hero of the first water, whose victories, though for the honour of his country, were thorns in the side of the Administration, the members of which were accused of taking bribes from the enemy. The bards compared Vernon to Cincinnatus:—

“Let Rome no more with ostentation show
Her so long-fam’d dictator from the plough;
Great Britain, rival of the Roman name,
In arts, in elegance, in martial fame,
Can, from the plough, her Cincinnatus fellow,
And show a Vernon storming Porto Bello.”

The admiral is further alluded to in another engraving produced upon this same election—“The Funeral of Independency,” where the mourning procession is passing a tavern with the loyal sign of the Crown and Anchor. Among other episodes is a man on a donkey, who is galloping “post to Ipswich 10s. 6d.”—in allusion to Vernon’s return for that place; while another man is apostrophizing the rider, “Thou art as tedious as the law.”

The sequel of the memorable Westminster election of 1741 is pictured in “The Triumph of Justice” (Dec. 1741), an engraving of a satirical character, in which the late events, the triumph of opposition headed by the Prince of Wales, and the discomfiture of the Administration, are figured in allegorical guise. Walpole’s earthly career is assumed to be finished by the defeat in the Commons, who voted by a majority of four against the election of that minister’s placemen; and he is hurried to the tomb. A sarcophagus is displayed whereon a Satyr, with hour-glass and scythe, usurps the post of symbolical Time; on the base of the monument is inscribed “Hic Jacet;” in front is a medallion of the statesmen supposed to be departed, with the legend:—“*Padera Robertas Ord: Perisci—tidis Eques;*” the supporting “weepers” are the disqualified members,—they bear a band inscribed “Our Hopes are gone, the Election’s lost.” Sir Charles Wager, as representing the admiralty, is leaning on a broken anchor. Lord Sundon has beside him a coin, two keys, a loaf, some mice (one of which is caught in a trap), in allusion to the treasury “loaves and fishes,” parasites, etc. On the ground, across the reverse of Walpole’s medallion, which bears the legend “*Regit dictus Animos,*” are a sceptre and three bludgeons, “*Boroughs*” and “*Bruisers,*” both used for electioneering purposes, to which a plate marked “Covent Garden” further alludes.

Above the clouds, and surrounded by an angelic host, is seated the Prince of Wales, the *deus ex machina* of Walpole's defeat; his sceptre is a bludgeon, and he is pointing to an orator, who is presumably denouncing "the king's party," whose power is broken. Beside the heir apparent is a female divinity, balancing the scales of justice above the figure of Edwin. At the prince's feet is seen "the glorious 220," the number of votes recorded by the opposition, disqualifying Wager and Sundon, and in favour of a new election for Westminster. The British crown, decorated with palms and laurels, caps the design; which is inscribed, on a riband beneath, "*To the Independent Electors of Westminster.*" A further allegorical engraving, appropriately due to Jo. Mynde, exhibits and commemorates the final stage in this contest, where the Court was defeated and the opposition scored a complete triumph; this version, which consists of a design and a petition, engraved on the same plate, is entitled, "The Banner of Liberty, displayed in the Petition of the Inhabitants of Westminster, with the Coat of Arms of the Glorious two hundred and twenty-two who voted in favour of the Petitioners." The emblematical design displays the tutelary guardian of Westminster, a female figure, seated on the ground in deep dejection; her hand is resting on the armorial shield of Charles Edwin, which is placed before that of Lord Perceval (Earl of Egmont); the arms of Westminster are engraved on a stone, and the shield of Admiral Vernon also appears. The goddess of Liberty has arrived on the scene, she has summarily put "Slavery" to flight, and while she is assisting the guardian of the liberties of Westminster to rise, the muskets of the soldiery are trampled under foot, in allusion to the bold and impolitic step of ordering grenadiers to close the poll, resorted to at the previous election by Lord Sundon, to the damage of his patron Walpole. In the Commons it was suggested to indict the soldiers who had the temerity to interfere with "the rights of election."

"THE INDEPENDENT WESTMINSTER ELECTORS' TOAST.^{[42](#)}
IN MEMORY OF THE GLORIOUS TWO HUNDRED AND TWENTY.

To the Tune of 'Come, let us prepare,' etc.

“My *Westminster* Friends,
Now we’ve gained our Ends,
Here’s a Health, and I’m sure ’twon’t repent ye:
With Gratitude think,
To the Health let us drink
Of the Glorious *Two hundred and Twenty*.

2.

“Come Honestly on,
Give your votes as you’ve done,
When you voted for EDWIN and VERNON;
Like Britons be bold,
Laugh at Power and Gold,
Else slavery comes, and will spare none.

3.

“The army so grand,
For the good of the Land,
That is annually chose our protectors,
A new Trade have got,
And without *Scott or Lot*;
Are now all become our Electors.

4.

“The Justices, too,
Will soon have their due,
As well as that Rogue the *High Bailey*;
Tho’ ye strut and look big,
With your Sword and Tye-wig,
The Parliament soon will to jail wi’ ye.

5.

“Brave *Edwin* for you
Did all he could do,
As at the last Poll ye remember,
Now all of ye shou’d
To him be as good,
And choose him once more for your member.

6.

“An *honest good* Lord
To find out, how hard,
At this time, let any man think, Sir!
Yet all do agree
Lord Perceval’s he,
Then EDWIN and PERCEVAL drink, sir.

7.

“Besides his brave spirit,
My Lord has this merit
With us; that Bob hates him to death, Sir,
He has sworn Zounds and Blood
That my Lord never shou’d
Be a member, as long as he’d breath, Sir.

8.

“Then under his nose
These brave men we will choose,
To show we don’t fear, but despise him.
We’ll laugh and we’ll flout
At the rabble at Court,
Who, for what they can get, idolize him.

9.

“The Parliament just
And firm to their trust,
Have giv’n you another Election;
Then your Liberty use,
These honest men choose,
And rely on their steady protection.

10.

“VERNON’S self will rejoice,
When he hears of our choice,
And is told how we’ve routed the Old-ones;
Then join Hand-in-Hand,
To each other firm stand,
For Success always follows the Bold-ones.

11.

“But if any more
Bob shou’d do as before,
Or by Fraud or by Violence cheat you,
In numbers then go
And demolish your foe—
Ye’re Fools if again he defeat you.”

Other verses appear in a version with a woodcut heading of a party of jolly citizens toping and toasting healths:—

“Your High Constable rout,
Your Vestrymen out,
Ye Burgesses, Stumps, and High Bailey;
Tho’ *Robert* assist,
We ne’er will desist,
No Power nor Help shall avail ye.

“But Vernon no more
You can serve as before,
He is chosen for several places;
Then choose in his room
A brave man who will come
And use the Court tools to their faces.

“Lord Perceval here
Will shortly declare,
Who fears neither Wager nor Sundon,
But hates all the tribe
Who take pension or bribe,
By which we brave boys are all undone.”

A second ballad bears a strong resemblance to the foregoing; one or two verses only are selected:—

“THE INDEPENDENT WESTMINSTER CHOICE, OR,
PERCEVAL AND EDWIN.
To the Tune of ‘The Free Masons.’”

“Ye Westminster Boys, unite and rejoice,
Be steady, and make no defection;
For if you stand true, you are not too few
To carry your glorious election.

“Thus, while Vernon shall ride on America’s tide,
And by arms bring the Spanish Dons under;
His friend shall stand here, this noble young Peer,
And rattle old Bob with his thunder.

“You may now firmly hope, your ruin to stop,
When Vernon abroad guards the nation:
And this noblemen true, match’d by none or by few,
Shall expose all Court Tricks and Evasion.

“Thus shall PERCEVAL brave, your Liberties save,
And with EDWIN in Senate defend you:
These men they were giv’n, a present from Heav’n,
Reject not what Heaven does send you.”

Another spirited ballad, on the same theme, and also to the tune of “*Come, let us prepare,*” appeared as “A New Song,” with a woodcut heading of a maiden and matron drinking tea at the sign of the Crown and Orange-Tree. A second version of the same ballad was published as:—

“THE TRUE ENGLISH-BOYS’ SONG TO VERNON’S GLORY.
OCCASIONED BY THE BIRTHDAY OF THAT BRAVE ADMIRAL.
To be sung round the Bonfires of London and Westminster.”

“Ye Westminster Boys, All sing and rejoice,
Your friends in the House will not fail ye,
We’ll the soldiers indict, And set matters right,
In spite of that Rogue the High Bailey.

“Let us raise our Bonfires As high as the spires,
And ring ev’ry Bell in the Steeple;
All the Art we defy, Of the whole Ministry,
To run VERNON down with the people.

“Stand round, and appear, All ye Hearts of Oak here,
And set the proud *Don* at defiance,
To VERNON let’s drink, who made Spain and France slink,
And BOB, who’s with both in Alliance.

“A true lad won’t flinch, Now we’re at this sad pinch,
But old England, on VERNON rely on,
For this honest Fellow, who took *Porto Bello*,
Shall find BOB a Gibbet to die on.

“Stop not VERNON’S career, Thro’ Folly and Fear,
Lest the *French*, or the *Spaniards* should beat ye;
Nor let *Don Geraldino*, Busy *Horace*, or *Keen O*
Bamboozle you with a new Treaty.

“This time then be bold, Be not bought and sold,
Nor let *Monsieur*’s old Tricks still seduce ye,
Like our Forefathers try, Or to conquer or die,
Ere *France* to a province reduce ye.

“*Hessian* Troops are all sham, The Neutrality damn,
The *Convention*, and ev’ry Vagary;
The money they’ve got, All is now gone to pot,
And so is the Queen of Hungary.

“But send Ships and Food, To VERNON, that’s good,
For unless Heaven feed him with *Manna*,
His designs they’ll defeat For without men and meat

THESE DESIGNS THEY WILL DEFEAT, FOR WITHOUT MEN AND MEAT,
How can he e'er take the *Havanna*.

“Besides, let us send, a true militant Friend,
Nor longer be Bob's, or Spain's dupe a;
They there would agree,—Both by Land and by Sea,
And soon be the masters of Cuba.”

The managers of what was called the “Country party” consisted of those who entitled themselves “patriots,” and were active in promoting the “good cause.” The victory which in 1741 unseated Wager and Sundon, and moreover inflicted so heavy a blow upon Walpole's influence that he lost his corrupt majority, and subsequently retired from the struggle, was annually commemorated by an association of members of the constituency which had been the first to assert its independence. An invitation was issued to the voters to meet together to celebrate this anniversary; a copperplate, neatly engraved, surmounted by an allegorical design, and surrounded by an elegant frame or border, formed the ticket:—

“The Independent Electors of Westminster
Are desired to meet at Vintners' Hall, Thames Street,
On Friday, the 15 Feb. 1744,

At 3 o'clock, to Dine together, in order to Commemorate their Success
on the 22nd of December, 1741, and further to promote the same
Public Spirit.

GEORGE DODINGTON, Esq. }	{ LORD GEORGE GRAHAM.
CHARLES EDWIN, Esq. }	{ GEORGE GRENVILLE, Esq.
THOMAS GORE, Esq. }	{ SIR JOHN PHILLIPS, Bart.

Stewards

Pray Pay the Bearer 5 shil^s.”

The design which heads this dinner-ticket represents Hercules and Britannia driving away the Harpies presumed to have been preying upon corruption; the Goddess of Liberty, with the British lion by her side, is trampling on prostrate venality,—two figures, with bags of money and a heap of gold, cast down ignominiously.

“The Body of Independent Electors of Westminster” was evidently constituted into a society, at first exclusively for the furtherance of patriotic views, but, as the Court party alleged in 1745, to spread Jacobite sentiments. The excitement evoked by the rising of the Scottish clans and proclamation of the Young Pretender in 1745 was still at its height; the gaols were filled with Scotch rebels, and the famous trial of Lord Lovat, which only commenced on the 9th of March, was absorbing popular attention to the extinction of everything but Jacobite plots, both real and feigned. As the patriotic party had long been in antagonism with the Court, whose ministers had been defeated through this influence, and the dissolution of Parliament was impending, those in office neglected no opportunity of bringing the so-called “friends of the people” into evil repute. On the assumption that all weapons are lawful in electioneering warfare, much political capital was manufactured out of the Pretender’s *fiasco*; and the Scottish Rebellion was seized as an opportunity to stigmatize all persons of integrity, and those who were declared enemies of the corrupt Administration then in power, as Jacobites and sympathizers with the rebels.

“The Independent Electors of the City and Liberty of Westminster” held their anniversary festival at Vintners’ Hall, on the 19th of March, 1747. The Stewards were the Earl of Lichfield, Earl of Orrery, Viscount Andover, Sir R. Bamfylde, George Heathcote, and Thomas Carew. On this occasion the stewards for the ensuing year were chosen; they were Lord Ward, Lord Windsor, Sir James Dashwood, Sir Charles Tynte, Sir Thomas Clarges, and George Cooke (who was then canvassing Middlesex). On the conclusion of the business of the afternoon, and after the festivities, toasts, as was customary, began to be proposed. *The London Evening Post* gives a list of these healths, beginning with “The King;” but, as an implication of Jacobite proclivities, it is added in another paper that the royal health was honoured in the recognized Jacobite fashion—to “Charley over the Water:”—“Each man having a glass of water on the left hand, and waving the glass of wine over the water,”—but this accusation was probably a bold electioneering *ruse*. The succeeding toasts were as follows:—“The Prince;” “The Duke;” “Prosperity to the independent electors of Westminster;” “Prosperity to the city of London and the trade thereof;” “Thanks to the Worshipful Company of Vintners’ for the use of their Hall;” “The Lord Mayor of London;”

“Success to the arms of Great Britain by sea and land;” “To the annexing *Cape Breton* to the Crown of *Great Britain*;” “That the spirit of independency may diffuse itself through the nation;” “That the enemies of *Great Britain* may never eat the bread nor drink the drink thereof;” “That the Naturalization Bill may be kicked out of the House, and the foreigners out of the kingdom;” “That the darkening our windows may enlighten our understanding” (tax upon light); “To all those that dare—be honest;” “The stewards elect;” “The late stewards, with thanks for the trouble they have taken;” “Our old Friend ——.”

According to the *Gentleman’s Magazine*, “amidst this mirth, one Mr. Williams, Master of the ‘White Horse’ in Piccadilly, being observed to make memorandums with a pencil, gave such offence that he was severely cuffed and kicked out of the company.” It appears that a Jacobite complexion was given to the rather forcible expression of public contempt bestowed upon the Ministerial notetaker, who was branded as “the Spy.” A spirited version of this incident, executed closely in the manner of Hogarth, if not by that master, to whose portrait of Lord Lovat it in style approximates (the artist was himself one of the free electors of Westminster), exhibits the ignominious ejection of “the Spy,” whose detection is further indicated by the paper he has dropped on the ground, marked “List of the persons, etc.” The pictorial view of an episode to which undue importance was attached, owing to the excited relation of parties at the time, is accompanied by a quotation from “Hudibras” appropriate to the subject:—

“Honour in the Breech is lodg’d
As wise philosophers have judged;
Because a kick in that part more
Hurts Honour than deep wounds before.”



MEETING OF THE ASSOCIATION OF INDEPENDENT ELECTORS OF
WESTMINSTER: THE SPY DETECTED. MARCH, 1747.

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A few days later a second entry shows that it was seriously entertained at that emergency to carry the matter farther; in any case—although they do not seem to have eventually made anything of it—the complaint was taken up by the Commons, and referred to the managers of Lord Lovat's trial, then just concluded. On the 24th of March—

“Complaint being made to the House that John Williams, keeper of the ‘White Horse Inn’ in Piccadilly, was on Thursday last, in a public assembly, assaulted and severely treated, upon a public assertion made by some persons in that assembly—*‘that, Fraser, said by them, to be one of the principal witnesses against the Lord Lovat, was in his custody’* ORDER’D. That a committee be appointed to enquire into the matter of this complaint, and examine persons in the

most solemn manner; that this committee be the managers against Lord Lovat.”

The whole matter is obscured by party misrepresentations. One James Fraser, who was pronounced a Jacobite, was active against the Ministerial candidates at the Westminster contest of 1749, where all opponents of the Court were denounced as Jacobites, while the “patriots,” “country party,” and “independent electors of Westminster,”—as they indiscriminately christened themselves—retorted upon Earl Gower, through his son, Lord Trentham, the Ministerial candidate for that city, the accusation of Jacobite leanings:—“Ask Lord Trentham *who had his foot in the stirrup* in the year 1715.”

The parliamentary dissolution followed in June, 1747, when the favourite manœuvre of those in power was to recklessly accuse their opponents of belonging to the Stuart faction. The odium attaching to the suspicion of Jacobite tendencies was sufficiently strong to place the “Independent party” in a smaller minority than at the previous election, and thus the outbreak in favour of the Pretender served to recruit the strength of the Court party, which had been jeopardized at the 1741 election, and had shown signs of declension before the rising in 1745. The Government candidates for Westminster, Admiral Sir Peter Warren and Lord Trentham, were again chosen from the Admiralty. Lord Trentham was the son of that Earl Gower who was for some time the head of the Opposition, and at this juncture was one of the recent recruits of the Court party.

“See Gower, who the Court had opposed thick and thin;
Was out, then was in, then was out and now in;
He kiss’d hands, then look’d pensive—as much as to say,
“I can’t judge which is best, to go or to stay.

Derry Down.”

(Place Book for the Year 1745.)



WESTMINSTER—THE TWO-SHILLING BUTCHER. 1747.

Lord Trentham's selection as a lord of the admiralty occurred somewhat later (1749). The second candidate was Admiral Sir Peter Warren, who, as usual, was supported by a mob of Jack Tars, or of ruffians dressed in sailors' clothes for the occasion, a common party subterfuge at the Westminster elections. The candidates put forward for the suffrages of the "Independent Electors," and who came out of the contest ingloriously, were, as first announced, Sir Thomas Clarges (one of the stewards of the

association) and Sir John Phillips (who was a steward in 1744); after a ten-days' canvass the latter declined to proceed in his candidature, on the plea of ill health, and Sir Thomas Dyke was put up in his stead. Early in the contest a well-executed caricature, in the manner of Boitard or Gravelot, both artists being contemporary with Hogarth, was offered to the public under the title of "The Two-Shilling Butcher." It was at this election that the highest personages canvassed. The Duke of Cumberland and the Prince of Wales appeared in support of the rival factions. In the pictorial view of this situation, Lord Trentham, a dandified person dressed in the extreme of French taste, is in conference with his "backer" the "Two-Shilling Butcher," who has been supposed by Thomas Wright and other authorities to represent the "Culloden Butcher," *i.e.* the Duke of Cumberland. Mr. F. G. Stephens, who has described all the early caricatures in the Hawkins Collections with the utmost pains and minutiae, sets down this personage as Mr. Butcher, the agent to the Duke of Bedford, whose residence is introduced in the rear. However, the figure in the present version corresponds with similar representations of the stout Cumberland Butcher; moreover, an allusion to cattle put into the mouth of this personage strongly indicates, by analogy with other caricatures on "horned cattle," that none other than the duke is meant. The results of the election were at this time uncertain. The affected lordling, also satirized as Sir Silkington, is drawling, "Curs me! you'd buy me, ye Brutes, at 2s. p. Head *Bona fide*?" to which the figure travestied as a butcher, with apron, knife, and steel, is responding, "My Lord, there being a Fatality in ye Cattle, that there is 3000 above my Cut, tho' I offered handsome." The "3000" presumably refers to the Association of Independent Electors, who, at the previous poll (1741), registered for the "patriot" candidates (Vernon and Edwin), but were found wanting in 1747, as the figures at the close of the poll demonstrated. The Duke of Bedford's residence is introduced to recall the circumstance that he and the candidate were close matrimonial connections, the duke having married the eldest daughter of John, Earl Gower. In front of this building, with the "bustos" of sphinxes above the posts of the gateway, is another important personage, who is bribing rival canvassers with gold openly filched from the pockets of Britannia, who is highly indignant at the proceeding; she is made to exclaim, with reason, "Ye Gods, what pickpockets!" The people seen in the dark transaction of being bribed were defectors from "Phillips and Clarges," demoralized by the spell of gold;

another voter is hastening away, denouncing the venality of these persons. One of the sphinxes is exclaiming—"We can't decoy them in!" while labels, carried through the air by pigeons, record "The Independent has it," and "For Yorkshire." On the opposite side is shown the front of St. Paul's, Covent Garden, with its dial and the motto "So passes ye glory of ye world." Before its portals stand the rival candidates, Sir Thomas Clarges and Sir Thomas Dyke; they are showing their contempt for mere "placemen representatives" by trampling upon government bribes: "Places in Exchequer we tread on," and "No lucrative Employment." Near them are the poll clerks, and the returning officer, with the poll-book under his charge. Beside the "independent" candidates are shown their supporters: one of these, bearing in his hand the cap of liberty, is pressing the latter on the acceptance of the electors, and assuring them, "Those candidates will serve you!" while a scroll, borne above the heads of the voters, carries the warning, "No Trentham!"



THE HUMOURS OF THE WESTMINSTER ELECTION; OR, THE SCALD MISERABLE INDEPENDENT ELECTORS IN THE SUDS. 1747.

Other caricatures appeared on the same subject, which excited, as usual, the largest share of public interest during the elections throughout the country. One of these first appeared, in compliment to the Scottish Rebellion, the latest novelty of the time, as “The Jaco-Independo-Rebello-Plaido.” In this version the business of the election is represented to take place before Westminster Hall, as a further allusion to the Jacobites and Lord Lovat’s trial there. The two parties and their respective head-quarters, established at taverns, are represented, and above all hovers the power of Destruction, always pictured as an important agent of “the other side,” according to the respective allegations of the contending parties. The Devil, in the present instance, is made “to take care of his own,” and has a stock of halters and axes for the rebels. “I have the Fee in my hands,” saith the Evil One. One side is appropriated to Ministerialists at the sign of Jolly Bacchus and the (Rabbit) Warren. Two persons are leaning from the first-floor window, and exhorting those with votes to “Give the Devil his due”—*i.e.* the Jacobites. The most prominent figure is a butcher; and no doubt, according to Mr. F. G. Stephens’s suggestion, the person thus implied is Mr. Butcher, the Duke of Bedford’s agent, and a less distinguished person than the “Cumberland Duke” pictured in the “Two-Shilling Butcher.” He is waving a scroll endorsed, “Trentham and Warren.” The butcher agent is surrounded by partisans; Admiral Sir Peter Warren’s sailors (a Lascar among them) are asserting “bludgeon law;” the people are pushing to the Governmental head-quarters, crying “No independency” and “No Pretender,” as if the terms were synonymous; a Frenchman may be identified in the crowd; and a person is offering the butcher a paper, “They squeak.” The head-quarters of the opposite party is shown as a Jacobite house. The flag displayed is adorned with the figure of an owl dressed in a full wig and a counsellor’s bands, and indicates “Morgan’s Ghost,” the Morgan thus favoured having been a Jacobite barrister who had the misfortune to be implicated in the abortive rising of 1745 in the interests of the Pretender, which cost Morgan his life. The adherents rallying round this questionable house, intended as a reflection upon the Association of Independent Electors of Westminster, who were stigmatized as friends of the Jacobites, are dressed for the most part in plaids, and wear Scotch bonnets, to imply their Jacobite sympathies. This caricature was republished, with the hustings at Covent Garden substituted for Westminster Hall, and the Devil very civilly giving place to the figure of an angel, with

the legend “Faithful to King and country.” The title was changed to “The Humours of the Westminster Election; or, the Scald Miserable Independent Electors in the Suds,” 1747, with the following lines:—

“Britons brave are true and unconfin’d,
To lash the Coxcombs of the Age design’d;
Fixt to no Party, censure all alike,
And the distinguish’d Villain sure to strike;
Pleas’d we behold the great maintain the Cause,
And Court and Country join the loud applause.”



GREAT BRITAIN'S UNION; OR, THE LITCHFIELD RACES. 1747.

[Page 114.]

Strong Jacobite imputations are farther conveyed in the pictorial version of “Great Britain’s Union; or, the Litchfield Races, 1747.” Both Whig and Tory parties, not content with the legitimate and recognized contests of the hustings, and their ultimate goal, the senate, carried their partisan proclivities on to the racecourse, and ministerial and opposition

stakes were alternately put into competition on the same turf. Thus, at Lichfield were held Tory race weeks, succeeded by similar gatherings on the part of their opponents. Some rather extraordinary doings occurred there, the general description of which is conveyed by the caricature; the two factions by some means came into collision, and his Grace of Bedford received a sound hiding with a horsewhip as an acknowledgment of his services to the House of Hanover and his antagonism to the Patriotic party, denounced as Jacobites by their Hanoverian rivals; Earl Gower, and his modish son, Lord Trentham, were also roughly handled. Various freaks of an extravagant nature were performed, ladies and gentlemen of the Patriotic faction appearing dressed in Scottish plaids. In the design this circumstance is specially embodied: a party of enthusiasts, assembled in a booth on the course, are toasting the Pretender, whose sun is seen in the distance, falsely depicted as in the ascendant. A despondent grenadier outside the Jacobite head-quarters, is grumbling, "We are rode by Germans;" a cradle, a Gallic cock, and a *fleur-de-lis* allude to the Chevalier and the French assistance lent to his pretensions; overhead several hands are seen clasped, with the suggestive legend, "A-greed." A Frenchified person, pointing to a gamecock fighting his own shadow, is denouncing the Duke (of Bedford) in no measured terms; under his right arm is the whip with which the duke was castigated, and in the left hand of this valorous bravo is a paper, "We have courage." As usual, the Devil is present, and this time he is flying off with "Information," possibly to be laid before his dear friends in office. A sort of zany, seated beneath a flag marked, "And curse upon denial" (alluding to equivocation on the part of several), is giving the starting signal. The Scotch plaid-clad jockey riding for the Chevalier is beating the Hanoverian jockey on the traditional "White Horse." This highly fanciful conception, the reverse of actual experience, is hailed with extravagant delight by the excited assembly; the occupants of the Grand Stand are described as "Don Juan and his friends at the place of Desert." Various ballads and satirical productions were evoked upon the transaction related.

Lord Trentham, his father, Earl Gower, and their great relative, the Duke of Bedford, are, with various references to the late election for Westminster, introduced into several caricatures which followed, and notably in "Great Britain's Union; or, Litchfield Races transposed," "A Sight of the Banging Bout at Litchfield," and "An Exact Representation" of

the same occurrence. The circumstances to which these pictorial satires refer are traceable to the national ferment succeeding the suppression of the Rebellion, when, as recapitulated, various eccentricities were committed by those who favoured the Pretender's cause; among others, certain Staffordshire sportsmen made themselves conspicuous. Smollett, in his "History of England," describes these vagaries: the Stuart partisans—

"appeared in the Highland taste of variegated drapery, and, their zeal descending to a very extraordinary exhibition of practical ridicule, they hunted with hounds clothed in plaid, a fox dressed in red uniform. Even the females at their assembly and the gentlemen at the races affected to wear the chequered stuff by which the prince-pretender and his followers had been distinguished. Divers noblemen on the course were insulted as apostates; and one personage of high rank is said to have undergone a very disagreeable flagellation."

The sequel of this adventure is related in the *Gentleman's Magazine* (1748):—

"Before Mr. Justice Burnett, took place the trial of the information against Toll (a dancing-master) and others, for insulting and striking the Duke of Bedford, and other gentlemen, upon Whittington Heath, at the late Litchfield horse-races; when it was likewise proposed by the counsel for the defendants, that the several rioters, to the number of thirteen, should submit to be found guilty: if the counsel for the crown would consent to withdraw the information against several other persons concerned in that riot."

The circumstances of the *fracas* are also alluded to in the "Letters of Junius" (xxii.):—

"Mr. Heston Humphrey, a country attorney, horsewhipped the duke with equal justice, severity, and perseverance on the course at Litchfield. Rigby and Lord Trentham were also cudgelled in a most exemplary manner."

These incidents gave rise to various ballads as well as caricatures; a parody on "Chevy Chase" offers the liveliest version of the affair:—

“THE LORDS’ LAMENTATION; OR, THE WHITTINGTON
DEFEAT.

“God prosper long our noble King,
Our lives and safeties all,
A woeful Horse race late there did
At Whittington befall.
Great Bedford’s duke, a mighty prince
A solemn vow did make;
His pleasure in fair Staffordshire
Three summer days to take,
At once to grace his father’s race,
And to confound his foes;
But ah! (with grief my muse does speak)
A luckless time he chose.
For some rude clowns who long had felt
The weight of tax and levy,
Explain’d their case unto his Grace,
By arguments full heavy.
‘No Gow’r,’ they cried, ‘no tool of pow’r!’
At that the Earl turned pale.
‘No Gow’r, no Gow’r, no tool of pow’r!’
Re-echo’d from each dale.
Then Bedford’s mighty breast took fire;
Who thus enrag’d did cry,
‘To horse, my Lords, my knights and squires;
We’ll be reveng’d or die.’
They mounted straight, all men of birth,
Captains of land and sea;
No prince or potentate on earth
Had such a troop as he.
Great Lords and Lordlings, close conjoin’d,
A shining squadron stood;
But to their cost, the Yeomen Host
Did prove the better blood.
‘A Gow’r, a Gow’r! ye son o’ th’ w—e,
Vile spawn of Babylon!’
This said, his Grace did mend his pace,
And came full fiercely on.
Three times he smote a sturdy foe:

THREE TIMES HE SHOT A STARRY ICE,
Who undismay'd replied,
'Or be thou devil, or be thou Duke,
Thy courage shall be tried.'
The charge began; but, on one side,
Some slackness there was found;
The smart cockade in dust was laid,
And trampled on the ground.
Some felt sore thwacks upon their backs.
Some, pains within their bowels;
And who did joke the royal oak,
Were well rubbed with its towels.
Then terror seized the plumed troop,
Who turned themselves to flight.
Foul rout and fear brought up the rear,
Oh! 'twas a piteous sight!
Each warrior urg'd his nimble steed,
But none durst look behind;
Th' insulting foe, they well did know,
Had got them in the wind.
Who ne'er lost scent, until they came
Unto the gallows tree:
'Now,' said their foes, 'we'll not oppose,
Your certain destiny.
No further help of ours ye lack,
Grant mercy with your doom!
Trust to the care o' the three-legg'd mare,
She'll bring ye all safe home.'
Then wheel'd about with this fierce shout,
'Confusion to the Rump!'
Leaving each knight to moan his plight
Beneath the triple stump.
Now Heaven preserve such hearts as these
From secret Treachery!
Who hate a knave, and scorn a slave,
May such be ever *Free!*"

In 1749, Lord Trentham, having been appointed one of the lords of the

admiralty, had to vacate his seat, and every exertion was made by the Opposition to hinder his re-election.

“With this view they held consultations, agreed to resolutions, and set up a private gentleman named Sir George Vandeput as the competitor of Lord Trentham, declaring that they would support his pretensions at their own expense; being the more encouraged to this enterprise by the countenance and assistance of the Prince of Wales and his adherents. They accordingly opened houses of entertainment for their partisans, solicited votes, circulated remonstrances, and propagated abuse; in a word, they canvassed with surprising spirit and perseverance against the whole interest of St. James’s. Mobs were hired, and processions made on both sides, and the city of Westminster was filled with tumult and uproar.”

“Ye ELECTORS who hate all the French strolling Clan,
If you love yourselves, chase not the MINISTER’S MAN,
But give all your Votes to the *Man* of the KING,
SIR GEORGE VANDEPUT’S he—and GEORGE we will sing.”

This election occurred in the midst of a violent popular anti-Gallican feeling, which had been shown particularly against a company of French players who were performing at the Haymarket, and who were spoken of by the mob as the “French vagrants.” An attempt had been made to hinder them from acting, and they had been protected only by a mob hired by Lord Trentham, who appears to have affected Gallic manners, and to have been vain of his proficiency in the French language. The night after his ministerial appointment there was a great riot at the French theatre, in which Lord Trentham was accused of being personally active, although he denied it to the electors. This was made the most of by his opponents, who stigmatized him in ballads and squibs as “the champion of the French *strollers*,” and common people said that learning to talk French was only a step towards the introduction of French tyranny.

An “Elector” writes, by way of warning to others:—

“Being the other evening at the French Theatre, who should I see at the head of a mob of foreign varlets, cooks, etc., signaling himself in a laudable attack upon his fellow-citizens, but this very young man,

whom they had so lately made choice of as the defender of their rights and privileges. I was indeed amazed to see, at so critical a juncture, that sword, which had hitherto kept peaceful possession of its scabbard, brandished over the heads and planted at the hearts of several of his own electors, and that in support of a parcel of foreign vagabonds, who, from being a nuisance in their own nation, are now come to be the disgrace of ours. Certain I am this fit of Gallic valour could never be communicated by the touch of that Royal British hand he had but that very morning kissed for his employment. Perhaps an impatient desire to prove himself qualified for the warlike Board to which he was appointed might induce him to seize the first opportunity of displaying his prowess; being willing to convince the public, that how deficient soever the sea may have been, the land is, at least, able to produce a fighting Admiral. However, I cannot help concluding him a very unfit person to defend me *against* the French in one House, who is ready to cut my throat *for* them in another.”

A flight of satirical ballads appeared upon these events. The best of these compositions, which were remarkable for point and spirit, was entitled:—

“PEG TRIM TRAM IN THE SUDS; OR, NO FRENCH
STROLLERS.

“I sing you a song of a right noble Lord,
Whose name must, for ever, stand FOOL on Record;
Who, losing a *Seat*, by accepting a Place,
SUBSCRIB’D to *French Strollers*, so fell in disgrace.

“This right noble Lord, when elected before,
To preserve us, in our *ev’ry Privilege* swore;
How well he maintain’d them will quickly appear,
Deduc’d from right Reason, unaided by Sneer.

“Got snug in the House, he exerted his zeal,
Not for his Constituents, or the Common-Weal;
But to serve his own ends, and aid *Gentleman HARRY*,⁴³
Lest his Glorious Views, for our Good, should miscarry.

“Have you heard a pert *Parrot* cry ‘*Quaker-a-quer*;
A cup of Good Sack; *Pretty Poll*; *Saucy Cur*’?
You’ve then heard this Lord to great HARRY reply,
And echo, *Yes, No,—No, Yes*,” anything cry.

“Have you seen a young *Puppy* leap over a stick,
Fetch, carry, yelp, fawn, and learn every fond Trick?
Then you’ve seen this sleek Lordling on HARRY attend,
And, aw’d by his nod, most obsequiously bend.

“To reward such bright parts and so ductile a mind
The Dispenser of PLACES was strongly inclin’d;
When deeply reflecting what he could afford,
He fix’d him (slap dash!) at the Admiralty Board.

“This little Lord, conscious that he had no right
To a *Post* which requir’d, not to Fiddle, but Fight;
Resolved that for once he’d assume martial airs,
And in the *Haymarket* protect the FRENCH PLAYERS.

“He flew, he appear’d, and he heard a strange roar;
The like had ne’er tickl’d his soft ears before;
Then to set an example to future *Protectors*

Then to set an example to future Electors,
He drew forth his TILTER—and at his ELECTORS.

“Shock’d at this rough treatment, in print they demand,
Why, ’gainst his best Friends, he thus lifted his hand;
His answer was full of mean *Equivocation*,
Which made them the jest and contempt of the Nation.”



BRITANNIA DISTURBED BY FRENCH VAGRANTS. LORD TRENTHAM FOR
WESTMINSTER. 1749.

[Page 121.]

The caricaturists endorsed this view. In “*Britannia Disturbed, or an Invasion by French Vagrants*, addressed to the worthy Electors of the City of Westminster,” 1749, Lord Trentham is trying to force these importations on Britannia, who is nursing “Lunn” (Rich), and “Fribble;” these she declares “are my only Theatrical children, I will cherish no Foreign vagrants.” “Peg” Trentham, with drawn sword, is asserting that he will perforce cram these “entertaining dear creatures” down the throat of the

nation; the strollers are like marionettes, and wear wooden shoes, as a hint of French neediness. Earl Gower is anxious for his rash scion's future prospects: "My long-headed son will smart for this scheme." "Push on, my Lord," is the encouragement of "a subscriber." "Bludgeon-men, at two shillings a day," engaged for the election, are making a demonstration of force, and shouting for their employer's glorification.

This Westminster election is said to have been one of the most expensive contests that the Government had as yet experienced. The following epigram describes a supposed conversation between Lord Trentham and his father:—

"Quoth L—d G—r [*Lord Gower*] to his son, 'Boy, thy frolic and place
Full deep will be paid for by us and his g——e [*grace*]:
Ten thousand twice over advanced!'—'Veritable,
Mon pere,' cry'd the youth; 'but the D—e [*Duke*] you know's able:
Nor blame my *French frolics*; since all men are certain,
You're doing behind, what I did 'fore the curtain.'"

At the conclusion of the polling there appeared a majority for Lord Trentham, but his opponents demanded a scrutiny; and this scrutiny proved so laborious and difficult, or the parties interested in opposing the Court threw so many obstacles in the way, that it led to a quarrel with the House of Commons, which lasted some months, and gave a double celebrity to the Westminster Election of 1749.

The most was made of Lord Trentham's Gallic proclivities, which were held up to ridicule in ingenious satires. The following handbill is an example of the squibs circulated by his opponents during the election:—

"AUX ELECTEURS TRÈS DIGNES DE WESTMINSTER.

"MESSIEURS—

“Vos suffrages et Interêts sont desirés pour le Très Hon. mi Lord Trentham,

“UN VERITABLE ANGLAIS.

“N.B.—L’on prie ses Amis de se rendre à l’Hôtel François dans le Marché au Foin.

“TO MY LORD TRENTHAM.

“The King of France (my most glorious Monarch) being touched with a lively sense of the obligations he owes your Lordship, for the powerful protection you have given to his subjects in England, honours you with his thanks, and commands me to assure you, that your Lordship shall be the *Chief Manager* of his *Playhouse* in England, as soon as your Lordship and your Friends have brought those insolent rascals, the English, under his dominion, being satisfied the measures your Lordship and Friends now pursue cannot fail of your desired success.

“I have the honour to be
“Your Lordship’s most obliged humble Servant,

“MIREPOIX.

[French ambassador to the Court of
St. James’s, 1749-1751.]

“N.B.—Translated from the Original French.”

Great favour was shown to docile voters, while the refractory were subject to crying injustices. The following handbill, circulated at the time, exposes the meannesses to which a Duke of Bedford could descend in the interests of his candidate:—

“TO THE WORTHY ELECTORS OF WESTMINSTER.

“A true Copy of a Letter sent to an inhabitant of Covent Garden, who thought himself at liberty (though a Tenant to the Duke of Bedford) to vote according to his *own conscience*; which having done, he received the following:—‘I hereby give you Notice, that you are to quit the house you rent of his Grace the Duke of Bedford, situate in Bedford Street, in the parish of St. Paul, Covent Garden, at Lady-Day next, or to pay his Grace *Seventy-two pounds* a year for the same from that time.

““RT. BUTCHER, Steward to His Grace.

““Nov. 29, 1749.

““To MR. MATTHEW CREYGHTON.’

“NOTE.—I acknowledge to have received the above letter by the hands of Mr. Becuda, one of his Grace’s stewards, and accept the notice therein. The rent I at present pay is *thirty-six pounds* per annum. I voted for and to my utmost have served Sir George Vandeput. Who would not?

“✱✱ No rent due to his Grace.

“MATTHEW CREYGHTON,

“An insulted Elector of Westminster.

“N.B.—The House to Let.”

The general election of 1747 furnished Hogarth with a suggestion which employed his attention anterior to his more ambitious election series. The House of Commons dissolved on the 18th of June, and the artist, taking time by the forelock, had his engraving “A Country Inn-yard at the Time of Election” ready for publication while the contests were occupying the public. As the print in question informs us, the cry of a “Babe of grace,” heard at the City election of 1701, was repeated in 1747. The subject of the stage-coach and inn-yard is generally familiar. It contains the figures of the fat woman of abnormal proportions being assisted into the coach by the efforts of her meagre husband; while the equally obese landlady, seen at the bar window, which she fills, is vigorously pulling the bell to summons the

coach passengers. It is the background of the picture which illustrates the present subject. The sleek landlord, wearing an apron, and with a pair of snuffers pendent at his girdle, is presenting to an election agent a bill for the expenses incurred for the entertainment of his party; that the amount is excessive is conveyed by the expression of suspicion which pervades the features of the agent, who is preparing to settle the account; the landlord is evidently protesting as to his immaculate reputation, while a part of the *Act* against bribery on elections is projecting from his pocket. The galleries of the inn-yard are filled with spectators, who are favoured with a sight of the humours of an election procession—a posse of men carrying sticks and bearing an effigy of a more than life-size baby, with a child’s rattle and hornbook, or A.B.C. Behind the chair, in which this figure is seated, is carried a flag with the inscription, “No Old Baby.” Nichols and Stevens, in their “Notes to Hogarth” (1810) have explained that the “Old Baby” effigy and cry were resorted to by the antagonists of the Hon. John Child, whose family, by Act of Parliament, took the name of Tylney in 1735. This candidate stood member for the county of Essex in opposition to Sir Robert Abdy and Mr. Bramstone. At the election, a man was placed on a bulk, with a mock infant in his arms, who, as he whipped the babe in effigy, exclaimed, “What, you little Child, must you be a member?” The member in question was then Viscount Castlemaine, and afterwards Earl Tylney. At this disputed election, it appeared, from the register book of the parish where this candidate was born, that he was a “Child” in more than one respect, being but twenty years of age when returned for parliament.

CHAPTER V.

SATIRES ON THE PARLIAMENTARY ELECTIONS OF 1754.

A favourite figure with the satirists was to portray wily party manœuvrers as vermin-catchers, and those apostate representatives who were ready to sell themselves and their parliamentary trust were displayed as the spoils of their craft. A cartoon appeared at the time of these elections reflecting upon the tricks of administration. It will be seen that nearly all these early caricaturists seem disinterested, as their subjects oppose the dispensers of patronage. The engraving shows the Duke of Newcastle seated beside St. Stephen's Chapel, and fishing for partisans among the late members, and, in anticipation, bidding for the adherence of the possible representatives in the coming parliament; this subject is entitled, "The Complete Vermin-Catcher of Great Britain; or, the Old Trap new baited." The minister's line is dropped through the chimney of St. Stephen's, and is baited with *Titles, Bribes, Places, Pensions, Secret Commissions*, and patronage in *Army, Navy, and Excise*. The intriguing duke, who was a proficient in corrupting others, and spent a large fortune in electioneering wiles, is observing, "All Vermin may be caught, tho' differently, suit but the Bait to their various appetites. But there's a species will take no Bait; would I could scare them away; as they're not Vermin, they will not answer my purpose." The greedy place-hunters are swarming plentifully, and are offering to do any amount of dirty work, to "push for posts," "Jews and no Jews," being indifferent to everything but profit. The Pelhams, unscrupulous themselves, were past-masters of the art of finding venal tools. It is disclosed in the diary of Bubb Dodington (Lord Melcombe-Regis), the manager of the Leicester House intrigues, and himself an accomplished adept in dissimulation, how disreputably the Duke of Newcastle contrived to secure Bubb's parliamentary influence (six seats) "for nothing!"

The corrupt character of a large average of those sent to the Commons as representatives of the people was in perfect keeping with the no less greedy boroughmongers who found them seats and the mercenary voters, their constituents by presumption; what a man bought—and in those days almost everything political had its price and was purchasable—he held himself justified in selling when the chance occurred. A satirical rendering of the imperfections then supposed to affect the body of the senate appeared at the time of these elections of 1754, when, by wholesale bribery, the Administration was, at an enormous cost, doing its utmost to degrade the entire system of representation:—“Dissection of a Dead Member (of Parliament).” The subject is extended upon a table for autopsy, five surgeons have severally examined the different functions, and the results of their post-mortem inspection is thus stated:—

1st Doctor. The Brain is very foul and muddy, it has a Contusion, or, as it may be called, a soft place in it, locked in the stone kitchen by way of qualification.

2nd Doctor. Ay, ay, he knocked his head too hard against politics and bruised his pericranium. He was bred a Foxhunter.

3rd Doctor. The *Vena Cava* of the *Thorax* makes a noise, and sounds as if one should say, “My country be damn’d,” and his intestines have got, I think, ’tis “Bribery,” wrote on them—not a drop of good blood in his heart.

4th Doctor. Bribery, the *Auri Sacra fames* of the ancients—ay ’twas a diet he was fond of, ’twas his Breakfast, Dinner, and Supper, and affected all the corpuscles of his corporeal system, it was his *Insanible Membrum*.

5th Doctor. There’s a most potent Fœtor exhales as if the whole body was corrupted—if the bones are touched it won’t make an Anatomy.

The elections of 1754 are rendered more interesting to later generations from the circumstance that the famous series of paintings by Hogarth, better known by the engravings as the “Four Plates of an

Election,” owe their origin to the electoral contests which ensued on the parliamentary dissolution, April 8, 1754. Before that date the tendency of events was shadowed forth. For instance, Henry Pelham, a pupil of Walpole’s, who combined the offices of first lord of the treasury and chancellor of the exchequer, passed the Jews’ Naturalization Bill in June, 1753, chiefly by his own exertions; but reaping thereby an enlarged measure of unpopularity—sufficient to jeopardize his party and his future career, if not to extinguish the political prospects of the Pelhams beyond rehabilitation—this detrimental concession was recalled, and, in the face of a general election and its possible eventualities, the Bill was repealed. The hostile feeling provoked by the measure in question still remained, and although the principal agent on its introduction had himself departed, it exercised, as will be seen in the political satires, much influence over the elections of 1754, in the way of helping the return of fresh opposition candidates, and defeating ministerial nominees. Henry Pelham, the prominent figure of the administration, expired in the full tide of his unpopularity. That enmity—consequent upon his acts—followed him to the tomb is illustrated by a spirited caricature, published on his death, and disclosing the probable reception which awaited the late premier on the other side of the Styx. “His Arrival at his Country Retirement and Reception,” March 6, 1754 (the anniversary of Pelham’s decease). In this etching Henry Pelham is entering on his future state, introduced to the infernal regions by a demon chamberlain. The “salle des pas perdus,” is not so easy as anticipated; Pelham is observing to his conductor:—“It was much easier walking in the Treasury. I hope my successor finds it so.” The ghosts of departed statesmen are variously greeting the arrival of the latest addition to their class. His predecessor, Sir Robert Walpole, is welcoming a worthy pupil: “O, this is a child of my own bringing up. I found him a promising Genius for dirty work, I therefore did all I could to gain him the succession at my retirement hither, knowing that some of his black strokes would make me appear as fair as alabaster. He has done it in several respects, but chiefly in getting the Naturalization of the Jews passed,—have any of you great Genius’s done anything equal?” The spirit of Judge Jeffreys is declaring, “All my transactions in the West were but a joke to that great achievement.” The disembodied Cardinal Wolsey is observing, “Is that the choice spirit you have so often described? I made pretty large strides towards making the people swallow down what I thought proper—

but this beats all my '*Ego et Rex Meus's*' out of doors!" A shade affirms, "We are all puny statesmen to him;" and the most astute politicians of history are voted beginners beside Pelham—"If you, old Machiavel, had known him in your days, he'd a' lent you a lift."

In the elections which were held in April, 1754, the Court seems to have experienced less opposition than might have been expected; for although the spirit of the antagonistic "Leicester House party" had been damped by the death of the Prince of Wales, which occurred unexpectedly in March, 1751, it now showed signs of reviving.

The contest for the City of London gave rise to several interesting caricatures. The humours of canvassing are displayed in "The Liveryman's Levée" (April, 1754), which represents an elector, a self-sufficient tailor, with his vulgar wife. The pair are receiving the obsequious bows of five of the candidates, who, in 1754, put up for the City of London. The absence of Sir John Barnard, the celebrated city patriot, is professionally marked by a suit hanging on the wall,—"*A Plain Suit of Broadcloth for Sir John Steady.*" The liveryman is insolently resenting the independence of the favourite candidate: "Where's Sir John? I think he is greatly wanting in his duty. Does he imagine that a man of my figure is to be trifled with? Don't he know that we expect to be waited on?" There are other allusions to the recommendations for and objections against the respective candidates.

As the dissolution of parliament approached, satirical views of the situation became numerous, and there appeared various well-executed caricatures upon the subject of the city election. In "The City Up and Down; or, the Candidates Pois'd," the candidates were represented perched upon suspended boxes, part of a huge revolving machine. Sir John Barnard, Slingsby Bethel, and William Beckford are occupying the upper seats; they had represented the city in the last parliament, and, as there were no objections against their names, their re-election was considered secure. In a side box is Sir Richard Glyn, who was defeated; in another, somewhat lower, is Sir Robert Ladbroke, a new candidate, who was successful; below these is a fourth box, in which are Sir Crisp Gascoyne and Sir William Calvert; the latter, though one of the former representatives, secured the fewest votes in 1754. The reason for this falling-off in favour is

explained by the caricature; Calvert is surrounded by Jews, who are assuring him:—"You have all our interest, for your zealous support of our Bill!"—"Confound your Bill; now I have no hope left," replies Sir William, whose exertions on behalf of this measure lost him his seat. Barnard is declaring, "I am, strictly speaking, neither a friend to the Jews nor their enemy; excepting when they aim at having equal Rights and Privileges with my fellow-citizens and countrymen." While the inflexible Beckford, who later was Lord Chatham's "mouth-piece in the Commons," asserts, "It becomes a Man of Character to keep good Company." Ladbroke, who was a distiller, is declaring he "should like to be in good company too," but "fears it will be with the two kings"—"The King of the Jews" being Calvert the brewer, and Gascoyne, "King of the Gipsies." There are allusions to the occupations of the candidates; the voters are declaring, "If the gin-merchant [Ladbroke] gets in, gin will be cheaper." Other electors refer to Gascoyne and Calvert as "two very good beer-makers." On the opposite side of the river is shown Sampson Gideon, a prominent financier of his day, and afterwards knighted,—he is conducted by Satan, and his hat is filled with gold for purposes of bribery; he is eager to tamper with the balance of the boxes in the "great Up and Down machine;"—"If I was over I would turn the poise, though it cost me the profits of the last Lottery." Gideon was a strenuous supporter of those who voted for the Jews' Naturalization Bill, and, before the repeal of that measure, held hopes of getting into parliament. He is frequently alluded to in the electioneering squibs of the time. That he had substantial reasons for interesting himself in behalf of those in power appears from the "Report of the Committee appointed to investigate the Lottery of 1753," where it is stated that "Sampson Gideon became proprietor of more than six thousand tickets, which he sold at a premium." Preference allotments, being highly profitable, were useful as administrative patronage.

The city election is further illustrated by an engraving called, "A Stir in the City; or, some Folks at Guildhall," which represents various groups of citizens and persons prominent at the time, assembled before the Guildhall, while the six candidates are borne along on a long frame with six seats, and supported on men's shoulders, the procession being headed by a bishop; the party is received in state by the sheriffs, who are assuring the prelate, "as my Lord Rabbi," that "the Guildhall is not the Synagogue," and "no sons of

Levi have place here;”—in general, the bishops supported the Naturalization Bill. Dr. Ward, then before the public as an advertizing pill-vendor, is from his coach distributing quack nostrums; he is acknowledging that “not one will cure an Election Fever.” Gascoyne and Mary Squires, the gipsy, crooked and leaning on her staff, are represented, with Hogarth beside them; this refers to the charges against Squires brought by Elizabeth Canning, and proved false on further investigation by Sir C. Gascoyne, who retired from the city canvass, and successfully contested Southwark. Candidates for Hertford, Winchester, and other places are also introduced. A group of Jews stand by the Guildhall; one cries, “What a shame it is we have no votes!” Sampson Gideon is present, and another is confidentially remarking to him, “Tho’ you can’t vote, Sampson, you may still do business there;” to which the contractor replies, in reference to his expectation of sitting in parliament had the Act to remove the disabilities of the Jews continued in force, “I thought to have voted in another Building;” while a lean Hebrew neighbour whispers, “You have an excellent hand at a Lottery, all the world knows.” Orator Henley, standing in his tub, is recommending his butcher friends from Newport Market to convert the voters into Jews; and a hawker is crying, “Sir Andrew Freeport’s Address [to the Livery of London] for nothing.” The state of the polls for London and Oxfordshire are also given.

Of the six candidates carried in chairs, two and two, Sir John Barnard (at the head of the poll, 3553), is saying, “These are my fellow-citizens; I must not forsake them in my old age, for I always loved them.” Slingsby Bethel (3547), as president of the Free British Fishery Society, promises “the Herring Fishery shall thrive.” Beckford (2941) is made to declare, “I’ll vote for a new Bridge [Blackfriars]; but not for a new Jew Bill.” Sir R. Ladbroke (3390) is present, and so are the defeated candidates, Sir Richard Glyn, and, at the bottom of the poll, Sir W. Calvert, with the Jew Bill in his pocket—for which he asserts he “only voted!”

A further explanation of the allusions conveyed in this satire is afforded by the verses which accompanied the design:—

“O! see my Raree Show, good Folks,
All you who love Election Jokes,
You, John a Stiles! and John a Nokes,
Doodle, Doodle, Do.

“See Mr. Sheriff with his wand
Has put the Bishop at a stand,
Who takes Guildhall for Holy Land.

“There’s Sampson, full of discontent,
Because he’s not in Parliament;
Which was his very heart’s Intent.

“See Henley, with his surgeons there,
For Jew conversion all prepare,
Butchers cure cases, I declare.

“Sir Andrew Freeport has his eye
Upon the List and the Livery,
Fox, Barnard, Bethel, Beckford cry.

“A Beauty, Mistress Squires, see,
For Mr. Hogarth and I agree,
Beauty’s a Lane as crooked as she.

“There Doctor Ward, with looks demure,
Is giving his pills, but he is sure
Election fevers have no cure.”

The struggle for election was also epitomized under the popular paraphrase of a race-course: “The Parliamentary Race; or, the City Jockies” (April, 1754). Sir John Barnard is first on “Steady,” Mr. Slingsby Bethel is second on “Buzzard;” Sir R. Ladbroke on “Trimmer,” and William Beckford on “Will o’ the Wisp,” are making great exertions to cut out Sir Richard Glyn on “Little Driver,” who is flogging his horse to keep the third place, which he ultimately lost, his name standing fifth at the close of the

poll; Sir Crisp Gascoyne is left behind with “Miss Canning;” Sir William Calvert has come to grief, his horse, “Loose Legs,” having stumbled over a Jew pedlar, and, with the rider, been thrown out of the race. The contest is witnessed by horsemen, gentlemen on foot occupying the stand which the horses must pass, and the usual crowd of spectators present on a race-course, including an itinerant gin-seller dispensing spirits to workmen, in allusion to the distiller, Sir R. Ladbroke. Various observations are made on the chances of the race: “Old Steady [Barnard] is in first!” “Buzzard [Bethel] will blunder in second!” “Will o’ the Wisp [Beckford] has blood in him!” and other comments, as indicated above. The state of the “Parliamentary Stakes” is expounded in a copy of verses, possibly a parody after one of Tom D’Urfey’s odd ditties:—

“THE PARLIAMENTARY RACE; OR, THE CITY JOCKIES.

“O! Shade of D’Urfey, grant me Vit-a
To sing those Jockies of the city,
Who want in Parliament to get-a
Doodle, Doodle, Do.

“First comes Sir John, who wins the day;
His horse is ready to run away,
Nor will at all for ‘Loose Legs’ stay.

“But who is he on that scrambling Brute?
What, don’t you know, Sir, ’tis past dispute?
O! that is Alderman Orator Mute.

“Who flogs so hard, the third to be in?
O, that is a Knight, Sir Richard Glyn,
And ‘Little Driver,’ too, will win.

“O! see how he spins there, ‘Will of the Wisp’-a,
He’ll distance ‘Miss Canning,’ and Sir Crisp-a,
And all the Broomstuffs of the Gipsy.

“‘O! Damn the Jew,’ Sir William cries,
As o’er his horse he headlong flies.
Ay, that damn’d Jew threw dust in his Eyes.

“Sir Robert upon his ‘Trimming Nag’
Has too much spirit too long to lag,
He soon will pass the distance-flag.

“O! where’s ‘Miss Canning’? Out of sight,
Ay, her best strokes are in the night,
Now bring her up—or never, Knight.”

The summary of both the London and the Oxfordshire contests, which were regarded by ministers as of the utmost consequence, are given pictorially in a carefully engraved print, entitled “All the World in a Hurry;

or, the Road from London to Oxford,” April, 1754. At the extremities of the plate are views of the respective cities; to these the candidates and their supporters are proceeding on horse and foot, by two opposite lines of road. To the right, where the London cavalcade may be taken to commence, the largest mounted figure, and that nearest the spectator, is intended for Sir John Barnard, the head of the poll, who is trotting along at a steady pace, contented with his progress: “My steed is slow, but sure, Sir Robert.” Sir Robert Ladbroke, who is urging on his own career, replies, “What! without a spur, Sir John?”—Barnard having resorted to no election manœuvres, and not even canvassed the voters. Alderman Slingsby Bethel, jogging along comfortably in his gig, is observing; “I’ll leave my Election to the Arbitration of the Livery.” Sir Richard Glyn’s pace, in a post-chaise and pair, is checked by a group of pedestrians in the pathway; “What the Devil can’t you get before the Jews, Tom?” he is inquiring of his postillion, who replies, “They are in possession of the Road, Sir Richard:” Glyn, although for some time third in the voting, finally failed in his election. Also behind the group of foot-passengers are two prosperous-looking personages on horseback, Sir William Calvert and William Beckford, both late members for the city; the former is bantering his companion, “You won’t be first at Guildhall, Brother Beckford;” the famous patriot was returned third on the poll at the election of 1754: his rival retorts, alluding to Calvert’s position at the previous contest, “Nor you second, Sir William;” the support Calvert had lent the Jews’ Naturalization Bill was the cause of his being rejected in 1754. In the centre of the group of Hebrew obstructives is a stout man, mopping his forehead and complaining, as he drags along wearily, “Verily, England is too hot at this time of the year!”—this figure represents Sir Sampson Gideon, the loan contractor, who is surrounded by his co-religionists. One long-bearded Israelite is crying that “Sampson refuses to sweat a little for our friend Sir William!” (Calvert); another Jew declares, “Sir William has been sweated often on our account;” and a third is saying, “We must give him a little Grease for once” (*i.e.* spend money to further his election),—this refers to the encouragement the Jews offered Sir William Calvert, support rendered in return for his assistance in passing the Jews’ Naturalization Bill, which nearly cost the ministry their working majority, while one of the city members, Calvert, the great brewer of the day, lost both his popularity and his place in parliament. This measure had been passed by the Pelhams in the last session, and, until its repeal, Sampson

Gideon looked forward to a seat as a representative of the City of London. On the eve of the dissolution the ministers had repealed their unpopular Bill, and this concession to public opinion was regarded as an electioneering stratagem on their part. At the other end of the London group is Sir Crisp Gascoyne, who gave up his candidature for the city, and put up for Southwark, where he was rejected. At this time Sir Crisp was labouring under undeserved disfavour owing to his exertions to procure the conviction of Elizabeth Canning, the perjuress, for a false accusation against the gipsy, Mary Squires, who was, through Canning's devices, condemned to death, but was subsequently pardoned, after Gascoyne's investigation had established her innocence, and the true facts were made public. The case in question, which was not cleared up at the time of the elections, was the cause of that unpopularity which cost Sir Crisp his seat; in the engraving, he is made to exclaim, "Why, where are you, Mother Squires, with your infernal troop?"—Squires was alleged to be a witch! A friend riding beside him is pointing upwards, "Infernal! Sir Crisp? why, they are up in the air yonder!"—indicating a witch and three weird sisters riding on broomsticks over the heads of the parliamentary cavalcade. The leader, intended for the gipsy, is exclaiming, "I am afraid we are too late, sisters." The spectators are standing aside to let the procession pass; one is shouting bravely for the "tried members, Barnard and England for ever, huzza!" and two others are abusing Gideon's friends, who have hindered Calvert's election. "Damn the Jews! they are always in the way," "Turn 'em out of the Road." A copy of verses further elucidates the subject:—



ALL THE WORLD IN A HURRY; OR, THE ROAD FROM LONDON TO
OXFORD. 1754.

[Page 134.]

“LONDON.

“O! what! without a spur, Sir John,
And yet your steed is getting on?’
‘The steed is a good one I’m upon.’

“Says Madame Squires, in the air,
‘Our friend Sir Crisp need never fear—
Tho’ we are late, we will be there.’

“Sir William is not first, ’tis true,
Nor Barnard second, tho’ True Blue,
Glyn will be third—Jack! what say you?

“If there is an honest man in the nation
’Tis Bethel, I’ll say it without hesitation,
Nor leave it even to his own arbitration.”

The half of the engraving of “All the World in a Hurry,” having reference to the Oxfordshire elections, may be taken as an introduction to Hogarth’s famous series of “The Election;” the actual candidates, besides the contest, being set forth in this earlier version.

The two horsemen galloping in advance of their competitors represent Lord Wenman and Sir James Dashwood, the “True Blue” candidates, who gained the head of the poll, and were returned as “sitting members,” but were afterwards, “on a controverted election petition,” displaced to make room for Lord Parker and Sir Edward Turner, the representatives of the ruling party, who had been supported from the first with the entire government interest, and by a decision of the House of Commons were ultimately seated.

In the engraved version of this spirited competition, Lord Wenman is made to remark, “They are not far behind us, Sir James;” to which Dashwood responds, “Too far, my lord, to get up with us.” That every exertion was made is illustrated by the driver of the post-chaise which contains the ministerial nominees; the Duke of Marlborough, as postillion, is declaring “his jades, *i.e.* the voters, begin to kick”—the elections for Oxfordshire having been in the control of the Marlborough family at former elections; and, in fact, the same influence was so preponderating, that no opposition after the election of 1754, now in question, was offered in the county until 1826,—another Sir G. Dashwood was unsuccessful in the Whig interest in 1830. Sir Edward Turner and Lord Parker are in the ministerial post-chaise; the duke is proposing to throw over one of his nominees—“Sir Edward, you had better get out;” his colleague, however, is resisting this desertion—“You won’t leave me single, Sir Edward?” The latter is trying to spur their postillion forwards: “Push hard, my Lord Duke, or we shan’t get in.” Two Whig notabilities are riding at a distance; one is observing, “Sir James [Dashwood] and my Lord [Wenman] have got ground on ’em;” his neighbour is confidently replying, “Ay, and they’ll keep it, my boys.”

Last comes the great man of the administration, driving his phaeton and six. He bids a mounted messenger to “ride forward, and tell my Lord Duke I would have been with him, but my horses took fright at a funeral,

and won't pull together;" the Duke of Newcastle is the person represented, and the circumstance to which he attributes the restiveness of his six-in-hand was the death, just before the dissolution of parliament, of his brother Henry Pelham, a man of superior abilities to the duke, who had filled the same offices with a better hold on his team.

"OXFORD.

"From London into Oxford Town,
See all the world is hurrying down,
Dashwood and Wenman for a crown.
Doodle, Doodle, Do.

"The Duke of Newcastle in his Fly
Cannot get up to his grace; for why?
The Funeral! Ah! men will die.

"Sir Edward in the chaise you see;
'Get out, Sir Edward!' 'O, no!' says he;
'What,' cries my Lord, 'must I single be?'

"'My jades begin to kick,' says his Grace;
'Sir, you had better leave the place,
And never look them in the face.'"

The elections in Oxfordshire were marked by a more animated conflict than elsewhere; the Jacobite faction was still strong there, although the comparatively recent fate of those who had declared for the Pretender served to keep these sympathies within discreet limits. The contest was strongly marked by incidents which have survived in the four famous election pictures painted by William Hogarth, the unequalled originals of which, still in fine condition, are now somewhat lost to the public in Sir John Soane's Museum,⁴⁴ but of which the engravings are most familiar. Hogarth sold the series to his friend David Garrick for the modest price of 200 guineas; at the sale of Mrs. Garrick's effects, in 1823, they were secured by Sir John Soane for the corresponding moderate sum of £1732

10s. The “Election Entertainment” was exhibited at Spring Gardens in 1761. These characteristic satires seem to apply to electioneering episodes in general, not only of the eighteenth century, but until within the present; a recapitulation of the principal allusions, however, will show that these pictures are composed of studies for the most part drawn from life, and founded on the actualities of the 1754 contest in Oxfordshire. The “Election Entertainment,” the first of these plates, is so well known that it was felt unnecessary to reproduce any of its incidents. This scene might be taken as a generalistic view of the electioneering hospitality and “open house,” one of the first steps towards conciliating support, but that the three “party-cries” distinctive of this particular struggle are all pictorially perpetuated. The scene embodies gluttony, turbulence, and false patriotism, but bribery and violent intimidation prevail above all. The mayor, who occupies the seat of honour, has succumbed to a surfeit of oysters, and a phlebotomist of the barber tribe is endeavouring to blood his arm and cool his head at one time. A ministerial-looking personage is treated with coarse familiarity, while a youthful aspirant for popular favour is submitting to tipsified indignities at the hands of his temporary associates. Nichols, who mentions certain assurances he received from Hogarth as to the fact that, with one exception, none of the figures were intended for portraits, affects to recognize the handsome candidate.⁴⁵ This modish gentleman has been treating the fair sex to gloves, buff or orange favours, and other gear, from the pack of a pedlar of the Hebrew persuasion, who is also dealing in notes of hand; he holds one for £20 from the candidate, signed “R. Pention” (Pension being the word). While the Court party is regaling the Buffs, or Old Interest, at the leading tavern, their opponents, the Blues, are making an out-of-door demonstration; so that a view of the humours of both sides is simultaneously afforded. The New Interest procession is composed of “bludgeon-men,” bearing an effigy of the Duke of Newcastle, with the colours of the Old Interest, and a placard round his neck, “No Jews,” in allusion to the unpopular Act introduced by the Pelhams (1752) to permit the naturalization of foreign Jews. Another cry, inscribed on a blue standard, is “Liberty and Prosperity,” while a huge blue flag bears the inscription, “Increase and multiply in spite of old —,”⁴⁶ in reference to the recent Act for the regulation of marriages, which had encountered much opposition and given offence to the multitude. An animated exchange of missiles between the political antagonists is proceeding through the

window; those within are standing a siege from showers of bricks, to which they are replying with a volley of fluids and furniture showered on the heads of the passing patriots; while a rival detachment of Old Interest hirelings, displaying their orange cockades, being armed with oak cudgels, and headed by a partisan with a drawn sword, is sallying forth to make a diversion on the besiegers. A champion Orange bludgeon-man, seated on the floor in the foreground, has evidently returned from a raid on the foe, in which he has had his head broken, but he has succeeded in carrying off one of the obnoxious blue standards. A butcher, with a “Pro Patria” favour twisted round his head, is pouring gin upon the bruiser’s cracked cranium, which he has first plastered with a “Your vote and interest” card; the doughty champion is reviving his spirits with the same stimulant; his foot is trampling upon the spoils of victory, the broken staff and the flag inscribed, “Give us our eleven days,”—another whimsical popular party cry, explained by the alteration in the style, introduced in the session 1751, to correct the calendar according to the Georgian computation, then adopted by most European nations. To equalize the number of days, so that the new year should in future begin on the 1st of January, eleven intermediate days were for that occasion passed over between the 2nd and 14th of September, 1752, so that the day succeeding the 2nd of that month would be reckoned as the 14th—an alteration which provoked discontent, and, in spite of its obvious convenience, was denounced as a Popish innovation.

“In seventeen hundred and fifty-three,
The style was changed to P—p—ry [*Popery*],
But that it is lik’d, we don’t all agree;
Which nobody can deny.

“When the country folk first heard of this act,
That old father Style was condemned to be rack’d,
And robb’d of his time, which appears to be fact,
Which nobody can deny;

“It puzzl’d their brains, their senses perplex’d,
And all the old ladies were very much vex’d,
Not dreaming that Levites would alter our text;
Which nobody can deny.”
(*The Jew’s Triumph.*)

The business of the meeting, regarding the gluttony and drunkenness among the diversions, is centred in bribery. The Buff parliamentary agent has a seat next the unconscious municipal in the chair; before him is a ledger ruled with columns for “sure votes” and “doubtful.” The occupations of this important factotum are deranged by a flying brick from the opposition, which has struck home on his temple, bringing him down headlong, with destruction to objects around. Amid much horse-play and practical joking—to the strains of an extraordinary orchestra—promises of payment, bank-notes, and broad-pieces are being put into circulation. A lean Methodist tailor, with Blue sympathies, and who is suffering from qualms of conscience, is placed between two fires, the personal violence of his wife, with a half-shod offspring appealing for new shoes, while a clerkly agent is pressing on his acceptance a handful of silver coins to remove his pious scruples. Although bribery was so generally admitted, and stalked barefaced throughout the country, it was even then contrary to statute. With his usual irony, the painter has shown the “Act against Bribery and Corruption” turned into pipe-lights, and thrown aside in the tray of “long clays,” together with a packet of tobacco, for the use of smokers. This latter bears the name of “Kirton’s best,” and has its peculiar significance: Nichols records that Kirton “was a tobacconist by St. Dunstan’s Church, Fleet

Street, who ruined his health and constitution, as well as impaired his circumstances, by being busy in the Oxfordshire election of 1754.” The pictures on the walls, according to Hogarth’s practice, greatly assist the story: there is a view, presumably of Oxford from the river—the city is represented in flames; an undertaker’s escutcheon—the field sable bears three gold pieces, with a chevron, the motto “Speak and Have,” surmounted by an open mouth by way of crest proper. A portrait of William, Prince of Orange, as the Protestant prince of the Revolution, has been slashed across by rabid and indignant Jacobites, in allusion to the faction then supposed to have had much influence in Oxford; branches of laurel are entwined round a buff flag, marked “Liberty and Loyalty,” the standard of the party.

Further allusions to the respective Houses of Stuart and Hanover may be detected in the plate, “Canvassing for Votes,” in the signs of the “Royal Oak,” *versus* “The Crown.” All the taverns are pressed into the service of the candidates as a matter of course, the enterprising competitors striving to secure the preponderance of publicans, their interest, friends, and followers. “Tim Partitool, Esq.,” possibly a hit at Bubb Dodington, whose person, as sketched by Hogarth, may be identified in at least one picture of this series, is located at the “Royal Oak.” This enterprising gentleman, as depicted on his canvass, is nicknamed “Punch,” also indicative of Bubb’s unmistakable figure. A porter has brought two packages, evidently polling cards, inscribed, “Sir, your vote and interest;” one of these parcels is directed “at Punch’s, at the ‘Royal Oak’ Yard,” and to the candidate in question the bearer is presenting a note with the superscription, “Tim Partitool, Esq.” Above this gentleman’s head, and partly concealing the painted signboard of Charles II. in the oak, with the three crowns of the United Kingdom among the branches, is a pictorial poster in two compartments. In the upper one are shown the Treasury and Horse Guards, both burlesqued; while from the tall story of the former flows a stream of gold, which is being packed into sacks for conveyance by waggon into the country—there to be distributed for the purposes of bribery—to strengthen the party already in power, known as the Old Interest (their own). The way this is to come about is shown in the lower compartment of the painted cloth: “Punch, candidate for Guzzledown,” the *farceur*, with his protuberant rotundity of back and corporation, has a wheel-barrow before him, filled with bags of money, marked £7000 and £9000, and in all amounting to a considerable sum; he is

casting about the broad-pieces in a shower from a ladle, and they are caught in the hats of expectant electors.

“See from the Treasury flows the gold,
To show that those who’re *bought* are *sold*!
Come, Perjury, meet it on the road—
'Tis all your own—a waggon-load.
Ye party fools, ye courtier tribe,
Who gain no vote without a bribe,
Lavishly kind, yet insincere,
Behold in Punch yourselves appear.
And you, ye fools, who poll for pay,
Ye little great men of a day,
For whom your favourite will not care,
Observe how much bewitch'd you are.”

The candidate is treating all around, within the inn, as seen in the bar-parlour, his followers are feeding gluttonously; in the balcony above are two fair nymphs, whose favour he is conciliating by purchasing trinkets from a Jew pedlar. A farmer voter of some influence, probably a squire of the Tony Lumpkin order, who has ridden into Guzzledown, is making the most of his opportunities: the landlords of the rival inns are ostensibly pressing him to accept invitations to dinner at the respective head-quarters; the host of the Royal Oak is pouring a shower of silver into the receptive palm held out by the wary elector, while the other hand receives the broad golden retainer of “The Crown.” The landlady has a lapful of money, while one of George’s grenadiers (like those seen in “The March to Finchley”) is slyly watching the reckoning of the plunder, probably with an eye to spoliation on his own account. The Crown, which is also the Excise Office, is the scene of an animated contest, rival bludgeon-men are in fierce conflict at the doorway, furniture and stones are being thrown about, and a man from the window is discharging a gun into the thick of the fray below—an allusion to a murderous episode which really occurred. The sign of the Crown, suspended to a huge beam, is in process of removal; a man above, on the wrong side of the support, is sawing it through, while confederates below are dragging it down by force: this is also figurative—the man above,

who is assisting to demolish the Crown, will come down simultaneously, while those beneath it will be crushed by its fall. At a third house is the sign of the Porto Bello, at the side door of which is seen a barber demonstrating with pieces of tobacco-pipe the manner in which Porto Bello was itself taken with six ships only; his companion, a cobbler, has given up work, having received sufficient money from the elections to afford to forego toil for the present.



THE ELECTION AT OXFORD.—CANVASSING FOR VOTES. BY W.
HOGARTH. 1754.



THE OXFORDSHIRE ELECTION—THE POLLING BOOTH. BY W.
HOGARTH. 1754.

[Page 145.]

The view of the Polling Booth is full of intention. Within, seated at the back, on a raised platform, are the sheriffs or bailiffs with whom the election rests, and their attendant, the beadle; in the front are the poll clerks, with their register-books, and the lawyers to see the testaments duly offered for attesting the oath; in the left corner, a veteran (the Militia Bill peeps out of his pocket), who has lost both arms and one leg, is touching the testament with the iron hook which does duty for his missing hand; the clerk is trying to stifle his laughter, while the opposition lawyer is energetically protesting against this proceeding as informal. Hogarth has literally brought “the blind and the halt” to the hustings; in fact, as was too frequently witnessed on these occasions, he has introduced the extremes to which recourse was had,—a pitiable idiot, in a hopeless stage of imbecility, is brought up to the poll in a chair; this poor creature’s mind is too far gone to distinguish between his right and left hands; the clerk is vainly endeavouring to get the proper attestation, while the keeper, or mad doctor, Dr. Shebbeare,⁴⁷ whose legs are adorned with fetters as a felon, is prompting his charge; a political letter of the doctor’s is shown in his

pocket. Another victim, evidently on the verge of dissolution, is smuggled up to the booth in an unconscious state, wrapped in a blanket and carried by two repulsive ruffians; one of them is puffing a blast of tobacco smoke full in the face of the dying man, to whose night-cap is pinned a “True Blue” favour.

“Swift, reverend wag, Iërne’s pride,
Who lov’d the comic rein to guide,
Has told us, ‘Jailors, when they please,
Let out their flock to rob for fees.’
From this sage hint, in needful cases,
The wights, who govern other places,
Let out their crew for private ends—
Ergo, to serve themselves and friends.
Behold, here gloriously inclin’d
The Sick, the Lame, the Halt, and Blind!
From Workhouse, Jail, and Hospital,
Submissive come, true Patriots all!

And ’scaped from wars and foreign clutches,
An Invalid’s behind on crutches.”

Drinking is still proceeding, and “dying speeches” are hawked about, with the usual heading of a rude woodcut of the gallows, in allusion most probably to a local occurrence which produced considerable agitation amongst the public at large—the passions of the multitude having been set into a flame, in the absence of political excitement, by the trial and execution at Oxford, in 1753, of a young woman, Mary Blandy, for poisoning her father under rather romantic circumstances; she persisted in asserting her innocence, even on the scaffold; a number of pamphlets were published upon her case, which became the subject of warm dispute.



THE OXFORDSHIRE ELECTION.—CHAIRING THE MEMBERS. BY W.
HOGARTH. 1754.

The fourth plate, “Chairing the Members,” exhibits the last and apparently most trying episode as regards the successful candidate; the hero of the hour—the newly returned member, elected in the True Blue, or New Interest—occupies a position which may have its honours, but obviously has its perils. In place of the actually returned members, Hogarth seems to have selected the figure of the intriguing manager of the Leicester House party, Bubb Dodington (afterwards Lord Melcombe), for the hero of the chairing scene. He is elevated only to find himself surrounded with embarrassments: the dangers of his chairing are lost sight of momentarily, for his pale face is horror-stricken by being confronted with a fair lady of

fashion; she is equally affected by the *rencontre*, for she is swooning away—it is presumed with apprehension—in the arms of her maids. Over Bubb's head flies a goose—a happy conception, understood to be introduced as a parody of the “Triumph of Alexander,” by Le Brun, where that grandiose artist has suggestively made an eagle hover over the head of his hero. In the Blue procession following the chairmen are all the elements of an election triumph—rough music of marrow-bones and cleavers, True Blue flags,⁴⁸ plenty of bludgeon-men, while a “block head,” wearing the buff favour of their opponents, is carried to ridicule the opposition. Another humorous episode is shown in a vixenish dame sporting a buff cockade; she has boldly broken through the ranks of the Blues, and is driving from their midst her husband, a tailor, detected in his duplicity by the virago, who is soundly cuffing her crestfallen “inferior moiety,” lately deserted to the enemy. A barrel of beer has been placed in the street for public use; a pewter measure stands beside it; the mob seems to have used the opportunity, as a would-be drinker is discovering that the cask is already emptied. In the distance, a second chaired member is skilfully indicated, of whom the shadow only is seen, projected on a wall, while he is carried along to the evident risk of limb and life, as his gesticulations imply. Among other accessories may be noted a tar-barrel, in preparation for a bonfire later on. The sun-dial bears the date 1755 (when the picture was completed), and marks three o'clock, the quality dinner-hour. The bigwigs of the Court party are assembled at an adjacent mansion, at which a plentiful banquet is about to be served: a French *chef*, his long clubbed tail bound with an orange favour, a female cook, noblemen's servants, and other retainers, all wearing the colours of the Old Interest, are carrying the silver-covered dishes in procession. The ministerial adherents are assembled on the first floor; a large handsome window—all the panes of which have been broken by the stones of the patriots, affords a good view of the guests; from the side window they are catching the prospect of the Blue demonstration, surveying with malicious delight the perilous situation of the alarmed chaired member, whose triumph seems, for the time being, the reverse of enviable.

It is said the figure of the chief personage is intended for that of the Duke of Newcastle; the Duke of Marlborough was also actively engaged on the Tory side: while the back of another, wearing a broad ribbon, is possibly meant for Lord Winchilsea. Among the artist's fugitive sketches, as

published at his widow's, Leicester Fields, in 1781, are the two caricatures—engraved by Bartolozzi, from the Earl of Exeter's collection of Hogarth's originals—representing Bubb Dodington (very like "Punch"), and the back view of Lord Winchilsea; both these studies might have been made for the plate of "Chairing the Members." These figures are also included in a caricature entitled "The Recruiting Sergeant" 1757 (the design of which was ascribed to the Hon. George Townshend), while that of Lord Winchilsea, who was at the head of the admiralty, is reproduced with scarcely any alteration, excepting the position of the paddle shown over his shoulder, in the "Triumph of Neptune."



GEORGE BUBB DODINGTON (LORD MELCOMBE-REGIS) AND THE EARL
OF WINCHILSEA. BY HOGARTH. 1753.

Other multifarious incidents are given in the fourth plate of the “Election.” A soldier with the Buff colours is washing the wound received on behalf of his employers; his sword is snapped across the blade. A pig-driver, flourishing a formidable flail, is doing battle with a bear-leader, who is armed with a bludgeon. The backward swing of the flail is imperilling the security of the new member’s seat, while wounding the chair-bearers. Bruin is helping himself from the offal pail of a passing ass—the patient animal stopping to munch a thistle by the wayside; the driver is belabouring the bear over the head, to the alarm of a monkey equipped *à la militaire* and riding on the brute’s shoulder. In the monkey’s fright, a musket at his side is discharged in the face of a little chimney-sweep, who, raised aloft on the wall, is stooping forward to ornament a sculptured skull or effigy of death, placed above the church gate, with a pair of huge round spectacles, in imitation of those worn by Lord Winchilsea. This burning of powder, like the other episodes, has its significance; for, according to the account of Nichols, who claims to have discussed the hidden meanings of these pictures with Hogarth himself, it was “during the contested Oxfordshire Election in 1754 an outrageous mob in the ‘Old Interest’ had surrounded a post-chaise, and were about to throw it into the river (occupant and all), when Captain T——, withinside, shot a chimney-sweeper who was most active in the assault. The captain was tried and acquitted.” Among the items in these election bills it will be observed that more or less mortality has generally to be reckoned, “death by misadventure” having been sufficiently prominent in most contests of the kind during the turbulent times of the past. Private property was held in small respect while rioting was rife; for instance, Hogarth has, in the scene of the chairing, shown a mansion partially demolished, intending to imply that the house had been wrecked by the riotous mob in the course of their eccentric diversions: it will be noted that the wilful destruction of houses and furniture was another recognized feature of election times.

The diary of George Bubb Dodington, Baron of Melcombe-Regis, does not, it is true, contain any enlightenment upon the subject of the

Oxfordshire election as depicted by Hogarth, yet the writer is circumstantial in his account of the elections of April, 1754. The records, however, deal with other contests in which the diarist was active, and notably one which brought Dodington much perplexity of mind and loss of cash. The accounts are nearly all set down as recitals of long interviews with the Duke of Newcastle, who was then trying to strengthen his hands by giving away places to those whose allegiance was doubtful; while Dodington, upon whose influence and assistance he could reckon, reaped nothing but mortification, being in fact an intriguer who was for once played upon for ends other than his own by a more astute and less scrupulous diplomatist than himself. The heads of the alliance are set down as under discussion. Bubb was to furnish his interest towards the electing the new parliament (the dissolution was then an affair of hours), claiming to return six members on his own account. "I did it," he writes, "in the county of Dorset, as far as they pleased to push it. I engaged also specifically to choose two members for Weymouth, which he desired might be the son of the Duke of Devonshire and Mr. Ellis of the admiralty." The candidates nominated by the Duke of Newcastle, Lord J. Cavendish and Mr. Ellis, were successfully returned by Dodington's influence in the sequel. Further, there was opposition in Bridgwater, where Bubb was expected to return two members. Lord Egmont was putting up for that place against the Court, and it was the royal pleasure that Dodington should sacrifice himself to keep the Tory candidate out, as signified through Pelham; to which Bubb replied, "that I desired him, when next these matters came to be discussed, to lay me at the King's feet, and tell him that, as I found it would be agreeable to his Majesty, I would spare neither pains nor expense to exclude him; and thus it became my engagement to do it if I can." "Lord Egmont's successful return," he writes, "need not affect my election, though it might destroy the Whig interest in Bridgwater for ever." Poor Bubb, oblivious of the royal antipathies to the friends of the Prince of Wales, was hoping to secure his old post of treasurer of the navy, but the leadership of the House of Commons had fallen upon the Pelhams, and, as the party must be strengthened there, it was hinted that the Duke of Newcastle would have to buy supporters by giving away to waverers the offices which rightly were due to his friends; to which Dodington replied without sophistication, "that he considered himself as useful there as his neighbours, and, considering his age, rank, the offices he had held," and, "adding to that, choosing six

members for them at my own expense, without the expense of one shilling from their side, I thought the world in general, and even the gentlemen themselves, could not expect that their pretensions should give me the exclusion." The duke remarked that "the ease and cheapness of the election of Weymouth had surprised him, that they had nothing like it;" and Bubb considered again "that there were few who could give his Majesty six members for nothing." Newcastle then took the stout future Baron Melcombe in his arms and kissed him twice (!) "with strong assurance of affection and service;" moreover, notes of all Bubb had said were written out for the king's pleasure. A week later, Dodington sets down, "Dined at Lord Barrington's, and found that, notwithstanding the fine conversation of last Thursday, all the employments are given away."

Nevertheless, he valorously went to work to try and return two members for Bridgwater, though rather against his inclinations; unfortunately, although the doings of each day are set down, the details of the election have been abbreviated by the editor of the diary, Henry Wyndham.

"1754. April 8th. Arrived at Eastbury.

"11. Dr. Sharpe and I set out from Eastbury at four o'clock in the morning for Bridgwater, where, as I expected, I found things very disagreeably framed.

"12. Lord Egmont came, with trumpets, noise, etc.

"13. He and we walked the town: we found nothing unexpected as far as we went.

"14, 15, 16. Spent in the infamous and disagreeable compliance with the low habits of venal wretches.

"17. Came on the election, which I lost by the injustice of the Returning Officer. The numbers were—for Lord Egmont 119, for Mr. Balch 114, for me 105. Of my good votes 15 were rejected: 8 bad votes for Lord Egmont were received.

“18. Left Bridgwater for ever. Arrived at Eastbury in the evening.”

Altogether Dodington places his expenses at £2500, later on at £3400, and finally, when the king had thrown him over, at nearly £4000 spent in this affair. According to an accepted political axiom, what a man buys he may sell; Pelham admitted to Dodington that he possessed “a good deal of marketable ware (parliamentary interest), and that if I would empower him to offer it all to the king, without conditions, he would be answerable to bring the affair to a good account.” In this instance the vendor sold himself for “just nothing at all,” as is shown in the diary. The king disliked Bubb as the adviser of his son, whom he hated.

“April 26. I went to the Duke of Newcastle’s. Received with much seeming affection: thanks for Weymouth, where I had succeeded; sorrow for Bridgwater, where I had not.

“I began by telling him that I had done all that was in the power of money and labour, and showed him two bills for money remitted thither, before I went down, one of £1000, one of £500, besides all the money then in my steward’s hands, so that the election would cost me about £2500. In the next place, if this election stood, the borough was for ever in Tory hands; that all this was occasioned by want of proper support from the Court, and from the behaviour of the servants of the Crown.”

The truth was that the Court had really defeated Dodington. Lord Poulett, a lord of the bedchamber, “had acted openly against him with all his might;” and this action on the part of the higher powers had carried the Government employees, so that “five out of the Custom-house officers gave single votes for Lord Egmont.”

“The next head was—that, in spite of all, I had a fair majority of legal votes, for that the Mayor had admitted eight bad votes for Lord Egmont, and refused fifteen good ones for me; so that it was entirely in

their own hands to retrieve the borough, and get rid of a troublesome opponent, if they pleased; that if the king required this piece of service, it was to be done, and the borough put into Whig hands, and under his influence, without any stretch of power.”

The intricacies of electioneering are supplanted by those of statecraft from this point; Bubb’s diary rehearses—spread over four months—the reasons for and against petitioning for a just return; but it peeps out, and therein lies the rub—that Dodington has inflamed the Tories by his assistance in Dorset. Now, just at this time, the Duke of Newcastle sought to make friends with the opposition; and it occurred to this slippery tactician that, as Dodington had had the sole onus of trying to keep out the Tories and failed, if he allowed Lord Egmont to retain his seat for Bridgwater, it would purchase his allegiance without the cost and inconvenience of putting some post or piece of state preferment at his disposal. Thus did Dodington sacrifice both his money and pains without conciliating the favour of the king, with whom the ambitious courtier was the reverse of popular.

One important feature of electioneering, missing in the later days, was the edifying practice of “Burning a Prime Minister,” making effigies of unpopular candidates and obnoxious ministers for burnt-offerings.

A caricature appeared in 1756 representing a street, in the precincts of Westminster it is presumed, filled with a crowd of enthusiastic patriots on their way to make a bonfire of the offending minister in effigy. The figure wears a cocked hat, and has a wig and mask, evidently copied from those of the living prototype, mounted on a stick; the coat and gloves are stuffed; the legs are sticks, bound up into a rude resemblance to stockings and shoes. The effigy is strapped on horseback. At the rear is a gibbet, on which the dummy premier is to be finally suspended. One of the mob bears a supply of faggots. Beneath this pictorial satire, which is executed something in the style of Sayer, the caricaturist of a later date, appear the verses:—

“Were you in effigy to burn
Each treacherous statesman in his turn,
What better would Britannia be,
Whilst the proud knaves themselves are free?
Knaves have brought disgrace upon her!
Have bought her votes and sold her Honour!”



BURNING A PRIME MINISTER IN EFFIGY. 1756. (FROM DR. NEWTON'S COLLECTION.)

The following manifesto explains the object of this publication, an appeal “Against Corruption,” and directed to securing the purity of elections against Ministerial bribery. The subject of the squib was evidently suggested by the Guy Fawkes processions of November. It appeared at the time when the Newcastle and Fox administration was near its fall and after

those expensive elections in which the duke had spent enormous sums in bribery.

“Who can call to remembrance without abhorrence the behaviour of a Whiggish Ministry, who, neglecting everything else but the business of Bribery and Corruption, reduced the credit of the Nation and themselves to so low an ebb, that at length they were obliged to import Hessian and Hanoverian Troops to support an immense unconstitutional standing army, in defending them and their measures at home; whilst our perfidious enemies ravaged and distressed our wretched Colonies in every other part of the globe. Now it would be well for England if the several Tory or motley administrations since that time could demonstrate that they have spent less time and treasure in the same destructive employment. As a tree is known by its fruit, so is a bad minister by his attempting to influence Electors, or even to gain a Majority of the Elected by any other means than the justice of his measures; otherwise the use of a national Council is superseded; and when a King is thus deprived of the disinterested deliberations of his people in Parliament, the authors of the undue influence are certainly guilty of Treason in the strictest sense of the word.”

CHAPTER VI.

JOHN WILKES AS A POPULAR REPRESENTATIVE.

In the whole history of electioneering no figure is more conspicuous than that of John Wilkes, the quondam patriot, who was by the attacks of others brought into a prominence which neither his abilities nor character justified.

Hogarth commenced hostilities against Wilkes, Churchill (*The North Briton*), and Beardmore (*The Monitor*) by attacking their publications incidentally in that unfortunate attempt at political satire of his, christened “The Times,” Plate I. (1762). It will be remembered that the figure of the artist’s patron, Lord Bute, is there glorified as a Scotch husbandman engaged in extinguishing a general conflagration; while a frenzied man, intended to personify the Duke of Newcastle, is driving a wheel-barrow filled with *Monitors* and *North Britons* against the legs of the zealous Scot, who, unmoved, continues his exertions to subdue the threatened ruin of the State. Pitt and Lord Temple are further assailed—not too cleverly—in this view of the “Times.” On this provocation, Wilkes and Churchill naturally took up the cudgels in their own defence, and certainly gave Hogarth cause for irritation. He prepared the second plate of “The Times,” with a further pictorial castigation of his now-declared adversaries, but was induced to reconsider the policy of publishing the plate, and thus giving greater offence; consequently it was not until thirty years later, when the quarrel was almost forgotten, and the opponents had long been at rest,⁴⁹ that the world was favoured with a view of this equally laboured satire, when it was published by the Boydells at their Shakespeare Gallery, with the collected works of W. Hogarth (May 29, 1790). George III., Bute, Temple, Lord Mansfield, and others, are introduced in this version, but the portion which is pointed at Wilkes, in continuation of this “rough bout of clever men clumsily throwing dirt at each other,” as it has been described, is the

figurement of Miss Fanny, of “Cock-lane ghost” notoriety, pilloried and held up to infamy side by side with Wilkes, whose offence is indicated as “Defamation.” On his breast is pinned a copy of the *North Briton*, the No. 17 which was specially devoted to a base attack upon Hogarth. This incendiary publication is already threatened with flames from the penitential candle held by “Miss Fanny,” his shrouded companion in disgrace. Indignities are showered upon Wilkes in allusion to his involved circumstances; his empty pockets are turned inside out, a school-boy is watering his legs, a woman is trundling a mop over his head, and he is generally regarded with derisive contempt by the crowd.

The crowning effort of Hogarth’s revenge for the abuse showered upon him by both Wilkes and Churchill was the famous etching in which the popular favourite is pilloried to all time as the type and very personification of everything false and sinister, and yet most lifelike as to resemblance; for Wilkes was himself so cynically candid as to admit in after-life that he was “growing more like his portrait every day.” The famous likeness represents Wilkes seated in a chair at a low table, on which is an inkstand and the *North Briton*, Nos. 17 and 45; he is holding the staff, topped with an inverted vessel to simulate the cap of liberty. Attitude and features are alike expressive, and, as Mr. Stephens has described it, “he leers and squints as if in mockery of his own pretences to patriotism.” When brought up from the Tower, to which Lord Bute’s party had ventured to commit him for the attack in the *North Briton*, No. 45, Wilkes was tried at Westminster, before Chief Justice Pratt—subsequently eulogized as “the champion of Freedom and Justice,” and better known to fame as Lord Camden,—who caused the prisoner to be discharged, to the frantic delight of the populace. It was on this occasion that Hogarth secured his opportunity of sketching the idol of the people and the thorn of the Court. In a note prefixed to “An Epistle to William Hogarth,” by Churchill, it is averred that when Mr. Wilkes was the second time brought from the Tower to Westminster Hall, Hogarth skulked behind a screen in the corner of the gallery of the Common Pleas; and while Lord Chief Justice Pratt was enforcing the great principles of the Constitution, the painter was employed in caricaturing the prisoner. So popular was this print, issued at one shilling, that Nichols mentions “nearly four thousand copies were worked off in a few weeks.” “The Epistle” referred to was provoked by the etching of John Wilkes, “Drawn from the

Life.” Hogarth is said to have felt severely the retort which the vigorous and “bruising” Churchill thought proper to make.



JOHN WILKES, A PATRIOT. AFTER HOGARTH.

“Lurking, most ruffian-like, behind a screen,
So plac’d all things to see, himself unseen,
Virtue, with due contempt, saw Hogarth stand,
The murd’rous pencil in his palsied hand;” etc.

To this pasquinade, which revelled audaciously in the realms of libel, and was otherwise a false and indefensible attack on the artist’s private life, Hogarth characteristically replied with his graver; but not to lose time, while his mind was heated by the attack, he utilized a plate on which was already engraved his own portrait and his dog, after the painting now in the

National Gallery, and burnishing out those parts which were in his way, he engraved—

“The Bruiser, C. Churchill (once the Revd.!), in the character of a Russian Hercules, regaling himself after having kill’d the monster Caricatura that so sorely gall’d his virtuous friend, the Heaven-born WILKES.

“But he had a Club this Dragon to drub,
Or he had ne’er don’t I warrant ye.”
(*Dragon of Wantley.*)



A BEAR-LEADER. HOGARTH, CHURCHHILL, AND WILKES.

This plate was issued at 1s. 6d., and seems to have gone through various alterations and additions from first to last. On the palette which first displayed the mystifying “line of beauty,” was substituted two designs of a figurative nature—the one having reference to Pitt, his resignation and annual pension, and his city supporters, represented by the emblematic civic guardians, Gog and Magog; the other a group further applying to the castigation of the designer’s foes. Hogarth is armed with a triple whip, with which he is lustily chastising a big dancing bear, Churchill, held bound and

muzzled, as not only the artist but the ministry and the Scotch faction would have rejoiced to have effected; the Bruiser to the clerical ruffles and bands has incongruously added the modish laced hat of a man about town; the other end of the rope, by which Hogarth has secured the bear through the muzzle, is fastened round an ape, intended to personify Wilkes. This animal is wearing a wig exactly similar to that shown on Wilkes's head in the too-famous etching; the *North Briton* is in his left hand; the spear, topped with the inevitable cap of liberty, is turned into a hobby-horse, to infer, according to Mr. F. G. Stephen's account, "that Wilkes used Liberty to get his own ends, which not more than a child progresses on its 'cock-horse' did he really obtain." The face of the fiddling personage, who is making the music for this pretty caper, is a featureless blank; he wears a ribbon of knighthood, and it is understood that Earl Temple is the person intended.

Other uncomplimentary allusions to Wilkes and his proceedings appear in the *Public Advertiser*, where is a woodcut of an execution, I.W., and M.P., with a "Toast"—"May loyalists walk easily in their Boots [a reference to Lord Bute], and malcontents die like Wilks in their shells."

The notoriety of John Wilkes was much assisted by the ill-advised and clumsy conduct of the ministry, which elected to make a martyr of the man whose career proves him to have been but a sham patriot, and, who, if unnoticed, was totally without weight or consequence. On April 30, 1763, Wilkes found himself, in spite of the Habeas Corpus granted by the Common Pleas, conducted to the Tower on a warrant, signed by the Earls of Egremont and Halifax as Privy Councillors and Secretaries of State, authorizing the Constable of the Tower, the Right Hon. John Lord Berkeley of Stratton,—

"to receive into your custody the body of John Wilkes, Esq., herewith sent you, for being the author and publisher of a most infamous and seditious libel, entitled the *North Briton*, No. XLV., tending to inflame the minds and alienate the affections of the people from His Majesty, and to excite them to traitorous insurrections against the Government."

The small engraving which exhibits Wilkes in the Tower, forms one portion of a series, entitled "The Places" (being a sequel to "The Posts"), a

political pasquinade, dedicated to Bamber Gasoign, Esq., a Trading Lord for the time being.



A SAFE PLACE. WILKES IN THE TOWER, 1763.

“Satire’s a harmless, quiet thing—
'Tis application makes the sting.”

No. 3 is styled a Safe Place; the title is “Moderation, Moderation, this was Wonderful Moderation, an old song.” The prisoner is simultaneously

attacked by curs, and by one of the historical lions of the Tower, which cannot do much harm, being chained to the secure post Magna Charta. Wilkes is threatening his assailants with a whip; he has on a spear the cap of liberty—this emblem is inscribed “Habeas Corpus.” A yeoman of the guard is in charge of the hero of the XLV. *North Briton*.

“There’s a scene for an Englishman! Patriots ill-us’d,
Magna Charta despised, and poor Freedom abus’d;
Once the love of our country brought profit and pow’r,
But it now, tho’ with glory, sends WILKES to the Tow’r.”

In the version of “Daniel cast into the Den of Lions; or, *True Blue* will never stain” (April 29, 1763), Wilkes is shown the centre of a highly elaborate allegorical combination, which deals with the incidents of his arrest, associated with the *North Briton*, and his obnoxious writings. One of the scenes exhibits the king’s messengers violently breaking into Wilkes’s house, Great George Street, Westminster, and ransacking his receptacles for papers. On the other side, the messengers are shown conducting Wilkes to the Tower, the title “Den of Lions” not being wide of the mark, since it, at that time, was the abiding place of the royal menagerie. Wilkes is made to declare: “Corruption I detest, and Persecution I despise,”—sentiments befitting the patriotic martyr, as he was then believed to be, a “goodly repute” with which he was only too desirous of parting in exchange for such bribes as were weighty enough for his acceptance. In the symbolic view of this new “Daniel,” the goddess Fame hovers over her whilom favourite, with a wreath to crown his brow; she is publishing, through her trumpet, “Magnus est Veritas;” the door of the den which confines the lions is a prominent feature. Below appears the Lieutenant of the Tower; he has a written “counsel’s opinion” in his hand, and is replying to a demand for admittance made by Wilkes’s brother, “Consider, sir, my Lord Temple was not suffered to see him.” When Wilkes was committed to the Tower, both his brother and Earl Temple applied to be admitted to see him, and were refused.

The “general warrant” on which Wilkes was arrested was proved illegal, and on a writ of *Habeas Corpus*, he was set at liberty on the ground

of his privilege as a member of Parliament. After his release from the Tower, Wilkes was involved in a duel, and severely wounded; he then fled to Paris, January, 1764, and was, in his absence, expelled from parliament and outlawed for contempt of court. On the issue of writs for the general election, after the dissolution of parliament, March 12, 1768, Wilkes, who had made several vain attempts to get the sentence reversed, suddenly presented himself as a candidate to represent the city of London, in the interval addressing to the king a submissive letter imploring pardon and the reversal of the sentence of outlawry which had been passed upon him. This petition the king rejected with decision. Although Alderman Sir William Baker was the only citizen of note or influence who supported him, Wilkes persisted in his candidature, the lower people embracing his cause with ardour; but he polled the minimum of votes, and was signally defeated, the successful members being the Hon. Thomas Harley, lord mayor, with 3,729 votes; Sir R. Ladbroke, 3,678; William Beckford, 3,402; Barlow Trecothwick, 2,957. The unsuccessful candidates were Sir Richard Glyn, 2,823; John Patterson, 1,769; and Wilkes, at the bottom of the poll, who contrived to secure 1,247 votes.

On Wilkes's return from the Guildhall at the close of the poll, March 23, 1768, where, as seen, he obtained the lowest number of votes, the people displayed their fervour for spurious patriotism by removing the horses from his carriage, and drawing it themselves; other extravagancies of a like nature showed the spirit of the multitude, by whom Wilkes was regarded as the tribune of the people, a situation very much to his taste. Considering his mob-popularity assured, he now proposed to conciliate his opponents; the first step was to make a pretence of submission. On the 22nd of March, he wrote to the solicitor of the treasury: "I take the liberty of acquainting you, that in the beginning of the ensuing term I shall present myself to the court of King's Bench. I pledge my honour as a gentleman, that on the very first day I will there make my personal appearance." The letter sent by Wilkes to the king was certainly a plausible composition, but the fervid assurances there given being in direct antagonism with the conduct of the writer at that very time, it may be held that George III. was justified in treating the applicant with indignant contempt.

"SIRE,

“I beg thus to throw myself at your Majesty’s feet, and supplicate the mercy and clemency which shine with such lustre among your princely virtues. Some former ministers, whom your Majesty, in condescension to the wishes of your people, thought proper to remove, employed every wicked and deceitful act to oppress your subject, and to avenge their own personal cause on him, whom they imagined to be the principal author of bringing to public view their ignorance, insufficiency, and treachery to your Majesty and the nation.

“I have been the innocent and unhappy victim of revenge. I was forced by their injustice and violence into exile, which I have never ceased to consider, for many years, as the most cruel oppression; because I could not longer be under the benign influence of your Majesty in this land of liberty.

“With a heart full of zeal for the service of your Majesty and my country, I implore, Sire, your clemency. My only hopes of pardon are founded in the great goodness and benevolence of your Majesty; and every day of freedom you may be graciously pleased to permit me the enjoyment of, in my dear native land, shall give proofs of my zeal and attachment to your service.”

This letter was judiciously ignored, but meanwhile fresh publicity was awaiting Wilkes—on the 27th, he was carried by a writ of *capias ut legatum* to the King’s Bench.

The return of Wilkes from Paris, his failure for the city, and election for Middlesex are figuratively shadowed forth in “The Flight of Liberty,” a broadside consisting of two engraved designs, “The Return of Liberty,” and “Liberty Revived,” with verses in praise of Wilkes and reflecting adversely upon his antagonists. In the upper compartment is shown the Court, or administrative faction, destroying the Temple of Liberty (an allusion to Earl Temple), raised above the statue of Wilkes, with the cap of liberty, as usual, elevated on the staff of maintenance. Lord Bute trampling on Magna Charta, is foremost of the destroyers who are wrecking the whole edifice, the very foundations of which are being razed; the “Laird of Boot” is exclaiming, “Well said, guid friends, down with the mighty *Temple*,” in allusion to the protection and patronage that nobleman had already

extended to Wilkes; the Duke of Bedford, Lord North, and other ministers are aiding. The second design shows “the Temple of Liberty built by John Wilkes, A.D. 1762,” reinstated, “never to fall again.”

Nothing daunted by his defeat for the city of London, Wilkes at once offered himself for the county of Middlesex. In his “Memoirs of the Reign of George III.,” Walpole gives certain glimpses of the election proceedings, which are as descriptive as a more detailed account:—

“On the 23rd of March the Election began at Brentford; and while the irresolution of the Court and the carelessness of the Prime Minister, Grafton, caused a neglect of all precautions, the zeal of the populace had heated itself to a pitch of fury.”

The other candidates were Sir W. Beauchamp Proctor and Mr. Cooke, the former members. Cooke, who had sat from 1750, was confined with the gout; a relation, who appeared for him, was roughly handled. Amidst the wrecking of carriages which ensued, that of Proctor did not escape the attention of the roughs; it “was demolished by the mob.”

The coach-glasses of such as did not huzza for “Wilkes” and “Liberty” were broken, the paint and varnish of chariots and coaches, met and stopped for miles round, were spoiled by the mob—scratching them with the favourite “45.” Lord Bute, generally the object of popular disfavour, was denounced by an attack made on his residence, where the mob broke his windows, as usual, but failed to effect an entrance; the same unwelcome attention was paid to Lord Egremont’s, in Pall Mall, as the chief signatory to the warrant for Wilkes’s committal. The Duke of Northumberland had the honour of appearing, whether he would or no, of being forced to supply the mob with liquor, and to drink with them to Wilkes’s success. The demonstration assumed formidable proportions; all the windows from West to East were illuminated to please the mob, otherwise they were broken by the riotous “true loyal Britons and friends of Liberty,” who performed some curious feats; some of the regimental drummers, not the Scotch regiments it may be premised, beating their drums for Wilkes. This astute diplomatist, finding his election secure, very prudently dismissed his enthusiastic partisans, such as the weavers, back to town, the polling⁵⁰ was ended, and by the next morning quietude was resumed in the vicinity of Brentford.

Some of the incidents were particularly ludicrous, the mob going out of the way to perpetuate the number of the *North Briton* so objectionable to the Court. The Austrian Ambassador, the Count de Seilern, described by Horace Walpole in a letter to the Earl of Hertford as the most stately and ceremonious of men, was obliged to get out of his coach, and ignominiously held with his legs in the air while the figures "45" were chalked on the soles of his shoes. This insult formed the grounds of an official complaint. It was as difficult for the minister to help laughing at the gravity of his representations as to redress the slight offered to a friendly power in the person of its representative.

Wilkes was now master of the situation; all his expectations were verified. Elated with success, his audacity enabled him to make the most of his undeserved triumph, and assuming a tone which heaped fresh mortifications upon the Court, he printed an address of acknowledgment to his constituents, in which he invited them to give him their instructions from time to time, and promised that he would always defend their civic and religious rights. Although posing as the champion of liberty, Wilkes's parliamentary career was a dismal failure; in the House he was of no account whatever.

It is interesting to note contemporaneous opinion on a point which is so strongly distorted by partisanship that independent impressions are rare. Dr. Franklin, whose genuine passion for liberty it must be admitted was as absorbing and unaffected as Wilkes's assumed patriotism was shallow and self-serving, happened to be in London at the time of the violent ferment occasioned by the Middlesex election in 1768. Although lately returned from Paris, and himself, a citizen of the land which complimented Paine, he thus unreservedly sums up the popular candidate, together with the political agitation associated with his pretensions.

"'Tis really an extraordinary event to see an outlaw and exile of bad personal character, not worth a farthing, come over from France, set himself up as a candidate for the capital of the kingdom, miss his election only by being too late in his application, and immediately carrying it for the principal county. The mob, spirited up by numbers of different ballads, sung or roared in the streets, requiring gentlemen

and ladies of all ranks as they passed in their carriages, to shout for 'Wilkes and Liberty;' marking the same words on their coaches with chalk, and 'No. 45' on every door, which extend a vast way along the roads into the country. I went last week to Winchester, and observed that for fifteen miles out of town there was scarcely a door or window-shutter next the road unmarked, and this continued here and there quite to Winchester, which is sixty-four miles."

The day of Wilkes's election appeared the portrait of "John Wilkes, elected Knight of the Shire for Middlesex, March 28, 1768, by the free voice of the people," with, according to the allegorical taste of the time, Hercules and Minerva as supporters, the latter crowning the elect M.P. with a wreath, while the former tramples upon the serpent of Envy; the genius of Liberty is holding the staff of maintenance, surmounted by the cap of liberty (as invariably associated with Wilkes), and is pointing to the portrait as her champion. Simultaneously appeared an engraving commemorative of other incidents of the return from Brentford, showing the valour of the chief magistrate of the city. The guards on duty at St. James's Palace had orders to be in readiness to march at beat of drum to suppress any riots which might take place; it has been described how certain drummers took to drumming for Wilkes, while his sympathizers marched through Westminster to the city, upsetting all in their way, chalking doors, breaking window-glass, both in houses and carriages, inscribing vehicles and foot-passengers impartially with "45." "Wilkes and Liberty" was the cry, and woe to those who did not join in shouting, for they, without further inquiry, were promptly knocked down. In the city, the mob grew more outrageous, the lord mayor being the Hon. Thomas Harley, who had been elected for the city, at the top of the poll, when Wilkes, his name lowest on the list, had been defeated ignominiously; moreover, the lord mayor was a courtier, and was denounced subsequently in the *North Briton* as "a political gambler," nor was the charge groundless. The mob accordingly attacked the Mansion House and the lord mayor's private residence in Aldersgate Street; neither of these places being illuminated in honour of Wilkes was a sufficient offence in the sight of the mob, who proceeded to demolish the windows: every pane of glass was broken, even to those of the lady mayoress's bed-chamber. Then they erected a gallows, on which was suspended a boot and petticoat to symbolize the Princess of Wales, only too well-known,

according to popular clamour, in association with the Earl of Bute, the “Laird of the Boot” thus indicated in close proximity; these suggestive emblems of hated “secret influence” were also marked “45” for the nonce. The pictorial satire evoked on this topic, “The Rape of the Petticoat” (March 28, 1768), exhibits the lord mayor making a sally from the Mansion House, supported by constables armed with long staves; the chief magistrate has himself seized the obnoxious boot and petticoat, amid the ridicule and laughing resistance of the rabble, who are treating his lordship to indignities. Below the design is inscribed, “He valiantly seiz’d the Petticoat and Boot at the portal of his own Mansion.—*Daily Advertiser*.”

This loyal zeal was rewarded with signal favour. Harley was made a councillor of State, and subsequently, through Lord Suffolk, obtained a lucrative contract. To the impression of this print in the *Oxford Magazine* the following verses were added:—

“Sing thou, my muse, the dire contested fray,
Where Harley dar’d the dangers of the day;
Propitious Day, that could at once create
A Merchant Tailor⁵¹ Councillor of State!
A numerous multitude contriv’d to meet;
And Halloo *Forty-Five* thro’ every street;
And (what’s incredible) were heard to cry
Those words seditious, *Wilkes and Liberty*!
On lofty standards in the air did float
Those hieroglyphics ‘*Boot and Petticoat*.’
Soon as their dreadful shouts accost the ear
Of grocer knights, and traders in small-beer,
Confounded and amaz’d the Guildhall court
Forget their custard, and forsake their port;
Away, with ghastly looks, lo, Harley ran,
And thus, in doleful plight, their dismal tale began:
‘Most honour’d, most belov’d, thou best of men!’

Then from his mansion rush'd the val'rous chief,
To serve his country, or to—take a thief:
But more resolv'd to crush Rebellion's root,
And triumph o'er the Petticoat and Boot;
In equal balance hung the fierce dispute
Between the warlike Magistrate and Boot.
The Boot and Petticoat at length gave way,
And now remain the trophies of the day."

On the 20th of April, Wilkes appeared before the Court of King's Bench, Westminster, of which event an engraving was published. On his surrendering to his outlawry, the Attorney-General moved for Wilkes's commitment, but the judges refused to grant an order to that effect, on the ground that he was not legally before the court; Wilkes then left, accompanied by the plaudits of the spectators. "The Scot's Triumph; or, a Peep behind the Curtain" gives a further illustration of this subject; this print, and another following, are announced in the *Public Advertiser*:—

"To Connoisseurs.—This day is published a satirical scratch in the style of Rembrandt, entitled The Scotch Triumph; with the representation of their amazing exploits in St. George's Fields; the murder of the innocent, and the sacrifice of Liberty, by Molock; with some curious anecdotes."

In the first version, Wilkes and his friends are driving to surrender in state; their coach is about to crush a Scotch thistle by the way; the mob have taken the horses from the vehicle and are dragging it themselves on the road to the Bench; Wilkes is thus addressing his vociferous supporters—"Gentlemen and Friends, let me beg you to desist; I'm willing to submit to the laws of my country."

All the leading political personages are introduced as spectators. Lord Holland, an alleged adviser of Lord Bute, is observing, "We have got him safe in a trap at last." "Jemmy Twitcher" (Lord Sandwich) is responding, "Yes, but I much doubt whether we shall be able to keep him there." On the 27th of April, Wilkes again came up for judgment, and was then committed

to the King's Bench Prison. On his way thither, in the custody of two tipstaffs of Lord Mansfield, the coach was stopped by the people, a further popular demonstration was made, the horses were removed, and the vehicle drawn through the city by an enthusiastic crowd, the marshal's deputies being invited to get out. He finally was escorted to a public-house, the Three Tuns Tavern, in Spitalfields (or Cornhill, according to Walpole's account); from thence, after the departure of his demonstrative admirers, Wilkes judged it prudent to make his escape, and surrender himself again, this time at the prison gates and to the marshal of the King's Bench. When the news of his incarceration reached the mob there was a fresh uproar; the day following, the prison was surrounded, the palings enclosing the footpath were torn up and made into a bonfire, and the inhabitants of Southwark found themselves under the necessity, either of illuminating their houses, or of taking the consequences; the mob dispersed on the arrival of a small guard.

Meanwhile Sergeant Glynn was arguing before all the judges of the Court of King's Bench respecting the errors of Wilkes's outlawry; while, from his place of confinement, Wilkes next proceeded to address his sympathizing constituents:—

“TO THE GENTLEMEN, CLERGY, AND FREEHOLDERS OF THE COUNTY OF MIDDLESEX.

“GENTLEMEN,

“In support of the liberties of this country against the arbitrary rule of ministers, I was before committed to the Tower, and am now sentenced to this prison. Steadiness, with, I hope, strength of mind, do not however leave me; for the same consolation follows me here, the consciousness of innocence, of having done my duty, and exerted all my abilities, not unsuccessfully, for this nation. I can submit even to far greater sufferings with cheerfulness, because I see that my countrymen reap the happy fruits of my labours and persecutions, by the repeated decisions of our Sovereign courts of justice in favour of liberty. I therefore bear up with fortitude, and even glory, that I am

called to suffer in this cause, because I continue to find the noblest reward, the applause of my native country, of this great, free, and spirited people.

“I chiefly regret, gentlemen, that this confinement deprives me of the honour of thanking you in person, according to my promise; and at present takes from me, in a great degree, the power of being useful to you. The will, however, to do every service to my constituents remains in its full force; and when my sufferings have a period, the first day I regain my liberty shall restore a life of zeal in the cause and interests of the county of Middlesex.

“In this prison, in any other, in every place, my ruling passion will be the love of England and our free constitution. For those objects I will make every sacrifice. Under all the oppressions which ministerial rage and revenge can invent, my steady purpose is to concert with you, and other true friends of the country, the most probable means of rooting out the remains of arbitrary power and Star-chamber inquisition, and of improving as well as securing the generous plans of freedom, which were the boast of our ancestors, and I trust will remain the noblest inheritance of our posterity, the only genuine characteristic of Englishmen.

“JOHN WILKES.

“King’s Bench Prison, May 5th, 1768.”

By this letter it will be seen that Wilkes chiefly appealed to what is best described as clap-trap sensationalism; he continued, however, to be the cause of constant apprehension, the military and other authorities taking every precaution to preserve the peace of the metropolis.

While Wilkes was kept a prisoner in the King’s Bench, the authorities made demonstrations of resorting to armed force for the ostensible purpose of preserving the peace of the metropolis, and, taught precaution by the famous “45” demonstration which followed Wilkes’s election for Middlesex, to check further rioting with firmness, which unfortunately degenerated into ferocity.

Parliament met on the 10th of May, Lord Camden being now lord chancellor. It seems the misconception had arisen that Wilkes's outlawry would be reversed, and that in any case he would be suffered to attend the assembling of parliament. With the design of conveying him thither in triumph, a great body of people were gathered at the King's Bench. Finding their expectations disappointed of seeing the idol of the hour set at large and reinstated as "the tribune of the people," they demanded him at the prison, and grew very tumultuous; whereupon the Riot Act was read by two justices of Surrey, but the mob threw stones and brickbats while it was reading, when one of the spectators, seeing other persons run, ran too, but was unhappily singled out by a picket of the Scotch Guards, who broke their ranks—a breach of military discipline—and followed him about five hundred yards into a cowhouse, and there shot him dead. "Soon after this, the crowd increasing, an additional number of the Guards was sent for, who marched thither, and also a party of horse grenadiers (two regiments had, it appears, been under arms in St. George's Fields throughout the disturbances), when, the riot continuing, the mob were fired on by the soldiers, and five or six were killed on the spot, and about fifteen wounded, among them being two women, one of whom subsequently died of her wounds. She was, it appears, trying to move her oranges out of danger. Another account says (*Gentleman's Magazine*) several of the people killed were passing along the road at a distance; and, later on, it is said not one of the persons actually concerned in the rioting were hurt by the firing. Several versions of the fatal affair appeared immediately. The case of the inoffensive youth who was thus barbarously slaughtered excited general sympathy; his name was William Allen, and his father was master of the Horseshoe Inn and Livery Stables, Blackman Street, Southwark. On the Scotch faction was heaped all the opprobrium of this regrettable transaction."

Among others, appeared the illustration of "The Scotch Victory," 1768; on the wall of the outhouse, to which the lad had fled for shelter when pursued, is "'45," an allusion to the cruelties of the Highland raid in 1745, as well as to the "XLV. North Briton." Alexander Murray, the officer, Donald Maclury, a corporal, and MacLaughlin, a grenadier, are shown in the act of assassinating Allen. A halter which lies near the feet of the

soldiers and a sketch of a gallows and a man hanging indicate the public sentiments on the matter. The letterpress is to this effect:—

“The monumental inscription on a tombstone erected over the grave of Mr. William Allen, junior, in the churchyard of St. Mary Newington, Surrey. ‘Sacred to the memory of William Allen, an Englishman of unspotted life and amiable disposition, who was inhumanly *murdered* near St. George’s Fields, the 10th day of May, 1768, by Scottish detachments from the army.’

“‘Twas Grafton plann’d the horrors of that day;
’Twas Weymouth urg’d th’ enforcing his commands;
’Twas Barrington that gave th’ exciting pay,
The price of blood flow’d through his guilty hands.”

The Duke of Grafton was first lord of the treasury. Viscount Weymouth, afterwards Marquis of Bath, was one of the secretaries of state; he had urged the advisability of calling out military aid to strengthen the civil authority. Viscount Barrington was secretary at war. He had thought proper to convey to the field-officer in command of the Foot Guards the royal approval of the men’s behaviour.



“WILKES AND LIBERTY” RIOTS. THE SCOTCH VICTORY. MURDER OF ALLEN BY A GRENADIER. MASSACRE OF ST. GEORGE’S FIELDS. 1768.

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He begged “that they may be assured that every possible regard shall be shown to them in return for their zeal and good conduct on this occasion,” “and in case any disagreeable circumstance should happen in the execution of their duty, they shall have every defence and protection that the law authorities, and this Office (the War) can give.”

Justice Gillam, who was the first to give the order to the third regiment of Guards to fire on the people, was tried for the murder of Redburn, a weaver; the judges acquitted him of all responsibility, and complimented him on the humane manner in which he had exercised his authority. Sergeant Glynn, Wilkes’s friend and adviser, was for the prosecution. In the course of the evidence it appeared that there had been assembled in St. George’s Fields a disorderly concourse, where, after shouting “*Wilkes and*

Liberty,” they made an attack on the King’s Bench Prison, threw stones into the marshal’s house, and at length burst open the outward gate of the prison, to the terror of the keepers, who not only feared for the security of their prisoners, but imagined their own lives were endangered; notwithstanding their apprehensions, the keepers guarded the inner gates from the mob, so that the rioters dispersed without effecting their purpose.

The marshal, anticipating another attack the day following, applied to the magistrates for assistance, as shown in the foregoing. On the 10th of May, a larger mob assembled, repeating the cry of “Wilkes and Liberty;” whereupon the magistrates began to expostulate with them. The Riot Act was then read, and its intentions endeavoured to be explained. The rabble hissed and hooted the soldiers, who endeavoured to scatter them. At last, a stone struck Justice Gillam, and he ordered the firing, though, as far as could be proved, there existed no absolute necessity for this extreme measure. Gillam, who was exhibited to ridicule as “Midas, the Surrey justice,” appears to have been most unpopular, if not altogether unfit for the responsible position in which he was placed; “the note sent to a bookseller by a magistrate” is attributed to this hero: “Sir, Send me the ax Re Latin to a Gustus of Pease.” On his trial, James Derbyshire, a bookseller, deposed that Mr. Gillam said publicly in the hearing of the soldiers, “*that his orders from the ministry were, that some men must be killed, and that it were better to kill five and twenty to-day than one hundred to-morrow.*” According to the Rev. John Horne (afterwards Tooke, and known to fame as the “Brentford Parson”), who was present at the riot, it was he who procured the warrant for the arrest of the soldiers. The trial did not take place until the 9th of August. Witnesses appeared against Donald Maclury, who was charged with firing the fatal shot; it was Maclury (or M’Laury) who said “Damn him, that’s him, shoot him.” Mr. Allen’s ostler declared that when Allen fell, after the prisoner had fired, Maclury said, “Damn it, it is a good shot.” On his way to gaol, the day after the murder, it was proved Maclury acknowledged “that what they had done was in consequence of orders, and he hoped they should obtain mercy.” The defence was that MacLaughlin, a grenadier, acknowledged to Mr. Gillam and six soldiers that it was he who shot Allen, and *that his piece went off by accident*. He had since deserted, and, it was openly stated in the papers, received one shilling a day to keep out of the way. The verdict was “not guilty;” and it was admitted that, in

order to save the life of the soldier, who was liable for murder, it had “been found necessary to suffer the prosecutors to persist in their mistake in apprehending and impeaching an innocent man, and in the mean time giving the grenadier who actually fired the gun an opportunity to escape.” Both soldiers were charged at the King’s Bench, when, by arrangement, the guilty man was admitted to bail, to be smuggled out of harm’s way; “the other was remanded back to prison as the person who actually shot the lad,” according to the proceedings, May 16, 1768.

Another version of the “Scotch Victory,” with the rebus of the jack-boot standing under a petticoat, and enclosed by Scotch thistles, forms part of a mock dedication: “To the Earl of (Bute), Protector of our Liberties, this plate is humbly inscribed by F. Junius Brutus.”

“The Operation,” a frontispiece to the *Political Register* for June, 1768, shows Lord Bute stabbing Britannia with a dagger, while the ministers already mentioned in association with the death of Allen are catching the blood which flows from her wounds:—

“The Blood of Vitals from her wounds he drew,
And fed the Hounds that help’d him to pursue.”
(DRYDEN.)

The *Oxford Magazine* for 1769 gives an engraving of the monument finally erected over the grave of Mr. Allen, junior. It represents an altar tomb enclosed by iron rails: on one side is introduced the reprobated Scotch thistle, with the legend, “Murder screen’d and rewarded;” on the other side is shown a Scotch soldier of the third regiment of Foot Guards, evidently intended for the murderous MacLaughlin, approaching and pointing to the inscription on the tomb, exclaiming, “I have obtain’d a pension of a shilling a day, only for putting an end to thy days!”

CHAPTER VII.

MIDDLESEX ELECTIONS, 1768-9.

Within a month of his return died George Cooke, the Tory colleague of Wilkes in the representation of Middlesex, who had sat from 1750; he was prothonotary of the Court of Common Pleas, one of the joint paymasters of the forces, and colonel of the Middlesex Militia. Consequent on his decease a seat for the county was to be contested in December, 1768, and the public were indulged with another exciting struggle at the Brentford hustings. The candidates were John Glynn, the friend and advocate of Wilkes, and Sir William Beauchamp Proctor, the candidate defeated in the previous election. The superheated state of popular feeling had not had time to cool down; moreover, Wilkes, the chosen of the electors, was a prisoner. Both parties on this occasion seem to have resorted to terrorism; mutual recriminations as to the hiring of ruffians and bludgeon-men were made during the inquiries into the disturbances which ensued. A view of the situation, "Scene at the Brentford Hustings," 1768, exhibits the violent and brutal behaviour of mercenaries in the pay of Proctor's faction—chiefly reckless bullies, according to the engraving of the Brentford election. Females are beaten causelessly; a fruit-stall is wrecked, and a respectably attired person is taking advantage of the confusion to help himself from the stock, whilst the proprietress is wantonly beaten with a heavy cudgel; the legion of bludgeons is enlisted in the cause of "Liberty and Proctor;" a hero whose head is shaven, and who is evidently a professional pugilist of the Figg and Broughton type, is made to exclaim, "For a guinea a day; damn Glynn and all his friends." Other beaters—chairmen, linkmen, and the like—are driving all before them, and carrying the hustings by assault, demanding, "Bring down the poll-book—Proctor shall be the man." The scattered remnants of a rival mob are retiring; one of these is exclaiming, "D—— ye, you dogs—we'll match you all presently."



THE HUSTINGS AT BRENTFORD, MIDDLESEX ELECTION, 1768.
SERJEANT GLYNN AND SIR W. BEAUCHAMP PROCTOR.

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The *Oxford Magazine* (vol. i.) has printed the correspondence which ensued upon the disgraceful violence and the attack on the hustings, in which several persons were injured and at least one fatally. The candidate ultimately returned, John Glynn, began by addressing a "Letter to the Freeholders of Middlesex," pledging himself that the blood of his constituents so wantonly shed should be vindicated, and the charge brought home both to the hired and the hirers—"the more exalted their stations and the more privileged their persons, the louder is the call for justice." The serjeant continues, "The freedom of a county election is the last sacred privilege we have left; and it does not become any honest Englishman to wish to survive it. There is virtue still left in the country; we are come to a crisis, and the consequence of this struggle shall determine whether we shall be Slaves or Free."

Following suit, Sir W. Beauchamp Proctor also addressed a letter to the freeholders of Middlesex, rebutting the charges made against him. After

referring to twenty years, during which, by fair and honourable means, he had endeavoured to obtain their esteem,—

“Calumniated as I have been during a long-depending canvass, I was in hopes that every topic of defamation had been exhausted; and I never expected that the daring and tumultuous interruption of last Tuesday’s poll would have been ascribed to me in so illiberal and inflammatory a style as my antagonist has thought proper to use. For his conduct in the course of this business the serjeant appeals to me, and I appeal to the sense of mankind, whether a *band of writers* has not been let loose to be the *assassins of my reputation*? whether the serjeant has not, in a manner unworthy of a gentleman and a lawyer, exerted every effort to set up *usage* in opposition to the law of the land, and endeavoured in a dictatorial manner to compel the sheriffs to close the poll in one day, to the prejudice of the electors, and in violation of the authority vested in the returning officers, by the wisdom of the legislature.”

Proctor declared that he was not only struck by “the banditti,” but in the utmost peril of his life.

“If a signal was given,—if *Proctor and Liberty* appeared in the hats of the ruffians, how that might be contrived by the election arts of my adversaries need not now be mentioned. It was the opinion of my counsel, when a riot was artfully talked of by my opponents, *above an hour* before it happened, that the sheriffs in that case should resort immediately to the protection of parliament.” Finally, he expressed hopes “to bring this dark transaction into open daylight, and to show the world who has been the man of blood;” moreover, the writer “has full confidence that on the last day of the poll lawless men will not again dare to invade the rights of the freeholders.”

The disavowal, which “doth protest too much” as published by Proctor, goaded the virtuous indignation of the friends of freedom up to fever heat, and acted like a red rag on an infuriated bull in the instance of John Horne (Tooke), “the Brentford parson;” he addressed a scathing philippic to Proctor, declaring that Sir William’s refutations “subscribed his own guilt, and that the Court candidate had signed his name to a lie:”—

“I here declare in form, that you, Sir William Beauchamp Proctor, did both hire and cause to be hired, that mob which committed the outrages at Brentford; that mob, which immediately after the total interruption of the poll, demanded which was the house that belonged to the parson of Brentford; and to whose fury a neighbouring clergyman, who heard them ask after my house, was apprehensive of falling a sacrifice, by the mistake of a person who called himself by my name. Boast of your humanity, Sir William, to Captain Read; that gentleman, to save his own life, declared himself your friend. Persuade Mr. Allen they were not your mob; that gentleman brought you to the side of the hustings where they were, and heard them answer to his question, and to your face, that you, Sir W. Beauchamp Proctor, were the person that gave them orders for what they were about.”

As to the “band of writers,” Parson Horne frankly avowed himself the author of most of the letters that appeared against Proctor in the papers, and concluded with a stinging reference to those “new-fashioned constables,” as Sir John Fielding termed the hireling bullies.

“Where you endeavour to justify your proceedings by the usage of all contested popular elections, and where you affect to consider your hired ruffians, the Irish chairmen, as ‘assistants to the civil magistrates.’ The business of the approaching poll prevents my saying half what I have to tell you; but I promise you, you shall hear from me again and again, if you will please to issue out your orders to your ruffians to grant me a *Reprieve* till after the election.”

The main features of this ill-advised attack, which, it was believed, was intended to put an end to the election should the polling prove adverse to the party in whose pay the hired mob acted, are given in the *Oxford Magazine*:—

“Thursday, Dec. 8, 1768. This day being appointed for the Middlesex election, the candidates appeared on the hustings at ten minutes before nine. Notwithstanding this, the opening of the poll was delayed till near eleven. One of the narrow avenues leading to Brentford butts was occupied very early by a hired mob, with bludgeons, bearing favours in their hats, inscribed, ‘Proctor and

Liberty.' A much larger, but very compact body, armed as the former, and with the same distinctions, were placed near the hustings, on an eminence, and in a disposition which was evidently the arrangement of an experienced sergeant. The rest of these banditti were stationed in different quarters of the town, to strike a general terror into the honest part of the freeholders; there was besides a 'corps de reserve' which was to sally forth on a signal given.

"When these dispositions were secured, a chosen party of butchers, in the same interest, traversed the town, and insulted the hustings with marrow-bones and cleavers. When Sir William Beauchamp Proctor's numbers were nearly exhausted, and the course of the Poll declared decisively for Mr. Serjeant Glynn, who had still great multitudes unpollled, the signal was given. An instantaneous and furious, but regular attack, was made on the hustings. The sheriffs, the candidates (Glynn declares himself as having been the last to depart), the clerks, and the poll-books, all vanished in a moment.

"The whole town was presently a scene of blood. It was not enough to knock down an unhappy man; the blow was followed till he was utterly disabled. Those who have been exposed to riots declare they never saw such cruelty. All doors and windows were barricaded. There was no shelter, nothing was safe; nor can anything equal the consternation of the frightened people but the abhorrence and execration with which every tongue repeats the name of Proctor.

"It appears from every account of the above proceedings, that the people who began the riot there were the friends of the court candidate; and, in particular, it is affirmed that when the Irish chairmen, and the professed bruisers at their head, had proceeded so far in their cruel and villainous intention of murdering and wounding the people, that the gentlemen upon the hustings began to be in danger of their lives,—one gentleman went up to the court candidate, and expostulated with him on the base conduct of *his mob*. 'My mob!' replied the courtier. 'Yes, sir, *your mob*!' and the gentleman added, 'Sir, I insist upon your speaking to those fellows who are knocking down the people there.' But the courtier refused to say anything to

appease their fury; upon which the gentleman who had spoken to him, finding himself in danger of his life, seized him by the greatcoat, and showed his star to the armed ruffians, who instantly took off their hats and huzza'd him; while the ruffians were thus huzzaing, the gentleman escaped."

When the mob had cleared the hustings, they went into the town of Brentford, and attacked the Castle Inn, which was one of the candidate's houses of entertainment, and did considerable damage to it. The inhabitants of the town, observing this mischief, and beginning to fear their own houses would next be destroyed,—

"a general indignation took place: they sallied forth, attacked the rioters with great spirit, and drove them out of the town; and some of the voters vented their rage upon one or two of the houses opened for the other candidate. A number of persons with Proctor's cockades in their hats assembled about 'The Angel Inn' at Islington in a riotous manner, armed with bludgeons."

These well-paid hirelings were the worse for their potations, and, with the ringleader, were taken into custody.

It seems to have been a generally recognized stratagem imported into election tactics, where, as in war, nothing was considered "unfair," to get freeholders locked up on some fictitious pretence, such as false writs, actions, summonses, or impounded as witnesses at trials, etc.; where the principal never appeared, and the hearing never came on, while the victims "to error" were detained in durance until after the poll was finished. On the occasion under consideration, it appeared that a number of freeholders were particularly summoned as jurymen, to prevent their voting for the popular candidate; this manœuvre was defeated, as concerned the Old Bailey, where the lord mayor, Turner, behaved in a truly patriotic manner.

"When the jury was called, his Lordship asked them, upon their honour, if any of them were freeholders of Middlesex; it appeared that about eighteen of them were so (specially called in order that their votes might be lost), on which his Lordship immediately dismissed

them, that they might not be hindered from discharging their duty at Brentford.”

“Richard Dingham maketh oath that ‘the morning after the meeting of Sir William Beauchamp Proctor, at St. Giles’s, he saw four link-lighters named Welch, Hinton, Brady, and Quinn, disputing about some money they had received from Sir William, and they said that they had signed an agreement to go down, with several others, to Brentford on the day of Election to head a mob, and to put an end to the said Election, when they should receive orders, etc.’”

In the interval, and during the progress of the election, several men were committed to prison, including a chairman recognized as having acted as a leader, who was known as the “Infant,” being, in fact, a Hercules over six feet high; the true facts of the case came out upon examination, and, before the close of the poll, four affidavits were published in the papers, the tenour of which went to prove criminal complicity.

“Atkinson Bush maketh oath that he was at Brentford on the day of the election, and seeing a large body of men with labels in their hats, whereon was written, ‘Proctor and Liberty,’ this deponent asked them whether they were all voters for Proctor? upon which they declared they had no votes, but had in their hands what was as good, and showed him their bludgeons; and being asked who they supposed would get the election, they replied Proctor, swearing, if Glynn got the advantage, ‘By G——, we will have his blood!’”

Broughton, the notorious pugilist, happened to find congenial occupation, having been selected as a temporary generalissimo of the forces, with special recruiting powers as to the enlistment of his desperadoes.

“William Wheeler, Joyce, Davis, and other chairmen made oath that they, with about forty of their order, were engaged by Broughton, on the promise of a guinea a day each, for the like purpose of putting an end to the election when the signal should be given, and, according to the account of the deponents, all the parties mentioned appeared at Brentford.”

On the next day (December 14), the poll for the election of a knight of the shire for the county of Middlesex was peacefully concluded in the presence of the sheriffs and the justices of the peace of the county, attended by the constables to suppress any further demonstrations. At the close, the numbers stood, for Serjeant Glynn, 1542; Sir W. B. Proctor, 1278. It was said, "that the number polled on this occasion exceeded by forty-two the greatest number ever known to poll at any previous election."

The contest had been an expensive one; it was declared that Proctor and his party had been canvassing for six months; and, as an instance of the cost attending the election of a knight of the shire, it is set down as worthy of remark that the ribbons for hats alone, *i.e.* "favours," to distinguish Glynn's friends, cost four hundred pounds; the outlay of the Court candidate must have been excessively heavy.

"The populace in general, and the people of Brentford in particular, were very desirous to chair Mr. Serjeant Glynn after the sheriffs had declared his election; but he very politely entreated them to decline it, which, after much solicitation, they complied with."

In the letter of acknowledgment addressed to his supporters in the county of Middlesex, the serjeant declares—

"As my private advantage and honour were by no means the motives of your exertions in my behalf, so neither shall they be the objects of my actions. I consider the choice you have made of me for your representative as the most authentic declaration of your abhorrence of those arbitrary and oppressive measures which have too long disgraced the administration of these kingdoms, and which, if pursued, cannot fail to destroy our most excellent constitution.

"I hope that your example will lead other counties also to assert their independence, and that the sacred flame of liberty, which always ascends, will reach at length the higher orders of this nation, and warm them likewise to a disdain of offering or accepting the wages of corruption."

John Horne Tooke was only second to the successful candidate in the eulogiums showered on his name and conduct at this emergency. A portrait of “the parson of Brentford” was published, representing him in his clerical guise, at full length, seated in his study at a table, with his right arm resting on his “Treatise on Enclosing Commons, addressed to Sir Jno. Gibbins,” an essay which brought him an unusually handsome acknowledgment; in his other hand is a reference to his late correspondence with the defeated ministerial candidate—a paper inscribed, “Mobs made after the Court Fashion, by B. Proctor, Milliner of Brentford.”

Parson Horne wears a singular wig, with the sides in what has been described as a “cornuted”⁵² roll,—as peculiar as that affected by his friend Wilkes, to whom he bears a further resemblance from the obliquity of his eyes, his right eye having been blind, and fixed in its orbit.

The “Parson of Brentford” appears in the *Oxford Magazine*; it is evident that Horne’s parliamentary aspirations were talked of at this time, for opposite to the portrait is printed an “Extempore,—on the report that a certain Clergyman has a view on a seat in the House of Commons.”

“And is it true, and can it be?
Does Freedom so inflame him?
Exalt the *Horne* of Liberty;
No minister shall tame him.
Grant Heaven, we see it prove no jest,
But find, ere next November,
The man who makes a Patriot priest,
Become a Righteous Member.”

A copy of verses, with a quotation, “Templum Libertatis,” due to the pen of *Phileleutheros Oxoniensis*, confronts the copperplate portrait of Parson Horne:—

“TO THE REV. JOHN HORNE, MINISTER OF BRENTFORD.

“O, sent by Heav’n in these dishonest days
In ev’ry breast to kindle Freedom’s blaze,
To snatch the cov’ring from the statesman’s heart,
And awful truths, without a fear, impart!
Tho’ ministerial thunders round thee roll,
They roll in vain, nor shock thy manly soul:
Thy country’s rights thy midnight labours claim,
And with a Sidney’s join thy honour’d name.
Superior thou to every threat shalt rise,
And from the hands of rapine wrest her prize.
Thy pen shall Vice in all her wiles reveal,
And trembling Graftons⁵³ shall its vengeance feel.
Nor shall the murd’rer, foe to man and God,
Tho’ sav’d by power, escape thy painful rod;
Nor shall corruption, unmolested stand,
Sap all our rights, and sink a venal land;
True to thy conscience, to thy country true,
Thou shalt detect and dash her conquests too.
Proctor shalt, blushing, all his failings own,
Sigh o’er his loss, and o’er his triumphs groan;
His hir’d assassins fill his breast with shame,
And trembling own the terror of thy name.
Proceed, great Sir, in Freedom’s glorious cause,
O! save thy country and thy country’s laws!
The wiles of Statesmen without fear disclose,
And be a foe to all thy country’s foes.
So shall thy friend,⁵⁴ who in confinement sighs,
Smile in his pains, and great in suffer’ing rise:
In health, an honest patriot own in thee,
And, dying, joy to leave his country FREE.”

As in the previous election, there was a charge of murder, which arose out of the irregularities then committed, and two Irish chairmen, Balfe and McQuirk, were tried for the death of Mr. George Clarke, “a young gentleman of the law, whom curiosity had brought to Brentford at the late

election.” References to this incident are given in the satirical prints and magazines, together with the usual report of the trial of the malefactors. “The Present State of Surgery; or, Modern Practice” (Dec. 14, 1768), appeared in the *Universal Magazine*, vol. v. (April, 1769). This engraving shows Mr. Clarke, whose skull was fatally injured by a blow from a bludgeon, placed between two doctors, who are examining his head: one, a surgeon, is declaring, “If the fever does not kill him, contusions and fractures are nothing;” the other is of opinion, “A court plaister will remove the disorder.” One of a group of surgeons is inquiring of the senior, “Shall we apply the trepan, sir?” “A Glyster” is proposed as likely to “evacuate the broken pieces of bone.” The authors of the mischief, or some of the Irish bludgeon men, are standing by, and discussing the case: “The doctor says a broken skull’s nothing if they can but cure the fever.” His companion replies, “Thank God, we need not fear being knock’d on the head then!” A bystander is remarking, “I catch’d a fever from a bludgeon at Brentford myself”—many persons besides Clarke having complained of maltreatment during these riots. “Ay, they were deadly wise at the Election time,” is the opinion of another. A spectator ejaculates, “I wish those Irish dogs had kept the distemper to themselves—it’s worse than the Itch!” a double-barrelled allusion to the two trials for wilful murder which had arisen out of the successive Middlesex elections—the Irish chairmen who were the cause of Clarke’s death, and the Scotch soldiers who killed Allen. The contusion proved fatal; after languishing a few days the unfortunate young gentleman succumbed.

The trial of the two chairmen, Balfe and McQuirk, came on at the Old Bailey, January 14, 1769, and though the prisoners were provided with an array of learned counsellors, to the number of five, for their defence, they were pronounced “guilty,” and sentenced to transportation. An appeal was made to arrest judgment, but it was overruled, and the sentences ordered to be executed. Court influence, in the interval, procured a respite, and the men ultimately received a royal pardon, signed by Lord Rochford, secretary of state, which produced severe animadversions; see “Junius to the Duke of Grafton,” and the notes to this letter by John Wade (Edin. 1850). In the *Political Register* (IV.) is a copy of the document setting Balfe and McQuirk free. Meanwhile the College of Surgeons was consulted, to exonerate the guilty, to the dissatisfaction of the public.

“It is said that on a late surgical examination, there was the greatest privacy imaginable supported; not only several young surgeons (who, being advertised of the meeting, went there for the sake of instruction) were denied admittance, but there were two sentinels on the outside of the door to prevent any person from listening. Strange inquisitorial proceedings!”

On Monday, the master, wardens, and examiners of the Surgeons’ Company, ten in number, of whom five had appointments under administration, the president being one, and consequently holding the casting-vote (three of the committee actually held at that time appointments of “sergeant-surgeon” to the king, and another was surgeon to the Dowager Princess of Wales, his mother), met at their hall in the Old Bailey, in pursuance of a letter from the Earl of Rochford, one of His Majesty’s principal secretaries of state, desiring their opinion in relation to a doubt that had arisen whether the blow which Mr. Clarke received at the election at Brentford was the cause of his death; and the above gentlemen, after examining the surgeons, apothecary, and several others (*in camera*, as alleged), returned an answer the same evening to his lordship, giving it as their unanimous opinion, that the blow was not the cause of Mr. Clarke’s death. A satirical print, given in the *Oxford Magazine* as “A Consultation of Surgeons” (Feb. 27, 1769), exhibits the supposititious explanation of the inquiry and verdict. The surgeons are grouped round a table, on which are pens and ink. The president is pointing to the decision of the conclave, set down to order for Lord Rochford—“It does not appear that he died——” At the same time a large and well-filled bag of money, held up temptingly in the president’s right hand, appears the most conclusive evidence before the corporation. The chairman observes, “This [the money] convinces me that Clarke did not die of the wound he received at Brentford.” A Scotch surgeon is asserting, “By my Soul, his head was too thick to be broken, or he would ne’er ha’ gang’d to Brentford.” The next speaker, regarding the weighty motive in the president’s charge, avers, “Another such bag would convince me Clarke never received any blow.” A surgeon, with his gold-headed cane to his nose, is convinced, “Gold is good evidence, and carries great weight.” In reference to the surgeon Foot, who, called in at the time, deposed at the trial that Clarke died of the blow on head, but was of opinion that his life might have been saved by judicious treatment, one of the

consulting body, rising from his seat, is declaring, “Devil burn me, but that same surgeon was a blockhead; how should a Foot be able to judge of the Head?” The verdict of the College of Surgeons excited popular disgust, and various reflections were cast upon the method by which it was arrived at. The following appeared in the *Public Ledger* (April 13, 1769):—

“It is confidently repeated, that while a certain party of gentlemen were assembled together, in order to consult about vindicating themselves against Mr. Foot’s appeal, the ghost of Mr. Clarke appeared, and behaved in a most gross and insulting manner to the whole committee, which so terrified them all, that they have been very ill ever since, and it is thought some will not recover.”

Considerable interest attaches to the struggle in question, which made Wilkes a hero for a while. It was a time of trial as regarded the inviolability of the constitution. The ministers, safe in their bought majority in the Commons, ready to vote mechanically, seemed utterly callous as to the consequences of those infractions they were making on national liberties, presumably secured on an unassailable basis. The more impartial-minded of the people began to dread the attempted revival of despotic and irresponsible government and of those evils which had been guarded against by great exertions, firmness, and no slight sacrifices in the past. The spirit of resistance was abroad, and ministers for their own purposes disguised by every means the true condition of affairs from the head of the State. As the violation of popular liberties recalled the struggles which marked the later Stuart era, so were the means taken to resist these encroachments compared to the conduct of the people and their tribunes under the same trying circumstances. Petitions and remonstrances began to make ministers tremble lest the sympathies of the throne might be turned to their proper channel, the people.

Another election for Middlesex occurred in 1769, *vice* Wilkes; the results were that Wilkes was returned at the head of the poll, while his opponent (with a quarter of his votes) was declared duly elected. On the subject of Colonel Luttrell’s admission to the House much was said which must have been unpalatable to the Court. The *Oxford Magazine* printed a list of those members who were so patriotically inclined as to resist this

brazen violation of the constitution, as “the Minority who voted 1148 in preference to 296;” while those members who servilely voted for the right of the ministers to impose a defeated candidate on the Commons were described as “the Majority who preferred 296 to 1143.” A list is given of these placemen, pensioners, and courtiers, with particulars against their respective names which account for their lack of principle, all being in receipt of State patronage, or emolument of one kind or another, sufficient to prove that self-interest was their guiding principle, and that their consciences were closed by the greed of preferment. The despotic action enforced by the administration, in defiance of the principles of the constitution,—a common practice in the reign of George III.,—provoked a very pertinent disquisition upon the potentiality of the bulwark of popular rights. The great Lord Bacon, somewhere talking of the power of parliaments, says, there is nothing which a parliament cannot do; and he had reason. A parliament can revive or abrogate old laws, and make new ones; settle the succession to the Crown; impose taxes; establish forms of religion; naturalize foreigners; dissolve marriages; legitimate bastards; attain a man of treason, etc. Lord Bolingbroke, indeed, is of a different opinion, and affirms there is something which a parliament cannot do: it cannot annul the constitution; and that if it should attempt to annul the constitution, the whole body of the people would have a right to resist it. It is natural, too, to think that Lord Bacon limited the power of parliament, great as he believed it, to those things which do not imply a physical impossibility. Modern ministers, however, have shown that a parliament is able, at least in appearance, to effect even such impossibilities. Sir Robert Walpole was wont to boast that he had “trained his fellows,” as he called his venal majority in the House of Commons, “in such a manner, and brought them to such exact discipline, that were he to desire them to vote Jesus Christ a Gildon” (*i.e.* the head of an infidel sect, Gildon being a deistical writer in Walpole’s day) “he was sure of their compliance.” The ministry then in office (the Grafton administration), as will appear by the list referred to above, had assumed a power no less arbitrary and equally unreasonable, by persuading their servile majority to vote in defiance of the constitution on the question of Colonel Luttrell’s qualifications to sit in the Commons—that the 296 suffrages (recorded for Luttrell) were preferable to the 1143 polled for Wilkes.

The ministerial conduct on the case of Wilkes and upon the events arising therefrom, joined with their ill-advised manœuvres on behalf of their own chosen candidates, produced a marked effect on the constituencies elsewhere, and, as Horace Walpole writes to his friend, Sir H. Mann (March 23, 1769), towns began to break off from their allegiance to the administration in power, and sent instructions to their members to oppose the measures of the Court party. "As the session approached, Lord Chatham engaged with a new warmth in promoting petitions." In opposition alike to the "Remonstrances," and to those who questioned the policy of turning a deaf ear to the petitions of the nation—loyal to the throne, but earnestly set upon the reform of abuses and the extinction of "grievances,"—the ministers encouraged their adherents to secure addresses approving their acts, and praying the throne to disregard petitions for rights. The public prints satirized these servile expressions, manufactured to order, while the wits and caricaturists mercilessly exposed the *modus operandi* of fabricating these illegitimate addresses. According to Horace Walpole, Calcraft and Sir John Mawbey "by zeal and activity obtained a petition from the county of Essex, though neither the High Sheriff, the members, nor any one gentleman of the county would attend the meeting." It was the old story of the Essex petitions over again, as already set down in the group of "Election Ballads" under Charles II., when the same county made itself conspicuous in a similar fashion: "It was thought wise," wrote Walpole, "to procure loyal addresses, and one was obtained from Essex, which being the great county for calves, obtained nothing but ridicule." A pictorial version sets forth the situation (March 6, 1769) as "The Essex Procession from Chelmsford to St. James's Market, for the good of the Common-Veal." The engraving represents a street ending in the archway of St. James's, towards which are progressing two carts, drawn by donkeys tandem-wise, and filled with bleating calves. The cart is driven by Rigby, the Duke of Bedford's factotum, a supporter of the Court, much interested in the petitions presented to the king at this period: this political agent is travestied as an ass; he is crying, "Calves' Heads à la daube! Who'll buy my veal?" One of the victimized calves in the cart is bleating, "This is a Rig-by-Jove;" another exclaims, "How we expose ourselves!" The other charioteer is intended for C. Dingley, author of the "Saw-mill" experiment at Limehouse, and who was an influential projector of the new "City-road;" he was a creature of the Duke of Grafton, a prominent ally of the Court faction

against Wilkes and the patriots, and was generally obnoxious to the more constitutionally minded of the citizens. Dingley is transformed into an ox, and he is made to declare to his special consignment of calves, "Friends and Countrymen, you shall not be misrepresented." One of the calf contingent, mindful of slaughter, is bleating, "I hope they won't drive us to St. George's Fields," the place of slaughter—otherwise, the scene of the recent wanton attacks of the Scottish soldiery on the people; while another of Dingley's followers is expressing a wish that the famous saw-mills, which were the cause of a riot in which they were demolished, might prove the destruction of the speculator himself. In opposition to the "foolish Essex address," it was, as described in the *Gentleman's Magazine*, "resolved at a meeting of gentlemen held at Chelmsford, December 15, 1769, to support the right of election to Parliament, and to petition the king for a dissolution of Parliament."

The Essex address was followed up, on the part of what were entitled London merchants, by a similar production, which was chiefly promoted by Charles Dingley; a version of this transaction is entitled "The Addressers." It appears that "officious tools," and interested, if not bribed, citizens, designated as "the Merchants of London," attended, March 8, 1769, at the King's Arms Tavern, Cornhill, at the invitation of Dingley and his followers. One shilling was charged at the door to keep away the crowd, ostensibly to defray the expense of the room; and one Lovell, having complied with this, found Dingley with a few others assembled. Mr. Muilmann, a German or Dutch stockbroker, professionally nicknamed "Van Scrip," gave Lovell a copy of the address to read, and told him he could sign the original then on the table; but on Lovell's expressing that "he did not approve of the address," Dingley ordered him out; but, having paid his shilling, he stood on his right to remain. Then followed Reynolds (who was Wilkes's attorney), and having paid his shilling, and refusing to sign the address, was also asked to leave, but elected to enjoy the privilege of remaining. Vaughan and others did the same. The room being then filled, when Mr. Charles Pole was invited to take the chair at the suggestion of the anti-addressers, their opponents "opposed all order," repeating the cry of "No chair!" with the utmost fury, and threatening to "turn down stairs all who called for any chairman." The chair itself became an object of contention between the hostile parties; one secured the seat, another the

frame, and the “abhorrrers of disorder” triumphed until another chair was obtained. The ticklish office of president was at last accepted by Mr. Vaughan. Attorney Reynolds was standing near the chairman, when Dingley, enraged at the success of this counter-demonstration, addressing him as a “d——d scoundrel,” struck him a violent blow in the face; on which provocation, Reynolds, being of commanding size, knocked Dingley down. “Many were the efforts made to dispossess Mr. Vaughan of the chair, strokes were aimed at him with canes and sticks, but the blows were warded off by his friends.”

Such is the disturbance set forth in the satirical engraving of “The Addressers” (March 8, 1769), in which is represented the *fracas* at the King’s Arms Tavern consequent on this insidious attempt to manufacture a bogus address. Attorney Reynolds’s wig is awry, from the blow inflicted by Dingley; he is knocking the latter out of the chair, and exclaiming, “I’ll make you pay for this.” Dingley is saying, “For this £2000 more;” while, in falling, from his pocket drops a paper, “Saw-mill, £2000.” “Van Scrip,” Muilmann, alluding to the cash considerations held out by the ministers to their allies, is extending his hand, and crying in dismay, “We shall lose this scrip!” A spectator, armed with a riding-whip, is asserting, “You’ll be Jockey’d, Mynheer.” The persons in the crowd are demanding, “A chair! a chair!” while others shout to the contrary; the chair itself is mounted on a table placed in the middle of the room. Mr. Apvan (Vaughan) is occupying this perilous distinction. “Why *address*, Gentlemen?” is his question to the meeting. A slight fencing-match is going on; the chairman holding his own, while those who attack him cry “Order.” A clergyman—no other than the “Brentford Parson” in person—is suggesting the propriety of “an Address to keep the streets clean,” the condition of the thoroughfares in London being the subject of complaint at this time. From the report of these proceedings published in the *Gentleman’s Magazine*, it appears that a speaker asserted that the “proper functions of such an assembly were to order the scavengers to clean the streets, and beadles to remove vagrants from them.” The fragments of the chair first dismantled, as described, are in the hands of some of the company by the door. A man has gone down in his exertions “to stand up for the Address.” The incendiary document in question is carried off by one Mr. Phelim O’Error, who is declaring, “I’ll take it to the

Merchant Seamen's Office," to which it was removed on the next stage of its career.

Another version of these proceedings appeared, March 8, 1769, as "The Battle of Cornhill;" an engraving given in the *Town and Country Magazine*, with a short parody in the style of a drama on the subject, as detailed in the foregoing "Addressers." The counter-assault upon Dingley is similarly illustrated. Reynolds, the Attorney Freeman of the drama, is depicted as a tall, burly man. Dingley is made to cry, "Murder, murder. Oh, the rascal. I'll have him imprisoned seven years for this illegal attack. He has done me twelve hundred, if not two thousand pounds damage." Van Scrip is much alarmed: "Heaven! what will become of me! I shall lose all my interest in the Treasury, if we fail in carrying it. I shan't have a single government contract, not so much as a thousand pounds scrip." An anecdote is related in the *London Museum* (ii. 1770, p. 32) concerning the use of lottery tickets as bribes by the Government, where Bradshaw, secretary to the Treasury, stigmatized by "Junius" as "the cream-coloured parasite," is alleged to have "met the member for Buckinghamshire (Lowndes), and offered two hundred lottery tickets at ten pounds each, which were accepted." Scrip and lottery tickets were freely employed for political bribery at this period, as Walpole mentions in his "Memoirs of the Reign of King George the Third," and Sir H. N. Wroxall describes in his "Historical Memoirs."

"The Enchanted Castle; or, King's Arms in an Uproar" (March 8, 1769) is a further pictorial version of the same occurrence, with little variation as to the persons or incidents represented, but containing a reference, like the last, to the "London Tavern," the recognized head-quarters and meeting-place for the Society of Supporters of the Bill of Rights, and consequently opposed to sycophantic admiration of ministerial illegalities. Beneath the print in question is a copy of verses, beginning—

"I sing the bloody fight and dire alarms
'Twixt London Tavern and King's Arms.
Planning Addresses Dingley's party sate,
And meditating on their Country's fate."

Horace Walpole thus describes the transactions represented in the foregoing:—

“The merchants of London, to the number of six or eight hundred, amongst whom were Dutch, Jews, and any officious tools that they could assemble, having signed one of those servile panegyrics [addresses], set out in a long procession of coaches, to carry it to St. James’s.”

The *modus operandi* by which the address was promoted is fancifully summed up in the plate of the *Oxford Magazine*, vol. ii., p. 134, “The Principal Merchants and Traders assembled at the Merchant Seamen’s Office, to sign ye Address.” This print represents a further stage in the progress of the transaction. The *Public Advertiser*, March 11, 1769, announces, “For these two Days past, numbers of the Merchants and principal Traders of London have attended at the Merchant Seamen’s Office, over the Royal Exchange, in order to sign an Address to his Majesty, etc.”

It is stated in the *Oxford Magazine*, “So eager were the ministers to procure a long list of subscribers that, it is credibly reported, some of the addresses of the then ‘City Merchants,’ were signed by cobblers, porters, chairmen, livery-servants, and the very meanest of the rabble; for as the number of hands was the chief point of view, they cared but little of what rank or condition they were.” The caricaturist has carried out this view of the signatories. The chairman or president is a butcher, whose tray, containing a shoulder of mutton, is laid down at his feet; he is filled with loyal frenzy, and, with his butcher’s knife grasped ready for action, is exclaiming, “I shall stick my knife in *Magna Charta*, and cut up the carcase of the Bill of Rights.” A porter, with his knot, is anathematizing Wilkes’s “swivel eyes,” and wishing he “may sink under his load.” The petition is being signed by a barber, with his bowl under his arm, together with an aldermanic wig just ordered: “Ah, I’ve got an order for a new wig, only for signing my name.” A Scotch pedlar, with pack and staff, one of Lord Bute’s followers, declares, “Sawney mun sign too, gin it be to the De’il, for my guid laird’s sake.” A journeyman baker, with a basketful of loaves on his back, is coming in succession, well paid for his assistance: “Brother

Merchants, follow my example, and you'll never want bread;" and even a sooty chimney-sweep has expectations of ministerial patronage, "Who knows but I may be appointed to a Chimney at Court?" Prominent among those at the table whereon is the much-denounced "Address," is a Jew money-jobber, who is elated at his prospects of a Treasury "job," "Oh! for a large portion of scrip!" and the Dutch stockbroker, Van Scrip, is exclaiming, "Ah! de gross Scrip for Mynheer too,"—the subscription scrip to government loans, profitable to those who secured preference allotments, and, as described, alleged to be manipulated by the ministry in the nature of bribery.

The strictures provoked upon the underhand methods by which these addresses were forced upon the public are exemplified in an "Epistle to the *North Briton*," which appeared in the *Oxford Magazine*, to accompany the engraving of the "Addressing Merchants." The epistle is lengthy, and we have only room for the opening passages. It is possibly written by the "Brentford Parson;" indeed, the manner as well as matter indicates the authorship suggested. The motto is given, "There is nothing new under the sun" (*Eccles.* i. 9)—

"And so, sir, what you have often foretold is at last come to pass. We are fairly fallen back into the very dregs of the Stuart reigns. The party of *Abhorrers* is once more revived; of those *Abhorrers*, who, in the reign of King Charles the Second, expressed their detestation of all the patriotic and public spirited, as I would say—but, as they were pleased to call them, the factious and insolent petitions that were presented to the king for assembling a parliament, and for securing the other rights and liberties of the People.

"That such wretches should have existed at a time when the Sovereign claimed, and many of his subjects were willing to allow him, a divine, indefeasible, hereditary right to play the tyrant, and to destroy the constitution is nothing strange; but that any such should be found in the reign of a prince, whose family was advanced to the throne in direct contradiction to this absurd principle, would be really surprising, did we not know that human nature is always the same, and that though the seeds of slavery may be smothered for a time, yet

whenever they meet with the vivifying influence of court sunshine, they immediately begin to quicken, and to spring up with vigour. And never, sure, did these seeds meet with a more fertile soil, or a more benign sky, than under the present arbitrary and despotic administration, when every man is sure to be rewarded in exact proportion to the servility of his character.

“In this respect, indeed, the present ministers have greatly the advantage of all that have gone before them; for I do not remember a single compliment paid to the *Abhorrers*, in the reign of King Charles the Second, except the honour of knighthood conferred upon Francis Withers, Esq., who procured and presented the Address from the City of Westminster. But how much more grateful and generous have been our present ministers! They have made the late chief City Magistrate a Privy Councillor, and have given him a contract with government for clothing soldiers, worth £1000 per annum. They have pardoned the murderers MacLaughlin, Balfe, and McQuirk, and have even granted them pensions. This, say the ministry, is only supporting their friends; but, if murderers be their friends, I believe few people will envy them the credit of such a connection.

“Some of the addresses in the reign of the Stuarts breathed a very free and independent spirit. That of the Quakers, upon the accession of King James the Second, may serve as an instance. It was conceived in the following terms:—

“‘We come,’ said they, ‘to testify our sorrow for the death of our good friend Charles, and our joy for thy being made our governor. We are told thou art not of the persuasion of the Church of England, no more than we; wherefore we hope thou wilt grant us the same liberty which thou allowest thyself. Which doing, we wish thee all manner of happiness.’

“There we see the Quakers, with their usual plainness and simplicity, very roundly tell his majesty, that he was not a member of the church of England; a circumstance, which was then thought by many, and hath since been declared by law, to be sufficient to disqualify him for wearing the crown of these Kingdoms.

“But how much more courtly and polite is the language of our present Addressers. They not only pay the highest compliments to the King, which he certainly deserves, they even offer the most nauseous and fulsome flattery to his ministers and servants, and express their entire approbation of every part of their conduct. They must therefore approve of the robbery committed upon the Duke of Portland, of the massacre in St. George’s Fields, of the riot and murders at Brentford, of withdrawing MacLaughlin from the cognizance of the laws, and of pardoning Balfe and McQuirk after they had been fairly tried and condemned by their country.

“But, not satisfied with declaring their approbation of the conduct of the ministry, they express their utter abhorrence and detestation of the conduct of those who have had the presumption to oppose them. They must, therefore, *abhor* the conduct of the Freeholders of Middlesex, who chose Mr. Wilkes and Mr. Serjeant Glynn, their representatives in parliament, in spite of all the violent, outrageous, and illegal attempts which the ministry made to prevent them. They must *abhor* the conduct of the 139 independent members who voted against the expulsion of Mr. Wilkes from an august assembly, of which they form the respectable, and perhaps even the most wealthy, tho’ not the most numerous part. They must *abhor* the conduct of the Citizens of London, of the Citizens of Westminster, of the Freeholders of Middlesex, and of all the other counties and corporations, who, in their instructions to their representatives, have disapproved of those very measures which the Addressers approve. In a word, they must abhor the conduct, at least the sentiments, of ninety-nine parts in a hundred of the people of England, who, if taken separately, and fairly interrogated, would be found to entertain opinions very different from those of the Addressers.”

The “Battle of Cornhill,” otherwise the fight for the signatures to the servile loyal address as already described, was followed by another stage in the contest, an attempt to carry the address in state through the city, the procession being stopped by a conflict in Fleet Street, of which turbulent episode a caricature appeared, March 22, 1769, under the title of the “Battle of Temple Bar.” The engraving offers a vista of Fleet Street; the Devil

Tavern, the arched entrance to the Temple, and Nando's Coffee-house are shown to the right; the gates of the bar are closed, and around is a scene of confused conflict. The decapitated heads of Fletcher and Townley, stuck on poles over Temple Bar, are represented in conversation. The Jacobites executed for their share in the Scottish raid of 1745 are inquiring whether the Addressers are not "friends to the cause which we all love so dear," and which had planted their heads on the bar over twenty years before. A carriage, drawn by two horses, is the centre of the struggle; the coachman is observing "They all seem in a fair way;" the rabble are pelting the vehicle, from which the person charged with the care of the loyal address is making his escape. Another member of the party bound for St. James's is seeking shelter from the shower of missiles at the entrance to Nando's. Other coaches have been subjected to similar indignities; the servants are declaring, "Our masters are finely bedaubed!" The city marshal and his charger are under fire from the mob; grasping his baton and holding his hat to protect his face, the marshal declares, "I find I must go to y^e Devil!" The Devil, perched on the sign of the famous tavern christened after his name, is crying, with a Scotch twang, "in compliment to my Lord Bute," "Fly to me, my Bairns!" This plate is given in the *London Magazine*, with an account of the pelting and flight of those who were engaged in carrying the address to the king.



SEQUEL TO THE BATTLE OF TEMPLE BAR—PRESENTATION OF THE
LOYAL ADDRESS AT ST. JAMES'S PALACE. 1769.

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The concluding stage in the progress of the address and the cavalcade of carriages which attended it, was marked by the appearance of the satirical engraving entitled the “Sequel to the Battle of Temple Bar,” 1769, of which a reduced fac-simile is given. The spot represented is the front of St. James’s Palace, facing St. James’s Street. The remnants of the procession of merchants charged with the address in support of the ministry in power are escaping down Pall Mall, the carriages, with broken windows, being followed by galling volleys of stones and dirt on the part of the mob, while a hearse exhibiting inflammatory placards is accorded an enthusiastic reception. The spectators gathered at the St. James’s Coffee House and around the palace are encouraging the hostile demonstration; the courtiers are surveying the tumult from the gateway and windows of St. James’s Palace. A person mounted on the tower, and assumed to be intended for Lord Bute, is pointing to the weathercock, exclaiming, “High north wind,” *i.e.* a Scotch wind. The Guards are making attacks upon individuals; a gentleman is being surrounded; the violence of the soldiers is watched by a

clergyman, evidently intended for Parson Horne, whose eye was upon those who infringed the rights of the subjects or unlawfully maltreated any of the people. A burlesque funeral procession diversified the proceedings, headed by a mounted mute, wearing a crape weeper, with mourning staff, the hearse drawn by two wretched screws, one black and one white; the coachman is equally odd—the person who drove was declared to have been a frolicsome lordling, it is said young Earl Mountmorres. The body of this vehicle displays a flaring placard—the presentment of an Irish chairman striking with a bludgeon a person who is knocked down and defenceless; this moving picture, inscribed “Brentford,” represents the fate of Mr. Clarke, whose fractured skull, caused by the brutal attack of Proctor’s hired ruffians, ended in his death. Similar placards, “St. George’s Fields” and “Scot Victory,” are posted on the hearse to remind the ministers that the odium of the massacre of the people at St. George’s Fields, and the deliberate assassination of William Allen (May 10, 1768), by a grenadier of the Scottish Regiment, were not forgotten; a coloured picture of this episode was displayed on the other side of the hearse. A diversion is attempted at the entrance to the palace gates, where the figure of a short nobleman is distinguishable by the star on his coat; he is using his broken official staff like a sword. This personage, who actually seized one of the rioters, and who is intended for Earl Talbot, lord steward of the household, is bareheaded, his wig having been displaced in the scuffle with the people, and, finally, a knock on the head cooled his courage; the Guards are coming to his support. Further details of the ending of this vexed question of the address are given in the political intelligence of the time. From all accounts, Mr. Boehm, in whose charge was the fateful roll, was too occupied in securing his own safety to trouble about the fate of the address. It appears that the scattered procession went on to St. James’s without the presenter of the document which had entailed so many embarrassments. According to the *Political Register*, a messenger was despatched back to the coffee-house for the address; where “Mr. Boehm, having missed it, remained in great suspense.” After many inquiries and great alarm, the roll was found under the seat of the coach, where, by a miracle, it had escaped the search of the mob; the address was immediately forwarded to St. James’s, where it was expectantly awaited.

The history of this incident is taken up by the *Political Register* for 1769:—

“The merchants and traders who retired with the address mentioned in the account of the proceedings at the ‘King’s Arms,’ having by means of repeated advertisements and private letters obtained a considerable number of persons to sign the said address at the Merchant Seamen’s Office over the Royal Exchange; ... Wednesday, the 22nd March, at two in the afternoon, being appointed, on that day at noon, a great number of the merchants, etc., of this city, set out from the Royal Exchange in their carriages, in order to present an address to His Majesty, attended by the City Marshal and constables; before they got to Cheapside, the mob showed them many marks of their resentment, by hissing, groaning, throwing dirt, etc., but when they arrived at Fleet Street, the multitude grew quite outrageous, broke the windows of the coaches, threw stones and glass bottles, and dispatched a party to shut up the gates at Temple Bar, on which the cavalcade was obliged to stop. Mr. Cook, the City Marshal, going to open the gates with his attendants, was very severely treated; his clothes were torn off his back and his head cut in two places. The populace then attacked the gentlemen in their carriages; Mr. Boehm (who carried the roll) and several of his friends being covered with dirt, were obliged to take refuge in Nando’s Coffee-house. Some of the coaches then drove up Chancery Lane, Fetter Lane, and Shoe Lane; but the greater part of the gentlemen, finding it impossible to proceed, returned home. The Addressers, however, did at length reach St. James’s, but the mob threw dirt at the gentlemen as they got out of their carriages at St. James’s Gate.”

The few that reached the palace were so covered with dirt as to be unpresentable, and those of the courtiers who came within reach of the mob were also bespattered. The document which was the main cause of this disturbance was within an ace of never reaching its destination.

“When Mr. Boehm was obliged to get out of his coach at Nando’s Coffee-house to avoid the mob, in his hurry he left the address under the cushion on one of the seats, and immediately ordered the

coachman to go home; some of the mob opened the coach door, and began to search for the address, but the coachman declaring 'it was sent before' (though he knew not where it was), they were the less diligent in their search, and missed laying hold of it, by not feeling six inches farther on the seat."

On the road thither, by the Strand, the additions already mentioned were made to the cavalcade, to the consternation of those who formed part of it:—

"When some of the coaches got to Exeter Exchange, a hearse came out of Exeter Street, and preceded them, drawn by a black and white horse, the driver of which had on a rough coat, resembling a skin, with a large cap, one side black, the other white, whose whole figure was very grotesque. On one side of the hearse was painted on canvas a representation of the rioters killing Mr. Clarke at the Brentford election; and on the other side was a representation of the soldiers firing on young Allen in the cow-house."

The *Town and Country Magazine* (1769) divulges that the driver of the decorated hearse was "a man of fortune;" moreover, another account avers —

"I have always understood that the late Lord Mountmorres, then a very young man, was the person, who on that occasion, personated the executioner [of Charles I. ?], holding an axe in his hands, and his face covered with crape." (See Wraxall's "Historical Memoirs;" also the "Letters of the First Earl of Malmesbury," etc.)

The hearse attended the cavalcade, making a short stop at Carlton House, where the Princess of Wales lived, also at the residence of the "Cumberland Butcher," and at Lord Weymouth's, in Pall Mall (as the author of the St. George's Fields massacre); thence the hearse, with its "humiliating insignia, was driven into the court-yard of St. James's, followed by the mob, after which it went off to Albemarle Street." A copy of the address is given in the *Political Register* (iv. 1769).

The address and its supporters were in a sad plight when the levee-room was reached, after the foregoing vicissitudes. The Duke of Chandos wrote Mr. Grenville—

“Out of one hundred and thirty merchants who went up with the address, only twelve could get to the King, and they were covered in dirt, as indeed was almost the whole Court.”

The riotous crowd continued to create a disturbance at the palace gates, “accompanied with threats of a most dangerous kind” (as declared in the royal proclamation); while the Earl of Malmesbury wrote, “Many of the mob cried, ‘Wilkes and no King,’ which is shocking to think of.” At last, the proclamation against tumultuous assemblies was read, and—

“Several persons taken into custody by the soldiers; and two were taken by Lord Talbot, who was the only minister who had sufficient resolution to come down among the mob; his lordship had secured another, who was rescued, and his lordship received a violent blow on the head, by being thrown against a coach, and then thought it prudent to take shelter among the soldiers.”

A grand council at St. James’s was held on the afternoon of these events, and in the evening a *Gazette Extraordinary* was published, with a proclamation by the king—who had in person witnessed the disturbances attending the sham address,—“for suppressing riots,” etc., beginning—

“Whereas it has been represented to us that divers dissolute and disorderly persons have most riotously and unlawfully assembled themselves together, to the disturbance of the public peace, and have, in a most daring and audacious manner, assaulted several merchants and others, coming to our palace at St. James’s, and have committed many acts of violence and outrage before the gates of our palace,” etc.

The proclamation further charges the lord mayor, and justices of the peace for the cities of London and Westminster, borough of Southwark, and counties of Middlesex and Surrey, to prevent and suppress all riots, tumults, and unlawful assemblies, etc.

Another engraving on the same topic—as described by Mr. Edward Hawkins, from whose collection, bequeathed to the British Museum, many of these early illustrations are selected—was entitled:—

“THE GOTHAM ADDRESSERS; OR, A PEEP AT THE
HEARSE.”

“Sing the Addressers who lately set out
To flatter the great and honesty rout,
Where Frenchmen, and Swiss, and Hollanders shy
United their forces with Charley Dingley,” etc.

The procession and hearse (the driver is exclaiming “Wilkes and Liberty”) are again shown at St. James’s Palace. The chief promoter, Charles Dingley, is made the principal butt of this satire, and, as the address began with him, it is appropriately so terminated. The hearse with the placards is succeeded by a coach bearing on the roof a windmill, an allusion to Dingley’s too famous saw-mills at Limehouse, which were dismantled by the sawyers out of work and other rioters. The coachman of this equipage is endeavouring to pacify the mob: “Wilkes and Liberty, Gentlemen; I had no hand in the d——d Address.” The chief offender, seen inside the coach, is also appealing to the incensed crowd: “For God’s sake, Gentlemen, spare me; I wish the Address had been in Hell before I meddled with it.” His bemired footman is declaring, “My livery’s like my master, d——d Dirty.” The next coach has on it a zany with cap and bells, seated “on the Massacre of Aboyna;” this figure of folly is exclaiming, “I give Mr. Dingle the lead;” the rider, one of the loan-contractors and bidders for ministerial favour, cries, “Ayez pitié de moi!” “Dingle’s Downfall, a new Song,” is chanted by a female ballad-singer. Dead cats and mud are thrown at the procession, which is followed by the groans and hisses of the spectators.

The foregoing events are further elucidated in “A Dialogue between the Two Heads on Temple Bar.” The narrator professes to have overheard the following conversation upon politics between the decapitated heads of the 1745 rebels stuck over Temple Bar:—

“But soon more surpris’d, and I’ll tell you the cause, sir,
The heads on Temple Bar were in a deep discourse, sir.

‘Why, Fletcher,⁵⁵ your head and mine has been fixed hither
These full twenty years, expos’d to all weather
For being concerned in a Scottish rebellion:
Not like Bute, the nation to rob of three million.’

‘Ay, Townsend, but Bute play’d the jockey so fair, sir,
Got the money for riding the old Georgian mare, sir,
But his tricks at St. James’s Wilkes soon did disclose, sir,
Tho’ squint-ey’d, saw how Bute led the King by the nose, sir.’

‘Why, Fletcher, that’s worse than open rebellion!
And here’s room on the Bar if they would but behead him;
In St. George’s Fields there’s room for a gibbet,
But justice of late, they don’t choose to exhibit.
If justice took place, ’twould cause Jack some trouble,
Lord Mansfield himself, might, by chance, mount the scaffold.
No more alt’ring records; but this joke might be said,
As blind with the scales, he appears without head.



And half a score more, tuck’d up in a halter;
But don’t forget to hang Luttrell and Proctor,
For ’tis such rogues as these that corrupted the nation,
And caus’d these disturbances, strife, and vexation.
Then the King would be freed from all of roguish party,
And let those fill their places who are loyal and hearty.’”

CHAPTER VIII.

PETITIONS AND REMONSTRANCES TO THE THRONE, 1769-70.

Petitions and remonstrances began to make ministers tremble lest finally the sympathies of the throne might be turned into the proper channel, and the king be led to espouse the cause of the people, who, to do them justice, remained loyal under both the critical emergencies described as occurring under Charles II. and George III., and which had more than a casual resemblance.

The remonstrances of the citizens were persistently laid before the king, although every obstacle was interposed in the way of their presentation by petty indignities imposed upon those bold enough to approach the presence with objects thus distasteful to the royal ideas of sovereign right—

“Make prayers not so like petitions
As overtures and propositions.”
(*Hudibras*.)

On July 5, 1769, the Livery of London presented a petition to the king; the lord mayor, Samuel Turner, Sir Robert Ladbroke,⁵⁶ Alderman Beckford, and other friends of popular liberty being charged with this statement of grievances, of which the following extracts must suffice:—

“We should be wanting in our duty to your Majesty, as well as to ourselves and our posterity, should we forbear to represent to the throne the desperate attempts that have been, and are too successfully, made to destroy that constitution to the spirit of which we owe the

relation which subsists between your Majesty and the subjects of these realms, and to subvert those sacred laws which our ancestors have sealed with their blood.

“Your ministers, from corrupt principles and in violation of every duty, have, by various enumerated means, invaded our invaluable and inalienable right of trial by jury.

“They have, with impunity, issued general warrants, and violently seized persons and private papers.

“They have rendered the laws non-effective to our security, by invading the Habeas Corpus.

“They have caused punishments and even perpetual imprisonment to be inflicted, without trial, conviction, or sentence.

“They have brought into disrepute the civil magistracy, by the appointment of persons who are, in many respects, unqualified for that important trust, and have thereby purposely furnished a pretence for calling in the aid of the military power.

“They avow, and endeavour to establish, a maxim absolutely inconsistent with our constitution, that ‘an occasion for effectually employing a military force always presents itself, when the civil power is trifled with or insulted;’ and by a fatal and false application of this maxim, they have wantonly and wickedly sacrificed the lives of many of your Majesty’s innocent subjects, and have prostituted your Majesty’s sacred name and authority, to justify, applaud, and recommend their own illegal and bloody actions.

“They have screened more than one murderer from punishment, and in its place have unnaturally substituted reward.

“And after having insulted and defeated the law on different occasions, and by different contrivances, both at home and abroad, they have at length completed their design, by violently wresting from the people the *last sacred right we had left*, the right of election, by the unprecedented seating of a candidate notoriously set up and chosen only by themselves. They have thereby taken from your subjects all hopes of parliamentary redress, and have left us no resource, under God, but in your Majesty.

“All this they have been able to effect by corruption; by a scandalous misapplication and embezzlement of the public treasure, and a shameful prostitution of public honours and employments; procuring deficiencies of the civil lists to be made good without examinations; and, instead of punishing, conferring honours on a paymaster, the public defaulter of unaccounted millions.

“From an unfeigned sense of the duty we owe to your Majesty, and to our country, we have ventured thus humbly to lay before the throne these great and important truths, which it has been the business of your Ministers to conceal. We most earnestly beseech your Majesty to grant us redress. It is for the purpose of redress alone, and for such occasions as the present, that those great and extensive powers are entrusted to the Crown by the wisdom of that Constitution which your Majesty’s illustrious family was chosen to defend, and which we trust in God it will for ever continue to support.”

Of each paragraph given in the foregoing the meaning was conclusive, the instance known to all. There is in this petition no statement exaggerated, no sentiment overcoloured, considering that one paragraph alone describes no less than the suicidal measures which dismembered the empire, and cost the mother country the allegiance of “the colonies,” *i.e.* the continent of America, in these plain words:—

“They [the Grafton administration] have established numberless unconstitutional regulations and taxations in our colonies. They have caused a revenue to be raised in some of them by prerogative.”

However meritorious the cause, it was an offence to a king whose mind, never remarkable for lucidity, was then under “the influence of the worst of counsellors,” as stated in the first prayer of the petition. The document—when the petitioners were, after much discouragement, delay, and many subterfuges, and, “although no time could be fixed for its acceptance,” permitted to approach the presence at a levee—was at last presented; but the king made no reply, but, handing the petition to the lord-in-waiting, turned his back on the presenters, who represented the integrity and commercial greatness of the city of London and were its elected guardians, and addressed Baron Dieden, the Danish ambassador, who was standing in his vicinity, on an indifferent topic.

After the late fulsome reception of “bogus addressers” nothing could be more contemptible than the studied impertinence with which the Corporation of London was treated, and the affront of leaving the civil magistrate to

“skulk about the passages of the Court that he may have a glimpse of His Majesty as he passes along in state, in order to deliver into his hands a remonstrance affecting the most essential interests of above twelve millions of people, who by the sweat of their brow support the pomp and parade of royalty and swell the fastidious pride and coxcombical vanity of empty courtiers.”

It was boldly hazarded at this emergency, from the premeditated affront to the representatives alike of the city and the people, that the rulers, blinded to their own destruction, then concluded—

“themselves sufficiently prepared for the final extirpation of liberty in this island, and that by deliberate insults they were urging the people to commit some outrage, which might give them a pretence for putting their scheme of tyranny into immediate execution.”

If the city, by its dignified and law-abiding demeanour, disappointed these expectations, it was argued that the Court party would not wait for an excuse to wreak their vengeance under some thin disguise of retributive justice, but would proceed to order out the “Scotch Regiment, as in the

affair of St. George's Fields, without waiting for the least appearance of necessity."

A correspondent of the *Oxford Magazine*, writing under the signature "Philopolis," referring to the threatened massacres in St. George's Fields, and, on the grounds that the late firing did comparatively little damage to the rioters concerned, declared:—

"I have heard it indeed alleged by courtiers in excuse, that all the military execution of that day was solely aimed at Mr. Wilkes, who they hoped would be despatched by some lucky shot, as Herod expected our Saviour would be murdered among the innocents he murdered at Bethlehem. As a proof of this extenuation of the crime, they show flatted balls, which were discharged by heroes planted in proper places for the purpose, and which have left marks in the walls about the windows of Mr. Wilkes's apartments in the King's Bench." "If this has any foundation in truth," writes "Philopolis," "I would advise the city to be cautious, and never allow above a dozen of its inhabitants to be seen together at one time, for fear the Riot Act should arrive unexpectedly, with two or three brigades of musqueteers, headed by a trading justice, who may think nothing of the citizens' lives, provided he has any hopes of murdering Beckford and the two sheriffs through their sides."

The petition presented by the lord mayor with such difficulty, and after many insolent subterfuges and repulses, failed to bring the king to a reasonable sense of his situation or of the dangers to which the throne was exposed by the reckless and unconstitutional conduct of the administration. Subsequently, on the presentation of a "remonstrance," the king returned a written reply to the original petition, visiting with severe censure the persevering claim of invaded birthrights, urged by "the afflicted citizens," and treating their just grievances with reprimand instead of redress; the pleas set forth in the petitions being considered by His Majesty "as disrespectful to himself, injurious to his parliament, and irreconcilable to the principles of the constitution"—a piece of bold duplicity more worthy of the Stuart dynasty.

The vexed question of Middlesex election, the imprisonment of Wilkes, the unconstitutional admission of Luttrell into the House, and particularly the supineness of the King to the petitions and just remonstrances of his people, are embodied in a metrical form, as—

“A NEW SONG; BEING A POETICAL PETITION TO THE
KING.

“Good Sir, I crave pity, bad is my condition:
You’ve sworn to relieve me, as I understand;
To tell you the whole, pray read this Petition;
My name you know is Old England:
Tho’ you’ve receiv’d many, and not answer’d any,
I hope Old England’s will not be forgot,
For if you deny me, the land will despise ye—
’Twas King Charles the First by the axe went to pot.
My right arm is wounded, and Middlesex county
I always esteem’d the bloom of my plumb.
And murd’ers have got a pardon and bounty,
From this precious arm they have torn a thumb;
For Wilkes is took from me, such wrongs have they done me,
They’ve alter’d records unto their disgrace;
’Tis thus that they’ve done, and a bastard son,
While my darling’s in prison, now sits in his place.
My head is wounded, if such a thing can be,
My troubles are such that I can take no rest;
Two sons are ta’en from me, Great Camden and Granby,
And to the world they have left me distress:
For Granby’s a soldier, none better or bolder,
And Camden’s a lawyer in justice well known,
In law had such power, took Wilkes from the Tower,
These, these are the children I ne’er will disown.
So read my Petition, good Sir; ’tis not tattle,
But matter of consequence, you’ll understand;
And answer me not, Sir, about horned cattle,
Pray what’s a few beasts, to the peace of the land?
The land has been injur’d, our rights they’ve infringed,
And loud for redress it behoves us to call,
For should we let trespass, like an indolent ass,
With Middlesex then all our rights they must fall.
Our land it is ruled by rogues, roughs, and bullies,
In the nation’s confusion they go hand in hand,
Sharps, gamblers, profuse and extravagant cullies,
A very odd set for to govern the land:
Here’s Rute we hear diving his mistress for him crying

Here's Kate, we hear, crying, his mistress for him crying,
Her son he has learnt the same fiddle to play;
For he touches the string, in disgrace to the king,
But his mother has taught him—why what?—shall we say?"

In the March of the year following, after awaiting a response for nearly twelve months, the Livery of the city resolved to draw up a further and more stringent remonstrance; and a meeting was held under the Right Hon. William Beckford, elected lord mayor for the second time, in the interval. In his address "to the Supreme Court of the whole City," the real dangers which menaced the State were by Beckford traced to their true source, "the comprehensive violation of the *right of election*"—

"to preserve which right, the Crown had been justly taken from James the Second, and been placed by the people of England on the head of William the Third, and conferred on His Majesty's family. That the corruption of the people's representatives was the cause and foundation of all our grievances. That we have now only the name of a parliament, without the substance."

He observed how improper it was for *placemen* and *pensioners* to sit in the House of Commons; "for if a man was not fit to be a Juryman, or a Judge in a cause where he was interested, how much less to be a Senator and justify his speculation." "*He complained of the unequal and inadequate representation of the people, by means of the little, rotten, paltry boroughs.*" In the remonstrance drawn up on this occasion, the wrongs of the people were again eloquently urged, and it was especially pointed out that the House of Commons, by the venal majority—

"had deprived the people of their dearest rights. They have done a deed more ruinous in its consequence than the levying of ship-money by Charles the First, or the dispensing power assumed by James the Second. A deed which must vitiate all the future proceedings of this parliament; for the acts of the legislature itself can no more be valid without a legal House of Commons than without a legal prince upon the throne.

“Representatives of the people are essential to the making of laws, and there is a time when it is morally demonstrable that men cease to be representatives. That time is now arrived. The present House of Commons do not represent the people. We owe to your Majesty an obedience under the restriction of the laws, for the calling and duration of Parliaments; and your Majesty owes to us, that our representation, free from the force of arms or corruption, should be preserved to us in them.

“The forms of the Constitution, like those of Religion, were not established for form’s sake, but for the substance. And we call God and man to witness that we do not owe our Liberty to those nice and subtle distinctions, which *places*, and *pensions*, and *lucrative employments* have invented; so neither will we be cheated of it by them, but as it was gained by the stern virtue of our ancestors, by the virtue of their descendants it shall be preserved.

“Since, therefore, the misdeeds of your Majesty’s ministers in violating the freedom of Election, and depraving the noble constitution of Parliaments are notorious, as well as subversive of the fundamental Laws and Liberties of this Realm; and since your Majesty, both in honour and justice, is obliged inviolably to preserve them according to the Oath made to God and your subjects at your Coronation; we, your remonstrants, assure ourselves that your Majesty will restore the constitutional Government and quiet of your people, by DISSOLVING this Parliament, and removing those evil ministers FOR EVER from your councils.”

This manly and righteous remonstrance was presented after many pettifogging slights and indignities, vexations, and subterfuges on the part of the Court and Crown; and there were made various attempts to bring into discredit the authenticity of this document as the expression of the Court of Aldermen. The Corporation of the city, in sixty carriages, proceeded with the various officers to the palace of St. James’s, and were received by the king on his throne. The remonstrance was read; and, in reply, His Majesty

read an answer, drawn up in advance, condemning both the former petition and the present remonstrance in unmistakable terms, and ending with an assurance that “he had ever made the law of the land the rule of his conduct, esteeming it his chief glory to rule over a free people;” and then, descending into more palpable falsehoods, asserting, in the face of facts, with a power of dissimulation worthy of Charles II:—

“with this view I have always been careful, as well to execute faithfully the trust reposed in me, as to avoid even the appearance of invading any of those powers which the Constitution has placed in other hands.”

The king was evidently the puppet of more vicious minds, being blessed with but a feeble reasoning faculty of his own. After reading his equivocative answer, and as the lord mayor and the city representatives were withdrawing, the vacuity of his intellect made itself manifest—for it is asserted in contemporaneous accounts, “His Majesty instantly turned round to his courtiers, and *burst out laughing*. NERO FIDDLER WHILE ROME WAS BURNING.”

The reception accorded to these petitions being far from such as their gravity demanded, fresh agitations commenced in the metropolis and in the provinces, and, on March 30th, Horne Tooke delivered a remarkable address to the freeholders of the county of Middlesex, in which he graphically described both the murders he had seen committed and the conduct of the justices of the peace, who said the ministerial instructions were for the soldiers to fire, and referred to the partiality shown on the trials and the defences made at the expense of Government when it was endeavoured to bring the guilty to justice. At this meeting, “An Address, Remonstrance, and Petition of the Freeholders of Middlesex” was drawn up for presentation, in which it was urged on the king—

“that a secret and malignant influence had thwarted and defeated almost every measure which had been attempted for the benefit of his subjects, and had given rise to measures totally subversive of the Liberties and Constitution of these once flourishing and happy kingdoms.”

“It is not for any light or common grievances that we presume thus repeatedly to interrupt your Majesty’s quiet with our complaints. It is not the illegal oppression of an individual; it is not the partial invasion of our property; it is not the violation of any single law of which we complain, but it is a violation which at one stroke deprives us of the only constitutional security of our Fortunes, Liberties, and Lives.

“Your Majesty’s servants have attacked our Liberties in the most vital part; they have torn away the heart-strings of the Constitution, and have made those men our destruction, whom the laws have appointed as the immediate guardians of our Rights and Liberties.

“The House of Commons, by their determination at the last election for this county, have assumed a power to overrule at pleasure the fundamental *Right of Election*, which the Constitution has placed in other hands, those of their Constituents, and from whence alone their whole authority is derived; a power by which the law of the land is at once overturned and resolved into the will and pleasure of a majority of one House of Parliament. And if this pretended power is exercised to the full extent of the principles, that House can no longer be a Representative of the people, but a separate body, altogether independent of them, self-existing, and self-elected.

“These proceedings have totally destroyed the confidence of your Majesty’s subjects in one essential branch of the legislative power, and if that branch is chosen in a manner not agreeable to the laws and constitution of the kingdom, the authority of Parliament itself must suffer extremely, if not totally perish.”

The remonstrance from which the above paragraphs are extracted was, together with a petition from the county of Kent, presented to His Majesty at St. James’s; both being received and handed to the lord of the bedchamber in waiting; *but no answer was returned*.

The electors of the city of Westminster also drew up a similar “Address, Remonstrance, and Petition”—

“their former application to the throne having been ineffectual, and new and exorbitant grievances being beyond patient endurance. By the same secret and unhappy influence to which all our grievances have been originally owing, the redress of those grievances has been now prevented; and the grievances themselves have been repeatedly confirmed; with this additional circumstance of aggravation, that while the invaders of our rights remain the directors of your Majesty’s councils, the defenders of those rights have been dismissed from your Majesty’s service—your Majesty having been advised by your ministers to remove from his employment, for his vote in Parliament, the highest officer of the Law (Lord Camden), because his principles suited ill with theirs, and his pure distribution of justice with their corrupt administration of the House of Commons.

“We beg leave, therefore, again to represent to your Majesty that the House of Commons have struck at the most valuable liberties and franchises of all the electors of Great Britain; and by assuming to themselves a right of choosing, instead of receiving a member when chosen, and by transferring to the representative what belonged to the constituent, they have taken off from the dignity, and, we fear, impaired the authority of Parliament itself.

“We presume again, therefore, humbly to implore from your Majesty the only remedies which are in any way proportioned to the nature of the evil; that you would be graciously pleased to dismiss *for ever* from your councils those ministers who are ill-suited by their dispositions to preserve the principles of a free, or by their capacities to direct the councils of a great and mighty kingdom; And that by speedily dissolving the present Parliament, your Majesty will show by your own example, and by their dissolution, the rights of your people are to be inviolable, and that you will never necessitate so many injured, and, by such treatment, exasperated subjects, to continue the care of their interests to those from whom they must withdraw their confidence; to repose their invaluable privileges in the hand of those who have sacrificed them; and their trust in those who have betrayed it.

“We find ourselves compelled to urge, with the greatest importunity, this our humble but earnest application, as every day seems to produce the confirmation of some old, or to threaten the introduction of some new injury. We have the strongest reason to apprehend that the usurpation begun by the House of Commons upon the right of electing, may be extended to the right of petitioning, and that under the pretence of restraining the abuse of this right, it is meant to bring into disrepute, and to intimidate us from the exercise of the right itself.”

The representatives elected by the people had done their utmost, as respected the venal majority, to betray their trust and those who had sent them to the Commons. Resistance was countenanced, and, by counter-addresses to the throne, the king was prejudiced against listening to the wishes of the people. This remonstrance elicited his Majesty’s reply “*that he would lay it before his Parliament;*” a curious conclusion, inasmuch as his afflicted subjects specially prayed therein that the king would be their safeguard against the majority in that body, who had betrayed the nation, and to the deliberation of that corrupted assembly the complaint—which affected the duration of the House—was to be submitted for redress! The remonstrance, which resembled an impeachment of the administration, was, in fact, handed to the ministers under accusation, to be by them resisted, prosecuted, or rendered ineffective at their discretion. The indignant judgments enunciated by “Junius” against these unprincipled politicians, foes to the kingdom, have been abundantly confirmed by the verdict of posterity.

The reception otherwise accorded to the Westminster remonstrance was altogether undignified. When the deputation, headed by Sir Robert Bernard, who had been returned member for that city by the unanimous suffrage of the constituency, arrived at the palace gate, an extra guard of soldiers was immediately turned out, not, however, as a compliment, for—

“although there was not the least appearance of anything disorderly, yet the soldiers behaved in a most insolent manner, and struck many

persons with their bayonets, and that without provocation. The Gentlemen having alighted from their carriages, amidst the acclamations of the people, walked through the lane of soldiers, and went upstairs to the Levee Room door, where they were met by one of the Grooms of the Bedchamber, who asked Sir Robert Bernard if he had anything to present to his Majesty? To which Sir Robert replied, 'Yes, the Address, Remonstrance, and Petition of the City of Westminster.' Upon which the Groom of the Bedchamber said, 'He would go and acquaint the Lord-in-Waiting.' He went immediately, but not returning soon, Sir Robert Bernard proposed to go into the Levee Room, which he did. On opening the door, the same Groom of the Bedchamber said he could not find the Lord-in-Waiting; but should soon. However, the Gentlemen went on, and after some time the Lord-in-Waiting came to them, and said, if they had anything to deliver to his Majesty, he would receive it in the next room, whither they accordingly went; and after some time, his Majesty coming into the room, Sir Robert presented the Remonstrance open. His Majesty delivered it to the Lord-in-Waiting, who delivered it to another, who handed it to the Groom of the Bedchamber, and he carried it off."

The recreant majority of the Commons, still at the bidding of degraded ministers, continued to address the king with counter-petitions intended to bring into disrepute the remonstrances of the people—those very constituents who had chosen them as the defenders of their liberties.

Finally, another effort was made by the city, and a general assembly was held for that purpose, when the chief magistrate, the Court of Aldermen, and Common Council resolved to renew their petition, and further to consider the king's "answer."

"A motion was then made, that the thanks of this Court be given to Lord Chatham for his late conduct in Parliament, and for his zeal shown for the most sacred Rights of Election and of petitioning, and for the promise of his endeavours to support an independent and more equal representation."

On a motion denouncing the most unbecoming treatment which the city of London had of late experienced from his Majesty's ministers, it was

suggested to draw up the strongest remonstrance possible on the violated right of election. Upon which, Alderman Wilkes, remarking upon the peculiar delicacy of his situation, said—

“that he would not mention a syllable about the person excluded; but if the House of Commons could seat any gentlemen among them who was not chosen by the people, the constitution was torn up by the roots, and the people had lost their share in the legislative power; that the disabling any person from sitting in Parliament, who was not disqualified by law, was an injury to every County, City, and Borough, and a dissolution of the form of government established by law in this Kingdom.”

The recorder cavilled at certain spirited expressions in the drawing-up of the remonstrance, particularly respecting the king’s answer, which he declared could not be considered an act of the ministers, but must be held to be the king’s personally. The committee was shocked at the recorder’s bringing home to the king one of the most unconstitutional acts of his ministry, and without one dissentient voice determined to overrule the objection of the recorder, whereon this functionary protested against the remonstrance in strong terms as a LIBEL. Alderman Wilkes then rose and mentioned his unwillingness to speak again, but he was forced to it by the recorder’s declaration that the remonstrance was a libel; that he too claimed to know something of the nature of a libel; that he did not speak from theory only, but had bought much experience on that subject; that the remonstrance was founded throughout on known and glaring facts, every word bearing the stamp of truth; that the particular act complained of in the violated right of election was a malicious and wilful act of the majority in the House of Commons, for the minister had declared, that “if any person had only four votes for Middlesex, he should be the sitting member for the county!” The lord mayor, Beckford, confirmed Wilkes’s assertion, concluding, “I was then present in the House of Commons.”

The remonstrance was accordingly presented; in it astonishment was expressed at the censure lately passed by the throne upon the faithful and afflicted citizens, laying their complaints and injuries at the feet of their

Sovereign, as the father of his people, able and willing to redress their grievances.

The concluding paragraph was very much to the purpose, and displayed no diminution of firmness:—

“Your Majesty cannot disapprove that we here assert the clearest principles of the constitution against the insidious attempts of evil counsellors to perplex, confound, and shake them. We are determined to abide by those rights and liberties, which our forefathers bravely vindicated, at the ever-memorable Revolution, and which their sons will ever resolutely defend. We therefore now renew, at the foot of the throne, our claim to the indispensable right of the subject—a full, free, and unmutated Parliament, legally chosen in all its members; a right which this House of Parliament have manifestly violated, depriving, at their will and pleasure, the county of Middlesex of one of its legal representatives, and arbitrarily nominating, as a Knight of the Shire, a person not elected by a majority of the freeholders. As the only constitutional means of reparation now left for the injured electors of Great Britain, we implore, with most urgent supplications, the dissolution of the present parliament, the removal of evil ministers, and the total extinction of that fatal influence which has caused such national discontent.

“In the meantime, Sire, we offer our constant prayers to Heaven, that your Majesty may reign, as Kings only can reign, in and by the hearts of a loyal, dutiful, and free people.”

To this remonstrance the king’s answer was:—

“I should have been wanting to the public as well as to myself, if I had not expressed my dissatisfaction at the late Address. My sentiments on that subject continue the same; and I should ill deserve to be considered as the father of my people, if I could suffer myself to be prevailed upon to make such an use of my prerogative as I cannot but think inconsistent with the interest and dangerous to the constitution of the kingdom.”

After His Majesty had been pleased to make the foregoing answer, the lord mayor requested leave to reply, which, being granted, Beckford made the dignified and noble response which is a matter of history:—

 (“If worth allures thee, think how Beckford shone
 Who dar’d to utter Truths before the throne.”)

“Most Gracious Sovereign—Will your Majesty be pleased so far to condescend as to permit the Mayor of your loyal City of London to declare in your Royal presence, on behalf of his fellow-citizens, how much the bare apprehension of your Majesty’s displeasure would at all times affect their minds. The declaration of that displeasure has already filled them with inexpressible anxiety, and with the deepest affliction.

“Permit me, Sire, to assure your Majesty that your Majesty has not in all your dominions any subjects more faithful, more dutiful, or more affectionate to your Majesty’s person and family, or more ready to sacrifice their lives and fortunes in the maintenance of the true honour and dignity of your Crown.

“We do, therefore, with the greatest humility and submission, most earnestly supplicate your Majesty, that you will not dismiss us from your presence without expressing a more favourable opinion of your faithful citizens, and without some comfort, without some prospect at least of redress.

“Permit me, Sire, further to observe, that whoever has already dared, or shall hereafter endeavour by false insinuations and suggestions, to alienate your Majesty’s affections from your loyal subjects in general and from the city of London in particular, and to withdraw your confidence in and regard for your people, is an enemy to your Majesty’s person and family, a violator of the public peace, and a betrayer of our happy Constitution, as it was established at the glorious revolution of 1688.”

At the conclusion of these expressions of enlightenment for the royal mind, the lord mayor waited more than a minute for a reply of “some more favourable opinion,” but none was given.

“On this occasion,” says the satirist, “Nero did *not* fiddle while Rome was burning.” The humility and serious firmness with which the dignified Beckford—who enjoyed the friendship of the great Earl of Chatham, and with whom he had many points in common—uttered these words, “filled the whole Court with admiration and confusion;” for they found very different countenances amongst the citizens than they expected from Lord Pomfret’s description, who declared in the House of Lords—

“that, however swaggering and impudent the behaviour of the low citizens might be on their own dunghill, when they came into the royal presence, their heads hung down like bulrushes, and they blinked with their eyes like owls in the sunshine of the sun.”

On the 19th of May, the king prorogued that parliament which, by approving addresses from both Houses, had fortified the royal censure returned to the popular remonstrances. “The prevalence of animosities and of dissensions among their fellow-subjects” was specially alluded to in his Majesty’s speech, while the conduct of both branches of his legislature received in return such flattering encomiums as their servile pliability had earned by despicable means:—

“The *temper* with which you have conducted all your proceedings has given me great satisfaction, and I promise myself the happiest effects from the firmness, as well as the moderation, which you have manifested in the very *critical* circumstances which have attended your late deliberations.”

However undignified the reception accorded at the time to these petitions addressed to the throne from its truest supporters, the good cause eventually triumphed, in defiance of the chicanery of counter-expressions of servility, fabricated at the instance of those whose prospects depended on the continuance in power of false politicians, despising alike the voice and interests of the people, and resting their reliance on the venality of their

adherents, and the base instinct of self-aggrandisement at the expense of the state existent in minds equally mercenary with their own.

“Eventually the citizens succeeded, in spite of the united efforts of the Court, the Ministers, and the Parliament; and their cause has since been solemnly and universally recognized as that of the Constitution and of liberty. It is impossible to appreciate too highly the national importance of the conduct they pursued.”

It was well said by “Junius,” the integrity of whose sentiments bears more than a casual resemblance to the utterances of that patriotic statesman, Lord Chatham, with whose fame the authorship of Junius’s “Letters” may one day be identified:—

“The noble spirit of the metropolis is the life-blood of the state, collected at the heart; from that point it circulates with health and vigour through every artery of the Constitution.”

The great Chatham and his friend, William Beckford, stand out conspicuous from their fellow-men in association with that corrupt time when statescraft was for the most part a question of ability for debasing the largest number on the easiest terms contrivable; they lived at a time when liberty ran especial risks, and, as champions of popular rights, proved worthy of those emergencies with which they were confronted. In days when the chief magistrate of the city may degenerate to a subservient courtier, the history of Beckford’s firm attitude may be regarded as no longer the worthiest part of the civic traditions. That his fellow-citizens appreciated his exertions is shown by the thanks he received for his able and dignified speech to the king; his reply was ordered to be inserted in the city records, and afterwards, at his death, was inscribed on the monument erected in the Guildhall to his memory.

The blow struck at a corrupt administration by the Westminster and other remonstrances seems to have damped the ardour of the ministers; in any case, no Court candidate was put forward for Westminster in 1770, and consequently the election of a liberal candidate was unopposed.

On the 30th of April, at noon, came on at St. Paul's, Covent Garden, the election of a representative in parliament for the City and Liberty of Westminster, in the room of the Hon. Edwin Sandys, created Lord Sandys. A considerable number of the electors assembled early in the morning at the "Standard Tavern" in Leicester Fields; and proceeded from thence with a band of music, etc., in procession through Piccadilly to the residence of Sir Robert Bernard, in Hamilton Street. When they came to Covent Garden, the whole square was full. Proclamation of silence being made, Sir John Hussey Delaval, Bart., addressing himself to the people, said—

“he rejoiced to see such a prodigious number of the Electors present, to support the nomination in Westminster Hall the previous Thursday; that Sir Robert Bernard had stood forward in support of the rights of the people in their just complaints against the late flagrant violation of their liberties; and concluded with observing, that they were come to confirm with their votes this their free and glorious choice.”

Lord Viscount Mountmorres seconded the motion in a spirited speech, in which he stated—

“the services and principles of Sir Robert Bernard; the grievances under which the people laboured; the great violation of their rights in the case of Middlesex; the impossibility that any king, that any parliament, that the courts of justice, or that all together, could annihilate the people's constitutional rights.”

These speeches were received with acclamation by the twenty thousand people present, amongst whom strict good order was preserved.

The proper proclamations being made, and no other candidate appearing, the return was signed by the gentlemen present on the hustings. The election being entirely over, the gentlemen retired into the vestry-room, where the indenture was signed by them, and finally returned to the Crown Office. On the day following, Sir Robert Bernard was introduced into the House of Commons by the Hon. Henry Grenville and William Pulteney, and took his seat as member for Westminster. The Westminster returns being generally looked upon with interest by other constituencies, this election was held out as a proper example to every city in the kingdom, and to all

the counties and towns, to choose their members with a spirit of freedom and without expense. It was resolved by the freeholders of Westminster, in advance—

“that if this election had been contested, it would not have cost Sir Robert Bernard a shilling, the electors being determined to support their free choice.”

This particular return is a case in point, which goes to prove that the authors of corruption in electioneering matters were more guilty than those they corrupted. At the Covent Garden hustings—where, on previous occasions, the ministers had spent enormous sums, besides moving every power and art of intrigue to get their own nominees returned—the entire proceedings were one long scene of bribery, trickery, and illegality, brute-force, and disorder. On the occasion in question, 1770, the administration seems to have been slightly cowed by the results of their ill-advised manœuvres to impose placemen upon the county: the recent Middlesex proceedings were still a source of concern; the constitution had been violated—not with impunity,—and serious effects in the way of impeachment were by no means impossible: consequently, the people being left to the legitimate exercise of their liberties, the election passed off in the pacific, well-ordered, and regular manner described, freedom did not degenerate into licence, “no one was a penny the worse,” and the representative system in its purity of action was for once maintained in Westminster.

CHAPTER IX.

REMARKABLE ELECTIONS AND CONTROVERTED ELECTION PETITIONS, 1768 TO 1784.

The feats of the Whartons, Walpoles, Marlboroughs, Pelhams, and Graftons, in the direction of lavishing large sums for the corruption of the electorate, were dwarfed into insignificance by the fortunes staked upon a single contest later on: thus the disbursements over a contested election at Lincoln would be twelve thousand per candidate; and, we are told, “occasionally, after a hard fight at such places as Colchester, all the defeated men appeared in the *Gazette*.” It is stated that the two great county contests for Hampshire, in 1790 and 1806, cost the ministerial candidates twenty-five thousand apiece on each occasion, while their opponent’s expenses were proportionately large. The contest, still remembered by Northampton worthies as the “Spendthrift Election,” in which three earls fought for the borough election in favour of their respective nominees in 1768, is a startling instance of the lengths to which electioneering Peers were tempted to proceed in “scot and lot times.” The opponents were the Earls of Halifax, Northampton, and Spencer, and the respective nominees they pitted against each other in this all but ruinous “tourney” were Sir George Osborne, Sir George Bridges Rodney, and the Hon. Thomas Howe. The candidates were of small account in the conflict; their patrons bore the brunt of the battle. The canvassing commenced long before the polling; this was extended over fourteen days—a phenomenal circumstance in the days when elections were often settled and returns made before ten o’clock on the morning of the polling day. According to the poll-book, the legitimate number of electors, some 930, was exceeded by 288, but confusion of persons is accounted for by the promiscuous hospitalities of three noble mansions being at the mercies of the crowd for weeks: at the famous historical seats of Horton, Castle Ashby, and Althorp, the orgies pictured in

Hogarth's "Election Dinner"—"filled with the tipsified humours" of what Bubb Dodington fitly called, "venal wretches"—were indefinitely prolonged. "The Scot and Lot,"—woolcombers, weavers, shoemakers, labourers, pedlars, militia-men, and victuallers held "high revel," prolonged without intercession from night till morning, and *vice versâ*, in the ancestral halls, of which, including the well-stocked wine-cellars, they were in a body "made free." Therein lodged the perdition of Horton; for, after they had drained dry the goodly stock of matured port, Lord Halifax had to place before them his choicest claret, whereon, with one accord, filled with vinous fastidiousness, the "rabble rout" deserted to a man, declaring, "they would never vote for a man who gave them sour port," and went over in a body to Castle Ashby. Each of the candidates claimed more votes than could be legally registered in his favour. Howe, the unsuccessful candidate, whose "potwallers" and "occasional voters" were likewise challenged, petitioned; and the "controverted election" came before the House of Commons. During the six weeks the scrutiny lasted, sixty covers were daily spread at Spencer House, St. James's, for those concerned in the case. The results were no less eccentric: the number of votes being finally found equal, the election was referred to chance, and decided by a toss, which Lord Spencer won, and nominated a man out in India. The cost of this escapade then had to be counted. It is said Lord Spencer expended one hundred thousand pounds; his antagonists are credited with having wasted one hundred and fifty thousand pounds each—an incredible sum, considering this represents at least double the equivalent amounts at the present day. Earl Spencer came off lightest, and appears to have been in no way involved; Lord Halifax was ruined; Lord Northampton cut down his trees, sold his furniture at Compton Winyates, went abroad for the rest of his days, and died in Switzerland. Canon James, who has related the story of the famous "Spendthrift Election" in his "History of Northamptonshire," mentions that at Castle Ashby is still preserved a sealed box, labelled "Election Papers," the evidence of this insane contest—one of no political moment; but none of the present generation has had the courage to open the dread receptacle of bygone folly.

A whimsical anecdote is related by Edgeworth, in his "Memoirs," respecting the contest for Andover at the general election in 1768, when Sir J. B. Griffin was returned at the head of the poll with seventeen votes; the

second member was B. Lethieulier, with fifteen votes; and the defeated candidate was Sir F. B. Delaval, who only polled seven. The latter was a celebrity, both in fashion and in the politics of his day, and the story which is connected with his electioneering experience properly belongs to the traditions of the subject. Sir Francis found himself at loggerheads with his attorney, an acute practitioner, whose bill had been running for years, and, though considerable sums of money had been paid “on account,” a prodigious balance was still claimed as unsettled; this Sir Francis disputed at law. When the case came before the Court of King’s Bench, amongst an exorbitant list of charges the following item excited general attention:—

“To being thrown out of the George Inn, Andover; to my legs being thereby broken; to surgeon’s bill, and loss of time and business; all in the service of Sir F. B. Delaval £500.”

It was found that this charge required explanation. It appeared that the attorney, by way of promoting the interests of his principal in the borough, had sought to propitiate the favour of those important potentates at electioneering times, the mayor and corporation, in whose hands, as seen in the foregoing, was vested so much of the local influence. A pretext was necessary to decoy these worthies to a banquet, where they might be conciliated, so the attorney sent cards of invitation to the mayor and corporation in the name of the colonel and officers of a regiment in the town; he at the same time invited the colonel and staff, in the name of the mayor and corporation, to dine and drink the king’s health on his birthday;—an ingenious *ruse*, but the arch-diplomatist had literally “reckoned without his host.” The two parties met, were cordially courteous, ate a good dinner, toasted his majesty’s health, and proceeded to other oratorical compliments before breaking up. Then came the acknowledgments: the commanding officer of the regiment made a handsome speech to Mr. Mayor, thanking him for his hospitable invitation and entertainment; “No, Colonel,” replied the mayor, “it is to you that thanks are due, by me and my brother-aldermen for your generous treat to us.” The colonel replied with as much warmth as good breeding would allow; the mayor retorted in downright anger, vowing that he would not be choused by the bravest colonel in His Majesty’s service. “Mr. Mayor,” said the colonel, “there is no

necessity for displaying any vulgar passion on this occasion; permit me to show you that I have here your obliging card of invitation.” “Nay, Mr. Colonel, here is no opportunity for bantering, there is your card.” The cards were produced simultaneously. Upon examining the invitations, it was observed that, notwithstanding an attempt to disguise the hand, both cards were written by some person who had designed to hoax them all. Every eye of the discomfited guests, corporation and officers alike, turned spontaneously upon the attorney, who had, of course, found it necessary to be present to flatter the aldermen; his impudence suddenly gave way, he faltered and betrayed himself so fully by his confusion, that, in a fit of summary justice, the colonel threw him out of window; for this, Sir F. B. Delaval was charged £500.

Among the parodies of election addresses issued at the time of the rival Shelburne and Rockingham parties, is a broadside “embellished” with a copperplate engraving of a whimsical assembly of citizens, met in solemn conclave to examine the political views of a deformed sweeper-lad, “a public character,” who, it appears, was nicknamed by his contemporaries “Sir Jeffery Dunstan.” The pointed satire is thus headed:—

“‘What can we reason but from what we know?’—POPE.

“SIR JEFFERY DUNSTAN’S ADDRESS TO THE WORTHY
ELECTORS OF THE ANCIENT BOROUGH OF GARRATT,

“NOW FIRST PUBLISHED BY R. RUSTED,—AUTHOR OF ‘THE
GUILDHALL ORATORS,’ ETC., ETC., ETC.

“‘A tous ceux à qu’il appartiendra.’—VOLTAIRE.” (Otherwise “to all whom it concerns.”)

The candidate’s address is one of those confused harangues in which a number of subjects are incongruously involved together, known in later days as “a stump oration.” Among other subjects, Dr. Graham’s “celestial beds,” recruiting for the army, polygamy, and divorce, “the delicate brave

men of the association” (volunteer force), and an “effete nobility,” are all mixed up according to the following sample:—

“As my honourable friend Mr. Burke cannot lessen the influence of the Crown, myself and his grace of Richmond are determined to accomplish it, by abolishing the use of money entirely; it being irrevocable poison to men’s souls, and the only remedy existing to prevent Bribery and Corruption; an evil which all the learned gentry of Westminster Hall could never annihilate; and I do faithfully declare, being no placeman, that I will not waste my fleeting moments like the four city members, whose elements of oratory what Roman senator could ever equal.”

The address rambles through a variety of absurdities, and concludes with a quotation from Rusted’s “Poems.” Whoever that worthy may have been, his lines have a fine air of burlesque grandiloquence, sense being subordinated to sound:—

“Like those brave men, who nobly shed their blood,
I’ll die a Martyr for my Country’s good.
Be to my Sov’ reign ever just and true,
And yield to Britain what is Britain’s due.
Maintain the cause, and thro’ the globe impart
The bright effusions of an honest heart.”

The foregoing is found in the collection of ballads and broadsides which it delighted Miss Banks to accumulate. It will be remembered that eccentric lady was sister to Sir Joseph Banks, the president of the Royal Society, and one most instrumental in founding the British Museum, to which his collections and those of his sister were left. Among Miss Banks’s “Political and Miscellaneous Broad sides” is another electoral appeal to the same fanciful constituency; the document otherwise seems almost a literal copy of an actual address of the day:—

“TO THE NOBILITY, GENTRY, CLERGY, AND FREEMEN OF THE ANCIENT CORPORATIVE TOWN OF GARRATT.

“MY LORDS AND GENTLEMEN,

“Your Vote, Interest, and Poll (if needful) is earnestly desired for Thomas, Lord SHINER, to be your representative in Parliament, being a person zealously attached to the King and Queen, and their numerous offspring of Princes and princesses, and an enemy to all arbitrary Laws.

“His Lordship’s Committee for conducting the Election is held at the ‘Three Jolly Butchers,’ and ‘Black Moor’s Head,’ Brook’s Market, at which places his Lordship begs the audience of his Friends.

“N.B.—His Lordship’s colours are Blue and Orange.

“✱✱ Carriages will be ready on the Day of Election.”

Those corrupted electors of Shoreham who resolved themselves into a purchasable community on their own account, were roughly handled by the parliamentary inquisitors, but the avowed and professional traffickers in venal boroughs seemed to conduct their trade openly, and, with the great parliamentary lights, unadmonished and unexposed. They were generally the agents of those who had secured the influence in the seats by various methods—some by inheritance, others by patronage, sometimes by purchase *en bloc*, but generally *en détail*. Men invested in boroughs and cultivated them for sale, secure of a profitable mart when the proper season arrived; the burgage-houses were bought and accumulated; “shambles on old foundations” carrying voting qualifications were secured; burgage tenures were bought up; voters were pensioned from year to year, the process varying according to the nature of the suffrage. As in the case of Sheridan’s expenses at Stafford, the independent electors were retained at a settled price per head. Sheridan’s cost him five guineas per burgess; Wilberforce found four guineas the price at Hull for a plumper. Southey says it rose to £30 a vote at Ilchester, Somerset, where the burgesses had a direct control over their borough; although the tariff ran high, the four

candidates who recklessly bribed the constituents in 1774 lost their pains and money, petitions and counter-petitions establishing that the members returned and those who alleged they were unjustly rejected were alike so palpably culpable of corruption that the election was declared void. In 1826, Ilchester is given in the “Manual” as under the patronage of Sir W. Manners. Irrespective of the local and lesser bargains made with the mayors and burgesses, there was the “big business” conducted on behalf of the actual individual landholders of the place—those magnates set down in the election lists of constituencies as “patrons” of boroughs, the dispensers of seats.

For an instance of the facility which characterized the *modus operandi*, though “the prices ruled high” owing to extraneous demands, see the “Letters” of that skilled courtier, Lord Chesterfield, deeply versed in political chicanery and combination. In a passage of a letter dated Bath, December 19, 1767, he writes to that hopeful youth who by “Chesterfield’s Letters” was to be polished into a fine gentleman, and for whom a place in Parliament was a desirable opening—

“In one of our conversations here this time twelvemonth I desired my Lord Chatham to secure you a seat in the new parliament. He assured me he would, and, I am convinced, very sincerely.... Since that I have heard no more of it, which made me look out for some venal borough; and I spoke to a borough-jobber, and offered five and twenty hundred pounds for a secure seat in parliament; but he laughed at my offer, and said that there was no such thing as a borough to be had now, for the rich East and West Indians had secured them all, at the rate of three thousand pounds at least, but many at four thousand, *and two or three that he knew at five thousand*. This, I confess, has vexed me a good deal.”

Much has been said about “Old Sarum” (Wilts) as being typical of the unabashed and confirmed borough-mongering and corruption which existed not only in the last century, but, in fact, until the larger measure of Reform carried in 1832. Representative government, conducted on the principles which prevailed in “hole-and-corner boroughs” until the passing of that bill against which even Sir Robert Peel protested as a dangerous innovation,

certainly, for the most part, had but a theoretic existence, as a review of the facts sufficiently demonstrates. Amongst the statistics given in Stockdale's "Parliamentary Guide" (1784), Dr. Willis writes that the borough of Old Sarum was then reduced to *one house*. It returned members in 23 Edw. 1, and then intermitted until 34 Edw. 3, since which time representatives were returned until its disfranchisement. These were at first elected in the county-court, as was then customary; from 1688, the right of election was in "the freeholders being burgage-holders" and the number was *seven*. In 1826, when the last parliament of George IV.'s reign assembled, this state of things was unaltered, the patron was the Earl of Caledon, and the mysterious seven remained. New Sarum, otherwise Salisbury, which had taken the place of "Old Sarum," received its privileges by letters patent, 2 Hen. 3, which conferred on the bishops and canons *tanquam proprium dominicum*; afterwards confirmed by charter 34 Edw. 1. In 1784, there were about fifty-six voters; the right of election being "in the select number, that is, the mayor and corporation." The Earl of Radnor and G. P. Jervoise were the patrons in 1826, when Viscount Folkestone and Wadham Wyndham were returned by the fifty-four electors then set down as the suffrage-holders.

Boroughbridge, Yorkshire, was another scandalous and typical "pocket-borough" which obtained notoriety, especially at the time of the passing of Lord Grey's Reform Bill, Sir Charles Wetherell being turned into satiric capital by Doyle (HB), in his versions of the "Last of the Boroughbridges." The right of election was in the burgage-holders—a "pocket-borough" tenure, thus denounced by Charles James Fox: "If a man comes into parliament as the proprietor of a burgage tenure, he does not come there as the representative of the people," as explained in the eloquent speech of the great Whig chief, on Grey's motion for Reform, 1797. The Duke of Newcastle was the patron, and sixty burgage-holders returned two members. The constituency of Helston, where the franchise was originally invested in a corporation, under the Old Charter, had in 1790 dwindled down to one elector, to whose lot it fell to nominate two representatives.

The case of a "controverted election" at Hindon, Wilts, where the right of election was of an easy order, viz. "inhabitants of houses within the borough, being housekeepers and parishioners, not securing alms," raised

an altogether pretty scandal in the way of revelations on corrupt treating. The sitting members, returned in 1774, being Richard Smith and T. Brand Hollis, the unsuccessful candidates, James Calthorpe and Richard Beckford, were the petitioners on the ground that the former, by the bribery of themselves and their agents, had procured an illegal return. On the hearing of the petition it was discovered that all or the major part of the voters for all four candidates had been bribed, and the committee pronounced the election void. The candidates themselves had not only bribed, but thirteen electors, acting as agents, had also been employed to corrupt their fellow-voters. The committee resolved to disfranchise these electors:—

“A bill was then ordered to incapacitate from voting at elections of members of parliament 190 persons, besides the thirteen above-mentioned, out of 210 who had polled at the election.”

These persons appealed against the bill, and there being technical objections to the petitioners “being parties to and alike defendants in an indictment,” it was argued they “could not, without overturning the known rules of law and justice, be received as witnesses in this case.” By a tacit agreement the unfortunate cross-petitions were dropped the ensuing session, and two new writs were issued; meanwhile the attorney-general, on separate informations, proceeded against the four candidates (June, 1775) for bribery at elections, held to be a crime at common law independent of any statute against it. All the four informations were tried at the Lent assizes in the county of Wilts, March, 1775, before Baron Hotham. The two petitioners who were in the first instance responsible for this scrutiny were acquitted; Smith and Hollis, who had been returned, were found guilty, and were brought up to the Court of King’s Bench to receive judgment: this was on the 20th of May, the last day of the term, and the judges desiring time to consider the proper punishment, they were committed till the next term to the King’s Bench prison. Meanwhile, previous to this commitment, the new election for Hindon had taken place (May 16th), and Mr. Richard Smith was again returned. On the 7th of June, Smith and Hollis were again brought up for judgment, when they were each fined 1000 marks⁵⁷ and sentenced to prison for six months, and until they paid their respective fines; and it was ordered that Richard Smith should give security for his

good behaviour for three years, himself in the sum of £1000, and two sureties each of £500.

A flagrant instance of boroughmongering was exposed during a parliamentary investigation into a case of controverted election at Milborne Port, Somerset, where the right of voting was, amongst others, in the capital bailiffs and their two deputies. The petition proposed to disqualify eleven votes upon the score of “occasionality,” and to object to eleven who voted for the sitting members and were disabled by a corrupt bargain made between Mr. Medlycott, the senior member, and Loyd, an agent of Lord North’s. There were nine bailiwicks in the borough, with a bailiff appointed for each. Mr. Medlycott had long been in possession of four of these, and the remaining five belonged to the family of Walters. A remarkable example of downright trading appeared as the case developed. In February, 1770, Loyd arrived at Milborne Port as the friend of Lord North. A meeting was held at Yeovil between the agent and the patron, two or three others being present, at the house of one Daniel; where a contract was duly drawn up, signed, and witnessed, by which Medlycott agreed to sell the borough, and to throw out his old friend, the Hon. Temple Luttrell, who was one of the persons presenting the petition, which revealed the underground workings of administrative jobbery. The writing drawn up at Yeovil purported to be the “memorandum of an agreement to defray the expenses of procuring a seat in parliament for any friend of Lord North, whom his lordship or Loyd should recommend.” To this end Loyd agreed to deposit fifteen hundred pounds in Daniel’s hands, to be employed in purchasing the family interest of the Walters in the remaining five bailiwicks for the use and at the risk of Medlycott, who stipulated to pay Loyd five per cent. for the money so advanced, until such time as Lord North’s friend should be seated peaceably fourteen days in parliament—the time allowed for petitioning. The paper was put into Lord North’s hands, who returned it to Daniel, without committing himself to any observation. On the faith of this instrument—

“The Walters’ property in the voters was transferred; the five bailiffs were nominated, and consigned to Medlycott’s interest, thus purchased by Loyd. But the patron of the borough, on assuming the undivided influence therein, in the spirit of friendship wrote to his colleague

Luttrell on the subject, acknowledged this foul transaction, and urged the wretched excuse *that his poverty, and not his will, consented.*”

The counsel for the petitioners further said they would give evidence of the bribery, and several offers made, also of the *treats* given to influence the voters. The ministerial influence seems to have been paramount on this occasion; as the committee determined, in the face of the absolute documentary evidence, and other proofs of bribery, treating, illegal voting, and refusal to register legitimate votes on behalf of the petitioners, that the gentleman who had sold the seat in the borough to Lord North was—with the second ministerial nominee, brought in by his venality—duly elected. This borough of Milborne Port seems to have been a snug haven for nominees: in 1826 the patronage was at the joint disposal of the Marquis of Anglesea and Sir W. Coles Medlycott, and returned the Hon. Berkeley Paget and Lord Graves—proving the utility of “a stake in the country.” The warming-pan constituency was swept away, with similar anomalies, by the Reform Bill carried by Lord Grey.

In the general election of 1774 the contest for Westminster was marked by the unblushing exertion of much undue influence. Not only did two ducal houses bring all the weight of their purses and ministerial influence, adding to almost limitless resources such strong inducements as the Duke of Northumberland, with his metropolitan patronage, and the Duke of Newcastle, with his placemen, pensions, and ministerial patronage, could bring to bear for the return of younger scions of the two houses concerned; the royal authority was freely used, and the king’s servants, without, it was shown, any qualifications as voters, were allowed to record their voices for the return of the Court candidates. The famous election of 1784, although stronger in incident, must have been tame by comparison. Not only members of the royal household, but divers peers of the realm and lords of parliament publicly canvassed, and otherwise unduly interfered in the election, contrary to several express resolutions of the House. The candidates stood thus at the close of the poll:—Earl Percy, 4995; Lord Thomas Pelham Clinton, 4744; Lord Mountmorres, 2531; Charles Stanhope, Lord Mahon, 2342; and Humphrey Cotes, 130. A petition was presented by Lord Mountmorres and several electors of the city and liberty

of Westminster against the return of Earl Percy and Lord T. P. Clinton, seeing that—

“the king’s menial servants, not having proper houses of their own within the city of Westminster, gave voices in the said election, contrary to an express resolution of the House; that peers and lords unduly interfered and tampered with the voters; that during the election, after the *teste* and issuing out of the writ, Lord Percy and Lord Thomas Pelham Clinton, by themselves or agents, were guilty of bribing, corrupting, and entertaining the voters, (who must have made a fairly good thing of the contest); and that they allowed to the electors, and several persons who had or claimed a right to vote, money, meat, drink, entertainment, or provision; and that by those, and other undue means, a majority of votes was procured for Lord Percy and Lord T. P. Clinton, so that they were returned, and the petitioners prayed such relief as upon examination should appear just.”

As bribery commissions were then constituted, the party in power generally managed to make disputed returns a means of strengthening their own majority, so that although the House took the pains to examine the several allegations, it was decided that the sitting members were duly elected.

On the respective counts it was found that there was no general determination as to the right of election in Westminster, but it seemed agreed that the suffrages were vested “in the inhabitants, householders, paying scot and lot;” that the king’s menial servants, not having proper houses of their own within the city of Westminster, were not entitled to vote—as they had done, on the pretence of being residents in the royal palaces of St. James and elsewhere. It was admitted that the following resolution, providing against the interposition of peers in elections for the Commons, had been renewed on the opening of the House, from session to session, since the Act was made, January 3, 1701:—

“Resolved that it is a high infringement of the liberties and privileges of the Commons of Great Britain for any lord of parliament or any lord-lieutenant of any county to concern themselves in the elections of members to serve for the Commons in parliament.”

The petitioners set forth that it would appear, by different allegations, that the rights of the election had been invaded in a manner highly alarming, so as to call for the interposition and censure of the House; but the report of the committee disposed of these objections by finding the petitioners were not able to prove any direct solicitation of the peers.

A similar objection was raised on the same general election as to the legal return of the sitting members for Worcester,—that a peer and lord of parliament had, by himself and his agents, interfered in the election by publicly canvassing and soliciting votes, and by using threats to intimidate freemen from voting for the petitioner, in violation of the privileges of the House and the freedom of election, and to the infringement of the rights of the Commons of Great Britain. Moreover, there was an allegation of bribery, and that conducted on a wholesale scale. The mayor, aldermen, and justices of the city, the town-clerk and many of the common council had sworn in, for several days before and during the election, many freemen (some hundreds) to be constables, under a promise that they would vote for the candidates chosen by the persons so influencing them, “for which they were to have certain rewards in money;” and that this money was afterwards paid to them out of the funds of the city, or by the two sitting members.

In transparent cases of bribery, when the committee of the “whole House” serving on these “controverted elections” decided to retain and confirm the sitting members, there seems to have been a convenient formula much resorted to in silencing those petitions brought on the grounds of corruption; for instance, after the general elections of 1774,—

“An objection was taken to the petitioners examining any witness as to the payment, till they should first bring proof of the agency. It was argued that the circumstances which would establish both points were so complicated that they could not be separated;”

ergo, all evidence on the points to be proved was technically excluded, and the petition was stultified.

It seems, also, to have been not unusual for high sheriffs to return themselves; for instance, in the controverted election case for Abingdon,

Berks, March, 1774-5. The petitioner set forth that the member returned was then high sheriff for the county of Berks; his counsel arguing, “that by an express clause in the writ of election the choice of sheriffs is prohibited; and that this clause has made part of the writ for three centuries.” It was admitted that Sir Edward Coke, sheriff of Buckinghamshire, had been returned for Norfolk in the second year of Charles I., and that he sat till the dissolution of that parliament; but his right was questioned, and in the “Journals and Debates” he is invariably described as a member *de facto*. It was contended in reply, on the other side, that the sheriff was justified in his return, the wording of the writ not being taken literally, in any case such as “knights girt with a sword;” that Mr. Child, being sheriff of Warwickshire, was chosen and returned for Wells, in the county of Somerset; he was petitioned against, but was declared duly elected. It was also stated, on behalf of the controverted sitting member, that—

“since the statute of the 23rd Henry VI., the sheriff is in no respect the returning officer for boroughs; he is obliged to accept the return sent him, with his precept, and is merely the conduit-pipe to convey it to the clerk of the crown.”

The counsel for the member whose return was impeached further observed that if sheriffs could not be chosen members of parliament, the Crown would be able to prevent any one from being elected, by taking care to make him a sheriff before the election; by which means, in bad times, every friend to the rights of the people might be excluded from sitting in the House of Commons. On this occasion, as the high sheriff had returned himself, that is to say, for his own county, it was thought proper to decide that the election was void; thus, at the same time, disqualifying the petitioner as well, which, was seemingly unreasonable.

There were two petitions presented in reference to the controverted election at Morpeth, Northumberland, in 1774. On this occasion it was violence and intimidation more than corrupt and illegal practices—though all had been resorted to—which had unjustly influenced the return. The candidates were the Hon. William Byron, Francis Eyre, T. C. Bigge, and Peter Delme.

“It was proved by a number of witnesses, that, at the end of the Poll, the majority was declared to be in favour of Delme and Byron (a counter-petition set forth that a majority had been obtained for Delme by the corrupt practices of Byron), but that the returning officers were *compelled* to return Delme and Eyre: and it was also proved that, on the morning of the election, before it began, Eyre made an inflammatory speech to the people; that after the riot began, he having retired some time before, the returning officers sent him word they would return whom he pleased, and that an answer being brought them, that they must return himself and Mr. Delme, they complied, and the riot ceased.”

The decision of the committee was that the gentleman who, as master of the mob, had directed the storm, was *not* duly elected, while the Hon. W. Byron, who had found his way to the suffrages of the voters through their pockets, must be returned, together with his nominee, Delme, already seated.

At Petersfield, Hants, in 1774, the Hon. John Luttrell was unfortunate, and brought a petition against the two members returned, Sir Abraham Hume and William Jolliffe, the former being high sheriff for the county of Hertford, and both—

“having been guilty of divers acts of bribery, by money, meat, drink, reward, entertainment, and provision; and that James Showell, pretending to be mayor, had acted partially.”

Three or four witnesses were called to prove that gifts and promises had been made by Mr. Jolliffe in the presence of the other sitting member; in the course of this evidence—

“one Newnam was called to prove a declaration made to him by Brackstone a voter, about having got the promise of a *house* from Mr. Jolliffe for his vote.”

The committee resolved that the evidence was inadmissible on the grounds that—

“although the declaration (not upon oath) of a person who cannot be obliged to be a witness on the subject himself, is admissible in evidence to *affect such person*, yet is not admissible *against a third party*.”

Although the traditional figure of “Punch” is associated with punishments dealt out indiscriminately, it appears in the old electioneering days he was the agent for distributing illicit rewards for iniquitous acts. In the case of a “controverted election” for the borough of Shaftesbury (Dorset) the evidence produced vividly recalls Hogarth’s representation of an election broadside, “Punch, Candidate for Guzzletown,” introduced in his picture of “Canvassing for Votes.” After the general election, 1774, it was alleged that the sitting members, Sykes and Rumbold, by themselves or their agents, had been guilty of bribery, while it was attempted to be shown that Mortimer, who was the petitioner, had promised money to procure his election. The trial lasted four weeks, and among the points of evidence was the following indictment against the manœuvres of “Punch:”—Money, to the amount of several thousand pounds, had been given among the electors,⁵⁸ in sums of twenty guineas a man (654 votes were recorded in 1774; 532 being for Sykes and Rumbold). The persons who were entrusted with the distribution of this money, and who were chiefly the magistrates of the town, fell upon a very singular and absurd contrivance, in hopes of being able thereby to hide through what channel it was conveyed to the electors. A person concealed under a ludicrous and fantastical disguise, and called by the name of “Punch,” was placed in a small apartment, and, through a hole in the door, delivered out to the voters parcels containing the twenty guineas; upon which they were conducted to another apartment in the same house, where they found a person called “Punch’s secretary,” and signed notes for the value, but which were made payable to an imaginary character, to whom they had given the name of “Glenbucket.” Two of the witnesses, called by the counsel for the petitioner, swore that they had seen “Punch” through the hole in the door, and that they knew him to be one Matthews, an alderman of Shaftesbury; and, as the counsel for the petitioner had endeavoured to prove, an agent for the sitting members. It was said that those voters who admitted that they had received “Punch’s” money, had at the poll taken the bribery oath; it was contended for the other side that this was not legal evidence, that “it would be unjust to suffer what a man had

said in conversation, and without an oath, to invalidate what he had solemnly sworn.” The committee determined that, with regard to supposed agents, evidence should be first produced to establish the agency, before the bribery by such persons should be gone into. In the sequel it was determined that the two sitting members were not duly elected, and that the petitioner should be returned. “Punch,” his exertions, and his profuse distribution of bribes proved a grievous failure.

Not only was bribery freely practised under one or another disguise, but even the result of the petitions and scrutinies were made the subject of corruption. In a controverted election for Sudbury, in 1780, for instance, the question was put to the committee, “Whether a person who had laid a wager of about £40 on the event of the petition was competent to give evidence in the cause?” the decision being in the affirmative. This Sudbury election was altogether an odd affair.

“The mayor was the returning officer, and the petitioner alleged that at the close of the poll it was declared in his favour, but that afterwards a scrutiny was illegally demanded, when the other candidates were pronounced duly elected.” It was given in the evidence “that the election began Sep. 8, 1780, about ten o’clock in the morning, and continued until it was dark: that the petitioner and his friends then desired the mayor to adjourn the poll to the following day; but that he refused, and proceeded all night by candlelight”—

the election ending between six and seven o’clock the following morning: “There was some tumult during a part of the poll, but that it was upon the whole a very peaceable election.” This goes far to prove that an election must have been an extraordinarily turbulent business a century back, when proceedings varied by “a tumult during part of the poll” was admitted to be peaceful in an unusual degree.

The Shaftesbury arrangements for presenting voters with packets of twenty guineas were outdone by the electors of Shoreham, who combined and resolved themselves into a joint-stock company, that they themselves might derive the advantage from their borough which in other cases was monopolized by the patrons, or holders of bailiwicks. The suffrages being originally in the mayor and burgesses, these electors, with a forethought

superior to their generation, organized themselves into a compact league, or caucus, for electioneering purposes; but *not* with the intention of resisting and keeping out corrupt practices: the nature of this compact was disclosed during the hearing of the petition of Thomas Rumbold, on the election of a member in place of Sir Samuel Cornish deceased, and is set down in the *Journals* of the House (vol. 33), 1770-1. It appeared that the petitioner was duly elected, those who voted for him, to the number of eighty-seven, taking the bribery oath; as to the other candidates, thirty-seven votes were given for Purling and four for James; but the returning officer placed queries against the names of seventy-six of the petitioner Rumbold's voters, and immediately on the close of the poll declared Purling duly elected. The fourth plea related that in this borough of Shoreham had subsisted for many years a body which had assumed the name of the "Christian Society," though its organization was quite outside the diffusion of benevolence or Christianity; none but electors for representatives in parliament were admitted into the society, but the great majority of those who had votes were enrolled. A clerk was employed, and a meeting-place provided, where regular monthly and frequent occasional meetings were held, upon which gatherings a flag was hoisted to give notice to the members. About 1767, the members of the society entered into articles for raising and distributing small sums of money for charitable uses, these articles being designed to cover the real intention of the institution. The principal purpose of their meetings was for what they denominated *burgessing business*. An oath of secrecy was administered to all the members, who farther entered into a bond, under a penalty of five hundred pounds, to bring them all together with regard to *burgessing*; but otherwise the conditions of the bond were not allowed to appear. Upon any vacancy in the representation of the borough, the society always appointed a committee to *treat with the candidates for the purchase of the seat*, and the committees were constantly instructed to *get the most money and make the best bargain they could*; the society had no other purpose in view, and had no standing committee. On a false report of the death of the sitting member, Sir Samuel Cornish, the society was called together by the signal of the flag. On that meeting, which was numerously attended, the members declared that *they would support the highest bidder*; but some of their number, including Hugh Roberts, the returning officer impeached in the petition, expressed themselves offended at such a declaration, and declared that they were afraid of the

consequences, for the society was nothing but *a heap of bribery*, and withdrew from the body; but two months later, one of these ex-members returning to a meeting of the society, was treated with harsh expressions, and was told he came among them as a spy. The society, however, continued to meet, their gatherings being more frequent near election time. It was said that, on the death of Sir Samuel Cornish, when a vacancy occurred, a committee was appointed to treat for the seat with the incoming candidate, the members of the said committee themselves being careful to abstain from voting, though they were there on the day of election; three days before the polling, the society was reported to be dissolved, in order to escape the odium of proceedings on petition, but that the meetings had been resumed since. In the face of this evidence, Mr. Purling's counsel acquainted the court "that he could not carry his case further than by the witnesses examined, and could not impeach Mr. Rumbold's election or affect his votes." Although this closed the petitioning case, it was resolved that a further inquiry ought to be made into the transactions of the society, and a bill was ordered "to incapacitate certain persons from voting at elections," together with an address to the king to order the attorney-general to "prosecute certain persons for an illegal and corrupt conspiracy in relation to the late election for Shoreham." The bill was carried, printed, copies served on the offenders, passed through the House, agreed to by the Lords, and received the royal assent. The returning officer was ordered into the custody of the serjeant-at-arms; he was finally brought to the bar of the House to be reprimanded and discharged.

New Shoreham appears later under the patronage of the Duke of Norfolk and Earl of Egremont; the suffrage in 1771, after the extraordinary federation described in the foregoing, was extended to forty-shilling freeholders, "in the rape of Bramber," in which Shoreham is situated.

R. B. Sheridan, the brilliant but unstable genius,⁵⁹ sat for Stafford from 1780, until that ill-considered attempt to represent the city of Westminster in the place of his deceased friend, the great Charles James Fox, which completed his financial ruin. "Sherry" was notorious for looseness in his accounts, and it is curious to find one of the few circumstantial statements of election outlays calculated upon this unbusinesslike representative's borough expenses for the first parliament in which he represented Stafford

—always a moderate place, as prices ruled,—Sheridan being brought in chiefly by the influence of the shoemakers, an extensive body there.

R. B. SHERIDAN, ESQ., EXPENSES AT THE BOROUGH OF
STAFFORD, FOR ELECTION, ANNO 1784.

	£	s.	d.
248 Burgesses paid £5 5s. each	1302	0	0

YEARLY EXPENSES SINCE.

	£	s.	d.
House Rent and Taxes ⁶⁰	23	6	6
Servant at 6s per week, Board Wages	15	12	0
Ditto, Yearly Wages	8	8	0
Coals, &c.	10	0	0
	57	6	6
Ale Tickets	40	0	0
Half the Members' Plate	25	0	0
Swearing Young Burgesses	10	0	0
Subscription to the Infirmary	5	5	0
Do., Clergymen's Widows	2	2	0
Ringers	4	4	0
	86	11	0
One year	143	17	6
Multiplied by years			
	6		
	863	5	0
Total expense of six years' parliament, exclusive of expenses incurred during the time of election and your own annual expenses	£2165	5	0

(Moore's "Life of Sheridan," vol. i. p. 405.)

In 1806, when R. B. Sheridan was, by a coalition with Sir Samuel Hood, elected for Westminster—a seat lost by him, to his ruin, on the unexpected dissolution the year following,—his son, Tom Sheridan, that “proverbial pickle,” whose love of mischief and readiness of resource were alike remarkable, was offered for election in his gifted father’s place; the reputation of the Sheridans was, however, on the wane, and Tom, though admirable and even unapproachable at the hustings, was hardly endowed with the sterling qualities which should be found in a representative of the people to the Commons. The electors made choice of two Tory candidates, R. M. Phillips (412), and the Hon. E. Monckton (408), leaving but a poor record of votes for Thomas Sheridan (165). An amusing instance is recorded of the good-will of the constituents on this occasion:—

“When Mr. Clifford introduced Mr. R. M. Phillips to the electors—the journeymen shoemakers, as a token of respect, insisted that they should present him with a new hat, which was accordingly done, on the hustings, by a contribution of one penny each.”

Truly an exceptional circumstance, when voters—although expectant to receive—were rarely prepared to bestow, even their “voices,” unless for an adequate consideration!

The first entry into public life of William Pitt, as related by Earl Stanhope, is characteristic of the easy mode of procedure in those days, when a great man had merely to name his friends, and his tenants elected them. “Hitherto,” wrote Sir George Savile in 1780, “I have been elected in Lord Rockingham’s dining-room. Now I am returned by my constituents.” The spirit of the country, it was asserted, was rising at that period, but in 1780, it was still manifest that the territorial magnates and the monopolists of the borough franchises had their “own sweet will.” Pitt’s early friend, the eldest son of that Granby who had been an attached follower of Lord Chatham, had, mindful of this hereditary friendship, sought the acquaintance of William Pitt at the beginning of the latter’s career at Cambridge. Granby was five years Pitt’s senior; he became one of the members for Cambridge University, and in 1779 had the fortune to succeed his grandfather as Duke of Rutland. On Pitt’s coming to London, to commence his career, the young men became intimate, and the warm

attachment between them, which continued during the whole of the duke's life, was the cause of the early advancement of the son of the great Commoner. Owing to the Duke of Rutland's solicitude to see Pitt in parliament, he spoke upon the subject to Sir James Lowther, another ally of his house, and the owner of most extensive borough influence. Sir James quickly caught the idea, and proposed to avail himself of a double return for one of his boroughs to bring the friend of his friend into parliament. The duke mentioned the offer to Pitt; and Pitt, who was writing on the same day to his mother, Lady Chatham, added a few lines in haste to let her know. But it was not until he had seen Sir James himself that he was able to express his entire satisfaction at the prospect now before him.

“Lincoln's Inn, Thursday Night, Nov., 1780.

“MY DEAR MOTHER,

“I can now inform you that I have seen Sir James Lowther, who has repeated to me the offer he had before made, and in the handsomest manner. Judging from my father's principles, he concludes that mine would be agreeable to his own, and on that ground—to me of all others the most agreeable—to bring me in. No kind of condition was mentioned, but that if ever our lines of conduct should become opposite, I should give him an opportunity of choosing another person. On such liberal terms I could certainly not hesitate to accept the proposal, than which nothing could be in any respect more agreeable. Appleby is the place I am to represent, and the election will be made (probably in a week or ten days) without my having any trouble, or even visiting my constituents. I shall be in time to be spectator and auditor *at least* of the important scene after the holidays. I would not defer confirming to you this intelligence, which I believe you will not be sorry to hear.”

It is added (Dec. 7, 1780),—

“I have not yet received the notification of my election. It will probably not take place till the end of this week, as Sir James Lowther was to settle an election at Haslemere before he went into the north,

and meant to be present at Appleby afterwards. The parliament adjourned yesterday, so I shall not take my seat till after the holidays.”

This confidence discloses that such a thing as a contest, let alone a defeat, was not for a moment entertained.

“I propose before long, in spite of politics, to make an excursion for a short time to Lord Westmoreland’s (Althorp, Northamptonshire), and shall probably look at my constituents that should have been, at Cambridge, in my way.”

About three years later, William Pitt, by that time the most conspicuous statesman of his day, and already prime minister of England by the royal will, on the downfall of the coalition, realized his former ambition, and he offered himself successfully for the University of Cambridge. In order to enter for this distinction, Pitt had declined two seats, voluntarily placed at his disposal: when the war-cry arose from the hustings throughout the kingdom, he was put in nomination, without either his knowledge or consent, for the city of London, as usual the first election in point of time; the show of hands was declared to be in the young statesman’s favour, but when apprised of the fact he declined the poll. Such were the honours heaped upon this proud juvenile premier, that he was constantly refusing favours solicitously placed at his acceptance.

“He was pressed,” says Earl Stanhope, “to stand for several other cities and towns, more especially for the city of Bath, which his father had represented, and the king was vexed at his refusal of this offer. But the choice of Pitt was already made. He had determined, as we have seen, to offer himself for the University of Cambridge.”

He held at this time all the state patronage, and, moreover, with the king at his back, he meant mischief to the members of the ministry recently displaced from power by his royal master; and was about to trust to his faculties and the reserve forces he could command for a great electioneering campaign. He found time to write to his friend in Yorkshire:—

“DEAR WILBERFORCE,

“Parliament will be prorogued to-day and dissolved to-morrow. The latter operation has been in some danger of delay by a curious manœuvre, that of stealing the Great Seal last night from the Chancellor’s, but we shall have a new one ready in time. I send you a copy of the Speech which will be made in two hours from the Throne. You may speak of it in the past tense, instead of in the *future*.... I am told Sir Robert Hildyard is the right candidate for the county. You must take care to keep all our friends together, and to *tear the enemy to pieces*. I set out this evening for Cambridge, where I expect, notwithstanding your boding, to find everything favourable. I am sure, however, to find a retreat at Bath.

“Ever faithfully yours,
“W. PITT.”

Though Pitt had the “good things” to give away he did not escape sarcasm: thus it was suggested—it is said by Paley, who was then at Cambridge—as a fitting text for a university sermon, “There is a lad here which hath five barley loaves and two small fishes; but what are they among so many?”

“The author of this pleasantry,” declares Stanhope, “did not allow for the public temper of the time; in most cases the electors voted without views of personal interest; in some cases they voted even against views of personal interest.”

Pitt was supported by Lord Euston, the heir of the Duke of Grafton, and between them they defeated the late members, the Hon. John Townshend, and James Mansfield, both members of the coalition ministry, the former as lord of the admiralty, the latter as solicitor-general. After a keen contest, Pitt and Lord Euston were returned, Pitt at the head of the poll. It was a marked triumph, and exercised an influence elsewhere; nor was it a fleeting victory or a temporary connection, for Pitt continued to represent the university during the remainder of his life. Pitt, now, as he called himself, “a hardened electioneerer,” entered into the spirit of the warfare, and carried his forces into the strongholds of the Whig estates:—

“But,” writes Earl Stanhope, “of all the contests of this period the most important in that point of view was for the county of York. That great county, not yet at election times severed into Ridings, had been under the sway of the Whig Houses. Bolton Abbey, Castle Howard, and Wentworth Park had claimed the right to dictate at the hustings.”

The spirit of the country in 1784 rose still higher; the independent freeholders of Yorkshire boldly confronted the great Houses, and insisted on returning, in conjunction with the heir of Duncombe Park, a banker’s son, of few years and of scarcely tried abilities, though destined to a high place in his country’s annals—Mr. Wilberforce. With the help of the country gentlemen, they raised the vast sum of £18,662 for the expense of the election (twenty-one years later this “vast sum” would not have produced much effect on the same field, when Wilberforce fought, in 1807, what has been described as the “Austerlitz of electioneering,”—the candidates between them expending above three hundred thousand pounds,—the details of which follow in their chronological sequence); and so great was their show of numbers and of resolution, that the candidates upon the other side did not venture to stand a contest. Wilberforce was also returned at the head of the poll by his former constituents at Hull. “I can never congratulate you enough on such glorious success,” wrote the youthful prime minister to his equally youthful friend. Rank and file, leaders and spokesmen, of the coalition party fell before the masterly tactics of the young chief, who stirred the minds of the people by extreme views as to England’s sinister future (if the Whigs prevailed) menaced with the onslaught of sweeping revolutions, and the destruction of every moderate institution and every safeguard of the state. In this manner, writes Pitt’s biographer, the party of the opposition was scattered beyond rallying. “To use a gambling metaphor,” declares Stanhope, “which Fox would not have disdained, many threw down their cards. Many others played, but lost the rubber.” A witty nickname was commonly applied to them. In allusion to the History, written by John Fox, of the sufferers under the Romish persecution, they were called “Fox’s Martyrs;” and of such martyrs there proved to be no less than one hundred and sixty. Amidst all these reverses, however, Fox’s high courage never quailed. On the 3rd of April, we find him write as follows to a friend: “Plenty of bad news from all quarters, but I think I feel misfortunes when they come thick have the effect rather of rousing my

spirits than sinking them;”—as set down by Earl Russell in his “Memorials.”

One of the most remarkable features of the great electioneering contest of 1784 was the fact of the ex-demagogue Wilkes being returned as the ministerial candidate, to Pitt’s pronounced gratification too, for the county of Middlesex. But the ways of statesmen are indeed wonderful and manifold, and Wilkes, the man without prejudices, and equally unburdened by principles, was an expedient ally (though a redoubtable foe). Wilkes, very cleverly and plausibly, upon the score of Pitt’s constant advocacy of Parliamentary Reform, was enabled to press upon the freeholders of the county of Middlesex the advisability of extending their entire support to the “virtuous young Minister,” whose “liberal and enlightened principles promised to advance the best interests of the country.”⁶¹

“Johnny Wilkes, Johnny Wilkes,
Thou boldest of bilks,
What a different song you now sing!
For your dear *Forty-five*,
'Tis *Prerogative*!
And your blasphemy—‘*God save the King.*’”
(*The Backstairs Scoured.*)

Wilkes having made the most of his patriotism, after being elected lord mayor, and subsequently obtaining the lucrative and permanent office of city chamberlain, now exhibited himself in his true colours—a remarkable instance of tergiversation, disclaiming his own acts, and making no scruple of expressing his contempt for the opinions of his former supporters. On his return for Middlesex in 1784, as one of “the king’s friends,” the democrats represented the king and Wilkes hanged on one tree, with the inscription, “Give justice her claims.” The reconciliation of the “two kings of Brentford” was by no means popular, and the wits were severe on the fresh departure. One of these caricatures, May 1, 1784, is entitled, “The New Coalition.” It represents the King and the ex-archdemagogue fraternally embracing; Wilkes’s cap of liberty is cast to the ground; he declares to his Sovereign, “I now find you are the best of princes.” While great George

discovers the erst agitator, his late aversion, “Sure! the worthiest of subjects and most virtuous of men!”



THE NEW COALITION - THE
RECONCILIATION OF “THE
TWO KINGS OF BRENTFORD.”
1784.

Charles James Fox, the most popular Whig statesman of history, was returned for Midhurst in May, 1769. He was then only nineteen years and four months old; notwithstanding this, he took his seat the November

following, thus becoming a member of parliament before he reached the age of twenty. Curiously enough, his first speech, March, 9, 1770, was on a point of order, arising out of the Wilkes case and the disputes of the Middlesex election. In spite of his affected patriotism, Wilkes made a jest of his insincerity: standing on the hustings at Brentford, his opponent said to him, "I will take the sense of the meeting;" to which the pseudo "champion of liberty" responded, "And I will take the nonsense, and we shall see who has the best of it." In the same way he coolly disavowed his friend and advocate Serjeant Glynn, his colleague for Middlesex, who had fought all his battles through the courts to the hustings, and *vice versa*. Some years later, as related by Earl Russell, when the "two kings of Brentford" were excellent friends, and Wilkes, by the irony of fate, became a ministerial candidate, he was received at a levée, when George III., with his habitual practice of asking awkward questions, inquired after Wilkes's friend, Glynn. "Sire," said Wilkes, "he is not a friend of mine; he was a Wilkite, which I never was."

One of the most animated pictures which can be found of the humours of canvassing is that drawn from life by William Cowper, at the time the poet's mind was influenced to cheerfulness by the company of the lively Lady Austen, who, with the more gravely solicitous Mrs. Unwin, made Olney an halcyon abode. The year the "Task" was published, and while Cowper was touching up his spirited ballad of "John Gilpin," he has set down the visit of an aspiring young senator, no less than Pitt's cousin, Mr. W. W. Grenville, who, with a retinue of zealous supporters at his tail, quite "without your leave," bursts upon the poet's retirement in pursuit of suffrages; this was at the general election of 1784:—

"As, when the sea is uncommonly agitated, the water finds its way into creeks and holes of rocks, which, in its calmer state, it never reaches; in like manner, the effect of these turbulent times is felt even at Orchard Side, where in general we live as undisturbed by the political element as shrimps or cockles that have been accidentally deposited in some hollow beyond the water-mark by the usual dashing of the waves. We were sitting yesterday after dinner, the two ladies and myself, very composedly, and without the least apprehension of any such intrusion, in our snug parlour; one lady knitting, the other netting,

and the gentleman winding worsted, when, to our unspeakable surprise, a mob appeared before the window, a smart rap was heard at the door, the boys halloed, and the maid announced Mr. Grenville. ‘Puss’ [Cowper’s tame hare] was unfortunately let out of her box, so that the candidate, with all his good friends at his heels, was refused admission at the grand entry, and referred to the back door as the only possible way of approach. Candidates are not creatures to be very susceptible of affronts, and would rather, I suppose, climb in at the window than be absolutely excluded. In a minute, the yard, the kitchen, and the parlour were filled. Mr. Grenville, advancing towards me, shook me by the hand with a degree of cordiality that was extremely seducing. As soon as he, and as many more as could find chairs, were seated, he began to open the intent of his visit. I told him I had no vote, for which he readily gave me credit. I assured him I had no influence, which he was not equally inclined to believe, and the less, no doubt, because Mr. Ashburner, the draper, addressing himself to me at this moment, informed me that I had a great deal. Supposing that I could not be possessed of such a treasure without knowing it, I ventured my first assertion by saying that, if I had any, I was utterly at a loss to imagine where it could be, or wherein it consisted. Thus ended the conference. Mr. Grenville squeezed me by the hand again, kissed the ladies and withdrew. He kissed likewise the maid in the kitchen, and seemed, upon the whole, a most loving, kissing, kind-hearted gentleman. He is very young, genteel, and handsome. He has a pair of very good eyes in his head, which not being sufficient, as it should seem, for the many nice and difficult purposes of a senator, he has a third also, which he wore suspended by a riband from his button-hole. The boys halloed, the dogs barked, ‘Puss’ scampered, the hero with his long train of obsequious followers withdrew. We made ourselves very merry with the adventure, and, in a short time, settled into our former tranquillity, never probably to be thus interrupted more.”

It may be added that this persuasive young politician, W. W. Grenville, succeeded in securing his return at the top of the poll for the county of Buckinghamshire in 1784, as Pitt wrote to James Grenville (Lord Glastonbury)—“William was safe.”



A MOB-REFORMER. 1780.

CHAPTER X.

THE GREAT WESTMINSTER ELECTION OF 1784.

The excitement caused by Wilkes's election for Middlesex in 1768 was forgotten in the great Westminster contest of 1784. Although on each occasion the conflicts were in opposition to those ministerial interests which enlisted the Crown, the courtiers, and the following of placemen, state pensioners, with both branches of the service upon the Tory side in antagonism to popular rights and the freedom of election, in both instances of overstrained influence the Government had to submit to the mortification of defeat. The circumstances preceding the Westminster election were exceptional. The Fox and North Coalition Administration had, by an overstrained exercise of the royal prerogative, through a "back-stair" Court intrigue, and by defiantly unconstitutional means on the part of the king, lost their hold on power, temporarily—as they then supposed—but, as subsequent events proved, beyond recall.

Fox had introduced his vast measure of reform for the reconstitution of our Eastern Empire. Passed by the majority commanded by the Coalition Ministry in the Commons, the Bill was—in direct deference to the king's written instructions, freely heralded about—thrown out on the second reading in the Lords. Fox was feared by the king and the East India Company alike; it was apprehended that the great "Carlo Khan" was but beginning the work of revolution, and that all charters would be in equal jeopardy if that of the East India House was allowed to be revised. The wealth of the company was put into requisition to hurl from power the ministers who dared to legislate for the administration of the huge empire confided to their government; and the king chiefly aimed at the dismissal of the great Whig chief, against whom an unreasonable prejudice long continued to exist in the royal mind. On Fox's defeat it was left to Lord

Temple to constitute an administration which should satisfy the king; but although this juncture brought William Pitt to the front, it was found impossible to carry on the business of the country, the ministry, too weak to divide, being beaten on every measure introduced by their rivals; finally, the opposition majority carried the following damaging resolution by nineteen votes:—

“That it is the opinion of this House that the continuance of the present ministry in power is an obstacle to the formation of such an administration as is likely to have the confidence of this House and the people.”

An address to the king in the same spirit was passed, and similar motions and addresses were repeated until parliament was prorogued with a discontented speech from the throne, and it was dissolved on the day following, March 25, 1874; thus ending for the time this threatening contest between the Crown and the most important part of the legislature, and transferring the arena of conflict to the hustings. By the royal will, Pitt, though only in his twenty-fifth year, was established as Prime Minister of England, uniting in himself the offices of first lord of the treasury and chancellor of the exchequer; his colleagues being those already known as “the king’s friends,” or youthful aspirants to power willing to tread in their steps. At the elections, the opposition laboured under the disadvantage of leaving the patronage of administration in the hands of their antagonists, and though the contests were obstinate, the Court influence and the king’s name, which was used openly in defiance of the privileges of parliament, secured a majority of seats at once, confirming the apprehensions of the Whig party, and fixing Pitt in security at the pinnacle of power. Horace Walpole has pictured the feelings of the day:—

“The Court struck a blow at the Ministers, but it was the gold of the East India Company, that nest of monsters (which Fox’s Bill was to demolish), that really conjured up the storm, and has diffused it all over England. On the other hand Mr. Pitt has braved the majority of the House of Commons, has dissolved the existent one, and, I doubt, given a wound to that branch of the legislature, which, if the tide does not turn, may be very fatal to the constitution. The nation is

intoxicated, and has poured in addresses of thanks to the Crown for exerting the prerogative *against* the palladium of the people. The first consequence will probably be, that the Court will have a considerable majority upon the new Elections.”

The aversion to the late Coalition Ministry was turned to account by the Court; the elections showed the opposition, so strong before the dissolution, in a woeful minority; the great Whig families, Horace Walpole wrote—

“have lost all credit in their own counties; nay, have been tricked out of seats where the whole property was their own; and, in some of those cases, a *Royal* finger has too evidently tampered, as well as singularly and revengefully towards Lord North and Lord Hertford.... Such a proscription, however, must have sown so deep resentment as it was not wise to provoke, considering that permanent fortune is a jewel that in no Crown is the most to be depended upon.”

The Westminster election of 1784 was an event of importance in the political history of the last century; it was the only serious check that the Court encountered in the attempt to return a subservient House of Commons; and circumstances combined to render it the most remarkable struggle of the kind that has been witnessed. The metropolis was kept in a state of ebullition for weeks; the poll was opened on April 1st, and continued without intermission until May 17th. During this time, Covent Garden and the Strand were the scenes of daily combats between the rival mobs; the papers were filled with squibs of the most personal nature, according to their respective sides in politics, and hundreds of pictorial satires appeared on every incident, and embodying all the successive stages of the struggle. Rowlandson, who entered with spirit into the contest, chiefly in the Foxite interests, alone produced on an average a fresh caricature every day; the best of these are reproduced in the life of the caricaturist, and a selection of these subjects, from the work in question, are given among the present illustrations of the subject. The representatives of Westminster in the previous parliament were Fox and Sir Brydges Rodney. Sir Cecil Wray, lately a follower of the Whig party, had been nominated for the last parliament by the Whig chief, but on this occasion Wray

ungratefully deserted his political leader, and was put forward as the ministerial nominee. The king and Court had resolved to exert every influence to cause Fox's defeat on personal grounds. Admiral Lord Hood was also a Court candidate, but it was Wray who was more especially held forth as the antagonist of the "Man of the People." The political apostate was stigmatized as "Judas Iscariot, who betrayed his master." Other charges against him were certain proposals he is said to have made for the suppression of Chelsea Hospital and a project for a tax upon maid-servants; to these were added the general cries against his supporters of attempting an undue elevation of the prerogative, and also against the prevalent "back-stair" influence.

Against Fox was raised the odium of the coalition with Lord North, and his attack on the East India Company's charter was represented as but the commencement of a general invasion of chartered rights of corporate bodies. The Prince of Wales interested himself warmly in favour of Fox, to the extreme provocation of the king and queen; it was declared that the prince had canvassed in person, and that the members of his household were actively engaged in promoting the success of the Whig chief. The exertions of the Court were extraordinary; almost hourly intelligence was conveyed to the king, who is said to have been affected in the most evident manner by every change in the state of the poll. Threats and promises were freely made in the royal name, the old illegalities were revived, members of the king's household claimed votes, and on one occasion two hundred and eighty of the Guards were sent in a body to give their votes as householders—an ill-advised manœuvre, upon which, as Horace Walpole declared, his father, Sir Robert, would not have dared to venture in the most quiet seasons. All dependents on the Court were commanded to vote on the same side as the soldiers. When Fox's friends, the popular party, protested against this unconstitutional interference, their opponents retaliated by charging the Foxites with bribery, and with resorting to improper influences of extravagant kinds. Beyond the unpopularity of relying upon Court patronage and the imputations of "wearing two faces under a Hood," and being "a Greenwich pensioner," Admiral Lord Hood escaped; the most bitter party and personal attacks were made upon Wray. At the beginning of the election, Hood had brought up a large contingent of sailors, or, as the opposition alleged, chiefly hired ruffians dressed in sailors' clothes; these

desperadoes surrounded the hustings, and intimidated Fox's friends, and even hindered those who attempted to register votes in favour of the Whig chief; they grew uproarious as the poll progressed, and, parading the streets, assaulted Fox's partisans, made conspicuous by displaying his "true blue" favours; they also attacked the Shakespeare Tavern, where his committee met, when, threatening to wreck the house, they were beaten off by the inmates. After a reign of terror, which was endured for four days without organized resistance, the sailor mob encountered a rival faction—entitled the "honest mob" by the opposition newspapers,—these were the hackney chairmen, a numerous body, chiefly Irishmen, almost unanimous in their support of Fox; these, with hearty will, basted the sailors, breaking heads and fracturing bones in the neighbourhood of Covent Garden. The sailors thence proceeded to St. James's, where the chairmen chiefly plied for hire, to wreak vengeance on their chairs; but the Irishmen beat them again and the Guards quelled the riot. The day following, both parties were reinforced. The sailors, vowing vengeance, left the hustings to intercept Fox on his way to Westminster to canvass; but he luckily managed to elude them, and escaped into a private house. The sailor mob returned to Covent Garden, where they encountered the "honest mob," the chairmen being joined by a multitude of butchers, brewers' men, and others. A series of pitched battles ensued, the sailors were defeated at each renewal of the fighting, and, finally, many of their number being carried off to hospitals severely injured, the popular rival mob was left in possession of the field. Special constables were now introduced at the instance of the justices of the peace, who were in the Court interest, to surround the places where Hood and Wray's committees met, and these behaved in a manner so hostile to Fox's party, going about impeding and insulting Liberal voters, and shouting "No Fox," that their presence provoked a fresh outbreak. On the approach of the "honest mob," heralded by the sounds of the marrow-bones and cleavers, the insurrectionary signal, the constables made an attack, in which one of their own body was knocked down and killed by fellow-constables by mistake in the heat of the scuffle.

In Rowlandson's pictorial versions of the different stages of this famous election, the public were first excited against the Coalition Ministry, lately thrown out of office as described. "They Quarter their Arms" represents the contracting parties, Fox and Badger, united to share the

Treasury spoils, and battenning on the victimized John Bull; it was “money” which made the Coalition Wedding:—

“Come, we’re all rogues together,
The people must pay for the play;
Then let us make hay in fine weather,
And keep the cold winter away.”

The downfall of the Coalition was pictured as “Britannia Aroused; or, the Coalition Ministers Destroyed,” in which Fox and North are figuratively reaping the reward of iniquity.



THE COALITION WEDDING—THE FOX (C. J. FOX) AND THE BADGER (LORD NORTH) QUARTER THEIR ARMS ON JOHN BULL. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“Now Fox, North, and Burke, each one is a brother,
So honest, they swear, there is not such another;
No longer they tell us we’re going to ruin,
The people they serve in whatever they’re doing.”

“Within the Senate, and without,
Our credit fails; th’ enlighten’d nation
The boasted Coalition scout,
And hunt us from th’ administration.

“Fox, let thy soul with *grace* be fill’d:
Expect no other *call* but mine;
With penitence I see thee thrill’d,
With new-born light I see thee shine.

“How spruce will North beneath thee sit!
With joy officiate as thy clerk!
Attune the hymn, renounce his wit,
And carol like the morning lark!”



BRITANNIA AROUSED, OR THE
COALITION MONSTERS
DESTROYED. BY T.
ROWLANDSON.

“These were your Ministers.”

The astute young premier, whose youth at this time was alleged as his chief crime, began to bid for “loyal addresses,” and other servile expressions, to condone the rash experiments recently attempted upon the constitution. With this view he cultivated the citizens, and, being presented with the “Freedom of the City,” he was entertained by the Grocers’ Company as the son of that famous Earl of Chatham, the greatest friend of the rights of the people; it was expected he would be equally steadfast in defending popular freedom:—

“But Chatham, thank heaven! has left us a son;
When *he* takes the helm, we are sure not undone;
The glory his father revived of the land,
And Britannia has taken Pitt by the hand.”

In “Master Billy’s Procession to Grocers’ Hall” the adulation of the multitude is offered to the “charming youth,” who is declared to be “very like his father;” the gold box is carried before, and the voluntary slaves who are harnessed to his chariot are shouting for “Pitt and Prerogative.”

Before the dissolution (March 25th), Pitt’s ministerial manœuvres were already patent to all. The king had determined, with the obstinacy of purpose which characterized the royal mind, that he would endure any sacrifice rather than sanction the return of the members of the late Coalition Ministry to power; in the face of this eventuality, he even threatened, it is stated, to retire to Hanover, but, in the meanwhile, no effort was spared to obviate this embarrassing emergency. Places and pensions were freely employed as baits to detach followers of Fox and North. A pictorial version of the situation, as given by Rowlandson, represents the extensive “ratting”

system and its *modus operandi*, under the title of “The Apostate Jack Robinson, the Political Rat-catcher. N.B. *Rats taken alive!*”



T. ROWLANDSON: MASTER BILLY'S PROCESSION TO GROCERS' HALL—
PARLIAMENTARY ELECTIONS—PITT PRESENTED WITH THE FREEDOM OF
THE CITY, 1784.

“The City interests and votes, young Pitt would fain obtain.
For Freedom of the City, too, he does not sue in vain;
So Master Billy goes in state a Grocer to be made,
‘A fig for Fox,’ the Premier cries, ‘I’ve pushed him out of trade.’”



T. ROWLANDSON: THE APOSTATE JACK ROBINSON, THE POLITICAL RAT-CATCHER. 1784.

[Page 265.]

“Thus when Renegado sees a Rat
 In the traps in the morning taken,
 With pleasure he goes Master Pitt to pat,
 And swears he will have his bacon.”

Jack Robinson, as “Rat-catcher to Great Britain,” is equipped for his delicate task with a supply of baits, lures, and traps; round his waist is the “Cestus of Corruption,” in his pocket is a small aide-de-camp, who is made to exclaim, “We’ll ferret them out!” On his back is a double trap, baited with coronets and places; he is cautiously proceeding on all fours, along the Treasury floor, where “vermin” are “preserved;” the rats to be captured are toying with the gold laid down to attract them. To the nose of one veteran, whose face resembles the spectacled visage of Edmund Burke, is held a large bait of “pension,” which is regarded wistfully by other rats assembled.

Under the heading of “Rats of Note,” a placard on the wall announces the list of political apostates who have been captured. No concealment was attempted, for we find in the pages of the *Morning Post and Daily Advertiser*, for February 10, 1784, an advertisement, under the simple heading of “Jack Robinson,” with a woodcut representing a string of rats, such as might preface a common rat-catcher’s announcement, giving the names of twenty-two parliamentary rats already decoyed from their party allegiance to go over to the good pickings the king was able to hold out. This curious notification is repeated on the Treasury wall, shown in Rowlandson’s pictorial view of the corruption abroad, as a preparation for the coming elections.

The *dramatis personæ* of the great performance at the Covent Garden hustings are exhibited as “The Rival Candidates:” “Themistocles,” Lord Hood; “Demosthenes,” Fox; “Judas Iscariot,” Sir Cecil Wray.



HONEST SAM HOUSE, THE PATRIOTIC PUBLICAN, CANVASSER FOR FOX.

One of the most enthusiastic partisans of Fox, and second only to his fair friends, the ladies of the Whig aristocracy, in popular influence, was “Honest Sam House,” the publican, remarkable for his oddity and for his political zeal, who during the election not only canvassed with admirable tact, but throughout the contest kept open house at his own expense, and was honoured with the presence of many of the Whig aristocracy.

“See the brave Sammy House, he’s as still as a mouse,
And does canvass with prudence so clever:
See what shoals with him flock, to poll for brave Fox,
Give thanks to Sam House, boys, for ever, for ever,
Give thanks to Sam House, boys, for ever!

“Brave bald-headed Sam, all must own is the man,
Who does canvass for brave Fox so clever;
His aversion, I say, is to *small beer and Wray!*
May his bald head be honour’d for ever, for ever!
May his bald head be honour’d for ever!”

The fact that the public was being treated to the excitement of perhaps the most momentous and embittered, if not the hardest-fought election on record, is shown in Rowlandson’s version of the Covent Garden Hustings, round which is assembled a crowd of persons who are being addressed from the platform, whereon stands one of the ministerial candidates, Admiral Lord Hood, who is made to announce his intention of carrying “two faces under a Hood!” This caricature is a pointed comment upon the Court manœuvres, and exposes those royal tactics which had already demoralized the allies of the defunct Coalition Ministry. Major John Cartwright—the consistent and energetic advocate of reform, of which he was one of the most valorous pioneers—is made the mouth-piece of the artist’s satirical strictures, while endorsing those views held by “The Drum-Major of Sedition” (March 29, 1784), as the liberty-loving major, who remained conspicuous in the foremost ranks of reformers all his days, was entitled by his adversaries. A strongly ironical tendency characterizes the speech, which may be regarded as a tolerably pungent electioneering squib:—



Themistocles.
Lord Hood.

Demosthenes.
Charles James Fox.

Judas Iscariot.
Sir Cecil Wray.

T. ROWLANDSON: THE RIVAL CANDIDATES—GREAT WESTMINSTER
ELECTION. 1784.

“The gallant Lord Hood to his country is dear,
His voters, like Charlie’s, make excellent cheer;
But who has been able to taste *the small beer*
Of Sir Cecil Wray?

“In vain all the arts of the Court are let loose,
The electors of Westminster never will choose
To run down a Fox, and set up a *Goose*
Like Sir Cecil Wray.”



MAJOR CARTWRIGHT, THE
DRUM-MAJOR OF SEDITION.

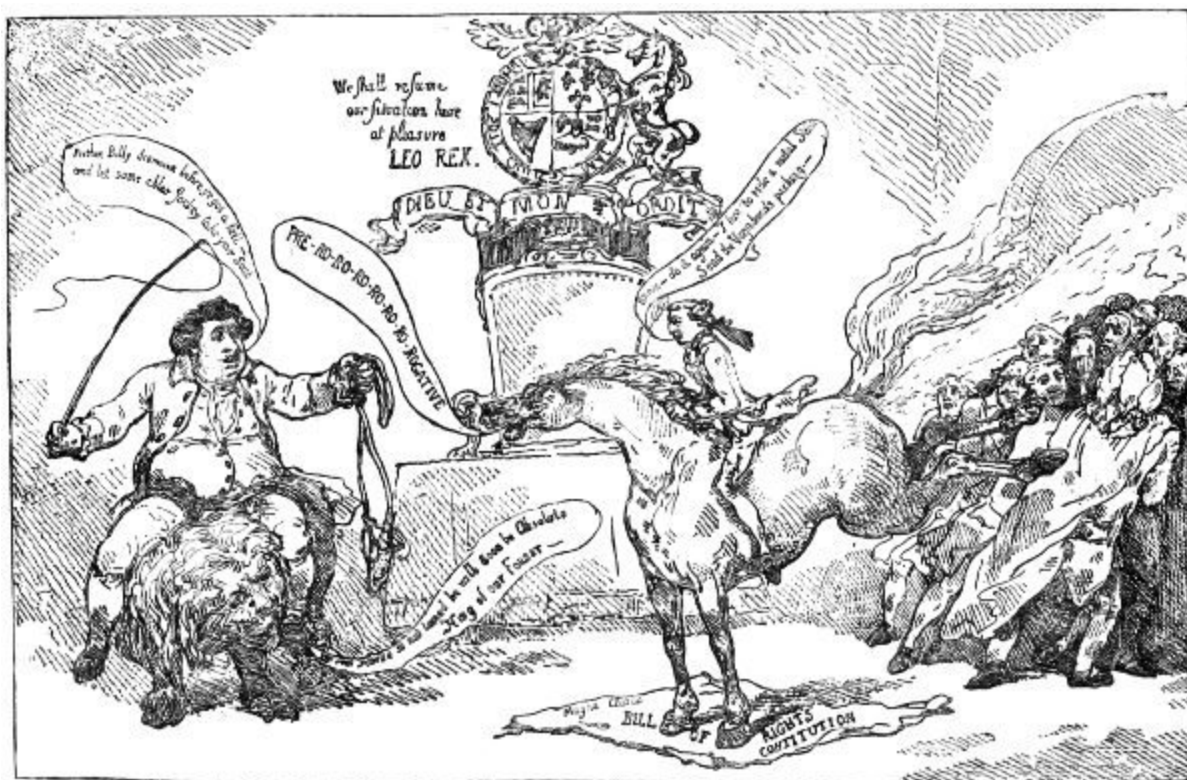
“All gentlemen and other electors for Westminster who are ready and willing to surrender their rights and those of their fellow-citizens to secret influence and the Lords of the Bedchamber, let them repair to the prerogative standard, lately erected at the Cannon Coffee House, where they shall be kindly received—until their services are no longer wanted. This, gentlemen, is the last time of asking, as we are determined to abolish the power of the House of Commons, and in future be governed by Prerogative, as they are in France and Turkey. Gentlemen, the ambition of the enemy is now evident. Has he not, within these few days past, stole the Great Seal of England” (this had actually occurred, the great seal being mysteriously carried off on the eve of the dissolution, which had to be postponed until another seal could be made to replace the missing instrument) “while the Chancellor⁶² was taking a bottle with a female favourite, as all great men do? I am informed, gentlemen, that the enemy now assumes Regal Authority, and, by virtue of the Great Seal (which he stole), is

creating of Peers and granting of pensions. A most shameful abuse, gentlemen, of that instrument. If you assist us to pull down the House of Commons, every person who hears me has a chance of becoming a great man, if he is happy enough to hit the fancy of Lord Bute and of Mr. Jenkinson.⁶³ Huzza! God save the King!”

Pitt’s valour, then deemed intemperate, in taking up the reins of office by “the royal will,” and thereby jockeying the discomfited ex-Coalition Ministry, is commented upon by Rowlandson in the course of his numerous caricatures on the great Westminster election. “The Hanoverian Horse and the British Lion; a scene in a new play, lately acted at Westminster with distinguished applause. Act ii., scene last” (March 31, 1784), is a version intended to be prophetic of the end, a view then warranted by circumstances, but one falsified by the results of the general election, which consolidated the power in Pitt’s hands, and completely left the opposition “out in the cold!” a surprise by no means anticipated at the date of the cartoon in question. The Parliament-house is shown as the arena of this constitutional tournament, and the faithful Commons are victimized by the aggressive tendencies of Pitt’s steed; the White Horse of Hanover is trampling upon “Magna Charta,” the “Bill of Rights,” and mangling the “Constitution.” Pitt, a remarkably light and boyish jockey, is exciting the brute, who is neighing, “Pre-ro-ro-ro-ro-rogative” with vicious energy. The youthful premier is enjoying the capers of his mount: “Bravo! go it again; I love to ride a mettle steed. Send the vagabonds packing.” The heels of the White Horse are effectually scaring the members and making a clearance. The British Lion has descended from his familiar post as a supporter of the royal ’scutcheon over the Speaker’s chair; in the vacant space lately occupied by the British Lion is the announcement, “We shall resume our situation here at pleasure.—Leo Rex.” The sturdy figure of the Whig Chief is safely mounted upon the British Lion, who is keeping a watchful eye upon his Hanoverian rival, while protesting, “If this horse is not tamed, he will soon be absolute king of our forest.” Fox has entered on the scene of conflict, armed for the encounter with bit, bridle, and a stout riding-whip, to tame and control the uproarious White Horse; he is volunteering advice to his upstart rival, “Prithee, Billy, dismount before ye get a fall—and let some abler jockey take your seat!” Fox was reckoning without his “Martyrs,” which the results of the election were destined to create on an

unprecedented scale, as this review will show. The reverse was shortly to be realized, as set down pictorially by Rowlandson. The poll was opened April 1, and three days later appeared a version of Fox as “The Incurable,” in a strait-waistcoat, and with straw in his hair, singing:—

“My lodging is on the cold ground, and very hard is my case,
But that which grieves me most of all is the losing of my place.”



T. ROWLANDSON: THE HANOVERIAN HORSE AND THE BRITISH LION.
MARCH, 1784.

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The royal physician, Dr. Munro, is examining the patient through his eyeglass, and attesting, "As I have not the least hope of his recovery, let him be removed amongst the Incurables."

“Dazzled with hope, he could not see the cheat
Of aiming with impatience to be great.
With wild ambition in his heart, we find,
Farewell content and quiet of his mind;
For glittering clouds he left the solid shore,
And wonted happiness returns no more.”

The most active and successful of Fox's canvassers was undoubtedly the Duchess of Devonshire, who, by the influence of her personal charms and her winning affability, succeeded in procuring for the Whig chief votes which would never have otherwise been polled in his favour. It was of the beautiful and winsome Georgiana Spencer, that Hannay said the Spencers had laid the world under further obligations by sending forth a second “Fairy Queen,” and it was the Westminster Election of 1784 which first brought into celebrity this gay and graceful leader of fashion, who, by universal suffrage, was the Queen of the Foxites. In the earlier stages Fox was behind both his opponents, and although Cecil Wray had only a small majority, Fox was at his last gasp. The story is told in Wraxall's “Posthumous Memoirs” by an eye-witness of the incidents:—



THE DEVONSHIRE, OR MOST APPROVED MANNER OF SECURING
VOTES. 1784. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“However courtiers take offence,
And cits and prudes may join, Sir,
Beauty will ever influence
The free and generous mind, Sir.

“Fair DEVON, like the rising sun,
Proceeds in her full glory,
Whilst Madam’s duller orb must own
The Duchess moves before her.”

“The party were driven to new resources, and the Duchess of Devonshire restored the fates of the Whig champion. The progress of the canvass thenceforward is amusing. The entire of the voters for Westminster having been exhausted, the only hope was in exciting the suburbs. The Duchess instantly ordered out her equipage, and with her sister, the Countess of Duncannon, drove, polling list in hand, to the houses of the voters. Entreaties, ridicule, civilities, influence of all kinds were lavished on these rough legislators; and the novelty of being solicited by two women of rank and remarkable fashion, took the popular taste universally. The immediate result was, that they gallantly came to the poll, and Fox, who had been a hundred behind Sir Cecil, speedily left him a hundred behind in return. An imperfect attempt was made on the hostile side to oppose this new species of warfare by similar captivation, and Lady Salisbury was moved to awake the dying fortunes of the Government candidate. But the effort failed; it was imitation, it was too late; and the Duchess was six-and-twenty, and Lady Salisbury thirty-four! These are reasons enough, and more than enough for the rejection of any man from the hustings.”

“A certain lady I won’t name
Must take an active part, sir,
To show that DEVON’S beauteous dame
Should not engage each heart, sir.

“She canvass’d all, both great and small,
And thundered at each door, sir;
She rummaged every shop and stall—
The Duchess had been before her.”

The Tories were furious at the success of the duchess, who, attended by several beauties of the Whig aristocracy, and, among others, by the fascinating Lady Carlisle, carried all before her; another rival canvasser, in addition to the “Diana of Hatfield,” was set up in the person of the Hon. Mrs. Hobart, Lady Buckinghamshire, of “Pic-nic” fame, who, though “fat and fair,” was under “forty,” and remarkably volatile, but, being of portly figure, this dashing lady, a connection of Pitt’s, was by the opposition

nicknamed “Madame Blubber,” and the caricaturists, who represent her as canvassing for Hood and Wray, with a weighty purse by way of inducement, make the electors on whom she has tried her persuasive powers unanimous in asserting “I’m engaged to the Duchess.” Mrs. Hobart was, however, looked upon as a rival of the gracious Georgiana, and many satirical shafts, both by verse and picture, were launched at her full-blown charms. Balloons, as novelties at that time, were exciting a share of attention, and Madame Blubber as the “Ærostatic Dilly,” was, as a balloon “launched at Richmond Park,” shown in mid-air, convoying to the hustings outlying and dependent voters.

“Tho’ in every street
All the voters you meet
The Duchess knows best how to court them,
Yet for outlying votes
In my petticoats,
I’ve found out a way to transport them!

“Eight trips in this way,
For Hood and for Wray,
I’ll make poll sixteen in one day.
Dear Wray, don’t despair,
My supplies by the air
Shall recover our losses on Monday!”

Walpole wrote under date, April 13th:—

“Mr. Fox has all the popularity in Westminster; and, indeed, is so amiable and winning that, could he have stood in person all over England, I question whether he would not have carried the parliament. The beldams hate him; but most of the pretty women in England are indefatigable in making interest for him; the Duchess of Devonshire in particular. I am ashamed to say how coarsely she has been received by some worse than tars. But nothing has shocked me so much as what I heard this morning. At Dover, they roasted a poor *fox* alive by the most diabolical allegory—a savage meanness that an Iroquois could not

have committed!" "During her canvass the Duchess made no scruple of visiting the humblest of the electors, dazzling and enchanting them by the fascination of her manner, the power of her beauty and the influence of her high rank, and sometimes carrying off to the hustings the meanest mechanic in her own carriage."

"The Duchess of Devonshire," writes Lord Cornwallis, on the 19th of April, "is indefatigable in her canvass for Fox. She was in the most blackguard houses in Long Acre by eight o'clock this morning."

The fact of the duchess having purchased the vote of an impracticable butcher by a kiss is said to be unquestionable. It was on one of these occasions that the well-known compliment is said to have been made her by an Irish mechanic, "*I could light my pipe at your eyes.*"

Of great beauty and unconquerable spirit, she tried all her powers of persuasion on the shopkeepers of Westminster, as Earl Stanhope declares in his "Life of Pitt":—

"Other ladies, who could not rival her beauty, might at least follow her example. Scarce a street or alley which they did not canvass on behalf of him whom they persisted in calling the 'Man of the People,' at the very moment when the popular voice was declaring against him."

Pitt and his royal patron were, however, exerting every method to secure the downfall of the redoubtable "Carlo Khan." Up to the third day of the polling, "Fox was in a minority, notwithstanding the immense exertions that were made on his behalf. The Ministerial Party," according to the statement of their own historians, "were sanguine in the hope of wresting from him the greatest and most enlightened, as it was then considered, of all the represented boroughs of England." Pitt's proud spirit was roused at the obstinacy of the contest, and, unlike his more magnanimous if not greater rival, he lost patience with his opponents; in a strain of acrimonious pleasantry he wrote to Wilberforce, "Westminster goes on well in spite of the Duchess of Devonshire and the other *Women of the People*, but when the poll will close is uncertain;" this was on the seventh day of the poll, and Pitt then little dreamt of its running for forty days uninterruptedly. By the

23rd of April, the premier was evidently losing temper, and the strain of electioneering was becoming tenser, as appears from a letter written to his cousin, James Grenville, afterwards Lord Glastonbury:—

“MY DEAR SIR,

“Admiral Hood tells me he left Lord Nugent at Bath, disposed to come to town if a vote at Westminster should be material. I think from the state of the poll it may be very much so. There is no doubt, I believe, of final success on a scrutiny, if we are driven to it; but it is a great object to us to carry the return for both in the first instance, and on every account as great an object to Fox to prevent it. It is uncertain how long the poll will continue, but pretty clear it cannot be over till after Monday. If you will have the goodness to state these circumstances to Lord Nugent, and encourage his good designs, we shall be very much obliged to you; and still more, should neither health nor particular engagements detain you, if, besides prevailing upon him, you could give your own personal assistance. At all events I hope you will forgive my troubling you, and allow for the importunity of a hardened electioneer.... Mainwaring and Wilkes are considerably ahead in Middlesex, and Lord Grimston has come in, instead of Halsey, for Herts.”

Pitt further alludes to W. W. Grenville, his cousin, “the kissing young gentleman” who visited Cowper in the course of his canvass, “I have not yet heard the event of Bucks, but William was safe, and, by the first day’s poll, Aubrey’s prospect seems very good.” John Aubrey was returned second, and William Grenville was at the head of the poll.

Fox’s prospects were gradually improved as concerned his own seat at Westminster; but the slaughter amongst his followers was altogether unexampled, the muster-roll of “Fox’s Martyrs” grew ominously longer as each election was determined. On the twenty-third day of the polling at Covent Garden the Whig chief passed Sir Cecil Wray, and continued to advance until the fortieth, when, by law, the contest closed. On the 17th of May, the poll stood—Lord Hood, 6,694; Fox, 6,237; Sir Cecil Wray, 5,998.

“There was,” writes Earl Stanhope, “strong reason, however, to suspect many fraudulent practices in the previous days, since it seemed clear that the total number of votes recorded was considerably beyond the number of persons entitled to the franchise. For this reason Sir Cecil Wray at once demanded a scrutiny, and the High Bailiff—illegally, as Fox contended—granted the request. But further still, the High Bailiff, Mr. Corbett, who was no friend to Fox, refused to make any legal return until this scrutiny should be decided. Thus Westminster was left for the present destitute of Representatives, and Fox would have been without a seat in the new Parliament but for the friendship of Sir Thomas Dundas, through which he had been already returned the member for the close boroughs of Kirkwall.”

Gallant Whig poetasters were rapturous in their praises of the fair canvassers who were making such havoc in the Tory ranks.



THE WIT'S LAST STAKE; OR, THE COBBLING VOTER AND ABJECT
CANVASSERS. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“Dear Charles, whose eloquence I prize,
To whom my every vote is due,
What shall we now, alas! devise
To cheer our faint desponding crew?

“Well have we fought the hard campaign,
And battled it with all our force:
But self-esteem alone we gain,
Outrun and jockey'd in the course.”

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“THE DUCHESS ACQUITTED; OR, THE TRUE CAUSE OF
THE MAJORITY ON THE WESTMINSTER ELECTION.

“Some strive to wound the virtuous name
 Of Devonshire’s, Duncannon’s fame,
 That beauteous peerless pair;
 And all the toiling earnest throng,
 Let’s celebrate in tuneful song,
 The brunette and the fair.
 When charms conspire, and join their aid,
 What mortal man is not afraid,
 Who can unmov’d remain?
 What heart is safe, whose vote secure,
 When urg’d by the resistless pow’r
 Of Venus and her train?
 Let Slander, with her haggard eye,
 No more blaspheme with hideous cry,
 Th’ indefatigable dame.
 ’Twas Venus in disguise, ’tis said,
 These efforts thro’ the town display’d,
 And her’s alone the blame.
 Than beauty’s force and mighty pow’r,
 Than charms exerted ev’ry hour,
 What greater cause of fear?
 Firm resolution melts away,
 At beauty’s so superior sway,
 And Falsehood seems as fair.
 The heart that still retain’d Love’s fire,
 Unchill’d by age, warm with desire,
 Could not resist their sway;
 ’Twas this rais’d Fox’s numbers higher,
 This did the tardy votes inspire—
 Ah! poor Sir Cecil Wray!”

The Tories in their annoyance resorted to libels of the most ungallant and ungenerous order; they accused the duchess of wholesale bribery, and reported that she had in one instance bought the vote of a butcher with a kiss, a rumour which was immediately seized by the whimsical wits for the

basis of endless exaggerations. “The Devonshire, or Most Approved Method of Securing Votes” embodies the butcher episode. The practice of claiming some slight service, rewarded at election times with extravagant liberality, as a subterfuge for bribery, is shown in the duchess engaging an elector to put a stitch in her shoe, and illustrated as “The Wit’s Last Stake; or, the Cobbling Voter and Abject Canvassers.”

Besides “The Devonshire, or Most Approved Method of Securing Votes,” two caricatures appeared on the 12th of April from Rowlandson’s prolific graver: one, exhibiting the struggle between the fair canvassers arrayed in rivalry at Covent Garden hustings, under the symbol of “The Poll:” a balancing plank, whereon the beauteous Georgiana “Devon’s Queen,” is elevated high in the air, while her stouter rival, the Hon. Mrs. Hobart (Lady Buckinghamshire), is overweighing her extremely. Above the heads of the group, which includes the rival candidates, Fox, Hood, and Wray, flutters a placard, “The Rival Candidates, a Farce.” Against Wray was revived, in allusion to the Court patronage under which he was fighting, the well-worn cry of “Slavery and wooden shoes,” and much stress was laid on the extreme measure of polling the Guards as householders; in reference to the two hundred and eighty votes given by soldiers at one time in a body—an astounding manœuvre, which shocked constitutional minds—appeared the placard:—

“All Horse Guards, Grenadier Guards, Foot Guards, and Black-Guards, that have not polled for the destruction of Chelsea Hospital and the Tax on Maidservants are desired to meet at the *Gutter Hole*, opposite the Horse Guards, where they will have a full bumper of *knock-me-down* and plenty of *soap-suds*, before they go to the poll for Sir Cecil Wray or eat. N.B.—Those who have no shoes or stockings may come without, *there being a quantity of wooden shoes provided for them.*”

A further presentment of the famous canvassing duchess, whose prominence at the great Westminster election of 1784 gave her such universal and lasting celebrity, is offered by Rowlandson in a fanciful domestic interior at Devonshire House, where the favoured candidate, Fox, and his staunch and invaluable ally, “brave Sammy House,” are introduced

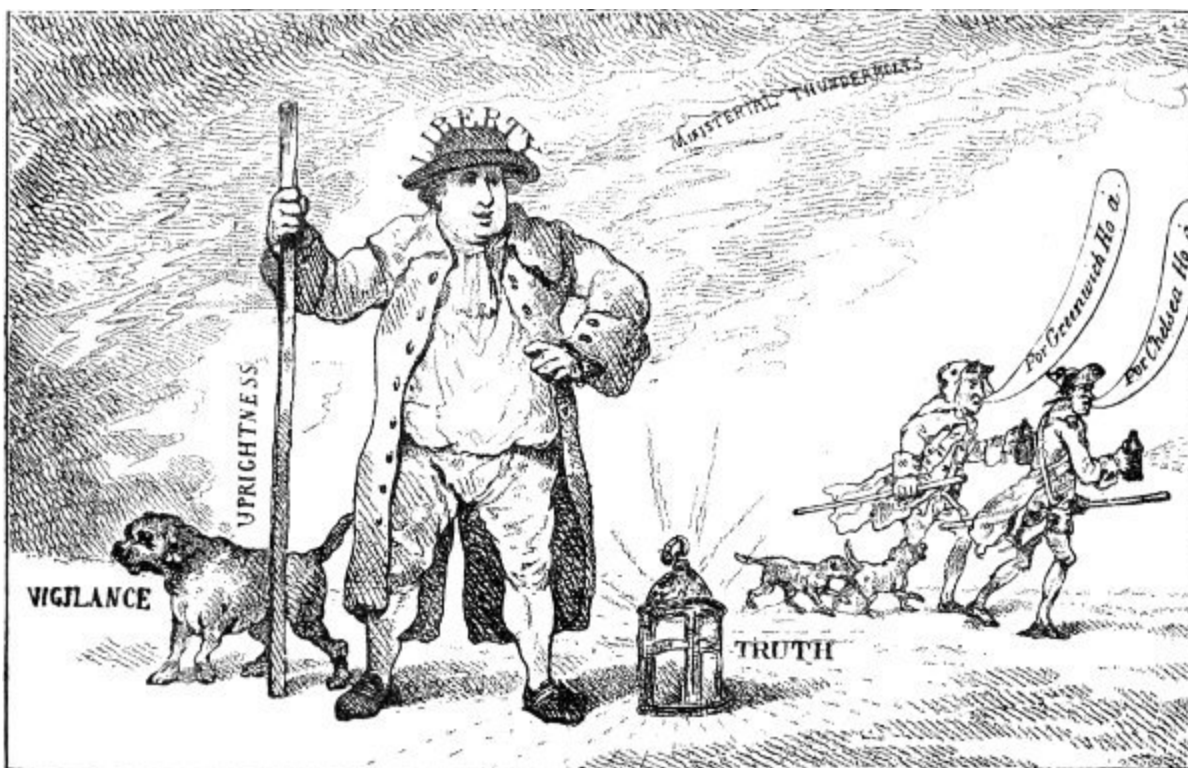
as “Lords of the Bedchamber” (April 14, 1784). In the caricaturist’s highly imaginary version, the duchess is entertaining the pair with a cup of tea in her boudoir; above her hangs the Reynolds portrait of her liege-lord. Sam House, in his publican’s jacket, otherwise attired in that neat costume which became historical, is stirring the cup “that cheers but not inebriates” with an air of supreme contentment, while Fox is patting, in friendly familiarity, the no less remarkable completely bald head of his indefatigable supporter by way of encouragement.



Sam House. Fox. Duchess of Devonshire.

LORDS OF THE BEDCHAMBER. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

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Fox. Hood. Wray.

THE WESTMINSTER WATCHMAN. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

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The third plate, “The Westminster Watchman,” is inscribed—

“To the Independent Electors of Westminster, this Print of their staunch old watchman, the guardian of their rights and privileges, is dedicated by a grateful Elector. N.B.—Beware of Counterfeits, as the Greenwich and Chelsea Watchmen are upon the look-out!”

Fox is standing firm, with his cap of “Liberty;” and the lamp of “Truth” is shedding its light around, the Whig chief is unmoved by the storm of “ministerial thunderbolts;” a trusty dog, “Vigilance,” is by his side; the “Counterfeits” are shuffling off, Hood for Greenwich, and Wray for Chelsea.

The ballads, epigrams, and poetical *jeux d’esprit* to which the circumstances of this famous contest gave birth are sufficiently numerous to

fill a volume. The rhymsters on both sides were evidently resolved to do their best: many of the lyrics and “squibs” are worthy of preservation; they are as a rule far above the average compositions evoked upon similar occasions. The tuneful songster, Captain Morris, wrote many of the most graceful and witty “impromptus” and verses. The bards of “Opposition” were severe upon the Court influence exerted against Fox’s cause, and justly exposed some of the manœuvres resorted to by Pitt’s adherents.

“To the will of the Court we are told to consent,
And never to do as we please, Sir;
If we vote against FOX we’re forgiven our rent,
Or else we must forfeit our lease, Sir.
Thus of freedom and rights poor electors they chouse,
Such slaves and such fools we are grown, Sir,
We must vote a Rogue into the Parliament House,
Or else be turned out of our own, Sir.”

It was the old story of intimidation, undue influence, and coercion, as practised at the Westminster elections for the best part of a century. The scene of the hustings is thus sketched:—

“A CONCISE DESCRIPTION OF COVENT GARDEN AT THE PRESENT WESTMINSTER ELECTION.

“A paradise for fools and knaves;
A hell for constables and slaves;
A booth for mountebanks and beavers;
A shop for marrow-bones and cleavers;
A stage for bulls and Irish chairmen;
A pit for Foxes, for to rear ’em:
In short, such are most glorious places(?)
For Duchesses to show their faces!”

Allusions to the machinations of “the King’s Friends” were abundant:

“STANZAS IN SEASON.

“It would not do! Black Thurlow’s frown
And Billy’s prudence gain’d the prize;
'Tis Beauty must redeem the crown,
And Fox must reign thro’ Devon’s eyes.
She saw, she conquer’d; Wray shrunk back;
Court mandates we no more obey;
Majorities no more they pack,
And Fox and Freedom win the day!
Who can deny when beauty sues?
And where’s the tongue can blame her Grace;
Not timid slavery can refuse:
Her life’s as spotless as her face.”

The countenance shown to Fox by the youthful rank, fashion, and wealth of the day excited the bitterness of Tory rhymsters. The active partisanship of the Prince of Wales was a source of caustic recrimination and envy:—

“Since Britain’s great Prince condescends to evince
His concern in your future election,
How happy each Cobbler, Butcher, Smith, and Pot-wobbler,
Who shall merit the Royal protection!

“For goodness consider the rank of the bidder,
Who offers so much for your plumpers:
What’s the Nation or Pitt, to the Prince and Tom Tit!
Dash such stuff—and to Fox fill your bumpers.”

Arrayed on the Whig chief's side was all the beauty and grace of fair and fascinating wives and daughters of the Whig aristocracy, a bevy of lovely political Circes, whose enchantments were all potent:—

“ON SEEING LADY BEAUCHAMP, LADY CARLISLE, AND
LADY DERBY IN THEIR CARRIAGES, ON MR. FOX'S SIDE
OF THE HUSTINGS.

“The gentle Beauchamp, and the fair Carlisle,
Around their favour'd Fox expectant wait;
And Derby's lip suspends the ready smile,
To ask 'the Poll?' and 'what is Charles's fate?'

“But say, ye *belles*, whose beauty all admit,
Do you in politics dispute the prize;
Or do ye near the Hustings proudly sit,
To take the *suffrage* of admiring eyes?“

The Duchess of Devonshire was idolized by enthusiastic Whigs,
who hailed in her the salvation of the cause:—

“Let Pitt and Wray dislike the fair,
Decry our Devon's matchless merit;
A braver, kinder soul we wear,
And love her *beauty*, love her *spirit*.
Let distant times and ages know,
When Temple would have made us slaves,
'Tis thus we ward the fatal blow,
'Tis Fox that beats—'tis Devon saves!”

“ON SEEING THE DUCHESS OF DEVONSHIRE, LADY
DUNCANNON, ETC., CANVASSING FOR MR. FOX.

“Sure Heav’n approves of Fox’s cause
(Tho’ slaves at Court abhor him);
To vote for Fox, then, who can pause,
Since *angels* canvass for him.”

“ON A CERTAIN DUCHESS.

“Her mien like Cytherea’s dove,
Her lips like Hybla’s honey;
Who would not give a vote for love,
Unless he wanted money?”

Walpole’s lovely nieces, the three Ladies Waldegrave, added the influence of their charms to those of the winsome Georgiana, and were gallantly apostrophized with “Devon’s Queen:”—

“Fair DEVON all good English hearts must approve,
And the WALDGRAVES (God bless their sweet faces),
The Duchess she looks like the sweet Queen of love
And they like the three Sister Graces.”

The influence of this novel captivation upon the hearts of those so happy as to be admitted to the electoral franchise acted like magic:—

“There’s Devonshire’s Duchess, all beauty and grace,
Each morning so early she shows her sweet face;
Tho’ ever so envious, all must her extol,
Then rouse up your spirits, and come to the poll.”

“EPIGRAM ON THE DUCHESS OF DEVONSHIRE.

“Array’d in matchless beauty, Devon’s fair
In Fox’s favour takes a zealous part,
But oh! where’er the pilferer comes—beware!
She supplicates a vote, and steals a heart.”

The compliments poured forth at the altar of this fair divinity were not alone addressed to the beauty of her face, the grace of her person, the excellence of her heart, and her captivating manners,—her intellectual charms also secured due recognition:—

“IMPROMPTU ON HER GRACE OF DEVONSHIRE.

“Whilst Devon’s Duchess for Fox takes a part,
Whilst she asks for your *vote*, she engages your heart;
Can beauty alone such influence sway?
Can the fairest of fair make all mortals obey?—
Oh no; for her empire is over the mind,
And *beauty* with *reason* in her is combin’d.”



Fox.

Wray.

Hood.

THE CASE IS ALTERED. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

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Although every concession was made to the empire of Beauty, many of the verses were slyly sarcastic, while some of the caricatures were strongly coloured by the uncompromising coarseness of the age:—

“ODE TO THE DUCHESS OF DEVONSHIRE.

“Hail, Duchess! first of womankind,
Far, far you leave your sex behind,
With you none can compare;
For who but you, from street to street,
Would run about a vote to get,
Thrice, thrice bewitching fair!
Each day you visit every shop,
Into each house your head you pop,
Nor do you act the prude;
For ev’ry man salutes your Grace,
Some kiss your hand, and some your face,
And some are rather rude.”

“THE PARADOX OF THE TIMES.

“See modest Duchesses, no longer nice
In Virtue’s honour, haunt the sinks of Vice;
In Freedom’s cause, the guilty bribe convey,
And perjur’d wretches piously betray:
Seduced by Devon, and the Paphian crew,
What cannot Venus and the Graces do?—
Devon, not Fox, obtains the glorious prize,
Not public merit, but resistless eyes.”

As an antidote to the bitterness there was, however, a surfeit of
“sweets:”—

“A NEW SONG, TO THE TUNE OF ‘LET THE TOAST PASS.’

“To Fox and to Freedom we give our support,
Every Englishman feels it his duty,
When their cause is attack’d by the pow’r of the Court,
And defended by Virtue and Beauty.”

The turn of affairs which placed Fox in a majority over Sir Cecil Wray, who for some time was in advance of the Whig chief, is summed up by Rowlandson, amongst other caricaturists, as “The Case is altered” (April 29, 1784). The election had nearly another three weeks to run, but already the satirists were forecasting the result. Fox, be it remembered, had other resources in reserve, and, at the close of the poll, when Wray demanded a scrutiny, and the high bailiff illegally declined to make his return, he was seated for Kirkwall. In the caricaturist’s version, the election has already settled Wray’s chances, and Fox is magnanimously driving off his defeated opponent, and late dependent, to Lincoln: the ministerial candidate is travelling, “without drums or trumpets,” smuggled away from the exciting platform of the hustings, in the “Lincolnshire caravan for paupers;” he is buried in self-contemplation,—“I always was a poor dog, but now I am worse than ever.” The generous Fox, charioteering his renegade *protégé*, is volunteering, “I will drive you to Lincoln, where you may superintend the *small beer* and *brickdust*.” Lord Hood’s majority was safe at the head of the poll,—for no reason which history has made manifest; he is pictured as suddenly surprising the degrading pauper-conveyance, and, in compassion for his late colleague, is exclaiming, much moved at these reverses, “Alas, poor Wray!”



MAN HAS HIS HOBBY-HORSE
—FOX AND THE DUCHESS OF
DEVONSHIRE.

The doings of the Duchess of Devonshire, her sister, Lady Duncannon, and their fair following of female canvassers are pictorially treated by the caricaturist in his version of "The Procession to the Hustings after a Successful Canvass," in which a select group of outlying voters, secured after much exertion, are seen conducted in triumph, and with "rough music," to the polling-place. The circumstance that, chiefly owing to the opportune assistance of the Duchess, Fox was placed second on the poll was commemorated in "Every Man has his Hobby-horse." Fox may truly be said to have been carried into the House of Commons by his fair coadjutor.



THE PROCESSION TO THE HUSTINGS AFTER A SUCCESSFUL CANVASS.
BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“Come, haste to the Hustings, all honest Electors,
No menace, no brib’ry shall keep us away:
Of Freedom and Fox be for ever protectors,
We scorn to desert them, like Sir Cecil Wray.

“Then come, ev’ry free, ev’ry generous soul,
That loves a fine girl and a fine flowing bowl,
Come here in a body, and all of you poll
’Gainst Sir Cecil Wray.

“For had he to women been ever a friend,
Nor by taxing *them* tried our old taxes to mend,
Yet so *stingy* he is, that none can contend
For Sir Cecil Wray.”

The fact that Wray—who, as a double “Renegado,” shortly rejoined the Whigs—appears to have gained but scant sympathy, was defeated and done for, is turned to satirical account in a travestied view of Fox, North, and the Duchess—the latter wearing a foxtail in her hat—“For the Benefit of the Champion.—A Catch, to be performed at the New Theatre, Covent Garden. For admission apply to the Duchess. N.B.—*Gratis* to those who wear large tails;” the lady is pointing to a headstone put up in memory of “Poor Cecil Wray, Dead and turned to Clay.”



Duchess of Devonshire.

Charles James Fox.

Lord North.

FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE CHAMPION—A CATCH. DEFEAT OF THE
MINISTERIAL CANDIDATE, SIR CECIL WRAY, WESTMINSTER ELECTION.
1784. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“Oh! help Judas, lest he fall into the Pitt of Ingratitude!!!”

“The *prayers* of all bad Christians, Heathens, Infidels, and Devil’s Agents, are most earnestly requested for their dear friend JUDAS ISCARIOT, Knight of the *back-stairs*, lying at the period of political dissolution, having received a dreadful wound from the exertions of the lovers of liberty and the constitution, in the poll of the last ten days at the Hustings, nigh unto the Place of Cabbages.”

The fate of Wray, with Fox reinstated in his seat for Westminster, and the concluding election scenes at Covent Garden are figured in “The Westminster Deserter Drumm’d out of the Regiment.” Sam House, with his perfectly bald head, and dressed in the clean and natty nankeen jacket and trousers, his invariable wear summer and winter, is drumming Wray off the stage: “May all Deserters feel Public Resentment”—is the sentiment of both the indignant Chelsea veterans and buxom maid-servants to whom Wray’s projects had given mortal offence. “The Man of the People” is planting the standard of Liberty and Britannia, and acknowledging his gratitude to his supporters with simple fervour—“Friends and fellow-citizens, I cannot find words to express my feelings to you on the victory.”

Finally, as an apotheosis of the fair champion who had contributed most of all to the success and glory of the triumph over the Court, Rowlandson etched the allegorical picture of “Liberty and Fame introducing Female Patriotism to Britannia.”

At the close of the poll, Fox was 235 votes ahead of Wray, but, as related, the high bailiff, Corbett, acting partially, refused to return him on the plea that a scrutiny had been demanded; Fox was also a candidate for Kirkwall, so that, in case of defeat at Westminster he might still have a seat.

At the end of the election there was an immense crowd collected for the chairing of Fox. A classic car was prepared, an improvement on the perilous glory of being hoisted on the shoulders of excited chairmen, or, worse still, lifted on those of volunteers—intoxicated alike with enthusiasm and drinking toasts. The Whig chief mounted his triumphal chariot; a multitudinous procession following, closed by the state-carriages of the Duchesses of Portland and Devonshire, drawn by six horses each. Fox descended from the car at Devonshire House, where was erected a temporary scaffolding, on which was raised a bevy of notabilities, including the Prince of Wales, with the Duke and Duchess of Devonshire, to whose exertions Fox owed a debt of gratitude. A commemorative dinner was given at Willis’s Rooms, where Fox made a glowing speech on the subject of the election. The Prince of Wales, after attending the king at a review at Ascot, rode up St. James’s Street in his uniform, and was received with acclamations, in acknowledgment of his partisanship for the Whig chief,

whose favours he wore,—and ended his day of triumph by dining at Devonshire House, where he appeared wearing Fox's colours (the Washington uniform), and with a laurel branch in token of victory.



Sir Cecil Wray.

Sam House.

Charles James Fox.

THE WESTMINSTER DESERTER DRUMMED OUT OF THE REGIMENT.
DEFEAT OF SIR CECIL WRAY. HUSTINGS, COVENT GARDEN, WESTMINSTER
ELECTION. 1784. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“Sir Cecil, be aisy, I won’t be unshivil
Now the Man of the Paple is chose in your stead;
From swate Covent Garden you’re flung to the Divil,
By Jabers, Sir Cecil, you’ve bodder’d your head.

“To be sure, much avail to you all your fine spaiches,
’Tis nought but palaver, my honey, my dear,
While all Charley’s voters stick to him like laiches,
A friend to our liberties and our small beer.

“The Irish Chairmen to Sir Cecil Wray.”

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LIBERTY AND FAME INTRODUCING FEMALE PATRIOTISM (DUCHESS OF DEVONSHIRE) TO BRITANNIA. 1784. BY T. ROWLANDSON.

“She smiles,
Infused with a Fortitude from Heaven.”—SHAKESPEARE, *The Tempest*.

“Let envy rail and disappointment rage,
Still Fox shall prove the wonder of the age!

“Triumph and Fame shall every step attend
His King’s best subject and his country’s friend!”

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The party rejoicings and festivities at the conclusion of this election are felicitously related by Wraxall, who enjoyed the advantages of himself participating in the scenes he pictures. “Still the Whigs were not to be disappointed of their ovation. The exultation of those gay times forms a strange contrast to the grim monotony of our own. Fox, after being chaired in great pomp through the streets, was finally carried into the court-yard of Carlton House. The Prince’s plume was on his banners in acknowledgment of princely partisanship. A banner, inscribed ‘Sacred to Female Patriotism,’ recorded the services of the Duchess. The carriages of the Dukes of Devonshire and Portland, each drawn by six horses, moved in procession, and Fox’s own carriage was a pile of rejoicing Whiggism. On its boxes and traces, and where they could, sat Colonel North, afterwards Lord Guilford; Adam, who but a few years before wounded the patriot in a duel; and a whole cluster of political friends, followers, and expectants. The prince came to the balustrade before the house⁶⁴ to cheer him, with a crowd of fashionable people. Fox finished the triumph by an harangue to the mob, and they in return finished by a riot, an illumination, and breaking Lord Temple’s windows.

“But the festivities were scarcely begun. The prince threw open his showy apartments to the nobility, and gave them a brilliant *fête* in the gardens, which happened to be at its height just when the king was passing through St. James’s Park in state to open the new parliament. The rival interests were within a brick wall of each other, and their spirit could not

have been more strangely contrasted than in their occupations. But nights and days to those graceful pursuers of pleasure and politics alike knew no intermission. On that very evening the celebrated beautiful and witty Mrs. Crewe gave a brilliant rout, in which ‘blue and buff’ were the universal costume of both sexes; the buff and blue were the uniform of Washington and his troops, and imprudently adopted by Fox to declare his hostility to the Government. The prince himself appeared in the party colours. At supper, he toasted the fair giver of the feast in the words ‘True Blue and Mrs. Crewe.’ The lady, not unskilfully, and with measureless applause, returned it by another, ‘True Blue and all of you.’”

With the enforced termination of the polling at the fortieth day, arrived the demand of Wray for a scrutiny, and the high bailiff’s unjustifiable attitude, for which he subsequently suffered severely, of declining to make a return, compelled Fox to look elsewhere for a seat, or find no place in the coming parliament, where, as Walpole said, could Fox have stood for every seat in the kingdom he would have represented the entire return in his own person, such was his influence and popularity. “The Departure,” (May 18, 1784), the day succeeding the close of the poll, shows Fox leaving behind him the palatial abode of his warm supporter, the Prince of Wales, and taking leave of his delectable champions, the Duchess of Devonshire and her sister, the fair Lady Duncannon, *en route* for “Coventry” or “Out-in-the-cold-shire.” Fox is observing on his retreat:—

“If that a scrutiny at last takes place,
I can’t tell how ’twill be, and please your Grace!”

Fox’s early ally, Burke, equipped as an outrider, is prepared to drive his friend away from the scene of his triumphs; under Edmund’s arm is a “plan of economy,” suggestive of necessary retrenchments in the Whig camp.



DEFEAT OF THE HIGH AND MIGHTY BALISSIMO CORBETTINO AND HIS FAMED CECILIAN FORCES, ON THE PLAINS OF ST. MARTIN, ON THURSDAY, THE 3RD DAY OF FEBRUARY, 1785, BY THE CHAMPION OF THE PEOPLE AND HIS CHOSEN BAND.

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Among the tactics of the Ministerialists may be reckoned the ominous “scrutiny,” which was threatened directly Fox’s votes began to outnumber those in favour of his rival, Wray. On Fox’s success this intention was carried out, the returning officer acting partially in order to connive at the manœuvre; a scrutiny being notoriously a tedious, lengthy, and costly affair, and hence more vexations to Fox than to the combined forces of his opponents. This circumstance is illustrated by the caricaturist, nearly a twelvemonth later; when the excitement of the protracted contest had cooled down, Fox secured another victory over his adversaries, which is commemorated in Rowlandson’s version of the affair (March 7, 1785), entitled:—

“Defeat of the high and mighty Balissimo Corbettino and his famed Cecilian forces, on the plains of St. Martin, on Thursday, the 3rd day of February, 1785, by the Champion of the People and his chosen band, after a smart skirmish, which lasted a considerable time, in which many men were lost on both sides. But their great ally at length losing ground, desertions took place, and notwithstanding their vast superiority in numbers and weight of metal at the first onset, this increased apace, altho’ often rallied by the ablest man in command, till at length the forces gave way in all quarters, and they were totally overthrown. This print is dedicated to the Electors of the City and Liberty of Westminster, who have so nobly stood forth and supported their champion upon this trying occasion, by AN INDEPENDENT ELECTOR.”

Rowlandson has pictured the rival combatants at the head of their learned forces. Fox’s lawyers are triumphant, and armed with such legal weapons as “Eloquence,” “Truth,” “Perseverance,” and “Law;” the Whig chief, in person, is dealing vengeance upon the disconcerted figures of his antagonists, Wray and Corbett. Fox had successfully prosecuted his action and recovered heavy damages against the bailiff, who, as a courtier, had made himself the tool of the Ministerialists. Fox is defended by his buckler, “Majority 38;” he is wielding the keen sword of “Justice;” a laurel crown is placed on the chieftain’s brow by a celestial messenger, who is charged with the decision of the Law Court—“It is ordered that Thomas Corbett, Esq., do immediately return.” Fox is declaring:—

“The wrath of my indignation is kindled, and I will pursue them with a mighty hand and outstretched arm until justice is done to those who have so nobly supported me.”

Sir Cecil Wray’s defence of “Ingratitude” is a sorry shield for the protection of himself or of his fallen ally; his sword is broken; in despair he cries, “My knees wax feeble, and I sink beneath the weight of my own apostasy.” The high bailiff is cast down; he confesses, “My conscience is now at peace.” Another supporter of the returning officer is exclaiming, “Help, help! our chief is fallen. O conscience, support me!” Corbett’s lawyers have turned their abashed backs on their client and his cause: “Nor law, nor conscience,

nor the aid of potent Ministers, can e'er support the contest 'gainst such a chief!" "Our support is gone, and we are fallen into a Pitt; yea, even into a deep Pitt!"—the premier having been unable to protect the guilty against the consequences of their act.

CHAPTER XI.

REMARKABLE ELECTIONS AND POLITICAL MEETINGS, 1788 TO 1807.

We have seen Admiral Lord Hood's energetic canvass at the great Westminster election, when, with the powerful assistance of the Court, he fought the Whigs, but failed to hinder Fox's election. In spite of the victory gained in 1784 by their opponents, four years later the ministerialists and the "king's friends" were again forced into a fresh contest on the same field, and more ignominiously defeated; the popular Lord Hood, their chosen champion, having in July, 1788, been appointed to a seat at the Admiralty Board, as a recognition of his services to Government, a fresh election was necessary for the city of Westminster. The Whigs were still to the front, and Lord John Townshend came forward and canvassed in that interest, with such strong support from the Opposition that the ministers now experienced a more inglorious reverse, their candidate being unseated, although recourse was had to every expedient, lawful or otherwise, that could promote the return of Hood, the Government nominee. After the close of the poll, which showed Lord John Townshend with 6392 votes, to Lord Hood's 5569, thus giving two Whig members for Westminster, Gillray exposed the corrupt practices of the Court agents in the caricature, published on August 14, 1788, entitled, "Election Troops Bringing in their Accounts to the Pay-Table." The premier is seen behind the bars of the Treasury gates; the undisguised and direct applications of his quondam allies are so compromising that it is inexpedient to admit the claimants, or acknowledge an acquaintance with such disreputable connections; but a saving compromise is suggested. Pitt is made to plausibly protest, "I know nothing of you, my friends. Lord Hood pays all the expenses himself;" then, in a whisper, "Hush! go to the back-door in Great George Street, under the Rose." Sir George Rose was Pitt's secretary and *factotum*; he is chiefly seen

in the contemporary satires as associated with what was called “back-stairs influence,” of which he may be accepted as chamberlain; his scene of operations was generally represented as the “back-door of the Treasury,” where he diplomatically carried out the stratagems of the premier—especially, as in the present instance—in the indirect recognition of secret services.



ELECTION TROOPS BRINGING THEIR ACCOUNTS TO THE PAY TABLE,
WESTMINSTER. 1788.

BY JAMES GILLRAY.

Foremost in the rank of election troops is the modish Major Topham, a conspicuous personage in his day, who frequently appears in the caricatures of the time; his notoriety was due to the *World*, a society newspaper of the last century, of which the major was proprietor, editor, and fashionable

gossip-monger. Topham has brought a copy of his organ to prove the active support he had lent the Government during the Westminster contest, and is the first to present his bill “for puffs and squibs, and for abusing the Opposition.”



AN
INDEPENDENT
ELECTOR.

A ragged newsboy from the *Star* has also brought his journal and a claim for payment “for changing sides, for hiring ballad-singers, and Grub Street writers.” As usual, some scenes of a desperate character had marked the election, and three downright bullies, giant troopers of the Guards, with ensanguined bayonets as evidence of their late employment, demand pay “for the attack in Bow Street;” a publican brings in a reckoning “for eating and drinking for jackass boys;” ballad-singers have come to claim “five shillings a day” for their professional services; a cobbler, with Hood’s cockade, presents a modest bill “for voting three times” as “an independent elector;” a clothesman of the Hebrew persuasion is clamouring for money “for perjury, and procuring Jew voters;” and a body of Hood’s sailors,

armed with formidable cudgels, are come for payment “for kicking up a row,”—as in the election of 1784, Hood’s boisterous sailors were brought up to the hustings to support their admiral, and were particularly violent and reckless in their zeal for the cause, intimidating those voters who were recognized as favouring the opposite party, and forcibly keeping them away from the polling booth. These jolly Jack Tars, with perfect singleness of mind, and oblivious of nice distinctions which they did not understand, were filled to overflowing with explosive loyalty for the king, and fealty for their admiral; but on this occasion the sailors were beaten by the Irish chairmen with hearty goodwill, and, with their patron, Lord Hood, experienced a defeat.

In 1790, it is consolatory to find that the gallant Lord Hood was again returned for Westminster; Fox heading the poll with 3516 votes; Hood, as a good second, with 3217: on this occasion the Whigs lost a seat, for John Horne Tooke, although so prominent a figure, failed to repeat the success of Lord John Townshend, 1679 votes were polled for the “Parson of Brentford,” otherwise John Horne Tooke, the celebrated philologist.

Curious anomalies were witnessed under the old boroughmongering system, anterior to the sweeping measure of reform. Helston, in Cornwall, was a typical case. The elective franchise was formerly invested in the corporation, which consisted of the mayor, who was the returning officer, eleven aldermen, and twenty-five common council-men, thirty-six in all. The old charter of Elizabeth was confirmed by Charles I., and, according to common report, there survived but one elector under this charter in 1790, to whose lot accordingly fell the unusual distinction of nominating two representatives on his own account.

The family interest of the Osbornes (Duke of Leeds) proved so paramount as to here prevent any hope of successfully contesting against their power.

It is interesting to find that a certain grace was lent to the generally discordant elements of electioneering by the zealous participation of Beauty in the canvassing department, where the seductive wiles of female charms and persuasions were relied upon, it is understood, with reason.

“——a faithful few
Worth more than all a Sultan's retinue.
They point the path, the missing phrase supply,
Oft prompt a name, and hint with hand or eye,
Back each bold pledge, the fervid speech admire,
And still add fuel to their leader's fire.”
(J. STIRLING, *The Election*.)



PROOF OF THE REFINED FEELINGS OF AN AMIABLE CHARACTER,
LATELY A CANDIDATE FOR A CERTAIN ANCIENT CITY. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

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The assistance of the fair sex was much relied upon for soliciting and securing votes; but at such turbulent times, when licence predominated, the electioneering Circes must have been prepared for brusque exchanges of

pleasantry, though hardly for such encounters as the one preserved in Gillray's "Proof of the Refined Feelings of an Amiable Character, lately a Candidate for a Certain Ancient City."

Some obscurity surrounds the incident represented; obviously the caricature was destined for electioneering purposes, but the positive history cannot be traced. It is assumed that the three circumstances of the candidate being "an eccentric," a sportsman, and a representative of a cathedral city point to Sir Charles Turner (created a baronet by the Marquis of Rockingham in 1782), who represented York from 1768 to 1783. This gentleman always dressed as a sportsman, wearing a green coat, "tally-ho" buttons, with top-boots, etc., upon all occasions; he was described by Coombe (*Royal Register*) as the "Marplot" of his own party, "and in his parliamentary capacity demands the pity of his friends, the contempt of the wise, and makes himself a laughing stock for the crowd." On the discussion of Pitt's motion for parliamentary reform, May 7, 1782, Sir Charles Turner by his blunt originality attracted more attention than either the mover or seconder; he declared—

"that in his opinion the House of Commons might be justly considered as a parcel of thieves, who, having stolen an estate, were apprehensive of allowing any person to see their title deeds, from the fear of again losing it by such an inspection."

The personage depicted by Gillray is flourishing his whip "Pro bono Patriæ," and forcibly demonstrating his aversion to rival canvassers of the gentle sex, much to the consternation of the ecclesiastical hierarchy and gownsmen, while the rough townsmen are cheering their eccentric candidate, and promising to support him.

It is to Gillray that we owe the version embodying the glorification of autocratic boroughmongering as "The Pacific Entrance of Earl Wolf into Blackhaven," January, 1792. Before Lord Grey's Reform Bill altered the constituencies, in the sordid old days of corrupt influence, when the representative system of electing parliaments was purely theoretical, a certain number of territorial magnates apportioned about half the constituencies between them; of this, the "upper order," or aristocratic patrons, trafficked in the seats in exchange for "honours" for themselves, or

lent their boroughs to support ministerial influence in return for places and pensions, or offices—sinecures for choice—in which to provide for their less opulent relations; thus in the old lists of place-holders, pensioners, and “ministerial patronage” may be traced the younger sons and cousins in several degrees, besides the names of those who have by marriage entered the families of the prime holders of “marketable ware,” otherwise parliamentary interest. When boroughmongering was a profession—a very highly paid one—and boroughs were farmed for sale, it might be expected that a less elevated class of adventurers would treat the question of buying and selling “seats” in parliament like any ordinary item of commerce, as was the fact; the markets fluctuated, thus we find Lord Chesterfield, whose authority is unquestionable, looking round for some venal borough to bring in that young hopeful to whom he addressed the famous “Letters,” thinking it a finishing part of a gentleman’s training to be in the House; the ex-ambassador communicated with an agent, proposing to pay “twenty-four hundred pounds for a seat,” presumably the price in Chesterfield’s younger days; but he found seats had risen to inordinate rates—up to five thousand pounds—owing to imported competition, chiefly rich factors returned home with fortunes from the East and West Indies. Bubb Dodington has set down in his “Diary” how he, the lordly proprietor of this said “marketable ware,” went about bargaining to bring in ministerial nominees for his five or six seats in exchange for places at the disposal of the administration; and instances might be multiplied to a tedious extent from the journals of the House containing the evidence of trafficking in boroughs and buying up voters, *en gros et en détail*, as disclosed on controverted elections.

This condition of affairs produced a mechanical majority as long as the prime minister in power could command wealth and influence sufficient to secure a larger number of seats than the opposition. It was in this direction that the famous electioneering genius, the Marquis of Wharton, spent a hundred thousand pounds in William III. and Queen Anne’s days; while Walpole manipulated such huge sums, thinly disguised as “Secret Service Money,” that, never wealthy enough to purchase all, and meeting occasional honest members, he was, at intervals, impeached for corruption in a House two-thirds venal, as it is alleged.

Walpole's successors, who finally drove him from office, bought elections on even a more extended scale; the Pelhams were clever dissemblers and apt negotiators for this commodity; it was written of the Duke of Newcastle, by his antagonist, Lord Hervey, it is believed:—

“And since his estate at Elections he'll spend,
And beggar himself without making a friend;
So while the extravagant fool has a sous,
As his brains I can't fear, so his fortune I'll use.”

Major Cartwright, the advocate of universal suffrage, who had the misfortune to live a trifle before the times were ripe enough for reform to be carried, addressed a petition to parliament in 1820, showing “that 97 Lords usurped 200 seats in the Commons House in violation of our Laws and Liberties;” while 90 wealthy commoners “for 102 vile sinks of corruption (pocket boroughs) brought in the House 137 members;” Ministerial patronage returning another twenty, thus giving, according to the petitioner's statistics, “a total of 353 members corruptly or tyrannically imposed on the Commons in gross violation of the law, and to the palpable subversion of the constitution.” At that time the Earl of Lonsdale commanded eight seats, as did the Earl of Darlington. William Pitt, as already described, was seated in Parliament, 1781, by Lonsdale, then Sir James Lowther, who had been stigmatized by “Junius” as “The contemptuous tyrant of the North,” and who himself declared that he was in possession of the land, the fire, and the water of Whitehaven. When the youthful Pitt became premier, one of his first acts was to acknowledge his obligations to “the Wolf,” and Lowther was raised to the peerage as Earl Lonsdale. The “pacific entrance” of this plutocrat shows the docile “free and independent voters” of Whitehaven, driven by Lonsdale's law agent, and lashed with thongs of “sham suits at law,” dragging the earl through the tumble-down streets of his town, every window being illuminated with candles in his honour. He exclaims, “Dear gentlemen, this is too much; now you really distress me!” Mobs of his miners are cheering vociferously, he having brought the townsmen to submission by suspending the working of his coal-mines. Fair canvassers, with complimentary inscriptions on their banners, head the triumphal procession:—

“The Blues are bound in adamantine chains
But freedom round each ‘Yellow’ mansion reigns!”

Before the parliamentary dissolution of 1796, the country was in an agitated state, for distress was prevalent among the poorer classes, the expenses of the continental wars were impoverishing the country, and there was a general outcry for peace; bread riots were common at the time, and the price of provisions in general was exceptionally high; political agitators were taking advantage of these circumstances to fulminate against the king and his ministers; while the various societies, called “seditious” by the Tories in office, received encouragement from the Whig party, whose prospects of succeeding to power were not encouraging. A meeting of an enthusiastic nature, largely attended, had been held in St. George’s Fields, the scene of the former riots, to petition for annual parliaments, and for universal suffrage, theories which at that time were regarded hopefully, and which would, it was anticipated, redress existing grievances. In the autumn of 1795, meetings were held at Copenhagen Fields, where an immense multitude assembled to sign addresses and remonstrances on the state of the nation. The immediate consequences of the inflammatory orations pronounced to the people on this occasion was that, on the opening of the final session of the parliament which had assembled in 1790, the king, on his way to the Peers to open the House in state, was assailed by vociferous cries of “Give us peace and bread!” “No war!” “No king!” “Down with him! down with George!” Before the House of Peers was reached, an attack was made on the royal carriage, stones were thrown, and one passed through the window. The riot on this occasion was made the pretext for the ministry to bring forward new bills for the defence of the king’s person, and to attempt further infringements on the liberty of the subject by interfering with the right of public meetings.



ENTRANCE OF EARL WOLF (LORD LONSDALE) INTO BLACKHAVEN.
1792. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

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“E’en by the elements his power confessed,
Of mines and boroughs Lonsdale stands possessed;
And one sad servitude alike denotes
The slaves that labour and the slave that votes.”

(*Rolliad.*)

The political clubs renewed their clamours for a more extended system of representation freed from corruption, and protested against Pitt’s new enactments; the London Corresponding Society called another public meeting, at which the premier is said to have shown symptoms of alarm. Gillray’s engraving of a meeting of “Patriotic Citizens at Copenhagen House,” November 16, 1795, satirizes the order of agitators and their disciples as the dregs of the people, which he represents them to be. This demonstration, which was largely attended, was held to protest against the “Seditious Bill” for the protection of the king’s person, for which, it was

argued, ample provisions were already legalized. Petitions to both Houses were prepared, and remonstrances numerously signed.

This situation is embodied in the picture of the assembly. The orator, Thelwall, is holding forth to an audience which is more picturesque than distinguished. Platforms are arranged at intervals as rostrums for the speakers, at one of which a butcher is enlarging on "The Rights of Citizens." The proprietress of a halfpenny gaming-table has labelled it, "Equality and no Sedition Bill." An emissary of Thelwall's is offering the remonstrance to sweep-boys for signature; and the autographs attached thereto, though notorious, are hardly such as to command the respect of parliament—"Jack Cade, Wat Tyler, Jack Straw, etc."

After the elections of 1784 parliament was entirely in the control of Pitt. It met, wrote Horace Walpole, "as quietly as a Quarter Session," the opposition seemed quelled, or driven to despair.

The meeting at Copenhagen House failed to accomplish its purpose, and further protests were entered against the Seditions Bill "for the better protection of the king's person," which was carried in the House by large majorities; this repressive measure provided that no gathering exceeding fifty persons should take place, even in a private house, without previous information had been laid before a magistrate, who might attend, and, if he saw cause, order the meeting to disperse, while those who resisted would be guilty of felony. In the face of such unconstitutional interference, fresh hostility sprang up throughout the land; and there being anticipations of an appeal to the country, the opposition endeavoured to present a bold front before the constituencies in view of that event; one of these meetings was summoned by the Sheriff of Middlesex, inviting the freeholders to assemble at the Mermaid, Hackney; this gathering has been commemorated by Gillray. The object of the meeting was to obtain a repeal of the obnoxious Seditions Bill, which, as the artist shows, the Whig member, George Byng, is vigorously denouncing from the platform; it was at the same time proposed to prepare an "Address to the King," and Mr. Mainwaring, the ministerial representative, is, with Jesuitical expression, deprecating hostility both to the Government and to their oppressive legislation, Fox is holding the hat of his oratorical disciple, Byng. It was on this occasion that

the sturdy Duke of Norfolk, who raised the royal ire by proposing as a toast in a public assembly, “The Majesty of the People,” took occasion to warn those who valued the liberty of the subject that they must not be misled by the specious titles of the bill.



MEETING OF PATRIOTIC CITIZENS AT COPENHAGEN HOUSE, 1795.
SPEAKERS: THELWALL, GALE JONES, HODSON, AND JOHN BINNS. BY JAMES
GILLRAY.

“I tell you, Citizens, we mean to new dress the Constitution, and turn it, and set a new Nap upon it.”

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AT HACKNEY MEETING—FOX, BYNG, AND MAINWARING. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

“I daresay,” he observed, “if the High Priest of the Spanish Inquisition was to come among us to introduce his system of inquisition here, he would call it an act for the better support and protection of religion; but we have understandings, and are not to be deceived in this way.”

Mainwaring stated in the House that the meeting had been most respectably attended, and that the requisition had been signed by three dukes, one marquis, two earls, and several freeholders.

As we have seen, in describing the elections of 1784, the results of which ended for a while all the prospects of the Whigs, William Pitt was called to office in the face of an unmanageable opposition, and almost in contravention of the voice of parliament; the youthful premier's bold resort to dissolution, with his energetic election tactics, disembarrassed him of the troublesome majority, and placed at his disposal a perfectly docile House. The progress of our relations with France, and many unpopular and stringent measures, like the Seditious Bill, had revived antagonism, and every fresh legislation which encroached on the rights of the people weakened the Government influence. Pitt, anticipating the struggle, boldly resorted to his old policy, and the intention of dissolving parliament was announced in the speech from the throne. Gillray, whose admirable caricatures illustrate the leading political events from 1782 to 1810, has epitomized the situation as "The Dissolution, or the Alchymist Procuring an Ætherial Representation," May 21, 1796. Pitt is seated on the model of his new barracks; the transmutation is carried out from the premier's recipe, "Antidotus Republica;" Treasury coals, *i.e.* golden pieces, feed the furnace; the breeze is raised by the Crown as a bellows; the old House of Commons, seen in the alembic, shows a few tenants, such as Fox and Sheridan, left on the opposition benches, but all is rapidly dissolving into a new chamber, where the alchemist is enthroned as "Perpetual Dictator," "Magna Charta" and "Parliamentary Rights" become his foot-stools, and adulation of the most slavish order is offered up by the members of the newly constituted and subservient Commons.

Maidstone, for which Benjamin D'Israeli took his seat in 1837, has been the scene of many severe and exceptionally costly contests. At the general election, 1796, the defeated candidate, Christopher Hull, is reported to have polled the greatest number of single votes ever tendered for that constituency, he having expended three thousand pounds in about seven hours. This heavy outlay proved fruitless, as Mr. Hull stood last on the list; but attempting to make a merit of this liberal use of money, the reputation of which he hoped might serve for a future occasion, the incipient

“electioneerer” was assured by his friends “he must start on fresh grounds, as the present would be considered as nothing more than electioneering experience.”



THE DISSOLUTION; OR, THE ALCHEMIST PRODUCING AN ÆTHERIAL REPRESENTATION. WILLIAM PITT DISSOLVING THE HOUSE OF COMMONS. 1796. BY JAMES GILLRAY.



THE HUSTINGS—COVENT GARDEN. 1796. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

VOX POPULI.—“We’ll have a mug.”—*Mayor of Garratt.*

CHARLES JAMES FOX.—*Loq.* “Ever guardian of your most sacred rights, I have opposed the ‘Pewter Pot Bill!’”

The general election of 1796 was less fruitful in incidents than its predecessor in 1790. The celebrated philologist, John Horne Tooke, endeavoured to gain the second seat, as the colleague of the great Whig chief. On this occasion “the Brentford parson” secured, though

unsuccessful, a larger number of votes; Fox was returned at the head of the poll, and Sir A. Gardner was second. Gillray has left a characteristic likeness of the Whig chief, very “spick and span,” deferentially bowing from “The Hustings,” in acknowledgment of the ribald, if popular, reception his admirers are according their old “true blue” member for Westminster. Fox is pressing to his heart, in parody of another measure, the “Pewter Pot Bill.” “Ever guardian of your most sacred rights, I have opposed the Pewter Pot Bill.” His audience is filled with enthusiasm. As an allusion to Fox’s supposed sympathies with events then proceeding in France—the pot-boy of “The Tree of Liberty,” Petty France, is offering a foaming measure to the well-tried patriot and popular representative.



THE FRIEND OF HUMANITY AND THE KNIFE-GRINDER.

The well-known “Friend of Humanity and the Knife-Grinder,” one of the most spirited poetical squibs, which first appeared in the *Anti-Jacobin*, was reprinted as a broadside for electioneering purposes, with a no less spirited plate, by Gillray, as a heading; and dedicated “To the Independent Electors of the Borough of Southwark,” of which constituency Tierney—whose person was figured as “the Friend of Humanity”—was the representative in parliament. Canning’s admirable parody was founded upon Southey’s poem, “The Widow,” and written in English sapphics, in imitation of the original.

“FRIEND OF HUMANITY.

“Needy knife-grinder! whither are you going?
Rough is the road; your wheel is out of order—
Bleak blows the blast—your hat has got a hole in’t,
So have your breeches!

“Weary knife-grinder! little think the proud ones,
Who in their coaches roll along the turnpike
Road, what hard work ’tis crying all day, ‘Knives
And scissors to grind, O!’

“Tell me, knife-grinder, how you came to grind knives?
Did some rich man tyrannically use you?
Was it the squire? or parson of the parish?
Or the Attorney?

“Was it the squire for killing his game? or
Covetous parson for his tithes distraining?
Or roguish lawyer made you lose your little
All in a lawsuit.

“(Have you not read the ‘Rights of Man,’ by Tom Paine?)
Drops of compassion tremble on my eye-lids,
Ready to fall, as soon as you have told your
Pitiful story.

“KNIFE-GRINDER.

“Story! God bless you! I have none to tell, sir,
Only last night, a-drinking at the Chequers,
This poor old hat and breeches, as you see, were
Torn in a scuffle.

“Constables came up for to take me into
Custody; they took me before the justice;
Justice Oldmixon put me in the parish
Stocks for a vagrant.

“I should be glad to drink your honour’s health in
A pot of beer, if you will give me sixpence;
But, for my part, I never love to meddle
With politics, sir.

“FRIEND OF HUMANITY.

“I give thee sixpence! I will see thee damn’d first!—
Wretch! whom no sense of wrongs can rouse to vengeance!—
Sordid, unfeeling, reprobate, degraded,
Spiritless outcast!”

*[Kicks the Knife-grinder, overturns his wheel, and exit in a
transport of republican enthusiasm and universal philanthropy.]*

It was in the session of 1797 that Mr. Grey first moved “for leave to bring in a bill to reform the representation of the country.” The motion, seconded by Erskine, was debated until three o’clock in the morning—an exceptional sitting in those days—when it was rejected by a Government majority of fifty-eight votes. Although the system of representation was notoriously corrupt, at least half the seats being in the patronage of interested persons, it was thirty-four years before Earl Grey’s measure for reform could be carried, and then only under extraordinary circumstances. After Grey’s earlier defeat, it was felt that in a House of Commons

completely submissive to the ministerial dictates, and which resisted amendment, the opposition leaders could make no impression, and they accordingly announced their intention for the present of taking no further part in its proceedings; the voice of Fox was scarcely heard in the House till the century closed.

Meanwhile, after the secession of the Whig party from the debates, the agitation throughout the country increased, political societies became more active, and frequent meetings were held to discuss the necessity for parliamentary reform. One of the most remarkable of these was held under the auspices of Bertie Greathead, the owner of "Guy's Cliff," near Warwick; a medal commemorative of this gathering and its object, reform, was struck for the occasion. These medals were a popular method of spreading political opinions. The patriotic reform medal was parodied by another of a loyal nature, representing the devil suspending three halters over the heads of the demagogues, who are mounted in "a condemned cart;" on the one side are shown the applauding "wrong-heads," while a large assembly of "right-heads" express their contempt for the proceedings.



Wilkes. Abbé Horne C. J. William Lord Earl of
 Siéyès. Tooke. Fox. Pitt. Holland. Chatham.

TWO PAIR OF PORTRAITS. PRESENTED TO ALL THE UNBIASED
 ELECTORS OF GREAT BRITAIN. 1798. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

[Page 305.]



LOYAL MEDAL. 1797.

A parody of the patriotic medal struck in commemoration of the Reform meeting held at Greathead's, Guy's Cliff, Warwick.

The Tories exulted over the secession of “the party,” and numerous caricatures appeared, imputing all sorts of offences to the Whigs; and one version represented Fox as “Phaeton” involving the Whig Club in his destruction. We have noticed the candidature of Horne Tooke for Westminster; ever since his prominence upon the occasion of Wilkes’s return for Middlesex in 1768, the “Brentford Parson” had striven to obtain a seat in parliament. He was in 1798 one of the most conspicuous members of the reform associations. Few were his match in ready eloquence, his pen was ever active, and his writings to the purpose. At an earlier stage of his career, a pamphlet appeared, written, it was alleged, by his hand, contrasting the two Pitts with the two Foxes as a pair of portraits; the comparison being in favour of the former. Advantage was taken of this circumstance to bring into discredit the confederation of Horne Tooke (who held more democratic views) with Fox for the advancement of the reform cause. James Gillray designed for the *Anti-Jacobin Review* his own satirical version of “Two Pair of Portraits, presented to all the unbiased Electors of Great Britain, by John Horne Tooke,” December 1, 1798. The eminent

philologist is represented as a portrait-painter, seated before his easel, on which appear the two original likenesses of the Whig and Tory chiefs, Pitt resting on the pedestal of "Truth," and Fox on that of "Deceit." The presentment of Lord Holland with the plunder of "unaccounted millions" so frequently quoted, is placed beside the portrait of the patriotic Earl of Chatham, dowered with the "Rewards of a Grateful Nation." Horne Tooke, who has in his pocket, "Sketches of Patriotic Views, a pension, a mouth-stopper, a place," is presumed to be retouching his unflattering and sinister portrait of the Whig chief, while demanding of the electors of Great Britain, which two of them will you choose to hang in your Cabinets, the PITTS or the FOXES? "Where, on your conscience, should the other two be hanged?" Allusions to various periods of the limner's life and principles appear round the studio—the windmill at Wimbledon (where Tooke resided), the parsonage at Brentford, the bust of Machiavel, the shadow or "silhouette" of the Abbé Siéyès; the picture of his old friend Wilkes, in his aldermanic gown as the prosperous and handsomely remunerated city chamberlain, *ci-devant* Wilkes and Liberty; "The effect in this picture to be copied as exact as possible;" "A London Corresponding Society, *i.e.* a Sketch for an English Directory;" with a folio of "Studies from French masters, Robespierre, Tallien, Marat," together with the prospectus for a new work, "The Art of Political Painting, extracted from the works of the most celebrated Jacobin professors."

The Shakespeare Tavern, celebrated as the head-quarters of the Whig party during Fox's candidature for Westminster, was the scene of a popular ovation on the twentieth anniversary of the Whig chief's election for that important constituency; the event was celebrated by a public dinner, October 10, 1800. Fox had so long absented himself from Parliament, feeling, as he declared, "his time of action was over when those principles were extinguished on which he acted," that his reappearance excited the greatest enthusiasm amongst his partisans, who were anxious both to hear his sentiments on the political outlook, and to demonstrate their unabated attachment to the "Man of the People," who preferred to seclude himself from public business and from the platform of his most brilliant oratorical triumphs, that he "might steadily adhere to those principles which had guided his past conduct." Every room in the house was filled with company. In replying to the cordial reception of his health, Fox reminded his auditors

that “During the twenty years I have represented you in Parliament I have adhered to the principles on which the Revolution of 1688 was founded, and what have been known as the old Whig principles of England;” and recalled that his first connection with his constituents occurred “during the calamitous war with America;” he then alluded to his absence from Parliament, extended to three years, and thus eloquently concluded: “I shall ever maintain that the basis of all parties is justice—that the basis of all constitutions is the sovereignty of the people—that from the people alone kings, parliaments, judges, and magistrates derive their authority.” Gillray has embodied this situation in his pictorial version of this most enthusiastic reception, ungenerously representing Fox as “The Worn-out Patriot; or, the Last Dying Speech of the Westminster Representative,” October 10, 1800. The great statesman is depicted as both mentally and physically in a state of decadence; Erskine is sustaining him with a bottle of brandy to stimulate his strength artificially, while Harvey Combe, in his robes as Lord Mayor, is lending his substantial support; a measure of Whitbread’s “entire” is also ready for the emergency. Among the guests are figured Sir J. Sinclair, and the gifted member for Southwark, Tierney. The speech the satirist has sarcastically introduced is a parody on that delivered by the Whig chief to the electors on the occasion:—

“Gentlemen, you see I am grown quite an old man in your service. Twenty years I’ve served you, and always upon the same principles. I rejoiced at the success of our enemies in the American War, and the war against the virtuous French has always met with my most determined opposition; but the infamous Ministry will not make peace with our enemies, and are determined to keep me out of their councils and out of place. Therefore, gentlemen, as their principles are quite different from mine, and as I am now too old to form myself according to their systems, my attendance in Parliament is useless, and, to say the truth, I feel that my season of action is past, and I must leave to younger men to act, for, alas! my failings and weaknesses will not let me now recognize what is for the best.”



THE WORN-OUT PATRIOT, OR THE LAST DYING SPEECH OF THE WESTMINSTER REPRESENTATIVE, ON THE ANNIVERSARY MEETING, HELD AT THE SHAKESPEARE TAVERN, OCTOBER 10, 1800. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

Pointed and pungent as is this version, it is on record that Fox's mental activity was still most brilliant; indeed, to the extent of converting his consistent enemy, George III. The supposed "Worn-out Patriot" lived to form an administration in 1806 in conjunction with Lord Grenville, who made Fox's accession to power a *sine qua non*. He filled the office of Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs at perhaps the most delicate and

critical period of our history, when Napoleon entertained designs against England; and on the death of the patriotic statesman, the king declared “he had never known the duties of that office so efficiently discharged for the honour of the country.”

“Who,” remarked a contemporary, “in reviewing Fox’s noble adherence to the cause of Liberty, as it affected the American nation, and weighing the wisdom of his forewarnings of the fatal consequences of the American War, but must admire the prophetic spirit with which he foretold all the direful events which resulted both to the Mother Country and her colonies from that unnatural fratricidal war.”

The first Parliament after the Union with Ireland met January 22, 1801, and was marked by the reappearance of Fox and the election of Horne Tooke for the borough of Old Sarum through the influence of Lord Camelford. The return of one who had been in holy orders involved a great constitutional question; his admission was opposed on the ground of his clerical profession, and it led to a bill making clergymen incapable of sitting in parliament. Tooke occupied his seat until the next dissolution, which occurred the year following, when he was no longer eligible. The circumstances are commemorated in a caricature by Gillray, entitled, “Political Amusements for Young Gentlemen, or the Brentford Shuttlecock between Old Sarum and the Temple of St. Stephen’s,” March, 1801. Lord Temple led the opposition to Tooke’s admission, and he is represented as resisting his entrance to the House, within which Fox is pictured crying, “The Church for Ever!” Lord Camelford, who was in the navy, is batting the shuttlecock from Old Sarum (the electors depicted as swine at a trough) to the Commons; he cries, “There’s a stroke for you, messmate; and if you kick him back, I’ll return him again, if I should be sent on a cruise to Moorfields for it! Go it, Coz.” Lord Temple is replying, “Send him back? Yes, I’ll send him back twenty thousand times, before such a high-flying Jacobin shuttlecock shall perch it here in his Clerical band.” Lord Camelford’s “List of Candidates” includes, besides Tooke, the names of Black Dick (his negro servant), and orator Thelwall, in case his ex-clerical nominee’s election was annulled; but his lordship disclaimed ever having entertained the intention of offering so gross an insult to the House. The

inscriptions on the feathers stuck in the head of the noble lord's plaything, "The Old Brentford Shuttlecock," are intended to indicate his character.



Lord Temple.

J. Horne Tooke.

Lord Camelford.

POLITICAL AMUSEMENTS FOR YOUNG GENTLEMEN, OR THE
BRENTFORD SHUTTLECOCK BETWEEN OLD SARUM AND THE TEMPLE OF
ST. STEPHEN'S. 1801. BY J. GILLRAY.



THE OLD
BRENTF
ORD
SHUTTL
ECK
—JOHN
HORNE
TOOKE
RETURN
ED FOR
OLD
SARUM.
1801.

Though the cause of Sir Francis Delaval suffered at Andover from a *contretemps* in which the commanding officer of the district was concerned, by an opposite course of events the return of Mr. N. Jefferys for Coventry was assured through military intervention. When writs were issued for a new parliament in 1802, a meeting was convened at Coventry, when it was resolved to invite Mr. Jefferys again to become a candidate to represent them, and to support his re-election. Upon Mr. Jefferys accepting this invitation, and proceeding down to Coventry to meet his constituents, his entrance into the city was unhandsomely opposed, a riot ensued, and things began to look dangerous, when Captain Barlow of the First Dragoon Guards, who happened to be there, his regiment being stationed in the neighbourhood, exerted himself with much spirit to quell the riot and protect the candidate and his friends from insult. Rarely has a casual and unexpected service been more singularly acknowledged; Captain Barlow was at once invited to join Mr. Jefferys as second Conservative candidate, which he readily accepted; the show of hands at the hustings was in his favour, and both were triumphantly returned. The contest was a close one;

Captain Barlow stood at the head of the poll with 1197 votes, N. Jefferys was elected with 1190; and the two Whig candidates were defeated—Wilberforce Bird with 1182, and Peter Moore with 1152 votes.

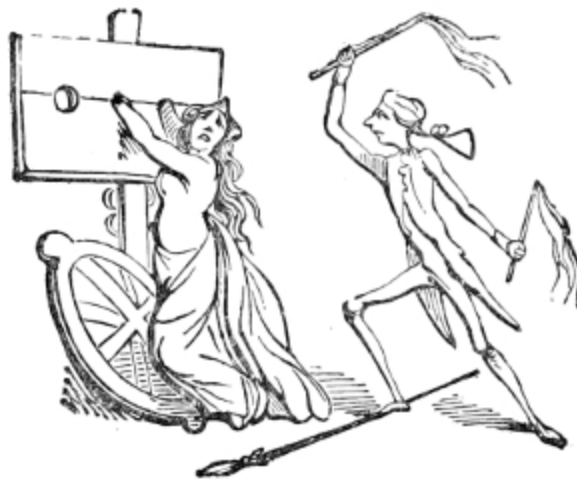
The Middlesex election of 1804 vividly recalled the previous excitement manifested at the Brentford hustings on the return of John Wilkes; the new party of “root-and-branch reformers,” more extreme in their political views than the Foxites, were now becoming most conspicuous by their agitations for the revision of the Constitution, and began to be known under the designation of Radicals. At the head of these “patriots” in the House of Commons were several of the younger politicians and “new luminaries,” such as Whitbread, Lord Folkestone, and others; but the most prominent leader of the movement was Sir Francis Burdett, then occupying the position previously held by “Wilkes and Liberty” at the commencement of the reign, and by Fox before his secession from Parliament. Horne Tooke, who passed out-of-doors as the baronet’s political sponsor, “guide, philosopher, and friend,” was actively supporting his pupil, and William Cobbett was, by his energetic writings, proselytizing in the same cause, and was generally regarded as the apostle of the latest sect. In the same ranks were included the wealthy Bosville and other zealous partisans. At the Middlesex election of 1802, Sir Francis Burdett, in the Radical interest, had unseated the Tory candidate, W. Mainwaring, polling nearly double the votes obtained by the ministerial candidate, who had represented the county from 1784.

In 1804, the election for Middlesex was equally trying for the administration as the memorable struggle at Westminster in 1784, and recalled the scenes witnessed on the same spot in 1786. Gillray has commemorated this occurrence in one of his most elaborate caricatures, published August 7, 1804:—“Middlesex Election, 1804—a Long Pull, a Strong Pull, and a Pull All Together;” the hustings at Brentford appear in the distance, whereon the ministerial candidate is holding forth to an exuberant crowd, amidst which derisive symbols are displayed—a huge begging-box, a gallows with an effigy suspended, and a banner inscribed, “No Begging Candidate.” The head-quarters of the Court party, at the sign of the Constitution (a crown and mitre) placarded with posters, “Mainwaring, King, and Country,” and advertising “good entertainment,” is

treated to a perfect shower of missiles and dirt; a free fight is proceeding at a distance. Beneath the standard claiming “Independence and Free Elections,” now a reasonable aspiration, but, in those days, regarded as little short of sedition, a rat is hung to a lantern, expressive of contempt for “ministerial rats.” Sir Francis Burdett is carried triumphantly to the hustings; his barouche, drawn by the most illustrious members of the opposition, is emblazoned on the panels with suggestive devices: “Peace” is figured as a French eagle, with the legend, “*Égalité*,” the Torch of Liberty is a flaming and incendiary brand; and “Plenty” is symbolized by a pot of porter with the head of Bonaparte on the measure. Beneath the wheels of Burdett’s chariot is figured a dog with “A Cur-tis” on his collar, a blow at Sir William Curtis, enriched by “fat” Government contracts; by him is Tooke’s tract, “A Squeeze for Contractors.” On the box is the baronet’s reputed preceptor, the Brentford Parson himself, “in his habit as he lived,” smoking his pipe like his confederate “Bellenden,” that “revolution sinner” Dr. Parr; from the prime agitator’s pockets fall the speeches, “hints,” and addresses it is implied he had prepared for his hopeful pupil.



“The Party” is doing its utmost to forward Burdett’s career, and to mortify the Ministry. Tyrwhitt Jones and General Fitzpatrick, eccentric and independent politicians, are leading the “marrow-bone and cleaver” music; two lines of influential Whig statesmen are propelling the car; Bosville, Grey, the Duke of Northumberland, the Marquis of Lansdowne, and the Duke of Norfolk in one file, and Lord Carlisle, the Duke of Bedford, Lord Derby, and Fox in the other, all travestied felicitously under disguises which the caricaturist has suggested as appropriate to their characters or situations. Lord Moira (Marquis of Hastings), with the prince’s plume on his instrument, is acting as drummer. Behind the carriage rides Erskine in his bar robes, with the cap of liberty on a pike, marked “The Good Old Cause.” Tierney has “The Key of the Bastille,” in allusion to Burdett’s exertions on behalf of the political prisoners with which the prisons, such as Coldbath Fields, were at that time filled; while Sheridan is raising aloft the pictorial version of the “Governor in All His Glory,” *i.e.* Pitt flogging Britannia, who is fixed in the pillory, of which an enlarged version appears.



BRITANNIA FLOGGED BY PITT
—THE GOVERNOR IN ALL HIS
GLORY. 1804.

The election contests in 1806 and 1807, which ensued on the death of Fox, fully occupied the pencil of Gillray: his elaborate cartoons, of which reduced *fac-similes* are given, prove that election squibs must in his day have enjoyed a large circulation; the artist seems to have developed them into elaborate conceptions. Westminster was again the constituency, where the struggle was regarded as of most absorbing interest. Sheridan, who had sat for Stafford from 1780, now flattered himself that his popularity and his intimacy with Fox would, on the decease of the Whig chief, point him out as the natural successor of the illustrious statesman. He found an embarrassing opponent in James Paull (the son of a prosperous tailor), who had returned from India, where he filled an appointment, and brought home with him a moderate fortune and liberal ideas as regarded administrative reform. His candidature for Westminster was supported by the influence of all the advanced politicians, the ultra-Liberals, and the Radical Reformers.

In the first of Gillray's satires on this topic, the "Triumphal Procession of Little Paull, the Tailor, upon his new Goose," November 8, 1806, Sir Francis Burdett, who was for some time travestied as "The Famous Green Goose," is lending Little Paull a helping mount; Tooke is leading his pupil; Colonel Bosville is distributing money to make the candidate popular; Cobbett, with "Political Register" in hand, is canvassing for Paull and "Independence and Public Justice"—referring to the new patriot's articles of impeachment against the Marquis of Wellesley on his return from India. In view of the energetic tactics of the new candidate and his allies, Sir Samuel Hood and Sheridan thought it advisable to combine their interests, and make a coalition for the occasion. The situation is pictorially summed up as "The High-flying Candidate, Little Paull Goose, mounting from a Blanket—*Vide* Humours of Westminster Election" (November 11, 1806). Paull, according to the ungenerous practice of all concerned, was taunted with being the son of a tailor. Sir Samuel Hood, with one arm lost in his country's service, and Sheridan in sables for his late friend, and with the farce of "The Devil Among the Tailors" in his pocket, are together raising their high-flying antagonist in the "Coalition Blanket." The Admiral's sailors and patriotic volunteers for Sheridan are alike pronouncing emphatically for the combined names of the two senior candidates. At the feet of the Coalition members is the memorial slab to departed greatness, "Sacred to the Memory of Poor Charley, late member for the City of

Westminster,” “We ne’er shall look upon his like again;” the monument is thrust aside by the outraged spirit of the deceased patriot, who is in anguish exclaiming, “*O tempora! O mores!*”

Lord Granville.	Mellish.	Marquis of Buckingham. Lord Temple.	Head of Fox.	Byng.	Wm. Cobbett.
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Sheridan and Sir Samuel Hood.	James Paull.	Napoleon as Postillion.	Sir F. Burdett.	J. Horne Tooke.	Col. Bosville.
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POSTING TO THE ELECTION; OR, A SCENE ON THE ROAD TO
BRENTFORD. 1806. BY JAMES GILLRAY.



Sir Samuel Hood.

James Paull.

R. B. Sheridan.

THE HIGHFLYING CANDIDATE, LITTLE PAULL GOOSE, MOUNTING FROM A BLANKET—*Vide* HUMOURS OF WESTMINSTER ELECTION. 1806. BY J. GILLRAY.

Gillray's third caricature on the general election of 1806 exhibits a spirited panorama of the procession to the hustings as "Posting to the Election: a Scene on the Road to Brentford," in which each of the candidates is hastening in the way supposed to best characterize his prospects and party: William Mellish, who enjoyed the interest of the Coalition Ministry then in office, is driven in style, in a dashing "Rule Britannia and the Bank" four-in-hand, under the "Flag of Loyalty and Independence," by Lord Granville as coachman; Lords Temple and Castlereagh, and the Marquis of Buckingham are perched behind; the latter is giving a sly helping pull to the post-chaise and pair in which is seated George Byng—"in the good old Whig interest;" the head of Fox is displayed on the box as "the good old Whig Block." Prominent in the foreground is the grand *melée* of the Coalition candidates for Westminster—Sheridan and Sir Samuel Hood, mounted on a prancing brewer's horse,

just escaped from the dray, with panniers overflowing with gold pieces, and labelled, "Subscription Malt and Hops from the Whitbread Brewery."



COALITION CANDIDATES—SHERIDAN AND SIR SAMUEL HOOD. 1806.

Burdett's ballad-singers and marrow-bone-and-cleaver men are scattered by the plunging dray-horse from Whitbread's, and the startled donkey, which bears little Paull, is giving the rider an upset, in which Paull's famous "Impeachment of the Marquis of Wellesley" is falling to the ground. Last comes Sir Francis Burdett, who, on this occasion, experienced a mortifying defeat in the face of his former triumphs at Brentford; the gay barouche of 1800 and 1804 has given place to an "untaxed cart" with four miserable jackasses; the efforts of a posse of sweeper-boy followers with difficulty extricate this shabby conveyance from the slough. Acting as

postillion is the little Corsican, Bonaparte, then but recently elected Emperor of the French. It was at this time one of the theories of Napoleon I., that, after the visionary conquest of England, he would inaugurate a republic, for the presidency of which he declared Sir Francis Burdett to be, in his estimation, the fittest person in England; this opinion, it is believed, was shared by the baronet—an entertaining aspect of the “might-have-beens”! “Liberty and Equality, No Placemen in Parliament, and No Bastilles,” are the watchwords of the party in the condemned cart; all the members wear “Liberty” favours in their hats. Burdett has “The Life of Oliver Cromwell” for consultation ready at hand; behind him is his political preceptor, Horne Tooke, shown in parsonic guise, and Bosville with the “Rights of Man” next his heart. Cobbett appears as the “Radical Drummer,” beating up recruits for Burdett and Paull, with his “Political Register” and “Inflammatory Letters.” “Orator Broad-face, of Swallow Street,” whose mob pleasantries overpowered the veteran Sheridan at Covent Garden, is among the baronet’s enthusiastic supporters.



A
RADICAL
DRUMMER.
1806. W.
COBBETT.



Sir Samuel Hood. Whitbread. Sheridan. James Paull. Sir F. Burdett.

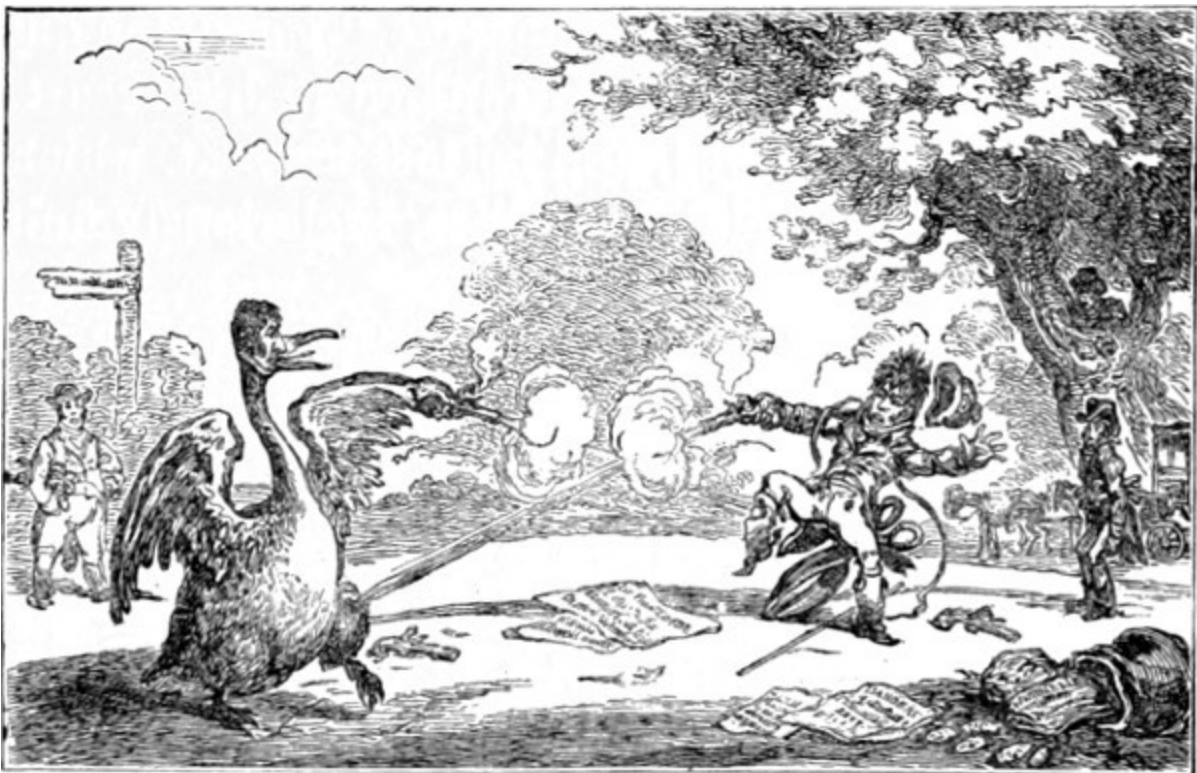
VIEW OF THE HUSTINGS IN COVENT GARDEN—WESTMINSTER
ELECTION. 1806. BY J. GILLRAY.

It was at the Westminster election of 1806 that the excitement culminated. This long and expensive contest was fruitful in incidents. Gillray has produced the most characteristic “View of the Hustings in Covent Garden.” At the time this version appeared, Paull was at the head of the poll; he is shown vigorously denouncing his discomfited antagonist —“Harlequin Sherry” as “the sunk, the lost, the degraded treasurer.” Immediately behind Paull is the Duke of Northumberland, whose son, Lord Percy, had relinquished Westminster after representing it in parliament for one session, that immediately following Fox’s decease; the Duke has “No Coalition” inscribed on his hat, and a “Letter to the Vestry of St. Margaret’s” in his hand. Cobbett, Burdett, and Bosville, wearing favours for Paull, are in the front ranks of his supporters. Sheridan, exhorted to “Pay your Debts, Mr. Treasurer,” is represented as filled with consternation; Whitbread is vainly trying to rally his spirits with his “New Loyal Porter;”

Sir Samuel Hood is seemingly ashamed of his colleague, and is chuckling over his confusion. The exchange of personalities between Paull and Sheridan, who was assisted by the notorious "Pickle," his son Tom, exceeded all that had gone before, and degenerated into "Billingsgate" abuse. Sheridan, with questionable propriety, dwelt more particularly on the descent of his opponent from "tailorism," and was waggish in allusions to the "ninth part of a man." Paull complimented Sheridan on "his good taste," and justified it by referring to the manager of Drury Lane as the "son of a vagabond," actors being by Act of Parliament classed in that category. Paull was the readier at mob oratory, and Sheridan, "erst the wit of the Commons," found the hustings a terrible penance; his appearance was the signal for violent uproar, and requests for "renters' shares" and sums of money owing, and for which it was alleged he was liable. Painfully conscious of his familiar embarrassments, this raillery, in the presence of persons of credit and influence whose support was growing lukewarm, broke down the spirit of the veteran champion of this order of encounter. He had trusted to his well-seasoned experience in mob demonstrations, to his playful wit, apt jocularities, and sarcasms to convert the mob to good humour, and to cajole them with his popular persuasions into a friendly disposition; but he reckoned without allowing for rivalry. Besides the fluent Paull, there was one man in the crowd who fairly compelled "Sherry" to retire abashed; in vain he tried by turns ridicule and denunciation of "hireling ruffians," the broad-faced orator in the green coat seemed stimulated by these counter-attacks. A comedy was then popular in which a dandy was repeatedly quizzed by inquiries, directed to the various portions of his apparel, of "Who suffers?" This artillery was constantly played upon Sheridan: "Sherry, I see you've got a new coat—who suffers?" "Sherry, who suffers for that new hat?" After this the disconcerted treasurer avoided the hustings, and his son Tom, whose cool audacity was proverbial, managed to take his place. Sheridan only gained the election through his coalition with Hood; but the shafts of Cobbett's "porcupine quills" and the conflict of the hustings rankled in his breast. A dissolution shortly followed, and he lost his seat, which, by precipitating his financial difficulties, ingloriously finished Sheridan's career.

The defeat of the famous Coalition Ministry of "All the Talents" upon the vexed question of Catholic Emancipation was the cause of a fresh

appeal to the country early in 1807, when the followers of the late Granville Administration contested the constituencies at a disadvantage, confronted with the popular cries of “Church and King” and “No Popery.” Paull now flattered himself that his chances of being returned for Westminster were reviving, but candidates were more numerous, and Sir Francis Burdett, who was discouraged by his last experience from contesting Middlesex, was appealing to Westminster himself. Paull advertised a dinner to be held at the Crown and Anchor, and as Burdett had promised his support, and had actually gone to the length of nominating Paull, he was announced, without authority it appeared, to take the chair; this was the cause of a rupture between the prominent Radical candidates. Two days before the meeting, Burdett wrote to Paull:—



PATRIOTS DECIDING A POINT OF HONOUR; THE DUEL AT WIMBLEDON, BETWEEN SIR FRANCIS BURDETT AND JAMES PAULL. WESTMINSTER ELECTION. 1807. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

“I must say, to have my name advertised for such meetings is like ‘Such a day is to be seen the great Katterfelto,’ and this without any previous consent or application. From any one else I should regard it as an insult!”

At the dinner, it was explained by Sir Francis’s brother that Burdett had given no promise to preside; after the meeting broke up, Paull waited on his proposer, and a warm altercation ensued, when a hostile meeting was arranged to take place the next morning near Wimbledon. This duel is made the subject of a fresh satire by Gillray—“Patriots Deciding a Point of Honour! or, the Exact Representation of the Celebrated Rencontre which took place at Combe Wood on May 2nd, 1807, between Little Paull the Tailor and Sir Francis Goose.” On the field of honour, Burdett continued to be travestied as the famous “great green goose:” his letter to the electors at the Crown and Anchor is, with other political and personal publications, scattered around as the cause of the encounter; one pair of pistols is already discharged. At the second exchange of shots, which Paull demanded, as Burdett declined to apologize, both combatants were wounded, as shown in the picture. Sir Francis was highly indignant, according to the satirist’s version: “What, must I be out! and a Tailor get into Parliament?—You’re a liar! I never said that I would sit as Chairman on your Shopboard!” Paull, who is girt with a huge pair of shears sword-wise, responds, “A liar!—Sir, I’m a Tailor and a Gentleman, and I must have satisfaction.” Bellenden Kerr and Cooper, the seconds of the respective combatants, are provided with two armfuls of pistols for the emergency, which Sam Rogers described as “ending in a lame affair.”



THE POLL OF THE WESTMINSTER ELECTION, 1807. ELECTION CANDIDATES, OR THE REPUBLICAN GOOSE AT THE TOP OF THE POLL. ON THE POLL: BURDETT, COCHRANE, ELLIOTT, SHERIDAN, PAULL; BELOW ARE TEMPLE, GREY, GRANVILLE, PETTY, ETC. BY JAMES GILLRAY.

The further results of the contest are shown as the “Poll of the Westminster Election.” According to Gillray’s figurative version, Burdett, still as the goose with wounded limb, is pitchforked to the top, whence he is hissing at the Crown as the “Sun of the Constitution;” his political tutor, travestied as the Evil One, is helping his rise; Lord Cochrane, flourishing a

club, marked, "Reform," is second; Elliot, the brewer, as "Quassia," is overset; Sheridan, in his old Harlequin suit, is slipping down, never to rise again; and Paull, with his leg damaged, has come down with a run, he having cut an insignificant figure in the polling; the members of the dismissed ministry are commemorating Burdett's triumph with "rough music." This version, which contains a number of portraits, is entitled—

"Election Candidates; or, the Republican Goose at the Top of the Pol(l)e—the Devil Helping Behind! *vide* Mr. Paull's Letter, *article* Horne Tooke. Also an exact representation of Sawney M'Cockran (Lord Cochrane) flourishing the Cudgel of Naval Reform, lent him by Cobbett, and mounting triumphantly over a small Beer Barrel, together with an old Drury Lane Harlequin trying in vain to make a spring to the top of the pole, and slipping down again; and lastly, poor Little Paull, the Tailor done over! wounded by a Goose, and not a leg to stand on." (May 20, 1807.)



THE HEAD OF THE POLL; OR, THE
WIMBLEDON SHOWMAN AND
HIS PUPPET. 1807. TOOKE AND
BURDETT.

The support and assistance afforded by the author of the “Diversions of Purley” to his pupil are further indicated in a caricature which represented the “Brentford Parson” carrying the candidate at the end of his *pole*, and, as in the former example, exhibiting Burdett to the crowd assembled in Covent Garden, under the title of “The Head of the Poll; or, the Wimbledon Showman and his Puppet.” Horne Tooke is advertising “The finest puppet in the world, gentlemen; entirely of my own formation. I have only to say the word, and he’ll do anything.”

Another view of a hustings is afforded by the caricaturist. From the platform a select few of superannuated statesmen are addressing the constituents, in this instance pictured as calves. This version, which is by Gillray, represents a phase of the “Patriotic Petitions on the Convention” (of Cintra); “The Chelmsford Petition,” with Patriots addressing the Essex Calves—who, it is notified, are “To be sold to the highest bidder.” Lord Temple is unfolding the *Essex Petition*—“Horrid Convention! Ministers firing the Park guns; Armistice in French lingo!” Earl St. Vincent is appealing to the electors, and declaring that all the misfortunes are due to the want of him; the gouty veteran is supported by the Marquis of Buckingham, who is asserting “It’s all for want of us, Gentlemen Calves!” sentiments which the other occupants of the platform, Windham and Lord Henry Petty, are applauding.

Marquis of Buckingham.

Lord Temple.



Lord H. Petty.

Earl St. Vincent.

THE CHELMSFORD PETITION: PATRIOTS ADDRESSING THE ESSEX
CALVES.

CHAPTER XII.

ELECTIONEERING CARTOONS AND SQUIBS, 1807-20.

It was the “royal” Duke of Norfolk, who, on the appeal to the country which followed the downfall of Lord Granville’s Ministry of “all the Talents,” declared in the true spirit of the old political grandees, “After all, what greater enjoyment can there be in life than to stand a contested election for Yorkshire, and to win it by one?” The harder and more costly the fight, the better the fun, and the more relishable the victory which stirred the blood of the Howards.

It is curious to view the precise Wilberforce, as pictured by himself, entertaining at midnight suppers his constituents, the Hull freemen located in London, to the number of three hundred, at waterside public-houses round Wapping, and by his addresses to them “gaining confidence in public speaking.” As a young man, only just of age, Wilberforce successfully contested a seat for Hull. His entry to the senate cost him between £8000 and £9000, on his own showing.

“By long-established custom the single vote of a resident elector was rewarded with a donation of two guineas; four were paid for a plumper, and the expenses of a freeman’s journey from London averaged £10 apiece. The letter of the law was not broken, because the money was not paid until the last day on which election petitions could be presented.”

This early success of Wilberforce was won in opposition to the paramount influence of Lord Rockingham, and that of the Government, “always strong at a seaport;” but this contest sinks into insignificance beside Wilberforce’s later experiences. It was after the philanthropist had already represented the county of Yorkshire for twenty-three years that, on

the unexpected dissolution in 1807, he found himself plunged in the most expensive contest on record, one in which it was alleged half a million of money was squandered, and which has been aptly designated the “Austerlitz of Electioneering.”

Wilberforce’s opponents were Lord Milton, backed by the powerful influence of his father, Earl Fitzwilliam, and with the active co-operation of the Duke of Norfolk; and the Hon. H. Lascelles, in promoting whose return his father, Lord Harewood, was “ready to spend his whole Barbados property.” When the great abolitionist arrived in York, he found his rivals had already marshalled their forces, retained all the law-agents, and engaged canvassers, houses of entertainment, and every species of conveyance in any considerable town. As Wilberforce assured his friends on the nomination day, when nearly every hand was uplifted in his favour, “he would never expose himself to the imputation of endeavouring to make a seat in the House of Commons subservient to the repair of a dilapidated fortune,” a vast subscription was set on foot to defray the expenses he incurred in standing, and, within a week, this fund reached £64,455. At the hustings, the high sheriff declared the majority in favour of Lord Milton and the Hon. H. Lascelles, whereupon a poll was demanded by Mr. Wilberforce, which commenced at once, and continued for fifteen days. The high sheriff presided in court, and the poll was taken at thirteen booths in York Castle yard. For the first few days Wilberforce stood so low that his professional adviser stated that “the sooner he resigned the better.” While the heavy purses had secured every mode of conveyance, even to “mourning coaches,” Wilberforce’s adherents were, at their own charges, slowly making their way to the poll.

“No carriages are to be procured,” says a letter from Hull, “but boats are proceeding up the river heavily laden with voters; farmers lend their waggons; even donkeys have the honour of carrying voters for Wilberforce, and hundreds are proceeding on foot. This is just as it should be. No money can convey all the voters, but if their feelings are roused his election is secure.”

“How did you come up?” they asked a countryman who had “plumped” for Wilberforce, and who denied having spent anything on his

journey. "Sure enow I cam all'd way ahint Lord Milton's carriage." Vast hosts of mounted freeholders rode in bodies to York, and, when interrogated, "For what parties do you come?" the response was, "Wilberforce" to a man, and these continued to arrive both by day and night. The *York Herald* summarizes the excitement of the election:—

"Nothing since the days of the revolution has ever presented to the world such a scene as this great county for fifteen days and nights. Repose or rest have been unknown in it, except it was seen in a messenger asleep upon his post-horse, or in his carriage. Every day the roads in every direction to and from every remote part of the county have been covered with vehicles loaded with voters; and barouches, curricles, gigs, flying waggons, and military cars with eight horses, crowded sometimes with forty voters, have been scouring the country, leaving not the slightest chance for the quiet traveller to urge his humble journey, or find a chair at an inn to sit down upon."

As Wilberforce's majority increased, the "Miltonians" and "Lascellites" freely resorted to tricky manœuvres included among "election tactics." Falsehoods about "coalitions" were circulated; it was asserted there was "an unholy alliance" between "Saint and Sinner"—Wilberforce and Harewood House; that the great slave abolitionist was in league with the "Nigger Driver," otherwise Lord Harewood, the holder of the Barbados slave property. "Then," says Wilberforce, "the mob-directing system—twenty bruisers sent for, Firby, Gully, and others." It was the object of Milton's "bravos" to drown Wilberforce's refutations of the "Coalition" charge, and when he addressed the people, the mob interrupted his explanation. "Print what you have to say in a handbill, and let them read it, since they will not hear you," cried a friend. "They read indeed!" said Wilberforce. "What, do you suppose that men who make such a noise as these fellows can read?" This sally won the heart of the crowd. To the other false rumours against him was added that of his own death; four days before the election closed he was attacked by an epidemic which disabled him from taking a further personal share in the struggle. Wilberforce stood at the head of the poll with 11,806 votes, Lord Milton was returned with 11,177, and Lascelles was defeated, with 10,989.

“Had I not been defrauded of promised votes, I should have had 20,000,” Wilberforce wrote to Hannah Moore. “However, it is unspeakable cause for thankfulness to come out of the battle ruined neither in health, character, or fortune.”

A large proportion of the subscriptions was returned. The motives which influenced Wilberforce to this arduous adventure are such as command the sympathies of those who prize constitutional freedom.

“It is but too manifest,” he wrote, “that expensive contests have a natural tendency to throw great counties and populous places into the hands of men of immense wealth; just as it has been sometimes found that mankind have sought a refuge from the evils of anarchy, by running into the opposite extreme, and surrendering their liberties.”

In a footnote to a series of satirical epistles, published in 1807, as “The Groans of the Talents,” in six epistles, purporting to be written by ex-ministers to their colleagues, we get a curious, if apocryphal, electioneering anecdote. The putative author of the epistle in question, the Right Hon. W. Windham, and his correspondent, T. W. Coke, were both sufferers from the damaging indiscretion recorded. It is explained how these candidates were supposed (incorrectly according to facts) to have lost their seats for Norfolk. In the general election, 1806, two ladies of the first respectability drove about the county to canvass for Col. Hon. J. Wodehouse (Conservative), and as they were universally respected, their success was proportionably great. Messrs. Coke and Windham were much chagrined at this circumstance; at length, however, the latter gentleman’s inventive genius devised a plan by which he hoped to turn it to their own advantage. Having procured two comely nymphs of light reputation, somewhat resembling in age and appearance the “fair petitioners” they were destined to personate, he arrayed them in similar apparel, and, having procured a carriage which formerly belonged to one of these ladies, they canvassed another part of the county in favour of Messrs. Coke and Windham; the trick, however, was discovered, and so indignant were Col. Wodehouse’s fair friends, that they instigated their husbands and friends to petition parliament against the sheriff’s return. Thus did the means by which Mr. Windham hoped to defeat the Hon. John Wodehouse contribute to the

discredit of himself and friend. It must be added, it is hardly credible the Right Hon. W. Windham would be likely to resort to so disreputable an electioneering ruse.

In the days when candidates paid their electors' travelling expenses (and these ranged high, averaging, for example, from London to Hull, ten pounds apiece for freemen, the recognized tariff), curious manœuvres were resorted to by the "other side;" one of these was to buy off the persons who had the responsibility of delivering these expensive cargoes safe and in good voting order at the end of their expedition. Among these anecdotes, it is related that, when those Berwick freemen who happened to reside in the metropolis—

"were going down by sea, the skippers, to whose tender mercy they were committed, used to be bribed, and have been known in consequence to carry them over to Norway!"

This is the forerunner of the Ipswich story, that the Ipswich freemen, under precisely similar conditions, have occasionally found themselves in Holland; while, on the authority of R. Southey, it had also occurred to electors to find themselves delivered at a port in the Netherlands. The notorious Andrew Robinson Bowes, who was famous for being undeterred by scruples, once stood for Newcastle. A cargo of Newcastle freemen were shipped from London for his opponent, and the master was bribed by Bowes to carry them to Ostend, where they remained till the election was over.

The majesty of the people is adequately represented from a humoristic standpoint by Pugin and Rowlandson, as it might have appeared on its septennial returns in the boisterous eighteenth century. In the view of the most celebrated polling-place of the kingdom, one of the candidates has secured the ears of the adjacent crowd:—

“A man, when once he’s safely chose,
May laugh at all his furious foes,
Nor think of former evil:
Yet good has its attendant ill;
A *seat* is no bad thing—but still
A *contest* is the devil.”

Possibly the voices will follow; a show of hands is offered with hearty goodwill; but, put to the test of the poll-book, it would seem that, for the most part, the audience is voteless. However, the polling-places may be recognized, like cattle pens, in front of the hustings, with the attendant officials under the supervision of the high bailiff of Westminster as returning officer. The flags indicate the respective parishes of the district, such as St. Margaret’s, St. James’s, St. Martin in the Fields, etc. Pugin is responsible for the literal exactitude with which the locality is represented; his drawing may be accepted as a faithful view of the customary arrangement of the Covent Garden hustings at the time of the Westminster elections: while Rowlandson has added the life and zest of the subject from actual observation. With the history of the famous contests held on this spot before us, it is noteworthy that the artist has given prominence to one well-known feature, characteristic of Westminster elections for nearly a century, the nomination of an influential naval officer in the Court interest, whose supporters, backed up by a contingent of loyal jack-tars, produced a due effect on the opposition. Rowlandson was quite at home in the scene: he has reproduced the bludgeon-boys, ballad-singers, professional pugilists, marrow-bone-and-cleaver “rough music,” and those vendors of cakes, nuts, fruit, and such small wares as were in request at such times; these itinerant traders found at elections a large mart for their commodities, but the business was at such times conducted at some personal risk, the baskets being overset, the contents scattered, and the owners roughly handled in the course of the attacks, counter-charges, and other party-manœuvres which diversified the proceedings in the vicinity of the hustings.

G. Cruikshank supplied a frontispiece to Fairburn’s “Electors of Westminster,” 1810—a copy of the “Speaker’s Warrant for the Commitment of Sir Francis Burdett to the Tower,” with a burlesque portrait of that

privileged functionary, the Speaker, in an enormous wig, surmounted by a miniature hat; the Right Hon. Charles Abbott was further caricatured by the artist as “The Little Man in the Big Wig”—*vide* “Fuller’s Earth reanimated.”

A burlesque, by George Cruikshank, upon one of the candidates for the City appeared in 1812, under the title of “The Election Hunter;” it consists of a broadside, commencing:—

“I’ve just learned, by the porter who stands at my door,
That your old friend, Sir Charles, means to offer no more.”

G. Cruikshank has supplied the pictorial embellishments. Sir Claudius Hunter, the canvassing candidate, is standing in the stirrups of his famous charger, “White Surrey,” mounted on the platform, attended by masked horsemen, and squired by a dilapidated knight in armour, who has evidently seen overmuch service. The candidate is thus addressing the civic constituency: “Gentleman, I earnestly solicit your vote and interest for me and my horse.” This appeal the electors receive with derision, “No, no; you may saddle White Surrey for Cheapside if you like, but not for the House,” “Off, off,” etc.

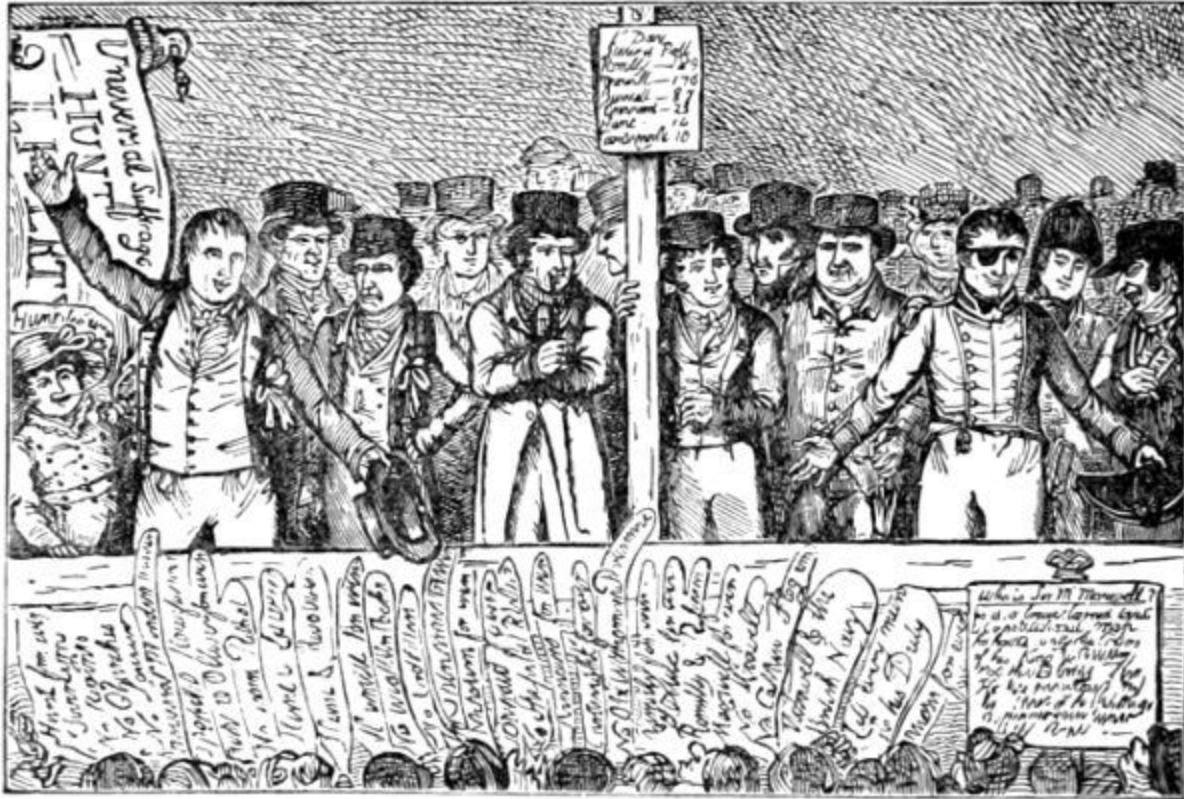
This electioneering squib was probably preceded by another, also designed by G. Cruikshank (published April 10, 1812). In this version, entitled, “Saddle White Surrey for Cheapside to-morrow—W. Lon. Mil. Regt. [West London Militia Regiment], General Orders,” Sir Claudius, mounted on his steed, is making, like a true knight-errant, a quixotic charge upon his constituents, preceded by the woeful man-in-armour, like Sancho Panza, on an ass; he is charging the throng with his lance. A groom behind Sir Claudius is exclaiming, “This is our High-bred Hunter!”

In 1812, G. Cruikshank found fresh exercise for his etching-needle on another electioneering cartoon—“The Borough Candidates,” published October 1812. Suggestions of Gillray will be identified in this plate, for the artist is dealing with Charles Calvert, the brewer, who was elected for Southwark with H. Thornton, in opposition to W. J. Burdett; the new

member is seated astride a barrel of his own brewing, the “stingo” is pouring forth from spigot and vent-peg. The discomfited candidates are figured on either side; while the heads of the brewer’s constituents appear in front.

Elections happily brought both food and occupation to the caricaturists and satirists, as it has been shown. Incidents connected with this subject evidently caught the popular taste, for we find Cruikshank making the most of the mere title, in association with the etching of a somewhat commonplace presentment of a country assembly-room, conveying no flattering impression of the provincial grace and deportment of the period; this was published in 1813—as “An Election Ball:” the floor is occupied by knock-kneed dancers doddering through figures, while the master of the ceremonies is shouting his instructions to the leader of the band, elevated in an orchestra overhead.

The artist evidently found this topic remunerative, for in 1819 he produced a smaller version of “An Election Ball”—a similar subject, with the arrangement of the room reversed; a country dance is proceeding with “hands across;” the clumsy master of the ceremonies, who is pigeon-toed, stands viewing the scene with evident gratification. This plate reappeared, with a new publisher’s name, in 1835 (republished by Thomas McLean, Haymarket).



Hunt. Burdett. Cartwright. Sir S. Romilly. Sir M. Maxwell.

THE FREEDOM OF ELECTION; OR, HUNT-ING FOR POPULARITY, AND
PLUMPERS FOR MAXWELL. 1818. BY G. AND R. CRUIKSHANK.

Both Robert and George Cruikshank were working away on the popular side of the Westminster election contest, June 18, 1818. "The Freedom of Election; or, HUNTING for Popularity, and Plumpers for MAXWELL," published June 22, 1818, owes its origin to this combination of talent. In the caricature, the candidates and their most prominent supporters are mounted on the Covent Garden hustings, of which a front view is given. Hunt stands hat in hand (he and Sir Francis Burdett sport "favours"); the Radical reformer is backed by his colours, his flag proclaims "Universal Suffrage and Liberty;" the standard is surmounted by a cap of liberty. Hunt is making a characteristically downright appeal to his audience:—

“I am a plain Englishman. I approve of the conduct of Sir Murray Maxwell in coming forward as he has done. Why should you send Sir Samuel Romilly to Parliament? He can find his way into the Den of

Corruption. You know the hero of the Tower, as well as I do—who ran out at the back door when his friends were waiting for him at the front. *I have hoisted the Cap of Liberty!*”

The followers of the speaker are shouting, “Hunt for ever! no Sovereigns, no Regents, no Churches, no Lawyers! Universal Plunder for ever! No Sham Patriots. Hunt and Liberty. Hunt and Revolution.” Sir Francis Burdett comes next, beside the Hon. Douglas Kinnaird and Major Cartwright; these candidates are variously received. “Burdett for ever!—No Weathercocks. No Coalition. The Spenceans for ever! Napoleon for ever! Burdett for ever! No Spafields Rioters.” “Kinnaird for ever!” “Cartwright for ever! No old woman in Parliament.” Sir Samuel Romilly is standing beside the poll on which the results of the first day’s votings are recorded. The cries for “Romilly and Justice,” “Romilly and Reform,” indicate a popular candidate. Sir Murray Maxwell is a prominent figure, and is represented in the full swing of his eloquence; like Hunt, he is disposed to be a courteous opponent:—

“Gentlemen,—Mr. Hunt is anxious you should hear me now. I am certain you will hear him presently with pleasure. I am certain my cause is as popular as his; for I see many pretty girls pressing forward to hear me. Of all the days in the year, none appear more favourable for a British officer to receive your support than the anniversary of Waterloo.”

“Maxwell and the British Navy! Let every man do his duty!” is shouted; while hostile voices cry, “No Maxwell—no Captain Flog-’em.” A notice-board, capped by the crown, sets forth the merits of this candidate:—

“Who is Sir M. Maxwell? He is a brave, learned, loyal, and Constitutional man. He hoists only the colours of his King and country—not the red flag. He has engaged to pay his share of the Hustings to prevent new levies on the people.”

Sir S. Romilly (W) headed the poll with 5339 votes; Sir Francis Burdett was a good second with 5238; Sir Murray Maxwell, the unsuccessful candidate, polled 4808: the others were “nowhere”—Hunt, 84; Kinnaird, 65; Cartwright, 23.



HUNT, A
RADICAL
REFORMER.

In the same spirit the satirists regarded as fair game for their shafts of ridicule the new political section which had seceded from the Whig party as being behind the age; these were the “root-and-branch reformers,” who, from their electing to call themselves Radical reformers, obtained the party designation of “Radicals.” The orator Hunt is travestied in this guise.

The general turbulence of the times at this precise period is graphically pictured in “The Law’s Delay.”

“Now greeting, hooting, and abuse,
To each man’s party prove of use,
And mud, and stones, and waving hats,
And broken heads, and putrid cats
Are offerings made to aid the cause
Of order, government, and laws.”
(The Election Day.)

There appeared in 1819 “A Political Squib on the Westminster Election, Covent Garden” (March 3), by G. Cruikshank. This etching forms the frontispiece to a tract published April 20, 1819, for Bengo, print-dealer,

Maiden Lane, Covent Garden. The somewhat mystifying title of the election squib is “Patriot Allegory, Anarchical Fable, and Licentious Parody,” and it purports to be written by Peregrine Castigator. G. Cruikshank has availed himself of that long-suffering animal, the British Lion; in this instance the monarch of the beasts personates the successful candidate, the Hon. George Lamb being figured as the lion. He is exhibited standing under the city gate, beneath a portcullis, wreathed with laurels; his tail is lashed in anger, while the unsuccessful candidates, as an additional ignominy to their defeat, are travestied as the heads of a hydra trampled beneath their political victor. John Cam Hobhouse (W) polled 3,861, and was beaten by G. Lamb (C) with 4,465 votes. T. T. Wooler, the revolutionary publisher, for whom Cruikshank was working in 1815, is personified as the “Black Dwarf,” as his whilom ally ever after represented him; his duck’s-head cap is made to exclaim, “Cartwright and ’38!!!” the next individual says, “Quack! quack! quack!”—an allusion to the small minority of votes polled by the Radical candidate at the Westminster election for 1819, vice Romilly deceased, when 8,364 votes were registered, and only 38 of these for Cartwright.



THE LAW'S DELAY. READING THE RIOT ACT. 1820. BY G. CRUIKSHANK.

Showing the advantage and comfort of waiting the specified time after reading the Riot Act to a Radical mob; or a British magistrate in the discharge of his duty, and the people of England in the discharge of theirs! See speeches of the Opposition—*Passim*.

[Page 334.]

Major Cartwright, the “Drum-major of Sedition” of the ministerial satirists, was one of the Radical reformers who laboured actively for the reform of parliamentary abuses. He put up for Westminster in the Radical interest in 1818 and 1819, but seems to have had no support. In 1820, Major Cartwright addressed a petition to the House of Commons for the purpose of disclosing “that ninety-seven Lords usurped two hundred seats in the Commons-House in violation of our Laws and Liberties.”

“*Resolved*. That it is a high infringement upon our Liberties and Privileges for Lords of Parliament to concern themselves in the

Elections of members to serve for the Commons.” (*Journals at the commencement of every Session.*)

How far the measure of reform was needed in the corrupt system of boroughmongering is clearly demonstrated by Major Cartwright’s—

“Lists and Tables of Peers of the Realm who have unlawfully concerned themselves in the Election of members to serve for the Commons in the Parliament which was then sitting (1820), with the Counties and Towns where the unlawful interference of Peers has operated, either by nomination or influence, with the number of members unlawfully returned.”

For instance, the Dukes of Bedford and Rutland respectively returned four representatives; the same number was in the nomination of the Earls of Ailesbury, St. Germans, Mount Edgecumbe, etc., while such powerful autocrats as the Earl of Lonsdale contrived to return eight nominees, as did the Earl of Darlington; six members were returned by the Duke of Norfolk and Earl Fitzwilliam respectively; while the Dukes of Devonshire, Newcastle, and Northumberland, the Marquises of Buckingham and Hertford, the Earl of Powis, and Baron Carrington each managed to return five seats. To the calculations given in his table, the petitioner added the Treasury patronage, then in the Earl of Liverpool’s control, giving eleven members; the Admiralty, under Viscount Melville’s patronage, imposing three members, the Ordnance (Duke of Wellington) one—adding again, according to the calculations given in Oldfield’s “Representative History” (vi. 289),—

“There are ninety wealthy Commoners who, for 102 vile sinks of corruption over which they tyrannize, further dishonour the House by forcing on it 137 members,” thus giving a total of no less than 353 members, who, as Cartwright represented to the House of Commons in his very remarkable Petition, [the Major writes] “to use the words of the royal proclamation of the 30th July, 1819,” were created such “in gross violation of the law, and to the palpable subversion of the constitution, being corruptly or tyrannically imposed on the Commons.”

“The pure and undefiled principles of the Constitution” were inculcated by Major Cartwright in his “Lectures on the British Constitution,” “Letters to Lord Mayor Wood,” “Letters to Clarkson on African and English Freedom,” “Resolutions and Proceedings of the Hampden Club,” “A Bill of Rights and Liberties; or, an Act for restoring the Civil Branch of the Constitution,” and the companion work, “A Bill of Free and Sure Defence, for restoring the Military Branch.” The major was brimming over with zeal, and had almost too good a case; unfortunately for the enforcement of his reforms, he was too early in the field.

The coming elections of 1820 were preceded by several caricatures. Those by George Cruikshank are the most meritorious, the artist’s work for this date being at its best. He was at that time employed by Humphrey, the print-publisher, of St. James’s Street, as a successor to James Gillray, an honour the artist regarded with pride to the close of his long career. On the 1st of January, John Cam Hobhouse, who was then canvassing Westminster, and was this year to be sent to parliament as the colleague of his friend, Sir Francis Burdett, was exhibited as “Little Hob in the Well,” under the title of “A Trifling Mistake—Corrected.” The diminutive statesman is exhibited in the place of his confinement, a prison-cell; he is gloomily contemplating two pictures on the wall, “St. Stephen’s Chapel *versus* Newgate.” A pile of manuscripts, blackened by the upsetting of an inkstand, and a mouse-trap assist the allusions. “The Trifling Mistake” is placarded on the wall in the indiscreet but pertinent utterances of the captive, which, if truly set forth, may account for his incarceration.

“What prevents the people from walking down to the House and pulling out the members by the ears, locking up their doors, and flinging the key into the Thames? Is it any majesty which lodges in the members of that assembly? Do we love them? Not at all; we have an instinctive horror and disgust at the abstract idea of a boroughmonger. Do we respect them? Not in the least. Do we regard them as endowed with any superior qualities? On the contrary, individually, there is scarcely a poorer creature than your mere member of Parliament, though in his corporate capacity the earth furnishes not so absolute a bully. Their true practical protectors, then—the real efficient anti-Reformers—are to be found at the Horse Guards and the

Knightsbridge Barracks. As long as the House of Commons majorities are backed by the regimental muster-roll, so long may those who have got the tax-power keep it,—and hang those who resist.”

In the same month appeared another strong “anti-reform” caricature from the same source—though, as we see by a later work, the artist’s sympathies were at this time on the side of the reformers, while Radical publishers of an advanced type were his chief employers,—“The Root of King’s Evil—Lay the Axe to it,” January 14, 1820. A learned prelate, seated in his library, is considerably scared by the apparition of the red spectre, literally a root—possibly implying the tree of liberty—planted in “le bonnet rouge,” and wearing the cap of liberty. On a pike in one hand is the mitred head of a bishop, in the other is another pike surmounted by a battered crown, with the tricolour flag edged with crape, and inscribed “Blood, Reform, and Plunder,” with a list of the “reds” and reformers in juxtaposition—Watson, Thistlewood, Preston, Hooper, Waddington, Harrison, Hunt, Pearson, Wood, Waithman, Parkins, etc. In the second category are Cobbett, Carlile, Tom Paine, Burdett, Little Hob, Death, and the Devil,—no King, etc. The prelate is interrogating the spectral visitor: “In the name of Satan, what the Devil are you, and where were you hatched?” “In Hell, your worship. I’m a Radical. Give me leave to present you a list of my best friends.” “Burn’s Justice” stands open at “Treason,” and a huge volume of “Etymology” stands exposed at the definition of “Radical”—“*Ex Radix* is a root, and *Calor* is heat, anger, strife; *q.d.*—The root of all strife.”

A comprehensive view of the respective sections of Radicals and Reformers on the dissolution of Parliament, February 29, 1820, is afforded by one of G. Cruikshank’s most successful caricatures, which may be considered, in point of execution, as among the works most worthy of his reputation; it is entitled, “Coriolanus Addressing the Plebs,” February 29, 1820. The scene is the screen in front of Carlton House Palace, and His Majesty, the magnifico George IV., is flatteringly travestied as Coriolanus. The “cauliflower” wig and false whiskers affected by “the finest gentleman in Europe” detract from the consistency of the figure, otherwise attired in classic guise, and presenting a dignified appearance; for, wonderful to relate, Cruikshank has gone out of his way to compliment the king in more

than one respect. The address, a felicitous quotation from Shakespeare, is antagonistic to the actual sentiments held by the artist at this stage of his career:—

“What would ye have, ye curs, that like not peace nor war? The one affrights you, the other makes you proud. He that trusts to you, where he should find you lions, finds you hares; where foxes, geese. Hang ye! trust ye!! With every minute you change a mind, and call him noble that was now your hate; him vile, that was your garland. What’s the matter, that in the several places of the city, you cry against the noble Senate, who (under the gods) keep you in awe, which else would feed upon one another?”

Hon. Douglas Kinnaird.



Coriolanus (George IV.).

Plebs:

Dr. Watson.

Preston.

Carlile.

W. Cobbett.

Orator Hunt.

Thelwall.

Sir F. Burdett.

W. Hone.

Wooler, the Black Dwarf.

Cartwright.

Hobhouse.

Alderman Waithman.

Cruikshank.

CORIOLANUS ADDRESSING THE PLEBS. 1820. BY GEORGE
CRUIKSHANK.

Beneath the quotation is a passage from Buffon, eulogizing the nobility of the figure above, “L’image de l’âme est peinte par la physionomie”—“animé d’un feu divin,” and other extravagances, such as “his majestic presence, and the firm and bold deportment which marks his nobility and rank.” In the other “Great George’s” parody, the various sections, from Reformers to Revolutionists and Socialists, are carefully kept apart, although the plebeians at the first glance appear but a miscellaneous mob.

First comes “Liberty of the Press,” a tricolour standard, topped by the “cap of liberty.” At the front stands William Hone, a stalwart champion, armed with two formidable clubs, one is styled “Parody,” and the other inscribed with the names of the famous satirical tracts, “The Man in the Moon,” and “The House that Jack Built,” both objectionable weapons in the eyes of the “Coriolanus” of the picture. Behind his ally and publisher, Hone, is the portrait of the artist himself, with a tricoloured portfolio marked “Caricature.” George Cruikshank, in his later days, when turned to Tory proclivities like one or two other notabilities in the group, endeavoured to soften the impression conveyed by this print, and described “your humble servant” as “one of the moderate reformers,” evidently not relishing the company of those among whom, in his early truculent days, he had voluntarily enrolled himself. Next comes the figure of the champion of the Princess of Wales, “Sheriff Double Hue,” otherwise Waithman, who is hugging a project for “Hell-wide Measures;” beneath the standard of the “Examiners” and “Chronicles” stands a figure clad in complete Highland garb; this is Douglas Kinnaird, on the alert, and armed with his trusty claymore. Sir Francis Burdett and John Cam Hobhouse, jointly grasping a formidable weapon, are enlisted under the standard of “Parliamentary Reform.” Hobhouse is trampling on the “Trifling Mistake,” a parodied version of the speech which procured him more notoriety than was desirable: over his head is seen Thelwall as a champion lecturer; Major Cartwright, the so-called “Drum-Major of Sedition,” after all his struggles in the cause, is but a broken-down leader, supported on a crutch stick with one hand, while raising the redoubtable sword of “Universal Suffrage” in

the other. Prominent in front of the group enlisted under the ensign of “Revolution and Plunder,” capped with the Death’s head, stands Wooler, travestied as the “Black Dwarf,” after the paper he had then made notorious. Orator Hunt, with pike reversed, is resting one hand on Cobbett’s shoulder; the latter, a brawny figure, flourishing two gigantic bones (of contention?); another communist is skulking away, having let fall Tom Paine’s “Age of Reason.” The publisher of the “new lights,” Carlile, is resting on a staff capped with a thistle; Preston, the bootmaker, a violent Democrat, together with Thistlewood and others holding extreme views, are enrolled under a bond of “Blood and Plunder.” The figure to the extreme left, next to the screen of Carlton House, is described by Cruikshank as intended for Dr. Watson. Truly the “Plebs” form a muster-roll of all the prominent Radicals and Revolutionists of a period when secret societies of those whose designs were inimical to constitutional order were presumed to flourish.

The evils which disfigured constituencies in the boroughmongering days are pictorially set forth by George Cruikshank, under date April 23, 1820, in a caricature entitled “Freedom and Purity of Election!!! Showing the Necessity of Reform in the Close Boroughs.” The scene refers to the elections in Cornwall; the locality being indicated by a signpost as Tregony and St. Austel. The unhappy villagers, by the independent exercise of their suffrages, have displeased their feudal proprietor, and are being summarily evicted from their houses, with their household belongings, by a truculent steward, with a list of the “proscribed” held in his hand. Old and young, women and children, are alike doomed, because they or their protectors have dared to act with independence, and have not voted according to the fiat of the lord of the manor. Daniel O’Connell appears as the unsuccessful candidate; he is viewing this mischief with compassion, and is encouraging those evicted “not to be cast down, as there are other houses besides his lordship’s,” and that he—the Liberator—“will not desert them, although they have lost the election.”

Parliament reassembled at the end of April, 1820, and in May, George Cruikshank again favoured the public with another anti-reform cartoon, “Radical Quacks giving a New Constitution to John Bull!” In this version the persons most prominent among the “Plebeians” are alluded to

incidentally. John Bull, the national prototype, is reduced, under the new “regimen,” out of all recognition; in fact, he is but the mangled remnant of his former portly self, for the new charlatans are having “their own sweet will.” John Bull is placed between Burdett and Hobhouse; many desperate operations have already taken place. He wears the bonnet-rouge of “Liberty” as a night-cap. His left arm is in a tricoloured sling, while his right arm is being bled. His two sufficient supports of Church and State have been amputated, and in their places are strapped two wooden-legs—“Universal Suffrage,” propped on the “Rights of Man,” and “Religious Freedom,” which is raised on the “Age of Reason;” the legs of his invalid-chair are equally unreliable—“Mistaken Confidence,” and “Mistaken Security;” the sufferer is resting on a pillow stuffed with “False Promises” and “Reformers’ Opinions.” Sir Francis Burdett, as a professional adviser, is holding the arm from which he is draining the patient’s blood:—

“Mr. Bull, you have lived too well, but when we have renovated your constitution according to our plan, the reform will be so complete—that you will never again be troubled with any fulness whatsoever!”

John Cam Hobhouse is administering a tricoloured bolus of formidable dimensions, to be followed by a corresponding draught:—

“Never mind, Mr. Bull; if we have thought it necessary to take off both your legs, you will find the others very good substitutes; this Revolutionary Bolus and decoction of disloyalty are very harmless, but they will restore the *general equality* of the intestines and remove any obstruction which may prevent us from effecting a Radical Reform in the system.”

The victim of these experiments is by no means assured as to his future—

“Maybe, gentlemen,” he replies to these plausible assurances; “but you have taken all the honest good blood out of my veins; deprived me of my real supporters, and stuck two bad props in their place, and if you go on thus, I shall die before ever my constitution can be improved.”

The real supporters, “Mr. Bull’s two legs—Church and State,” are consigned to a coffin, “to be entombed in the vaults of St. Stephen’s Chapel.” A formidable array of nostrums are displayed in the vicinity: Burdett has soporifics and opiates handy—a huge bottle, labelled “Burdett’s Mixture,” contains a red, white, and blue republican decoction, “Hobhouse’s Newgate-proof Purity,” and “Whitbread’s Entire;” a large packet of “Cartwright’s Universal Grease,” with a phial of “Wooler’s Black-drops;” “Old Bailey Drops” (the bottle broken); ditto, “Dr. Watson’s White + Comfort;” a packet of “Hunt’s Powder,” and a full supply of “Cobbett’s Hellebore Ratsbane”—enough, in all conscience, to kill or cure.

CHAPTER XIII.

ELECTIONEERING, POLITICAL WARFARE, AND PARLIAMENTARY REFORM UNDER WILLIAM IV., 1830-32.

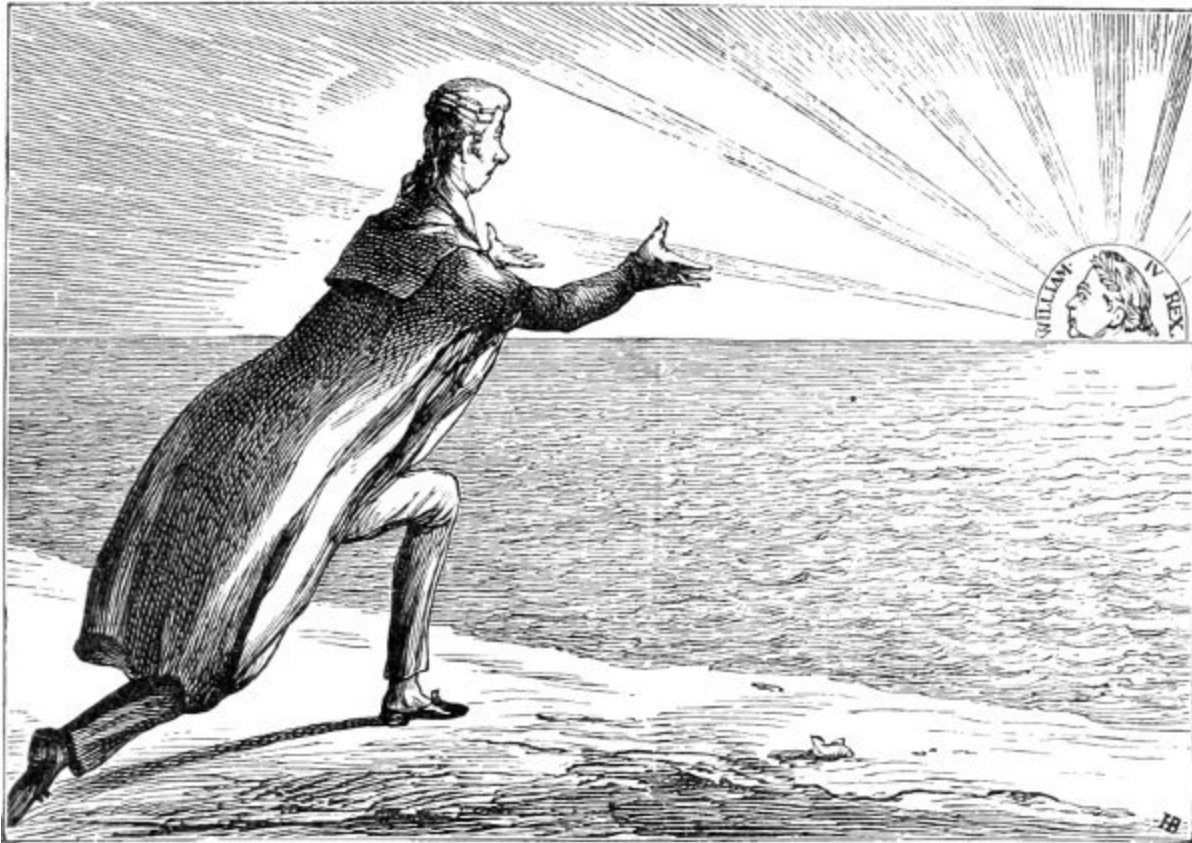
The last parliament of George IV.'s reign met November 14, 1826. Towards the close of the session, as is shadowed in Doyle's early cartoons, the nation was tiring of the Tories, and the unpopular and somewhat antiquated Wellington Ministry found the country in distress and clamorous for retrenchment, to each of which complaints the rigid disciplinarian in chief command turned a deaf and unsympathetic ear. Towards the middle of the year 1830 the king's condition was threatening, and with his impending decease the close of the session was anticipated. The situation is pictorially summed up in one of HB's sketches as the "Present State of Public Feeling Partially Illustrated" (May 28, 1830). The views entertained by various individuals upon the king's illness are illustrated in their persons: a dandy regrets the postponement of routs and balls, a speculator complains of the dulness of the funds, a merchant finds business at a standstill, while a lady of fashion is resigned to the will of Providence by the opportune reflection that should the king die there would be the gayer prospect of a queen and Court—an advantageous exchange for a sovereign shrouded from his subjects. John Bull good-naturedly declares he hopes George may recover, "he was such a fine princely fellow!" But the part of this picture which applies most pertinently to the subject in hand is found in a member of the Tory Government, who is reflecting "That should there be a change in the ministry—then I must walk out. That would be very inconvenient at the present. I wish most sincerely His Majesty won't die yet!" while another M.P. is filled with apprehension: "There will be a dissolution of parliament, and I shall lose my seat, and with it all chance of preferment. Oh, I pray God to preserve His Majesty's life these many years." Swiftly indeed, and

somewhat unexpectedly too, came the end of the king's reign and the inauguration of a more liberal *régime*.

The next day appeared HB's version of the "Mourning Journal—Alas! Poor Yorick" (May 29, 1830), showing the Duke of Cumberland and Lord Eldon as mutes in attendance on the (to them) melancholy occasion of their chief's decease. "The Magic Mirror, or a Peep into Futurity" (June 8, 1830), shows a magician favouring John Bull with the prospect he might anticipate: the youthful Princess Victoria becoming the point of contention on the one hand between her mother, the Duchess of Kent, and her uncle, Prince Leopold, of Liberal proclivities, and the Tory pressure of her uncle, the Duke of Cumberland, assisted by the Duke of Wellington, on the other.

While the dissolution was impending, Doyle indicated the revival of Whig prospects, "The Gheber worshiping the Rising Sun" (July 6, 1830) shows Mr. (afterwards Lord) Brougham paying his devotions to "William IV. Rex," the head of the king on the gold coin, known as "a coronation medal," rising over the waters, and taking the place of the orb of day. Parliament dissolved on July 24th. Owing to some intrigues of the old campaigner at this emergency, the Duke of Wellington was made to appear as "A Detected Trespasser," ordered off the slopes of Windsor by "John Bull, Ranger:" "Halloa, you sir; keep off the grass (see anecdote, *Times*, July 19th)."

Another pictorial version of strategies in high life is entitled "Anticipation; or, Queen Sarah's visit to Bushy" (July 27, 1830). At the door of the Lodge at Bushy, where resided the Duke and Duchess of Clarence, is the carriage of Lady Jersey, with attendants in her handsome liveries. One of her footmen is imparting the unwelcome intelligence, "Duchess not at home, my lady." The Duke of Wellington, who is on horseback at the other side of the carriage, is consoling Lady Jersey's disappointment: "Never mind, never mind, I'll get you a key to what is going on here thro' my dear little St. James's Marchioness." The duchess's footman, in the royal livery, cannot fathom the intrigue: "I wonder what brings her down here now? I have been in this place these twelve years, and never saw her here before!"



Henry Brougham.

King William IV.

THE GHEBER WORSHIPING THE RISING SUN. JULY 6, 1830. BY J. DOYLE
(HB).

What unknown marvels might be anticipated from the combinations of party, is hinted in the “*Un-Holy Alliance, or An Ominous Conjunction*” (July 29, 1830), showing the Duke of Cumberland and Lords Durham, Grey, and Eldon in close confabulation. “Old Bags,” as the whilom lord chancellor was irreverently christened, is characteristically “laying down the law,” for the enlightenment of his comrades in this strangely assorted quartette.

A general and somewhat conventional satire on the possible conduct of candidates before, upon, and after their return, appeared among the “*Election Squibs and Crackers for 1830*,” “Look on this Picture, and on that.” “General Election—dedicated to Electors in General—the difference between one hour after the return, and one month after.” The voter

represented is evidently a prosperous mechanic; he wears the colours of the newly elected one in his hat, and is thus addressed by the member he has contributed to return: "My worthy, my best friend, it will be my constant study to comply with your wishes—how can I serve you? Let me see you often; pray come to the Hall; we shall be so happy to see you." This overcoloured state of things is strangely altered within a month; the candidate is now a full member, and is evidently studying his own interests to the exclusion of those of his constituents; in his hand is a peremptory Government "whip," thus worded: "Ministers wishing to pass the measure, your vote will be required." The legislation in question appears to threaten the welfare of his late enthusiastic supporter, who has ventured to interview his member on the momentous topic: "Sir, there is a Bill about to pass that will quite ruin our trade, and bring our families to beggary. I hope, sir, you will use your influence to throw it out." The member now wears an indignant expression: "You are an impudent fellow! I don't know you, and, if I did, do you suppose I should be dictated to, fellow?" This plate was executed by William Heath, and issued by T. McLean, of the Haymarket. Perhaps the most notable feature is an announcement that "Election caricatures can be executed for gentlemen in three hours." This advertisement, appended to the caricature in question, is curious. Of course, for a not-extravagant consideration, intending candidates could secure the playful services of William Heath for rendering ridiculous or contemptible the persons and principles of their antagonists, and for the exaltation of their own.

LOOK ON THIS PICTURE—AND ON THAT.



Before the Election.



After the Election.

ELECTION SQUIBS AND CRACKERS FOR 1830. BY W. HEATH.

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Political satirists, happily for themselves, as a rule (with one or two exceptions, such as Sayer and HB) have soared above mere party distinctions; and though it may at first sight strike the observer as indicating a looseness of principles—rather, say, a freedom from prejudices—that each gifted artist seems to lash and laugh at both sides alternately to the best of his abilities, some allowance must be made for the impartiality which enables these latter-day Juvenals to detect the foibles of either faction. As a rule, it may be assumed the old generation of famous caricaturists, taking Gillray, Rowlandson, and George Cruikshank as the most eminent exponents, rather leaned to the popular side of any given question; but, inclination apart, they were just as capable of glorifying “the powers that be,” and of “dusting the jackets” of the would-be reformers. Of this trio, Cruikshank particularly prided himself, as he has himself recorded, upon espousing the side of right against palpable wrong, and of championing the

weak against the strong. But, in spite of this pleasing illusion, his caricatures are equally trenchant on either side—to-day the Regent is demolished, to-morrow his unfortunate wife is held up to opprobrium, with happy nonchalance and impartiality. In fact, it may be said of Gillray, as the specimens of his ability in this direction sufficiently demonstrate, that his pictorial satires against Pitt and the Tories were equalled only by his satires directed against Fox and the Whigs, or the youthful Burdett and the Radical reformers of his earlier day.

Apropos of the same general elections, we find our old friends, Sir Francis Burdett and his whilom preceptor and champion, William Cobbett, of *Political Register* repute, engaged in what the artist delineates as “A Character-istic Dialogue” (September 2, 1830). “Peter Porcupine,” having parliamentary aspirations, is applying to his ancient pupil and ally for a voucher: “Being much in want of a character, I make bold, Sir Francis, to ask you for one; it appearing that your benevolence in this way embraces all sorts of criminals, you cannot consistently refuse me!” Burdett, in spite of this touching reference to his exertions on behalf of the prisoner inmates of Coldbath Fields, is turning a haughty front to the applicant: “I cannot do anything for you; your character is already *Registered*.” With the reformed parliament, Cobbett was returned for Oldham. In the House he disappointed expectations, and was regarded as somewhat in the light of a failure.



WILLIAM COBBETT—"PETER PORCUPINE." BY J. GILLRAY.

The usual changes of seats had taken place in the course of the elections, and it was hinted that the Wellington-Peel Administration might find it expedient to increase its strength by the infusion of new blood, with a view to the "power-to-add-to-their-numbers" policy. The chiefs still in office are shown by Doyle as visiting "The Noodle Bazaar" (September 9, 1830, Q. and HB delt.). Reviewing the files of various assorted "bustoes," Wellington, using his eye-glass, is observing to his colleague, "Peel, I am in

great want of a few good heads to place in our Cabinet before the opening of the new House in October, and I see some here which I think would answer, if they could be had on reasonable terms." Peel, alive to the results of the elections, is replying, "I perceive that the places of some have been changed, and their value raised since I last saw them, and pray observe the strange mixture of heads upon the *upper shelf*." The Peers who, according to the notification below them, "May be had separately or together," occupy the upper shelf, and below is a cabinet of busts for sale, ready assorted. The shelved lords offer a motley choice: Lords Grey, Eldon, Holland, Lansdowne, the Duke of Cumberland, etc.,—all statesmen out of work. Below the upper shelf is a platform on which is an assorted ready-made ministry (of busts) arranged in a regular order. "This group is to be sold in one lot. Every head has its price marked on it." The respective busts represent Huskisson (president of the Board of Trade), Grant (colonies), Palmerston (foreign secretary), Melbourne (home secretary), etc. On a pedestal marked "Yorkshire, to wit," is the brazen bust of Henry Brougham, the plinth with the word "Rolls" struck out in favour of "Chancery." The bust of Hume in marble stands on a square and massive pediment, marked "Middlesex." O'Connell is below in clay; he is thus ticketed: "This head won't be sold—(until it be bought)." A row of lesser men on a shelf in the distance bears the advertisement, "These small busts may be had remarkably cheap." The bust of Charles X. is just upset; while, on a high plinth, marked "The People's Choice—a French pattern of inestimable value," stands his successor, Louis Philippe. The Dey of Algiers is also thrown aside, while Lords Manners, Redesdale, and Sidmouth are among the "antiques," obsolete patterns, and "oddments."

The proverbial independence of John Bull's character is playfully called in question (September 10, 1830), the national prototype being represented (not for the first or last time) as "The man wot is easily led by the nose." The *Times* is the potential leading organ to which John Bull is attached in the way described; he is exclaiming, in happy delusion, "What a glorious thing it is to enjoy the liberty and independence of an Englishman!"

The displacement of the Wellington-Peel Cabinet followed a little later on. We next see the Duke of Cumberland surrendering office: "Resignation

and Fortitude; or, the Gold Stick.” The king is seated busied in State affairs, the ex-Gold Stick, handing in the wand of office, is remarking, “I have now only to cut my stick and be off!” William IV., still pen in hand, replies briefly, “Thank ye, brother, thank ye,” being evidently reconciled both to his situation and the enormous sacrifice involved.

Incidentally we find a reference to the general election which was then engaging public attention; Doyle has ingeniously given a novel turn to his view of one of the candidates, by introducing a comparison with a performer who was also enjoying popular notice, “The Rival Candidates” (August 9, 1830). There are two hustings erected, and the crowd of free and independent electors is filling the intervening space. The satire is evidently aimed at Sir Alexander Grant, who, standing in front of his committee, is pointing, with a self-satisfied air, to his chin, of which Doyle has made the most. His rival is Michel Boai, “the musical wonder,” a Tyrolese performer, who “played tunes on his chin” by sheer muscular force. He is shown hammering his nether jaw with his fists, and giving a specimen of his chin-proficiency, supported by another minstrel with a small violin. Boai’s performance has won the sympathies and suffrages of his audience, who have with one accord turned their backs upon Sir A. Grant, and are applauding the new musical marvel. Boai’s agent is skilfully “working the oracle” while drawing attention to the rival booth:—

“The hon^{ble} Gentleman opposite has certainly a most extraordinary chin, and when he places his claims to your suffrages upon that broad and ample basis, it must be GRANTed that he rests his hopes upon some foundation; but, Gentlemen, the Candidate whom I propose to you possesses such transcendent superiority in this important feature that I feel BOAIed up with confidence, when I claim for him your triumphant preference (cheers); and, Gentlemen, permit me to add that, in the event of his return, which I now consider certain (cheers), few orators in the hon: House will command more attention, or be listened to with so much pleasure.”

That the interests of the Wellington Cabinet were in jeopardy is pictorially conveyed. “The Unsuccessful Appeal” (September 25, 1830) shows John Bull arm-in-arm with the king, while Wellington is pointing to

a distant movement amongst the crowd, and asking Mr. Bull's protection against his political foes. "My good old friend, I want your assistance against these fellows, who are about to unite for the purpose of overpowering me by numbers." The inimical confederates are Brougham and Lords Holland, Durham, Grey, etc., on the one side, who are fraternizing with Lord Eldon, the Duke of Cumberland, and others, on the other. Johnny is thus responding to the old campaigner's appeal:—

"I should be sorry to see you defeated by such an unholy alliance after all the battles we have fought and won together; but the fact is, I feel so oppressed with the glory of so many victories, that I must beg to be excused from interfering any more for the present in the disputes of others. There are, however, plenty of clever fellows to be had, who are able and willing enough to assist you, but when you again meet with such, let me advise you not to be too ready to quarrel with them!"

William IV. is quite at one with his friend, the last speaker—"Whatever you say, John, I will agree to; for *your* will is *my* pleasure."

Before the new parliament assembled, the Cabinet received some damaging assaults from the press. The nature of this concealed warfare is explained by HB in his sketch of "A Masked Battery" (October 4, 1830). The assailant is Henry Brougham: in his legal guise, entrenched behind the "Result of the General Election," with the *Edinburgh Review* for a screen, he is bespattering his opponents, the beleaguered "Ins," with ink. The Tory Cabinet is suffering severely: Wellington is to the front, trying to ward off the shower from Brougham's inkstand-battery; in his hand is a damaging attack on paper,—*"The Duke of Wellington and the Whigs."* Sir Robert Peel is endeavouring to shelter himself behind his chief. Lords Bathurst, Ellenborough, Lyndhurst, and Aberdeen are all suffering from the assault.

When the House met, we get a prospect of the prime minister reviewing his forces—"A Cabinet Picture" (November 5, 1830). Wellington, with his colleagues, Lords Aberdeen, Lyndhurst, Bathurst, Rosslyn, Melville, and others, whom the chief is thus addressing:—

"Having been obliged to recognize the King of the French, we must, as a set-off—acknowledge our friend Miguel. The Belgians—

poor people!—not knowing how to take care of themselves, must be protected from the evils of independence! So much for foreign affairs, now for domestic. I say that our present system is the very perfection of systems, and consequently admits of no improvement; I will go further, and say that, while I have power, no species of reform shall take place! and now—having said it—if Peel will but manage the new Police, Hardinge Ireland, Goulburn [Chancellor of the Exchequer] abstain from projects of finance, and Ellenborough hold his tongue, we may manage to keep our seats for another session.”

After the elections it was evident that things out-of-doors were moving antagonistically to the interests of the Wellington Cabinet, but the “Old Campaigner” still hoped by stratagem to keep in power, although resolute in asserting that while he kept office no species of reform should take place. The premier’s optimistic confidence “that his ministry might keep their places for another session” is shown to be misplaced, for the defeat of his ministry was clearly foreshadowed: “Guy Fawkes, or the Anniversary of the Popish Plot” (November 9, 1830), shows that destruction was abroad; and this cartoon is a late exemplification of the old British institution of burning in effigy a minister when out of favour. The political Guy is, of course, Wellington, the hero of a hundred fights, reproduced in straw, tied to a rickety chair, and is gaily borne to the bonfire by a rejoicing mob of statesmen, his political antagonists. Lord Lansdowne leads the way, with a blazing torch to fire the fatal pyre; the bearers are the Duke of Cumberland and Prince George (Duke of Cambridge), Lords Holland, Sidmouth, Eldon, etc.; Aberdeen, Stanhope, and the Duke of Newcastle bring up the rear in a high state of exaltation;—these were the peers who “sapped the Tory defences.”

Wellington was evidently losing popularity, and the lustre he gained in the field was being clouded in the Cabinet; John Bull has to come to his rescue against the rabble, and the valiant captain is once more shown sheltered under the king’s mantle. It appears the lord mayor’s banquet was threatened with a hostile demonstration, and the city magistrate, “Don Key,” was thrown into a deadly state of apprehension by the alleged prospect of being received with “cold indifference.” This cartoon is entitled “The False Alarm; or, Much Ado about Nothing.”

The Wellington tenure of power was doomed, and, like Cæsar's, his fatal stab was to come from the hand of a colleague, on the inopportune revival of the Eastern Question. "Scene from the suppressed Tragedy, entitled the Turco-Greek Conspiracy," shows the minister (wearing his well-earned laurels) done to death by the Peers at the foot of Canning's statue in the forum; the Senators being armed with deadly speeches wherewith to accomplish this tragic immolation. "Et tu Brute" are the hero's closing words addressed to his past comrade, Lord Londonderry, who is giving the *coup de grâce*.

W. Heath, who was employed by McLean at the time Doyle's sketches were making their appearance, has given many versions of events during George IV.'s somewhat oppressive reign. At the close of 1830, with the advent to the throne of a more constitutionally-minded sovereign, the artist sums up the dismissal of a Cabinet whose actions he had frequently criticized from a pictorially satirical point of view. In the version of "His Honour the Beadle Driving the Wagabonds Out of the Parish," November 28, 1830, Heath has impressed Sir David Wilkie's well-known picture of "The Parish Beadle" into the service of parody. King William IV., as the Bumble of the situation, is making a clean sweep of the relics of the past reign: "Come, be off: no hangers behind—out with you all! I'll let you see I represent the aristocracy of the parish!" John Bull, who may be considered to have generally endorsed his friend William's policy with hearty goodwill, is giving his approval: "That's right, Master Beadle, do your duty and clear the parish of the varments; they've been a pest ever since they've been here." The chancellor Lyndhurst, Lord Ellenborough, Goulburn (late chancellor of the exchequer), and the rest, are making a hasty retreat. Peel, dragging his "new police" monkey attached to a string, is hardly reconciled to his banishment from office: "Vell, ve did all ve could to kick up a row afore ve vent!" Wellington, as the "hurdy-gurdy" woman, dressed in the faded splendours of an old soldier's coat, is making all the noise of which the instrument is capable while retreating with his face to the foe.

The results of the general election of 1830 culminated within a month of the reassembling of parliament in the substitution of a Whig for a Tory ministry, and William IV.'s tenure of the throne was inaugurated by the early adoption of that liberal progress which developed into the larger

measure of reform within two years, the most memorable act of his reign. Doyle shows the ensuing distribution of offices, and sketches one of the intrigues for place—Henry Brougham, as “The Coquet,” being tempted by Lord Grey to a political allegiance, and courted on the woolsack with the bait of the chancellor’s wig. After the preliminary skirmishing and cementing of necessary alliances, the end was short, sharp, and decisive, and is embodied by HB with his customary point and felicity, as “Examples of the Laconic Style” (November 26, 1830). The king is “standing at attention;” he has sent for Lord Grey. “Your conditions?” The coming premier answers, “Retrenchment, Reform, and Peace.” “Done!” says the king, holding out his hand on the bargain. The Duke of Wellington, on the left, is stepping off the scene, while John Bull, to the right, is not reluctantly giving his late commander the order, “Right about face, march!”

Lord Chancellor
Lyndhurst.

Scarlett.

Lord
Ellenborough.

Goulburn, Chancellor of
Exchequer.



Duke of Wellington.

Sir Robert Peel.

William IV.

John Bull.

HIS HONOUR THE BEADLE (WILLIAM IV.) DRIVING THE WAGABONDS
OUT OF THE PARISH. NOV. 28, 1830. By W. HEATH.

With the advent of the powerful Whig party came such sweeping reforms that minds accustomed to the old order of things began to take fright. It seemed that national institutions, and those fabled landmarks, “The bulwarks of the constitution,” bid fair to be swept away within six months, and another appeal to the constituencies was imminent. The Tory views of the new order of things were embodied by Doyle (April 4, 1831) in “A Very Prophetical and Pathetical Allegory,” in which it was foreshadowed that the institutions of the country could not survive reform, but must succumb within ten years. This vision conjures up a deserted cemetery, wherein, in woeful anticipation, is erected the tomb of departed greatness: “Here lyeth the British Constitution, which, after a rapid decline of ten years, departed this world, 1841.—I was well; wishing to be better, here I am. *Sic transit gloria mundi*.” The Duke of Wellington, as a widowed and ancient crony in deep sables, is shedding a tear, and depositing a wreath on the family vault, which is presumed to contain such honoured dust.

The gloomy forebodings of the Tories are further illustrated with much spirit in the guise of an expected game of “Leap-Frog down Constitution Hill,” April 13, 1831, in which the Whigs are flying over the heads of the opposition. On Constitution Hill stand Burdett, O’Connell, Hunt, and other advanced politicians, crying, “Go it, my boys; we shall soon have it our own way;” the game is proceeding swimmingly down the slope. Lord King has brought down an archbishop—the head of the Church; Lord Althorp is sweeping down the judges; Lord Lansdowne has upset Lord Eldon; Lord Durham directs the tall Duke of Cumberland to stoop his head; Lord Brougham, in his chancellor’s robes, has alighted on the shoulders of the Duke of Wellington; William IV. has “tucked in his head” and “made a back” for Lord Grey; but the premier, in his flying leap, has failed to clear the crown, which is sent spinning. “D—n it,” says the king, “didn’t you tell me you wouldn’t touch the Crown?”

The coming appeal to the country was preceded by the usual political meetings; this circumstance is made the subject of a felicitous parody, “*Anticipated Radical Meeting*” (April 20, 1831). In one of Hunt’s Matchless

(Blacking) carts stands the glib-tongued Radical in the full tide of his harangue; “Hunt, the Matchless Reformer,” is surrounded by the Tory party; the opposition consists of the ex-ministers, and includes Sugden, Peel, Horace Twiss, Wetherell, Goulburn, Ellenborough, Wellington, Aberdeen, and others, who are ironically welcoming and encouraging the oration. Hunt’s speech is thus reported:—

“Will the Bill, I ask, do away with places and pensions? (Cheers.) Will it abolish tithes and taxes? (Cheers.) In a word, will it make the poor rich and happy? (Great cheering.) No! It will do none of these! therefore I say this Bill is all a delusion! (Tremendous cheering and waving of hats.)”

Old Eldon, mounted on the shoulders of his ally, the Duke of Cumberland, is vociferously calling for “One cheer more!”

The House dissolved on the 22nd of April, and the fresh elections took place in May. The nature of John Bull’s complaint and the respective views of the rival practitioners who were called in for consultation are set forth by HB (May 2, 1831) as “Hoo-Loo-Choo—*alias* John Bull and the Doctors.” The national prototype is seated in an arm-chair; his huge corporation seems to have become utterly unwieldy and inconvenient; he occupies the centre of the picture. His doctors “in and out of place,” are on the respective sides. John Bull is addressing Lord Grey:—

Sir F. Burdett.

Lord Durham.

Duke of Cumberland.

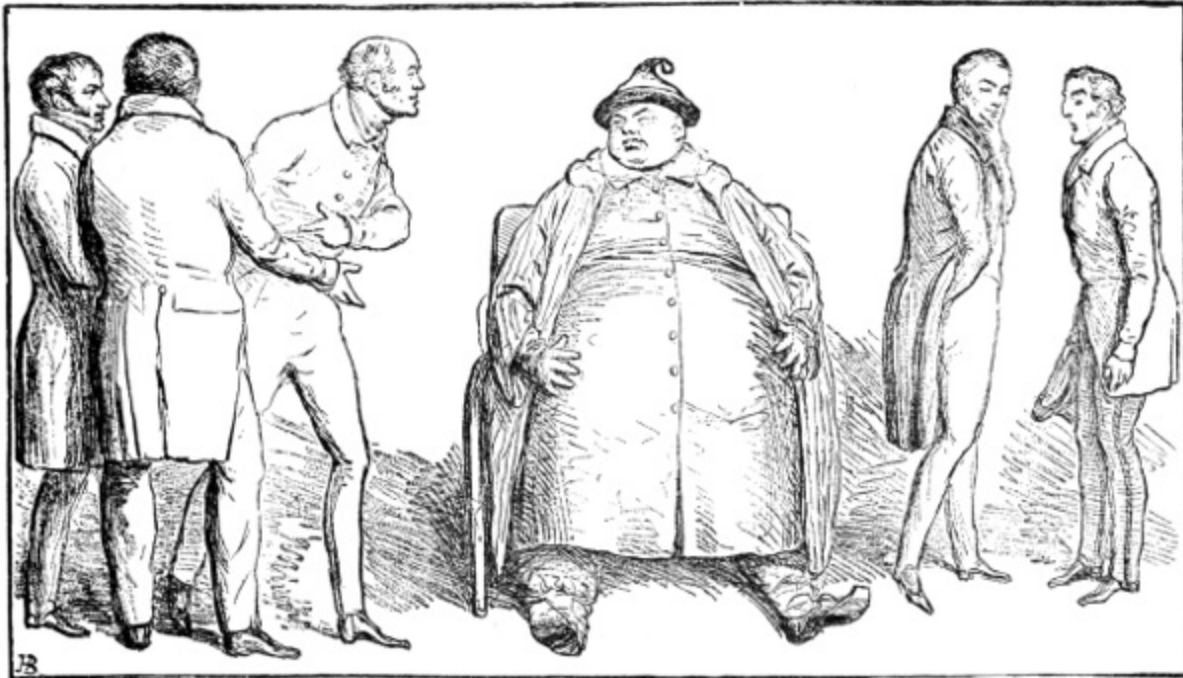


Lord Holland.	Lord Althorp on a Judge.	Lord King on the Bishop.	Lord Brougham (Lord Chancellor). Duke of Wellington.	The King (William IV.)	Lord Grey.
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LEAP-FROG DOWN CONSTITUTION HILL. APRIL 13, 1831. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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“With such vehement force and might
 Lord King drove all before,
 The Bill went through ’twixt Philpotts’ legs
 And turn’d him fairly o’er.”



Lord J. Russell. Lord Althorp. Lord Grey. John Bull. Sir Robert Peel. Duke of Wellington.

HOO-LOO-CHOO, *alias* JOHN BULL AND THE DOCTORS. MAY 2, 1831.

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“I can’t say that my bodily health was ever better, or that I ever felt stronger, tho’ to be sure I am not growing younger; but then every one is telling me how deformed I am grown of late, and this tumour—which I have had from my infancy—is all a mass of Corruption.”

Grey, while indicating his colleagues, Althorp and Russell, says in reply, “This deformity is quite inconsistent, believe me, with the nature of your Constitution, and therefore must be got rid of. I will undertake, with your approbation, to remove it, and my assistant, Doctor Russell here, will prepare you for the operation.”

Russell is observing, “I once thought that a case of this description ought to be treated with great caution, and even wrote, as well as talked, a great deal about it, but now I am quite of a different opinion. I think there is nothing like cutting away thro’ thick and thin!”

Sir Robert Peel, one of the dismissed doctors, on mature consideration, is inclined to question his past policy: "Yet I begin to think we could have done better, when we found him determined to think that his Constitution was impaired, to have tried, just in the way of soothing, a gentle alternative course."

Dr. Wellington is still of his old opinion: "I say that the man has no defect in his Constitution, and that what they call Corruption is necessary to his existence; but now, because he would not believe me, but chose rather to submit to the experiments of those rash operators, Wharncliffe, who is a sensible man, lays all the blame on me."

The lively proceedings while the returns were preparing were fittingly epitomized by HB as "May Day" (May 4, 1831), setting forth as a "Jack-in-the-Green" performance the new revels of the revisers of the constitution. The king occupies the green, which is topped by a crown, and bears the word "Reform;" the face of William IV. is peeping through the aperture. Earl Grey is "My Lord;" Sir Francis Burdett is almost equally conspicuous. Hobhouse, Hume, and O'Connell are making a good deal of rough music with shovels, and Russell has the Pandean pipes and big drum, on which he is vigorously performing. Lord Brougham, as "My Lady," is going round with the ladle; he is interrogated by the Duke of Cumberland and Lord Eldon as to the "Man in the Green." The Duke of Gloucester and Lord Londonderry, among the audience, are regarding "My Lady" with suspicion.

The second portion of the new tactics is developed as "Leap-Frog on a Level; or, Going Headlong to the Devil" (May 6, 1831). The turn of the Reformers has come, and the Radicals are making them submit to the same process as they lately inflicted on the Tories. Carlile is rolling over a churchman to the place of torment, having leaped a trifle too far; the Evil One, as he declares in person, "has come to end your games." "The Devil you are," says the author of the tracts. Sir Francis Burdett is unwillingly giving a back, "Have I stooped for this?" His old ally, "Porcupine" Cobbett, is leaping heavily on to the baronet's shoulders, "My turn now, old Glory." Grey is staggering while Hunt is "overing" him: "I begin to think this is a very disorderly game." The mob are shouting, "Go it, Hunt," which is

displeasing to the now elevated orator: “D—— the Rabble, they take me for one of themselves.” Brougham is brought to his knees: “Hullo! you’ll have off my wig;” O’Connell, firmly seated on the chancellor’s back, is crying, “Oh! never mind; *I’ll* take care of that!” The king is brought to the earth; “This is the levelling system with a vengeance.” He is overturned by Hume, who is exclaiming, “This summing-up is the *tottle* of the whole.”



Hume
on Lord
King.

Dan O’Connell
on Lord
Brougham.

Orator Hunt
on Lord
Grey.

W. Cobbett
on Sir Francis
Burdett.

R.
Carlile.

LEAP-FROG ON A LEVEL; OR, GOING HEADLONG TO THE DEVIL. MAY 6,
1831. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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“‘But God is with us,’ said the King,
‘The people must be free.
I will create an hundred Peers
If need should ever be.’”

The House had dissolved on the 22nd of April, 1831, and the elections which ensued were remarkable for spirit. A quantity of literature, in the

shape of broadsides, songs, and squibs of a startling character, was produced on this occasion, in such abundance that even for small constituencies in out-of-the-way places these *jeux d'esprit* form huge volumes. A number of parodies appeared on the great question of the Reform Bill, imitations of scripture among others. Of the ballads published over the border, the one most descriptive of the constitutional struggle is found in a parody of "Chevy Chase."

"THE NEW CHEVY CHASE.

“God prosper long our noble king,
Our lives and safeties all;
Some dreadful battles late there were
Fought in St. Stephen’s Hall.

“Long o’er the land, with pride and scorn,
The Tories held their sway;
The child will rue that is unborn,
That has their debts to pay.

“The Tory Lords throughout the land,
A vow to God did make,
Their pleasure in their borough towns
As formerly to take.

“For they would keep their borough towns,
Whate’er the King might say.
These tidings to Lord Russell came,
In Bedford, where he lay.

“Who sent the Tories present word,
He would prevent their sport;
These noble Lords not fearing him,
Kept up their old resort:

“With nigh two hundred Tories bold,
All men of the old light,
Who knew full well, but would not own,
They were not in the right.

“Dark rumours through the country ran,
And many filled with fear—
And an old ‘Blacking man,’ called Hunt,
At Preston did appear.

“And long before this time they had
Been lab’ring in vain,
And fencing round their borough towns

And reaching round their borough towns,
That must be sieged and ta'en.

“The Bill-men muster'd on the hills,
Unable to endure;
They of their bare backs show'd a part,
Their clothing being poor.

“The ancient Whigs in front did stand,
Not one was seen to quake;
And with loud cries the hills and vales
Were rous'd for freedom's sake.

“Duke Wellington stood in the bent,
And spoke with haughty sneer—
Says he, 'Earl Grey he promised,
And Russell, to be here.

“‘But now I think they will not come,
To meet us here this day.’
With that a trembling pensioner
Thus to the Duke did say:—

“‘Lo! yonder doth Lord Russell come—
Earl Grey is in my sight—
Behind I see a countless host,
And gloomy as the night.

“‘All men displeased, from hill and dale
The King's name gives them head.’
‘Fie on the King,’ said Wellington,
‘Although I eat his bread.

“‘And, now, my proud preservatives,
Your courage to advance;
Upon the plains of Belgium,
You know I conquer'd France.

“‘And even the great Bonaparte,

That filled the world with fear,
I him encounter'd man for man
With Blucher in his rear.'

"Lord John upon a gallant Grey,
Like his great sires of old,
Stood foremost of the company,
His bearing it was bold:

"Shew me,' said he, 'what right have ye
To kick up sic a steer,⁶⁵
For a few dirty border towns,
Worth little goods or gear.'

"The first that then did answer make
Was Wellington so free,
Who said, 'We'll keep our borough towns,—
Corrupted though they be.

"For we have bought our borough towns
There's none can that gainsay.'
Then Russell swore a solemn oath,
And likewise did Earl Grey.

"We will not thus outbravèd be:
Proud chief, thy strength we'll try;
We know thee for a bloody man,
In this thy strength does lie.

"But as we wish for no man's death,
Nor any blood to spill,
You see we've brought into the field
No weapons but a Bill.

"Let you and I the matter try,
With reason on each side.'
'Curse on your cant,' said Wellington;
'You Whigs I can't abide.'

“Then stept a quibbling lawyer forth,
Old Wetherell was his name,
Who said, ‘he would not have it told
In Boroughbridge for shame,

“That e’er his captain or himself,
While he stood looking on,
Would condescend, or reasons give,
For reasons they had none.

“I’ll do the worst that I can do,
These inroads to withstand;
While I have power to use my tongue,
The robbers I will brand.’

“The Tory archers seized their shafts,
And a long-bow they drew,
But in the flight they wanted might,
And were not pointed true.

“To urge the battle in its need,
Lord Althorp bade the bent,
He was not filled with any pride,
But had a good intent.

“They clos’d full fast on every side,
They fought at every mound,
Till at the last the Tories yield,
And quit the common ground.

“O but it was a joy to see,
And likewise for to hear,
The grateful sounds that through the land
Came pealing on the ear.

“At last Duke Wellington and Grey
Came in each other’s sight;
Like lions roused they stand at bay,

And parley ere they fight.

“‘Yield thee, proud Captain,’ said Earl Grey,
‘In name of our good King;
You little think, by this delay,
What mischief you may bring.’

“‘Thy praise I will most freely give,
And this report of thee,
Thou art the most outrageous Duke
That ever I did see.’

“‘To yield to thee,’ said Wellington,
‘Would bring me nought but scorn;
Bring up the bishops to the fight,
And blow the gospel horn.’

“‘With that there came an arrow keen,
Out of a bishop’s bow,
That struck Earl Grey upon the head,
And almost laid him low.

“‘But still he spoke these cheering words,
‘Fight on, my merry men all,
The bishops they are stumbling-blocks,
I’m stunn’d, but will not fall.’

“‘Then gaining strength, Lord Brougham took
The old Earl by the hand,
And bade him rest a little while,
While he took the command.

“‘O, but the very heart does bleed,
What sorrow does it make,
To see the holy men of God
Bound to a worldly stake.

“‘A peer amongst the Whigs there was,
Who did the bishops eye,

And instantly did vow revenge
Upon the carnal fry—

“The brave Lord King, well known to all,
Who, with the Bill in sight,
And mounted on an iron Grey,
Laid on from left to right.

“Lord Harrowby he swiftly past,
And Wharncliffe wav’ring near,
And sought the dastard bishops out,
Where they stood in the rear.

“With such a vehement force and might,
He drove down all before;
The Bill went through ’twixt Philpotts’⁶⁶ legs,
And turn’d him fairly o’er.

“So thus Earl Grey was well aveng’d,
And did no more complain;
A Tory archer then conceiv’d
That Philpotts he was slain.

“He had a bow bent in his hand,
Made of a rotten tree,
An arrow of the self-same root,
Without a head, drew he.

“Against the noble peer, Lord King,
The rotten shaft was set,
But wanting a good Grey goose wing,
It fell before it met.

“These battles they were fought at night,
Before the rising sun,
And when they rung the ev’ning bells,
Again the fray begun.

“There was not many nobles slain,
But some may yet atone;
Lord Eldon sunk, and his last speech
Is to all people known.

“Great Sir James Scarlett in the field
Was ta'en of small account;
John Wilson Croker would not yield,
His talking did surmount.

“For Wetherell I needs must wail,
As one in doleful dumps,
At Bristol town he took leg-bail,
With nothing but his stumps.

“On Russell's side there did not fall,
A man who held degree,
But all yet live, and yet will fight,
If needs should ever be.

“With the Lord Durham, true and staunch
Did noble Stanley stand;
And Scotland, too, sustain'd her part,
Old Joseph shook his brand.

“And the Lord Althorp, he, likewise,
Disdained a foot to flee;
He held the bill still firm and fast,
And promis'd victory.

“Next day did many people come
Earl Grey for to bewail;
They found the old man at his post,
Determin'd to prevail.

“He had assurance from the King,
Who thus to him did say—
'Betide, betide, whate'er betide,

I will support thee, Grey.'

"The news was brought to Edinburgh,
Where the French King 's again,
That Wellington had won the fight,
And that Earl Grey was slain.

"O joyful news,' King Charles⁶⁷ said,
'Scotland will witness be,
That Wellington and Polignac⁶⁸
Are Pears of the same tree.'

"Like tidings to King William came,
Within a shorter space—
Says he, 'The bishops are great fools,
And really a disgrace.

"But God is with us,' said the King,
'The people must be free,
I will create an hundred Peers,
If need should ever be.

"Yet shall not Wellington long boast
What mischief he does make:
I saw him lately with the Queen,
I doubt he is a rake.

"This vow the King he will perform,
In honour of the crown;
A hundred peers he can create,
Or knock a hundred down.

"Then Peers will be of small account,
And Peel that stood so high,
Because he wants consistency,
I think we'll pass him by.'

"God save the King, and bless the land,
May all dissensions cease

May all dissensions cease,
And grant henceforth that foul debates,
Like this, may end in peace.”

This view of the situation is followed up by a cartoon aimed at the opposition tactics, “Votaries at the Altar of Discord” (April 20, 1831). Hunt is the high priest fanning the incendiary flame at the Altar of Discord, before which Sir Robert Peel, who seems to have relinquished power reluctantly, as the mouthpiece of his kneeling followers, is offering this invocation: “Powerful Goddess, deign to hear our prayers; deserted in this, our great extremity, by justice and wisdom, we fly to thee as a last refuge.” The other devotees are Horace Twiss, Goulburn, Dawson, Sadler, Sir E. Sugden, Sir C. Wetherell, Earl Carnarvon, and the Dukes of Wellington and Newcastle. The opposition in the Upper Chamber was in a highly excited state, an example of this is given in “Peerless Eloquence” (April 25, 1831). Lord Londonderry is boiling with indignation: “Is it to be endured, I ask, that we should be called *things*—things with Human pretensions? What was the fish-woman’s virtuous indignation at being called ‘an individual’ to this? Nothing!” Brougham, on the woolsack, remains calm under the torrent; Lords Aberdeen and Wharncliffe, with the Duke of Wellington, are placidly surveying the outraged senator.

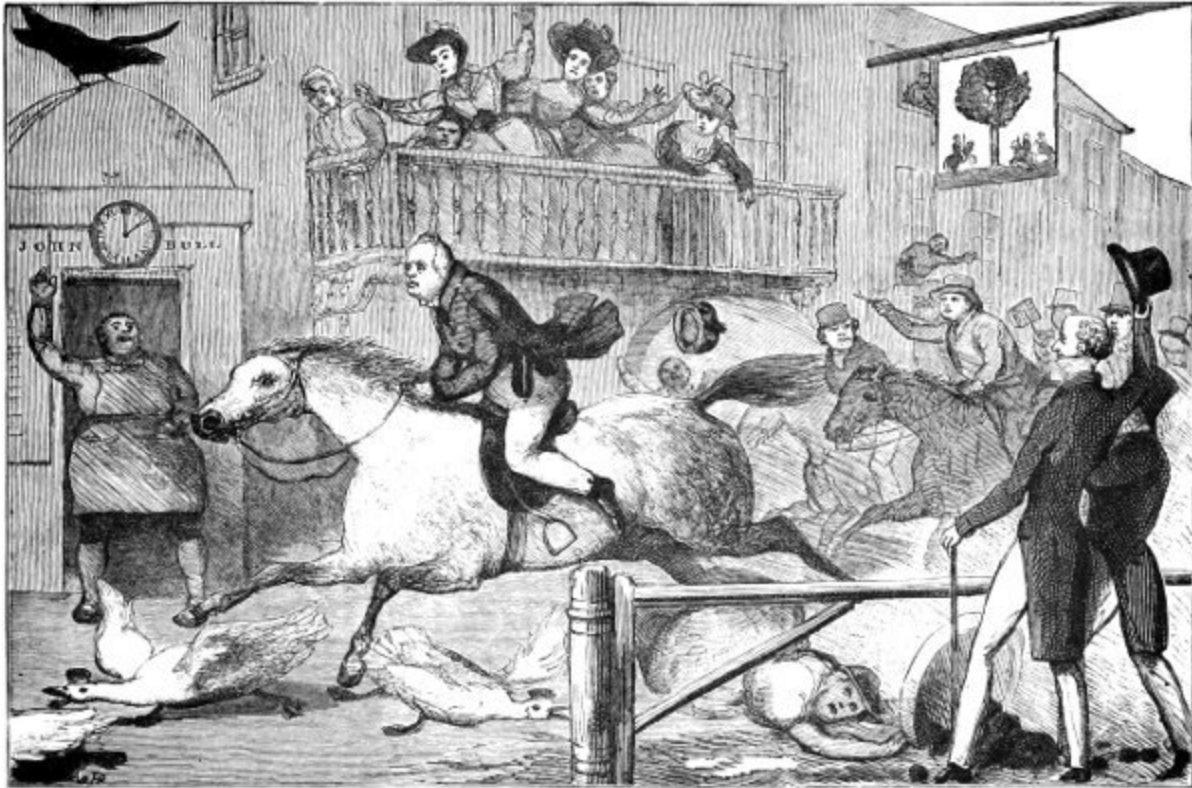
The slaughter of the innocents is figuratively told (May, 1831) in a novel edition of the “Niobe Family.” Lord Grey is the destroyer, his arrows are marked “Reform.” The Niobe of this version is the Duke of Newcastle; the smitten are Sir Charles Wetherell, Attwood, Sadler, and others, whose constituencies were threatened with extinction under the Reform Bill.

The motion for reform, then in full swing, is summed up from a Tory standpoint (May 13, 1831); the legend of “John Gilpin” is pressed into the service of the caricaturist.

“Away went Gilpin, neck or naught,
Away went hat and wig,
He little dream’d when he set out,
Of running such a rig.”

William IV. is, of course, the Gilpin of the situation; the bottles slung to his side are ginger-beer ones—"Rotunda Pop" and "Birmingham Froth;" the "Grey" horse is running away with the king at a dashing pace, and the crown is dislodged in the scuffle. John Bull, the pike-keeper, has thrown open his gate, and is highly excited at the sport: "Go it, my lads, never mind the turnpike!" Burdett is enjoying the fun, but opines, "The Grey is evidently running away with him." Hume, Hunt, O'Connell, Cobbett, and others are following on horseback in the king's wake. One cries, "Make way, make way; we've a great stake depending on it." The Irish Repealer is urging on the pace, "Go along, never mind the geese and old women." The "geese" wear coronets, to symbolize the scared peers scattered by the onslaught; and the "old apple woman" capsized in the rush is old Eldon, the Tory ex-chancellor; Croker is a "croaking" raven. The sign of the inn is changed to a new version of the Crown up in the oak tree, and the balcony is filled with the late ministers, travestied as the ladies of the Gilpin party. Wellington is distressed beyond measure at this alarming spectacle, and is appealing to John Bull: "Good Mr. Gatekeeper, stop him; he doesn't know where he is going!" Sir Robert Peel exclaims, "Oh, John Gilpin! John Gilpin! where are you going? Don't you know your old friends?" Goulburn is declaring, "He must have lost his senses to ride at such a rate!"

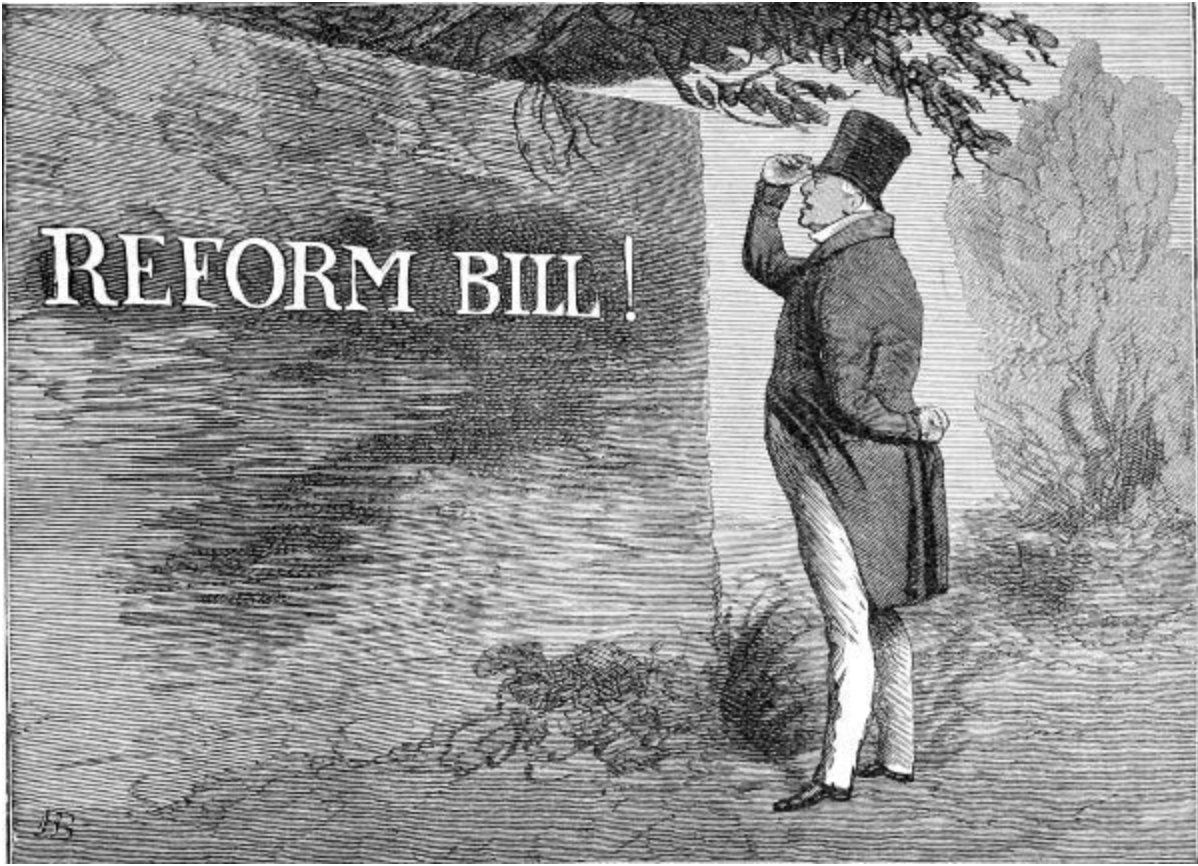
Wellington. Sir. R. Peel. Goulburn. J. Hume. Dan O'Connell.



Peers as Geese. The King on the "Grey." Lord Eldon. Sir Francis Burdett.

JOHN GILPIN. MAY 13, 1831. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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“THE HANDWRITING ON THE WALL.” MAY 26, 1831.

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King (William IV.). *Loq.* “‘Reform *Bill!*’ Can that mean me?”

Another admirable version, the felicity of which has been much appreciated, is entitled “The Handwriting on the Wall” (May 26, 1831). The King, taking his constitutional stroll in the Park, has come upon the inscription, in huge white letters, painted on the wall, “Reform Bill!” William IV., shading his eyes with his hand, is peering at this legend,⁶⁹ exclaiming “‘Reform *Bill!*’ Can that mean me?”

The tendencies of the time were considered fraught with danger; the measures of reform about to be experimentally tested would, it was hinted, produce a political revolution—if not a total subversion of everything; Lord Grey, the Mephistopheles of the situation, as viewed through Doyle’s “Conservative Magnifiers,” occupied an unenviable prominence, and might

expect a day of terrible retribution. “Brissot’s Ghost” (May 30, 1831) is the only hint which could be offered to the innovating statesman. The ghastly figure of Brissot, with his decapitated head under his arm, is disclosed to the premier as a startling vision, with a significant warning, drawn from his fatal revolutionary experience:—

“To lead the mob, ‘mid faction’s storm
I rode my hobby-horse—Reform,
And had it all my own way.
Till other levellers ruled the mob,
And then I lost my seat and nob,
Take warning, my Lord Grey.”

“Macbeth,” with the famous incantation scene, is impressed into the service of parody to sum up the anticipated state of affairs before the meeting of the House; “The Tricolored Witches” (June 6, 1831):—

“Black spirits and white,
Yellow spirits and Grey,
Mingle, mingle, mingle,
You that mingle may.”

There are five witches, wearing Republican red caps, and armed with besoms of destructiveness, assembled round the cauldron.

The three chief witches are Lords Grey, Durham (“Yellow Lambton”), and Brougham. As the ingredients are cast into the blaze, fed by Durham coal, Grey is singing the charm:—

“Forty years of toil and trouble
Like a hell-broth now shall bubble.
When the pot begins to boil,
Sons and daughters seize the spoil.
Double, double, toil and trouble,
Fire burn, and cauldron bubble.”

Lord Brougham takes up the invocation:—

“Freeman’s votes, and Grants by Charter.
First-born rights in ev’ry quarter,
Law and Justice, Church and King,
These the glorious spoils I bring.”

Lord Durham has his allotted share:—

“Saving-Banks, the Funds, and Rent,
Insurances and money lent,
Orphans’ Claims, and widows’ pittance,
Throw them in, to make a quittance.”

Lords Althorp and Russell are acting as the chorus:—

“Round about the cauldron go,
In the Constitution throw.”

The king is unexpectedly surprising the incantation. He is dumbfounded; the charm is already active, and away flies his crown. He is girt with a scarf, “Repentance,” and apostrophizes his reform friends:—

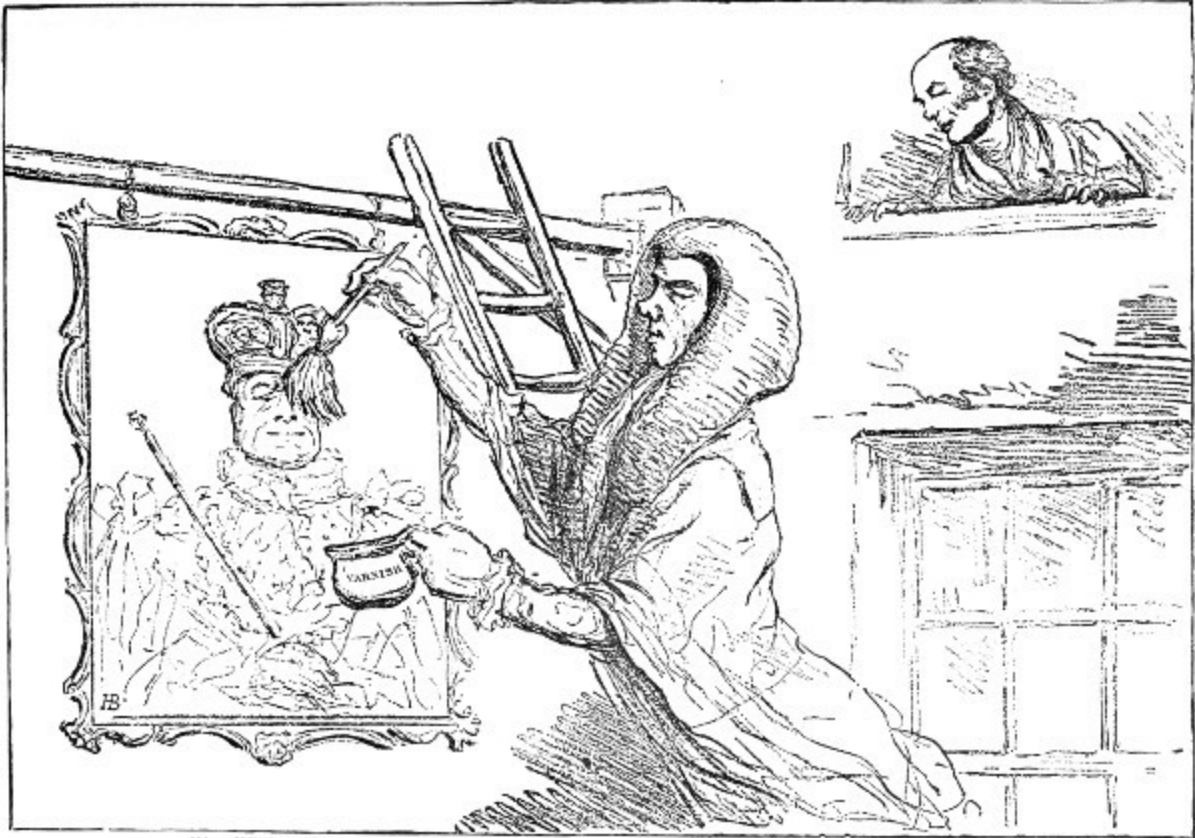
“Filthy Hags!
Infected be the air whereon they ride,
And damn’d all those that trust them.”

“A *Tale* of a Tub—and the Moral of the *Tail!*” (June 13, 1831) is another view of the critical juncture, as it was then assumed to be. The old constitutional ship is left for the whale-boat. The monster is in such dangerous proximity that a dash from its tail—while splashing “popular spray” over its would-be captors—threatens a fatal catastrophe. Lord Althorp has thrown over a pretty considerable tub, “Vested Interests and Chartered Rights;” “There,” he is made to exclaim, “amiable monster! In order to please you, we have thrown you all! Should you require more, you must only take ourselves.” Lord Grey is steering; Lords Brougham, Holland, and Durham have the oars. The king, wearing his naval uniform, is trying to keep the crown from falling overboard; he is evidently apprehensive of the worst: “But why approach so near the tail—the good-natured monster may, without meaning any harm, upset us all in one of his gambols!” The man at the helm is reassuring his chief: “My reasons for steering are pretty plain, tho’ fortunately for me some people don’t see them. It is by flattering the tail, that I command the head!” Lord Brougham, “the schoolmaster abroad,” is imparting this useful piece of knowledge: “It has been discovered in the march of Intellect, that the *Tail* often outstrips the *Head!*” Wellington and Peel have stuck to the ship; the latter is still of opinion that he ought to have made an effort to retain his post: “Yet I can’t but think we might have succeeded in amusing it for a long time with a very small *Keg*.” Wellington is less confident: “I tell you, Bob, the Monster is not to be satisfied!”

Other allusions of a seasonable character were also produced by Doyle, apropos of the tendency of the epoch. One of the best is selected among many, “Varnishing—a Sign (of *the Times*)” (June 1, 1831). The sign of the King’s Head is undergoing renovation; Lord Brougham, in his chancellor’s robes, is mounted on a ladder, and employed in touching up the royal countenance with a pot of varnish. “I think that, considering I was not bred to the trade, I am not a bad hand at bedaubing a King. After all, to produce effect, I find there is nothing like plenty of varnish.” Lord Grey,

from an open window, is surveying with marked satisfaction his colleague's work. "Canning used to talk about a Red Lion; but I say that, in our reforming times, there is no such sign for a (re) publican as a King's Head, although a Star and Garter is not to be despised!"

The somewhat well-worn subject of the hustings is also treated pictorially amongst the cartoons which appeared during the elections. One version is entitled, "*The Rival Mount-O'-Bankes; or, the Dorsetshire Juggler*" (May 25, 1831). The scene of the hustings is again travestied as a fair. "Bankes and Co.'s Old-Established Booth" is left quite deserted; a pillar of the Church is the solitary patron. "If our friends don't come up faster, we may shut up shop," says the showman; while his assistant is declaring, in allusion to the success of the rival show, "This Juggler is juggling all our customers away from us!" The "Nonpareil Juggler" has, in fact, monopolized all the custom. Lord Grey is the showman; he is holding forth his programme to the numerous patrons: "The Bill, the whole Bill, and nothing but the Bill of the Performance of the Nonpareil Calcraft." The showman, "Grey, Licensed Dealer in Curiosities," is pointing to a glowing picture of the entertainment to be seen within—Calfcraft, in the very act of swallowing a lengthy speech dead against the principles of the reform party as represented by Lord Grey; he is described as "Lately exhibited in the metropolis by Monsieur Villainton, with unheard-of success." The customers are thus exhorted:—



King William IV.

Lord Brougham.

Lord Grey.

VARNISHING—A SIGN (OF "THE TIMES"). JUNE 1, 1831. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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THE RIVAL MOUNT-O'-Bankes; OR, THE DORSETSHIRE JUGGLER. MAY 25, 1831. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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“Valk up, gemmen, valk up! Here you may see the most wonderful Juggler, *who eats his own words!* not at all in the usual way practised by pretenders to the ‘Craft, and which is now become almost as common a trick as swallowing the sword, but in a manner the most extraordinary and unparalleled! He likewise plays off many strange antics, quite peculiar to himself and most curious and amusing to behold. I aver, gemmen, I challenge the universal world to produce such a show as this here Juggler makes of himself!”

The crowds are flowing in,—says one, “I am tired of Bankes’s Booth, besides, this *promises* more amusement;” and another, “I like novelty, so here goes.”⁷⁰

Doyle has given a clever embodiment of a current political situation, borrowed from the illustrious humourist, his predecessor: “LINEal Descent of the Crown.” See Hogarth’s works, “Four Prints of an Election” (June 23, 1832). A modernized version of the sign of the “Crown” is dependent from a beam; Lord Grey, with his face to the building, is seated upon that portion of the support which he is hacking lustily with a sickle, marked “Bill.” Cobbett, Hume, and O’Connell are tugging away at the rope which is to accomplish the downfall. The former exclaims, “If we act in union, we’ll soon bring it to our own level.” Hunt remarks, “I fear his exalted seat will turn his head.” O’Connell is encouraging the dangerous exertions of the Reform chief: “Ply the Bill well there, Grey, and it will soon be all down.”

A reference to the possible effects of changed politics upon the suffrages of constituencies is slyly conveyed by HB’s sketch of “The Cast-off Cloak.” Sir John Hobhouse is standing at the entrance of the War Office; he has removed the red-lined cloak of “Radicalism,” which he is thrusting on his old colleague, Sir Francis Burdett: “Pray relieve me of this, Burdett. I shall find it a great incumbrance in a *warm* place like this.” The reply of the veteran Sir Francis is more politic: “Ay, but don’t forget that you have an engagement in Covent Garden.⁷¹ You may find the atmosphere rather *cool* in that quarter.” Burdett’s own political convictions were to undergo as sudden a transmutation, as HB has illustrated a few years later.

As it was felt by the Conservative party that the king, by whose instrumentality the important measure of reform was alone carried, was bound on an enterprise of which the results were doubtful, and, according to their apprehensions, desperate, they tenaciously fought for the inviolability of corruption.

“With nigh two hundred Tories bold,
All men of the old light,
Who knew full well, but would not own,
They were not in the right.

“And long before this time they had
Been lab’ring in vain,
And fencing round their borough towns
That must be sieged and ta’en.”

(New Chevy Chase.)

According to Doyle’s new version of “Mazeppa” (August 7, 1832), the king is bound and tied to “Reform,” represented as “the wild horse of the steppes,” surrounded by wolves, some of whom bear Tory visages, among which the face of the Duke of Wellington is easily identified. Horse and rider are overleaping the barrier of “Vested Interests,” while beneath the courser rushes the “Revolutionary Torrent,” whose volume is increasing. The success of this spirited version induced the designer to publish a second plate (September 25th), presenting the sequel. It is evident in this—which exhibits the wild horse, and Mazeppa, his rider, extended on the plains, but apparently uninjured—that the threatening vortex of the “Revolutionary Torrent” has been passed, and neither has been swamped; but the king is landed in the midst of the herd of wild steeds, weirdly careering round the prostrate pair are the rest of the tribe, on whose heads appear the faces of the leading advocates of reform—Lord Brougham, Lord Grey, Duke of Richmond, Lord John Russell, Lord Althorp, Sir James Graham, etc.



MAZEPPA—"AGAIN HE URGES ON HIS WILD CAREER." AUG. 7, 1832. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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"Freemen's votes and grants by Charter,
First-born rights in every quarter,
Law and Justice, Church and King,
These the glorious spoils I bring."

The new parliament only sat from June 14, 1831, to December 3, 1832. Towards the close of the session (November 22, 1832) it was hinted that ministers were not altogether too happy, and they had flown to stimulants to promote a fictitious confidence. "Ministers and (in) their Cups!" is the title; each has a presentation gold cup in his hand, and a punch-bowl is in the centre of the table. The Ministers are half-seas-over; Grey is singing "Here's Comfort when we Fret;" Russell is joining in the chorus. Althorp declares, "I am quite overpowered;" and Brougham, who

has further been presented with a gold toddy-ladle, is crying, “Ah, this is now the greatest consolation we have left. I wish some one would give poor Palmy a cup!”

CHAPTER XIV.

CHARACTERISTICS OF ELECTIONEERING, 1833 TO 1857.

John Doyle, as a Tory satirist, was eagerly anticipating indications of change in the popular sentiments. His warnings on the Reform Bill had fallen unheeded, and the Whig party was still strong in power. HB ventured on the hint that the Tories were only temporarily in disfavour, and that they had but to adapt themselves to the times and resume office. The “Waits” (January, 1833) gives an ingenious and novel view of political matters. John Bull, in dressing-gown and double night-cap, is leaning out of his first-floor window in critical contemplation of the minstrels’ efforts to please his ear. The Duke of Wellington, with the smallest of fiddles, has the leadership of “the waits.” Lord Ellenborough (trombone), Sir Robert Peel (flute), and Lord Aberdeen (’cello) are the midnight harmonists. The awakened householder, Mr. Bull, is requesting a more piquant programme: “I’m tired of your eternal ‘God save the King’ and ‘Rule Britannia,’—give us something French—‘The Marseillaise’ or ‘The Parisienne.’” Wellington, touching his hat, replies, “Please your Honour, we don’t play them ’ere tunes.”

“Sindbad the *Sailor* and the Old Man of the Sea!” (*vide* fifth voyage, June 8, 1833) was published after the dissolution. William IV. is, of course, the marvellous traveller, and the incubus he has submitted to get settled on his shoulders is the reforming premier, Lord Grey.

That parliamentary reform, though commenced, was by the extreme party considered but an imperfect measure, is pictorially illustrated in various designs by HB; for instance, the elusive “Time” is shown running away with the great Whig Reform Bill, and Lord Althorp is seen tearing after the vanishing roll, crying, “Stop thief!” He has the *Times* in his pocket, presumably the organ by which John Bull’s course was piloted, and is

vainly trying to come up with the departing thief and his measure, one tiny corner Lord Althorp has torn off, "Schedule A," and that promises to be all he can save from the abduction.



SINDBAD THE SAILOR AND THE OLD MAN OF THE SEA. JUNE 8, 1833. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

Another version, also by Doyle, embodies in graphic form the views of the root-and-branch reformers; a grand trio of Sir Francis Burdett, then a prominent Radical; Joseph Hume, who was all for economic reform, in which important branch he has left no true successor; and Daniel O'Connell, a most important factor in his time, whose covert designs were nothing less than "Repeal." These gentlemen, who were among the most conspicuous politicians of their day, are linked arm-in-arm as the "Three Great Pillars of Government; or, A Walk from White Conduit House to St. Stephen's" (July 23, 1834); published under the same auspices of Thomas McLean, at the Haymarket Gallery, as the other examples of Doyle's satirical ability reproduced in this summary. Sir Francis Burdett is with much spirit advocating "Equal Representation and Annual Parliaments—and *that* (a snap of the fingers) for the Borough-mongers." Hume is applauding this resolute front: "Bravo! and Cheap Government;" to which Daniel O'Connell is adding, "And Universal Suffrage, and Vote by BALLOT, eh?" with, as a supplement, in a very small whisper, "A Repeal of the Union."

When another general election occurred, the situation of honest John Bull was figured as that of a stout gentleman wishing to be carried on his road, but distracted as to the conveyance he must choose. The Tory 'bus stands contrasted with the new reform steam vehicle, which is crowded with experimentalists. "The Opposition 'Busses" is the title of this version, also due to HB. The Duke of Wellington is trying to secure John Bull for his old coach, which does not seem much patronized.

"Don't trust 'em, Sir, and their new-fangled machinery. Can't get on at all without being kept in constant hot water, and sure to blow up in the end; with us you'll be much more safe and comfortable,—careful driver, steady train'd horses, and rate of going much faster than formerly."



Sir Francis Burdett.

Joseph Hume.

Daniel O'Connell.

THREE GREAT PILLARS OF GOVERNMENT; OR, A WALK FROM WHITE
CONDUIT HOUSE TO ST. STEPHEN'S.

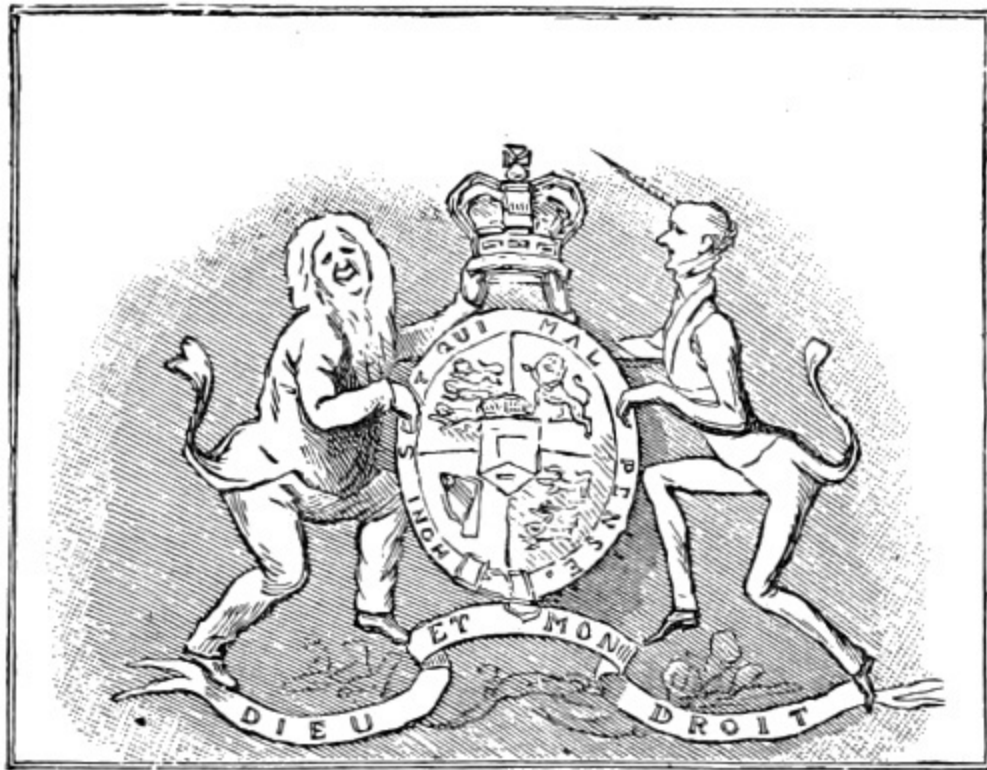
JULY 23, 1834. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

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Sir Robert Peel is the coachman. Steam-coaches were fashionable novelties in 1834; the uncomfortable-looking, nondescript new conveyance, with its steam up, is crowded with statesmen. O'Connell, Lord Melbourne, Lord

John Russell, and Lord Palmerston are distinguishable. Hume is touting for his new invention:—

“You are not such a silly Chiel as to go with them old screws? Eh, you’ll never get to your journey’s end. Ours is the new grand-junction Steam Omnibus, constructed upon scientific and feelosophical principles—warranted to go at race-horse speed, and no stopping.”



DESIGN FOR THE KING'S ARMS, TO BE PLACED OVER THE NEW SPEAKER'S CHAIR. FEB. 17, 1835. BY J. DOYLE (HB).

With the renovated and redressed Constitution, the wits hinted that novel accessories would be in request, and that the insignia of regality would also have to be revised. Such a suggestion is offered in Doyle's "Original Design for the King's Arms, to be placed over the *New Speaker's Chair*," where old Cobbett, late "Peter Porcupine," the persistent agitator, who obtained a seat in Parliament after the passing of the Reform Bill, is

playfully substituted as the British Lion; and the high-bred Sir Francis Burdett, who, as is seen in these electioneering illustrations, had so long figured before the public as a Radical reformer, and was now beginning to turn to the Tory interest, is usurping the position in the royal escutcheon generally appropriated to the fabled unicorn.

The advent of the ballot was not ardently desired by the Tories, and it was hinted that the consequences of its introduction would entail such inconveniences as are figured in the two illustrations here given, rather implying that violence and coercion would henceforth be unavailing, and that, as bribery would be in vain also, administrative corruptors would prefer to make a more legitimate use of their money.

A ballad of the “broadside” order appeared upon “The Windsor Election” of 1835. As a genuine rough-and-ready production, called forth by the circumstances of the contest, and embodying the names of the candidates, it is worth preserving as typical of thousands of similar ballads, which have in all probability perished from the bills of mortality.

“What a wonderful thing’s an Election!
It sets all the people alive;
And makes them all busy and nimble,
Like so many bees in a hive.
’Tis then the nobs learn to be civil,
And get all their lessons by rote;
With ‘How do you do? Honest friend,
I’m come to solicit your vote.’

“There’s enough of that humbug just now,
To be seen in a neighbouring town,
Where the voters don’t scruple to say
The whole will be dear for a *Crown*.
They’re professing to canvass for truth,
Which all honest folks must deny,
For ’tis plain as the nose on your face,
They’ll gammon you all with—*a-lie*.⁷²

“Then, to think of that corporate body,
All their mind on the thing is agog;
They’ll be gammon’d as surely by him
As they formerly were with their hog.
Just fancy that day at the hustings,
You see that comical crop,
The old soldier playing first fiddle
To the tune of the Bachelor’s Hop.

“When they’ve scrap’d and fiddled away,
And find little company come,
The Fiddler will soon bag his kit,
And then the day’s work will be done.
The people may think this is wise (Vyse),
But the thing will be well understood,
For a man to fiddle all day
Should be made of cast iron or wood (Col. Wood).

“Now to see the phizogs of this crew,

As they travel away cheek-by-jowl,
Led on by old Dot-and-go-one,
A-scratching the head *of his poll*.
At the warmints he's storming and raving,
And wishing 'em all at the Devil,
Whilst Sir John,⁷³ and the rest of his staff,
Are cursing the Bachelor's Revel.

"Success to Sir John de Beauvoir,
He's a man that is loyal and true,
He'll strangle that monster—corruption,
And live to bury him, too.
Whilst the ghost of old Elley, in pity,
To the Corporate body will come,
In a vision, with two bags of money,
On the back of old Dot-and-go one."

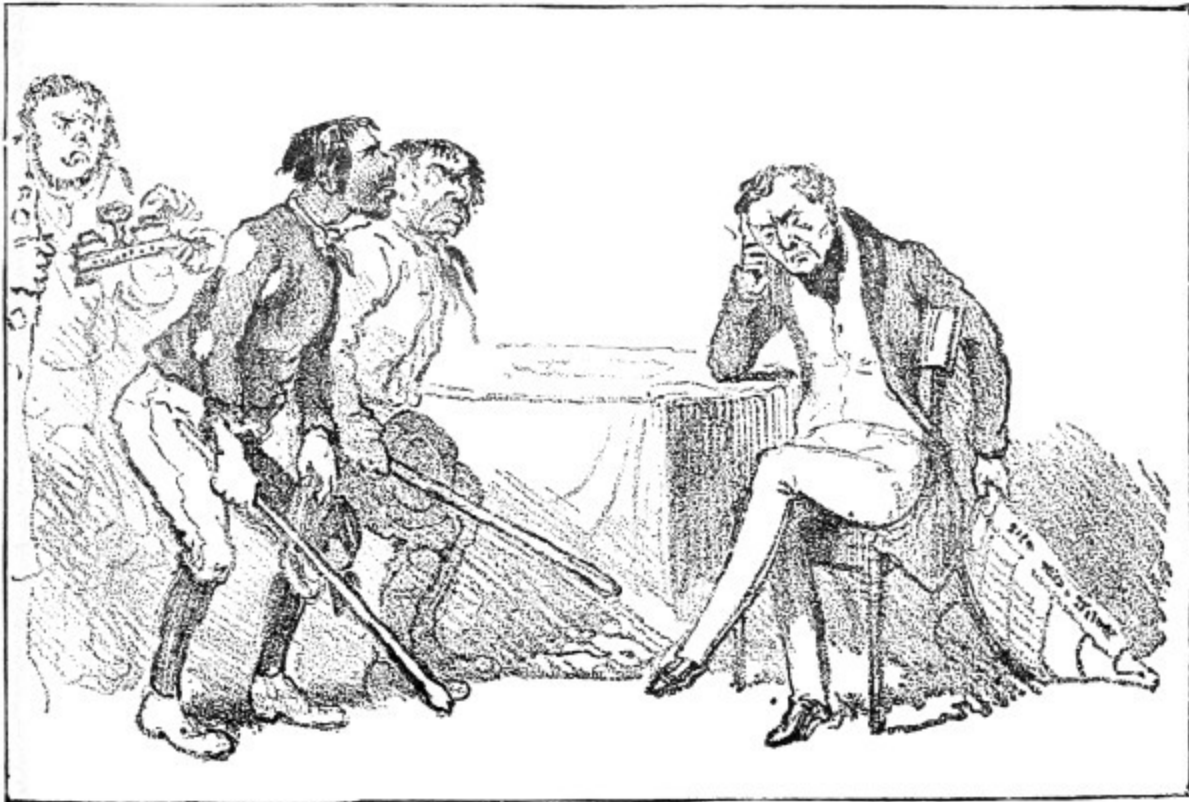


INCONVENIENCES THAT MIGHT HAVE ARISEN FROM THE BALLOT. BY
G. SEYMOUR.

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DUKE OF WELLINGTON.—“Yes, my Lord, fifty thousand pounds expended, four-fifths of the votes promised, and yet the Election lost!”

LORD ELDON.—“Oh, horrible!!”



INCONVENIENCES THAT MIGHT HAVE ARISEN FROM THE BALLOT. BY
G. SEYMOUR.

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“GIPSY-BOY” BLUDGEON-MEN.—“Arn’t we Gipsy-Boys to be your Bullies this Election, my Lord—if you want anything done, we arn’t at all partickler what it is?”

FIRST LORD.—“No; I’ve got no use for you now!”

It appears that the Whig interest had it all their own way; Sir John Elley was put forward by the Windsor corporation as an independent candidate, as appears from the following extracts from “A Parody of the Mistletoe Bough:”—

“A banner now hangs in a corporate town
Professing to keep all corruption down,
And many retainers are blithe and gay,
Being keeping an Election holiday:
But the Corporate body, they take offence,
And bring a man here under pretence
That an Independent Gent is he,
And they swear that he is no Nominee.”

Sir John Elley leaves his committee forlorn, and is sought for far and near without success:—

“Some time after, Sir John did recede,
A Bachelor passed him o’er Runnymede;
A Skeleton tall passed before his sight,
He thought the form was the good old knight;
And a death-like voice did grate on his ear—
‘We never have any corruption here;
This is sacred ground, so go back and relate,
Magna Charta has strangled your dear Candidate.’”

Two years later, another appeal to the country was impending. At the beginning of 1837, HB produced a figurative prospect of the situation, as “A New Instance of the Mute—ability of Human Affairs.” The British Constitution, that fabled “admiration of surrounding nations,” and “monument of the collective wisdom of generations,” is at last moribund: the fatal hour has arrived, and the chamber of mourning is presented to view. Mounted upon sable trestles, and covered with a rich pall, is the coffin which contains the defunct, according to the plate, “Died 1837, of the prevailing Influenza, the British Constitution of 1688, aged 149 years;” the

mutes, with trappings of woe, stationed on either side of the coffin, are Lord John Russell and Spring Rice.

In March, 1837, HB gave the public a version of that appeal to the constituencies, then becoming more imminent: “Going to the Fair with It. A cant phrase for doing anything in an extravagant way—known, it is presumed, to most persons.” The three performers are in the thick of the fair, within the circle of booths; one tent has the sign of the “King’s Head,” with the Union Jack flying, another mounts the sign of “The Mitre.” Dan O’Connell is seated on the ground as a conjuror, with a paraphernalia of swords, rings, and balls—“Irish titles and appropriation clause” among the former. He is performing the “great sword-swallowing trick,” with a blade marked “Repeal.” Spring Rice, dressed as a tumbler, is balancing a block on a stick which rests on his chin. The chief attraction, the only performance which is absorbing the wonder of the entire spectators, is that of the acrobat, Lord John Russell, who is sustaining himself in the air raised on a single support, marked, “Irish Corporation Bill.” John Bull, who occupies the central position, cannot disguise his interest in the feat: “Well done, little ’un; you’ve got up a surprising height—take care how you let yourself down.” The Duke of Wellington is counselling John Bull: “These tricks are decidedly dangerous, and should not be encouraged.” Sir Robert Peel and Lord Stanley are in conference, as retired professors of conjuring. “This is the great trick now—the stilts are quite discarded.” A bishop is observing, “That man balances very inequitably.”

On the other side are grouped various critics of the performance. Lord Ebrington considers the trick “wonderful, even more astonishing than the Stilts.” Sir William Molesworth declares, “They deserve encouragement, but they don’t go half as far as they ought.” Hume also thinks, “it is very well as far as it goes!” Lord Brougham, wearing his distinguishing plaid trousers, is in conference with Mr. Roebuck as to starting an opposition show: “What do you think if we were to set up a little concern of our own: you would make a very nice little Tumbler, and I—you know, am an old hand that way!” Sir Francis Burdett, who had given some surprising performances in his time, is leaving the fair, declaring, “I can’t stand it any longer;” while his associate, Sir J. C. Hobhouse, advises him to wait a while, “Don’t go yet; the best of the sport is to come!”

The struggles, twists, and contortions of ministers to keep in place, and the involutions of “Ins and Outs,” were ably parodied, a few months before the dissolution, as the “Fancy Ball—Jim Crow Dance and Chorus” (April 17, 1837); in which the most prominent movers of both parties are travestied in fancy costumes, out-at-elbows, and with blackened faces—the likenesses admirably preserved; and executing a reel worthy of “Chimney Sweeps’ Day;” the whole arranged to the then-popular air of “Jump Jim Crow,” introduced at that time by an actor named Rice—the forerunner of the “Christy Minstrels” of a later generation. The central figures are—O’Connell, who is making a contemptuous gesture, and his partner, Lord Melbourne; Wellington and Peel are *vis-à-vis*; Stanley and Graham are jigging gaily together, so are Lords Abinger and Lyndhurst; Sir Francis Burdett and General de Lacy Evans are figuring back-to-back in approved Irish-jig style; and Spring Rice is getting on well to a lively measure along with Lord John Russell.

“Behold the Politician!
Out of place he’ll never go,
But to keep it, don’t he turn about
And jump Jim Crow?

“Turn about, and wheel about,
And do just so,
The only Cabinet Quadrille
Is jump Jim Crow!”

Sir Francis Burdett—the “seven-stringed Jack” and admirer of the French revolution of Gillray’s cartoons, the fiery Radical of Cruikshank’s early flashing squibs—after a career of remarkable prominence as a zealous innovator and friend of reform, quixotically riding full tilt against abuses of all kinds, was exhibiting himself, in the session about to close his old career, as a convert to fine full-bodied Tory principles. HB has pictorially given the contests the famous baronet had waged with the mighty Dan O’Connell, whose “repealing” proclivities seem finally to have opened Burdett’s eyes as to the desirability of preserving the integrity of the kingdom. His highly characteristic speech at the Westminster hustings is the

best exposition of his changed opinions. In his picture of “A Fine Old English Gentleman, One of the Olden Time” (May 10, 1837), Doyle has commemorated the baronet’s final accession to the country party, by drawing Sir Francis in his familiar guise—blue coat, tightly buttoned, with swallow tails, white vest and ample white cravat, white cords, and top-boots,—seated, a prisoner in his own apartments, suffering from an attack of gout. A picture of the Tower, hung on the wall, indicates a previous episode of imprisonment, when Burdett became an inmate of that edifice (April 6, 1810); he was the last political prisoner confined there. It was felt that the baronet’s connection with Westminster was about to be severed; however, he offered himself for re-election, that his old constituents might pronounce upon his action.

The candidature of Mr. Leader formed the subject of several of Doyle’s suggestive sketches. In “Following the Leader” (May 12, 1837), HB has given a fanciful version of the candidate’s supporters impressed as boardsmen. O’Connell heads the file, with a placard “Leader for Westminster.” Lord Melbourne is advertising “Leader and Reform of the House of Lords.” Lord John Russell, as a “sandwich” man, announces “Annual Parliaments, Universal Suffrage, and Vote by Ballot;” Lord Palmerston’s board declares, “I am a Tory, and was always a Tory.” Sir William Molesworth, Hume, and others bring up the rear, with “Leader for Westminster” placards. The Duke of Wellington and Sir Robert Peel are surveying the demonstration from a distance, “These, I suppose, are some of the Pismires!”

“May Day in 1837” is another ingenious version of the political situation. The figure enclosed in the green, which is surmounted by the crown, is the king, William IV.; he is getting nervous at his situation: “I have got into a warm berth, it must be owned; indeed, it grows rather Hellish.” Melbourne makes a handsome “my lord,” and Russell’s figure just suits “my lady.” Lord Morpeth is a serviceable clown. The whole dance is performed to the drum accompaniment of Dan O’Connell. Spring Rice, as chancellor of the exchequer, is going round to John Bull for the supplies, much to the national prototype’s surprise: “You little spooney! How came you to be entrusted with the ladle, eh?” Sir Francis Burdett, still in his sweep’s disguise, is stalking off from the concern: “These ’ere fellers grow

so werry vulgar that a gentlemen can't keep company with them no longer."

It was on this occasion that Sir Francis Burdett,—finally forsaking those Radical principles upon which he had been returned in the first instance for Westminster in 1807—for which important city he had sat until 1837,—appealed to the constituency which had elected him for thirty years, and, with that chivalrous spirit which distinguished his nature, challenged the votes of his supporters as to how far his changed politics might enlist their approval, and invited his friends to pronounce their verdict on his conduct. Upon the baronet's appeal to his constituents, in the character of "a fine old English gentleman, all on the Tory side," when, in May, 1837, he resigned his membership for Westminster as a Radical, and offered himself as a Tory candidate, he was opposed by John Temple Leader, a prominent Radical politician. Party feeling was considerably intensified, and ungenerous efforts were made by his late Radical colleagues to inflict the mortification of a defeat upon the reformed baronet. The famous agitator, Daniel O'Connell, whose collision with Burdett was among the chief causes of his changed opinions, exerted himself to the utmost to bring about the discomfiture of his opponent, who, in return, dealt scathing contempt upon the arch-agitator. Many political satires and squibs were produced on this occasion, and, in a literary and artistic point of view, one feature of great interest associated with this incident was the appearance of an electioneering caricature by the author of "Vanity Fair." The Marquis of Wharton, Swift, Burns, Sir Hanbury Williams, Canning, Moore, and many eminent poets, writers, and statesmen have originated electioneering ballads, and Thackeray has associated his name with a pictorial squib; in 1837, he was, as part-proprietor and contributor, associated with the unfortunate venture (as regards the inroad its subsequent failure made on his fortune), the *Constitutional and Public Ledger*—a daily journal, of ultra-liberal views; and as its programme included extension of popular franchise, vote by ballot, equal civil rights, religious liberty, and short parliaments, it may be imagined that the political creed which he at that time professed inclined Thackeray to look with disfavour upon the converted Burdett as an apostate from his faith: he has expressed this view in a political satire addressed to the electors of Westminster. The picture, a quarto leaf, was presented with the *Guide* (May 13, 1837). It represents Sir

Francis Burdett and his opponent, Leader, on the hustings, as “The Rivals; or, Old Tory Glory and Young Liberal Glory.” Sir Francis is represented as decrepit, and a martyr to the gout—another attribute of a “fine old English gentleman”—from which the baronet suffered much in later life; his foot is swathed in flannel, and crutches support him to stand; his coat is worn inside out, and a glory round his head alludes to an expression of “pismire voters” he had applied to the following of his antagonists. Beneath the picture is a further explanation of the satirist’s meaning:—

“Historical truth has compelled the artist to portray the physical infirmities which keep Sir Francis from all duties except that of dining at the Pavilion; but our readers will recollect that that infirmity is the gout—one which mankind seem, by common consent, to have determined never to regard with compassion.... A picture of the Tower is seen in the background; and Sir Francis, with a ‘glory’ of ‘pismires’ round his head, is depicted as hobbling away in his turned coat from the recollections, as from the principles, of his youth.”

In spite of his sudden conversion, the electors of Westminster held their respected member in too much veneration to inflict upon him the ignominy of rejection; the wielder of the “Herculean club,” depicted as the foremost leader among the “plebs” by George Cruikshank, who has described the object of his shafts as “the eloquent and noble Sir Francis Burdett,” was placed at the head of the poll by a majority of five hundred votes over his antagonist, Leader, who had come forward as the Radical champion to oppose his return. Sir Francis Burdett is so prominent a personage in the annals of electioneering, as well as in those of parliamentary history, that a specimen of his eloquence may not be out of place; especially as the speech which he made to his constituents after the declaration of the poll by the high bailiff of Westminster is an admirable example of the orations which may be considered appropriate to these memorable occasions on the part of the successful candidate. Sir Francis rested his firm attitude on his antipathy to see the British empire *dismembered*: history repeats itself, and it was on the question of “Repeal of the Union” that he broke with his party.

“SPEECH OF SIR FRANCIS BURDETT ON HIS FINAL RETURN FOR WESTMINSTER, 1837.

“GENTLEMEN, ELECTORS OF THE CITY AND LIBERTIES OF WESTMINSTER

“It now becomes my pleasing task to return you my most sincere and grateful thanks for the high honour which you have again conferred upon me. In the first place, I have to thank you for the arrangements that you have made, and for the consideration you have manifested in regard to the present state of my health, and for the relief your attention has afforded me from those duties which would have been painful and difficult on this great and important occasion, and which has rendered my part in the struggle comparatively easy and full of satisfaction. (Cheers.) Permit me to congratulate you upon the noble, the patriotic, the independent efforts you have made, and through you, gentlemen, to congratulate the people at large upon the glorious triumph of the English constitution, which has been achieved against the vain and futile efforts of Radicalism and democracy. Gentlemen, I congratulate you upon the firm determination you have shown to maintain all the great and inestimable institutions of this country against the efforts of her enemies. (Loud cheers, with faint hisses.) The task which I have now to perform is both short and pleasant, and I shall not now detain you, after the triumph you have achieved and the victory you have won, merely to indulge my own feelings of exultation and of gratification; but this I will say, that the electors of Westminster have by the result of their noble and patriotic exertions set an example to the people of England, to be looked up to and followed; and in every part of this great nation I make no doubt but that this brilliant example will have the happy effect of sending good men, who love their country and venerate her constitution, to unite for their defence, and at the same time to defeat the machinations and conspiracies of the bad. (Loud applause.) I will not dwell on these subjects, but this much I will observe, that you are much indebted even to your enemies for the signal triumph you have so nobly and so gloriously achieved. (Great cheering.) The malignity and malice of some persons have done much to aid the cause of the constitution; but

I should say that if there is one individual to whom you are more indebted than any other, that person certainly was Mr. Daniel O'Connell. (Loud cheers and groans.) The attacks of that individual have tended to serve the cause which they were designed to injure. Gentlemen, the big beggarman of Ireland (renewed cheers) has mistaken the good sense and patriotism of the people of England. He has intruded himself with his uncalled-for advice upon the electors of Westminster, and with (as it now turns out) his disregarded threats. He has intruded that advice and those suggestions in an Irish letter, couched in a strain more Irish than Irish itself (loud laughter), and containing in every point that mixture of blarney and bully, the former of which has only excited the disgust, and the latter the contempt of the electors of Westminster. (Loud cheers, groans, and laughter.) I know not what influence that letter may be said to have had upon His Majesty's ministers; but this I know, that the people of England, and especially the electors of Westminster, were made of sterner stuff. Whatever His Majesty's ministers may think proper to do, what course they may choose to pursue, we have shown our determination to maintain and support the English constitution and to resist to the uttermost the dismemberment of the British empire, notwithstanding that Mr. Daniel O'Connell is our declared and determined foe. (Loud cheers, with shouts of disapprobation from the 'Leader' party.) In addition, I will merely say that you view as I do the attempt to control your opinions lately made by the great popish priest-ridden paid patriot of Ireland. (Great applause and sensation.) And I will add this, that I wish such persons would declare and destroy themselves as he has done; no danger could then be apprehended, as I think it would be on all occasions safer to have such persons my foes than my friends. (Cheers, and yellings from the 'Leader' party.) Gentlemen, with these observations I shall take my leave. The sun shines upon our principles and our affections at this moment; but there is a still brighter sunshine in every honest English heart at the triumph achieved by you and the example you have set to the rest of England. (Cheers.) Wishing you all good and happiness, and full of the devotion I owe you electors of Westminster and to the friends to the cause of England and the constitution, I now take my leave. (Renewed cheering, which continued for several minutes, during which time the hon. baronet

bowed to the meeting and retired from the hustings, accompanied as he came, by a large body of his friends and supporters.)”

The situation of Mr. Leader was illustrated by a parody of Sir E. Landseer’s picture of “The Dog and the Shadow;” the bone is Bridgwater (which seat he relinquished to contest Westminster)—the latter is inscribed on the shadow.

The sequel of the Westminster contest was given by HB as a “Race for the Westminster Stakes between an Old Thoro’bred and a Young Cock-tail—weight for age—the old ’un winning in a canter” (May 22, 1837). Lord Russell, Wellington, and others are assembled as spectators in a booth to the right. Lord Castlereagh, the jockey, is bringing in easily the high-mettled racer with Burdett’s face. Roebuck is vainly whipping and spurring “Leader,” the second horse. Hume and O’Connell are highly excited at the defeat of their favourite.

The question of a Repeal of the Union was one of a momentous order, and accordingly a considerable interest seems to have attended Burdett’s change of sides. Doyle has given a capital version of the story in “Taking up a Fare. ‘All the World’s a Stage’” (May 24, 1837). The coach represented is “Peel’s Stager;” Sir James Graham is ostler; Sir Robert Peel, as “whip,” is raising up his reins and addressing the box passenger, William IV., “We begin to load up capital well,” alluding to Burdett, the fresh customer. “You don’t say so,” remarks the king. Peel continues his reminiscences of the new inside passenger. “He as is now getting in—was formerly a great ally of the ‘Comet.’⁷⁴ He has since travelled occasionally with the ‘Mazeppa’⁷⁵ people; but, for some time back, I have missed him off the road entirely.” The Duke of Wellington, who is making everything secure, and Lord Lyndhurst are in the “boot.” Sir Francis Burdett, still lamed with the gout, is about to enter the coach; the door is held for him by Lord Stanley: “I should know your face: didn’t you once drive the ‘Darby Dilly?’ What are you doing now?” Lord Stanley (whom HB, in a former cartoon, had drawn upsetting the “Darby Dilly” in question) is touching his hat to Sir Francis, and replying, “At present, Sir, I’m with these people; but since ‘the Dilly’ was done up I haven’t had no regular engagement. I sometimes drives the

‘Conservative’ up a stage and sometimes take it down.” Lord Castlereagh appears as Burdett’s tiger.

Burdett, the ex-Radical champion, still in his congenial character of “Don Quixote,” is next shown attacking the “Lion of Democracy.” The picture of this adventure is entitled “The Last and Highest Point at which the Unheard-of Courage of Don Quixote ever did, or could arrive, with the Happy Conclusion.” “An Old Song to a New Tune” (June 17, 1837), shows the Whig wherry reduced to make great exertions to keep ahead; of the six rowers, the faces of Palmerston, Duncannon, and Melbourne are alone shown; Lord John Russell is steering. The passengers are John Bull, with an uneasy expression, seated beside the king, who is evidently upset by the motion, and looks very unwell. The parody runs—

“Row, brothers, row,
The stream runs fast,
The Raddies⁷⁶ are near,
And our daylight’s past.”

Leader’s fate over the Westminster contest (June 17, 1837) is summed up as “A Dead Horse—a Sorry Subject,—what was once a Leader in the Bridgwater Coach; supposed to have been driven to Death by his Cruel Masters.” Hume is driving off the defeated in a knacker’s cart.

“We, the People of England” (July 1837), exhibits Messrs. Hume, Roebuck, and Wakley as the “Three Tailors of Tooley Street,” all three sitting cross-legged; the former, slate in hand, is working out one of his grand historic “tattles.”

The candidature of General Evans for Westminster is summed up as “Reorganizing the Legion” (24 July, 1837). The boardmen all appear in ragged regimentals, as the remnant of the Spanish Legion, and a very woebegone set they seem; the fogleman, wearing a cocked hat, has a pictorial placard of a leader taking to flight, with the legend, “I run;” the posters appear chiefly designed to canvass “Murray for Westminster;” and

General Evans is himself trying to make the file straight with his malacca cane, while crying, “Eyes right.”

Sir Francis Burdett had, in his altered politics, fought, conquered, and made his final bow at the hustings of Westminster, he being at the time in indifferent health; his return for Wiltshire was the next point of interest. How far this change of constituency suited the baronet’s own constitution is displayed by HB, who had previously exhibited the subject of his sportive humour under his gouty infirmity. “Grinding Young” (July 25, 1837) is the title of a new application of an old fancy; Burdett, broken by age and debility, with his foot swathed in flannel, showing the gouty foe triumphant, is hobbling with a crutch up the ladder which leads from “Westminster” to the wonderful mill; and, presto! an agriculturist turns the handle, and forth from the hopper emerges the baronet in his familiar guise, spick, span, and spruce, with the elastic smartness and activity of youth, he is stepping out into “North Wilts.”

An ingenious election skit appeared on Lord Durham’s appeal to the local constituency: it is entitled, “The Newest Universal Medicine” (July 27, 1837). Lord Durham appears as a compounder of quack nostrums; he wears an apron, and is standing at a counter, stirring with a pestle a mortar containing his novel mixture. Beneath it is his “Letter to the Electors of Durham,” and around are the varied ingredients of his “Universal Panacea”—such as “Conservative Opiate,” “Radical Alcohol,” with “Whig Alkali;” while all sorts of colours are ready to hand, indigo, and orange, light blue, mustard (Durham), and verdigris. While mixing his pills, Lord Durham is exclaiming “Now to extinguish that Quack Morison!” A large box stands ready for the medicament, addressed to “Daniel O’Connell, Esq., M.P., General Association and Trades-Union, Dublin;” a smaller box is directed to the Bishop of Exeter. On a chair stands a small collection of the quack compounds and remedies in boxes of various hues, and addressed to the *Times*, *Standard*, *Globe*, and *Morning Chronicle*, indicative of Lord Durham’s versatile talents and scribbling propensities.

A touching allegory for a rejected candidate was furnished by HB over these same elections. “As You like It” (July 31, 1837). The wounded and solitary deer which has come down to the brook, presents the lachrymose

countenance of Roebuck; the shaft which has caused his tears is marked “Bath.” Lord John Russell, as the “Melancholy Jacques,” is, from the other side of the water, soliloquizing over the Roebuck’s fate.

Dr. Bowring is favoured with a place in Doyle’s portrait-gallery, as “The Rejected of Kilmarnock” (August 21, 1837).

Another defeat at the general election forms food for HB’s playful irony. This time it is Joseph Hume rejected by Middlesex: “Figurative Representation of the Late Catastrophe” (August 31, 1837). The Middlesex balloon is sailing majestically out of reach; the gentleman thrown out is descending at a fine pace; Joseph Hume’s parachute is blown inside out, and he is ejaculating in his fall, “Now, unless some friendly dunghill receives me, I am lost for ever.” Below him are the green plains of Erin, and the spot on which the discomfited aeronaut is descending is shown to be Kilkenny.

Daniel O’Connell pretty generally seems the master of the situation in the impressions we get of the big Liberator in Doyle’s admirable and genially humorous cartoons. In another aspect of the 1837 election, published at the same date, the great Dan is installed as passenger and traffic manager at the metropolitan head-quarters of the new railway. “Great Western General Booking Office” (August 31st) shows those gentlemen who have been so unfortunate as to miss their seats besieging O’Connell for fresh places, “Gentlemen,” he cries, with good-natured desire to assist all, “we are all full; but, if you will only wait for the next train, we shall, I have no doubt, be able to accommodate you all with seats.” The best-known of the rejected ones are clamouring round the counter: “I am afraid we are thrown out for the present,” says one; while Dr. Bowring “the rejected of Kilmarnock,” is of opinion, “It seems there is a screw loose somewhere in their principal engine.” Roebuck stands first of the unfortunates; his slight luggage is “at the end of his stick;” Hume, carpet-bag in hand, has secured a ticket, and is departing—evidently with grave misgivings—to Kilkenny. Emerson Tennent and Sir James Graham are standing at the door of the office.

The ultimate reception of Hume by Kilkenny is set forth by the same hand: “Shooting Rubbish” (August 31, 1837). Dan O’Connell, habited as an

Irish peasant, has brought Hume on a hay-trolley to a thatched cabin marked "Kilkenny;" he is gently lowered on to a heap by the wayside, where, according to a notice-board, "Rubbish may be shot." "I think," says Dan, "that is letting you down nice and easy." Hume is grateful for the opportune assistance: "Thank ye, friend; should you ever have occasion to come to the North, I'll endeavour to do as much for you."

Parliament was not summoned until November 15, 1837; in the interval, Doyle produced two or three ingenious cartoons summarizing the situation. One of the best of these represents the field of contest like the preceding versions; it is entitled, "Retzsch's Extraordinary Design of Satan playing at Chess with Man for his Soul, copied by HB in his freest manner" (September 29, 1837). The Great Dan takes the place of the evil one, the skull and cross-bones are mounted as his ensign, and he is evidently master of the board. "Man" is personated by Lord Melbourne, who is evidently in perplexity as to his next move. Britannia is personifying man's good angel, and she is pitifully regarding the loser.

"A Game at Chess (again): the Queen in Danger" is another version of the situation in the recess. This appeared October 20, 1837, with the quotation, "A change came o'er the spirit of my dream." The youthful sovereign is matched against Lord Palmerston. The Queen's political tutor and adviser, Lord Melbourne, is standing behind the chair of his royal mistress. Lord Palmerston has put the Queen in jeopardy; Her Majesty is evidently anxious, but fails to master the right move. Melbourne sees the situation, and looks on with some excitement, but is enjoined by Palmerston to refrain from prompting his royal pupil's play.

This situation is further exemplified in two later cartoons: "Susannah and the Elders" (October 27, 1837), in which the Queen is riding between Lords Melbourne and Palmerston; the spot appears to be Brighton, near the Pavilion, then a royal residence. The other version is borrowed from the popular farce, "High Life below Stairs (inverted), as lately performed at Windsor by Her Majesty's servants" (October 31, 1837). The Queen is seen, seated on a sofa, but partly screened from view by a curtain. Lord Melbourne, who makes a handsome "my lord duke," is monopolizing the youthful beauty; he observes to Lord Palmerston, who is also in livery, with

a cockade—"Stand off; you are a Commoner. Nothing under nobility approaches Kitty." Lord Palmerston is not overawed by these exclusive pretensions; as a representative of the Commons, he seizes his advantage,—"And what becomes of your dignity, if we refuse the supplies?"

A pungent epitome of the incidents of electioneering is thus set forth by an anonymous poetaster:—

“ELECTION DAY-A SKETCH FROM NATURE.

“THE HUSTINGS.

“Now, hail ye, groans, huzzas, and cheers,
So grateful to electors’ ears,
Where all is riot and confusion,
Fraud, friendship, scandal, and delusion;
Now houses stormed, and windows broken,
Serve as a pastime and a token
That patriots spare not, in their zeal,
Such measures for their country’s weal.
Now greeting, hooting, and abuse,
To each man’s party prove of use;
And mud, and stones, and waving hats,
And broken heads, and putrid cats,
Are offerings made to aid the cause
Of order, government, and laws.
Now lampoons, idle tales, and jokes,
And placards overreach and hoax;
While blustering, bullying, and brow-beating,
A little pommeling, and maltreating,
And elbowing, jostling, and cajoling,
And all the jockeyship of polling,
And deep manœuvre and duplicity,
Prove all elections fair and free;
While *Scandalum Magnatum*’s puzzled,
And lawless libel raves unmuzzled.”

“THE CHAIRING.

“And now the members, by freeholders,
Are mounted on the rabble’s shoulders,
To typify, that willing backs
Are made for any sort of Tax,
And kindly sent, prepared by fate,
To bear the burthens of the State.
But that elections to the mob
Might prove a right good merry job,
Down from the waving laurel bower
Descends the glittering silver shower,
And, thus, with open-handed fee,
Meant as a check to bribery,
Each new-made Senator is willing,
By many a sixpence and a shilling,
To compromise for thumps and bruises,
For broken heads and bloody noses;
For damage done by sticks and stones,
For pockets picked, and broken bones.”

One of the best pictures of a country election is due to the muse of John Sterling; a few stanzas will not be found out of place:—

“THE ELECTION.

“A POEM IN SEVEN BOOKS.

“Cox represented Aleborough, patriot pure,
On whose tried firmness Europe leant secure,
But, woe to manufactures, land, and stocks!
Europe and Aleborough could not rescue Cox.
At London’s Mansion House, the Poultry’s pride,
Cox in his country’s service din’d and died.

A new election! Glory to the town!
For all there's profit, and for some renown.
'The Lion' opes his hungry jaws, and springs;
And 'The Black Bear' seems dancing as he swings.
Before an hour the Patriot Blues are met;
Though Cox is gone, the Cause shall triumph yet,
The sacred cause of right; till it prevails,
The Universe hangs trembling in the scales.
'The Lion' for the Blues! our flag's unfurled,
And Mogg, instead of Cox, shall awe the world.
The big placard, with thunder in its look,
Glares like a page from Destiny's own book;
The drums and trumpets hired augment their zeal
By strong potations till inspired they reel;
The chaises three, and omnibus immense,
Display 'the Lion's' whole munificence;
And Mogg's committee-men, a Spartan few,
To save the sinking State would die True Blue.

There Small, who plied dear Mistress Mogg with pills,
Prescribed her husband for a nation's ills.
But chief of all amid that Senate wise,
Attorney Whisk had heard his country's cries."

Meanwhile the "Red" candidate, Frank Vane, has providentially
"dropped down from the skies," primarily for the benefit of the rival
attorney Spark:—

“The Reds’ grave Nestor he, a man sedate
As ever filed a bill, or ruled a State.”

— A bargain for organizing opposition is arranged between these twain:

“Ten minutes’ converse fixed the compact’s grounds,
And Frank engaged to pay twelve hundred pounds.”



Next comes the personal canvassing by Squire Mogg, and the purchase of votes by direct flattery and indirect bribery:—

“From house to house Mogg’s well-fed body springs,
Helped by his patriot spirit’s ostrich wings,
With Whisk, and Small, and Snooks, a faithful few
Worth more than all a sultan’s retinue.
They point the path, the missing phrase supply,
Oft prompt a name, and hint with hand or eye,
Back each bold pledge, the fervid speech admire,
And still add fuel to their leader’s fire.”

Now as to the bribery. After purchasing a superabundance of everything he was likely to use (such as a hundredweight of soap), the candidate plunges into eccentricities recognized on these occasions:—

“By ready speech and vow, by flattery soft,
Sometimes by gifts, by promised favours oft,
He prospered well, and many a purchase made,
That helped at once the Cause and quickened Trade.

A stuffed jackdaw upon an upper shelf
Now caught his fancy, now a cup of delf;
He paid three pounds for each. A cat that tore
His fingers cost him ten, a rabbit more.”



All these oddities, besides fifteen old almanacks, white mice, and other worthless articles, were secured to enlist suffrages, and purchased at similarly extravagant rates; a familiar subterfuge for stultifying the Bribery Act:—

“A bishop’s worn-out wig, an infant’s caul,—
Were paid for down, and sent to Harrier Hall.”

“The Rights of Women; or, a View of the Hustings with Female Suffrage, 1853.” George Cruikshank, whose hand was turned to the illustration of nearly every event which occurred in his long career, had produced election satires like his contemporaries at the beginning of the century. Later on, we find him turning his somewhat waning vigour to utilize the agitation for “Female Enfranchisement,” which, as a branch of “Women’s Rights,” appears to have come before the public in 1852-3. A fanciful and farcical prospect of the hustings when lady voters should rule the day presents the rival aspirants pictured as “The Ladies’ Candidate” and “The Gentlemen’s Candidate.” The latter is quite left to desolation. “Screw-driver, the Great Political Economist,” beyond his boardmen, stands alone. Although a placard is mounted advising the electoral community not to vote for “Ignorant puppies,” the “Champion of the Fair” seems to have a lively time of it; Cupid, or his representative, upholds the appeal, “Vote for

Darling and Parliamentary Balls Once a Week;" the committee and supporters of Sir Charles are ladies, appalled in the height of the fashions for 1852. Behind the tigerish candidate for parliamentary honours is a group of melancholy troubadours, travestied much as Cruikshank and Thackeray used to depict those worthy guitar-strummers at the now-obsolete "Beulah Spa." Great unanimity prevails in the mob; not only are the newly enfranchised fair ones giving their own votes, they go farther, and coerce the sterner sex, for all the well-regulated males are brought forward, under the influence of beauty, to record their votes for the chosen of the ladies. On the extreme left is seen one forlorn individual who has evidently lingering doubts of Sir Charles's programme, or an inclination to support the political economist, "Ugly Old Stingy;" but his wife is forcibly arguing him into an obedient frame of mind. The voters all carry bouquets and wear extensive favours. "Husband and Wife" voters are arrived first at the poll; and, following a mounted champion "in armour clad" with a heart for his device, comes the last section of "Sweetheart Voters," the "male things" docilely following the mistresses of their affections. "The Friends of Sir Charles Darling are Requested to Meet this Evening at the Assembly Rooms—the Hon. Mrs. Manley in the Chair. Tea and Coffee at 7 o'clock." Even Cruikshank's imagination had not risen to the elevation of lady candidates for senatorial as well as electoral honours, or he would doubtless have favoured the public with some original (pictorial) views on this question.

The general election which took place in July, 1857, found two famous men in the annals of literature contesting for senatorial honours, when W. M. Thackeray and his friend James Hannay were hopefully canvassing, on opposite political platforms, two constituencies, the former for Oxford, the latter for Dumfries, which his father, the Scotch banker, had unsuccessfully fought in the Conservative interest at the successive general elections of 1832 and 1835.

James Hannay again discovered, in 1857, that the electors of Dumfries remained consistent to Whig principles. The novelist and essayist was beaten at the hustings; but he has left something more characteristic than the average of parliamentary orations in the delightful essay upon "Electioneering," contributed to the *Quarterly Review*, with the writing of

which the defeated candidate immediately consoled himself for his recent disappointment.

The canvassing rejoiced Hannay's enthusiastic temperament. The varieties of the genus voter are so infinite that his eye for character was constantly studying original types; he discovered that the work is hard, and that the qualities a good canvasser must combine are as various as the dispositions he has to encounter.

“He must have unwearied activity, imperturbable good temper, popular manners, and a wonderful memory. Every person who has made a trial of electioneering can testify to the exhaustion and fatigue of the first canvass, the swarm of new faces seen and flitting through the mind in strange confusion, the impossibility of distinguishing between the voter who had a leaning to you, but doubted your fidelity to the Maynooth Grant, and his next-door neighbour who was coming round to you against his former prejudice, because of your freedom from religious bigotry. The mental eye wearies of the kaleidoscope that has been turning before it for hours. The hand aches with incessant shaking. The head aches with incessant observation. You fling yourself wearied at nightfall into an easy chair in your committee-room, and plunge eagerly into sherry and soda-water. You could lie down and sleep like a general after a battle. But your committee is about to meet, as a staring blue bill on the hotel wall informs the public; and a score of people have news for you. Tomkins, the hatter, is wavering—a man who can influence four or five; the enemy have set going a story that you beat your wife, and you must have a placard out showing that you are a bachelor. A gang are drinking champagne at the Blue Boar (one of the enemy's houses), fellows whose potations are usually of the poorest kind; your opinion is wanted on a new squib; the manager of the theatre is below, waiting to see if you will patronize his theatre with an early ‘bespeak night,’ and whether you will have ‘Black-Eyed Susan,’ or ‘Douglas;’ a deputation of proprietors of donkeys wants to hear your views on the taxation of French asses’ milk. Who, under such circumstances, can retain in his memory all the details of the canvass of the day?”

However galling the temporary disappointment experienced by Hannay and Thackeray respectively, their readers had no reason to regret that, as the great novelist wrote, philosophically accepting his defeat, “they were sent back to take their places with their pens and ink at their desks, and leave their successful opponents to a business which they understood better.” The test of tact and temper was certainly applied to the two novelists when competing for seats in the Commons.

Thackeray aspired to take the place in Parliament for the city of Oxford which his friend Neate, at the time Professor of Political Economy in that university, had lost for an alleged contravention of the Corrupt Practices Act, thus described by Thackeray at the hustings: “He was found guilty of twopennyworth of bribery which he never committed.” This was Thackeray’s ostensible motive for his candidature: “A Parliament which has swallowed so many camels, strained at that little gnat, and my friend, your representative, the very best man you could find to represent you, was turned back, and you were left without a man. I cannot hope, I never thought, to equal him; I only came forward at a moment when I felt it necessary that some one professing his principles, and possessing your confidence, should be ready to step into the gap which he had made.”

The author of the electioneering squib directed for “Young Liberal Glory” as against “Old Tory Glory” in 1837, was, twenty years later, found consistently advocating the Liberal principles which had inspired his early writings in the *Constitutional*. Thackeray appeared as an advocate of the ballot, was “for having people amused after they had done their worship on a Sunday;” while, “as for triennial Parliaments, if the constituents desire them, I am for them.”

The following passages from his address enlightened the electors of Oxford upon Thackeray’s political convictions:—

“I would use my best endeavours not merely to enlarge the constituencies, but to popularize the Government of this country. With no feeling but that of goodwill towards those leading aristocratic families who are administering the chief offices of the State, I believe it could be benefited by the skill and talent of persons less aristocratic, and that the country thinks so likewise.... The usefulness of a member

of Parliament is best tested at home; and should you think fit to elect me as your representative, I promise to use my utmost endeavour to increase and advance the social happiness, the knowledge, and the power of the people.”

One point in his speech at the hustings, a characteristic allusion to the paramount influence of the Marlborough dukes, for many generations masters of the Oxford elections, was in the true Titmarshian vein, and worthy of the occasion:—“I hear that not long since—in the memory of many now alive—this independent city was patronized by a great university, and that a great duke, who lived not very far from here, at the time of the election used to put on his boots, and ride down and order the freemen of Oxford to elect a member for him.” By a curious coincidence, not altogether reassuring, Thackeray’s reputation at Oxford had somehow failed to reach the majority with whom he was thrown into contact, as one of his committee-men has assured the writer. They mainly asserted that “he could not speak,” to which the candidate retorted “he knew that, but he could write.” Unaccountable as it appears, the fame of his writings had not, in those days, penetrated to any extent this short distance, as the novelist learned by direct and disenchanting experience. He said, in his valedictory remarks, “Perhaps I thought my name was better known than it is.” This illusion, natural in itself, ought to have been dispelled by a former revelation of unsuspected ignorance, which, though unflattering to the author, had, as related by the sufferer, its ludicrous side. Thackeray had betaken himself to Oxford on a previous occasion, with the intention of addressing his lectures on “The English Humorists” to the rising youth at Alma Mater, and, as it was necessary to obtain the licence of the university authorities, he waited upon the chancellor’s resident deputy, who received him blandly.

“Pray, what can I do to serve you, sir?” inquired the functionary. “My name is Thackeray.” “So I see by this card.” “I seek permission to lecture within the precincts.” “Ah! you are a lecturer. What subjects do you undertake—religious or political?” “Neither; I am a literary man.” “Have you written anything?” “Yes; I am the author of ‘Vanity Fair.’” “I presume a Dissenter. Has that anything to do with John Bunyan’s book?” “Not exactly. I have also written ‘Pendennis.’” “Never heard of

those works; but no doubt they are proper books.” “I have also contributed to *Punch*.” “*Punch*! I have heard of that. Is it not a ribald publication?”

On his reception in Oxford in the character of a canvasser, Thackeray addressed the electors with sturdy independence, beyond electioneering persuasive beguilements:—“You know whether I have acted honestly towards you; and you on the other side will say whether I ever solicited a vote when I knew that vote was promised to my opponent; or whether I have not always said, ‘Sir, keep your word. Here is my hand on it. Let us part good friends.’” Although beaten by the Right Hon. Edward Cardwell, Thackeray retained his good humour, energetically enjoining the extension of courtesy to his successful opponent and to the opposition party. A cry of “Bribery” being raised against them, he continued: “Don’t cry out bribery. If you know of it, prove it; but, as I am innocent of bribery myself, I do not choose to fancy that other men are not equally loyal and honest.” He attributed his defeat to the advanced views he avowed—and which, as he asserted, “he would not blink to be made a duke or a marquis to-morrow”—on the question of “allowing a man to have harmless pleasures when he had done his worship on Sundays. I expected to have a hiss, but they have taken a more dangerous shape—the shape of slander. Those gentlemen who will take the trouble to read my books—and I should be glad to have as many of you for subscribers as will come forward—will be able to say whether there is anything in them that should not be read by any one’s children, or my own, or by any Christian man.”

The most characteristic anecdote which has survived of this interesting incident in Thackeray’s experience as an “electioneerer,” exhibits him in a thoroughly John Bull attitude. While looking out of the hotel window, amused at the humours of the scene, in which he was only the second performer, a passing crowd, from hooting, proceeded to rough-handling, and the supporters of Mr. Cardwell, being in the minority against their assailants, would have been badly maltreated, but for Thackeray’s starting up in the greatest possible excitement, and, rushing downstairs, notwithstanding the efforts to detain him of more hardened electioneers, who evidently were of opinion that a trifling correction of the opposite party might be beneficial *pour encourager les autres*; he was not to be

deterred, but, expressing in strong language his opinion of such unmanly behaviour, he hurled himself into the thick of the fray; and, awful spectacle for his party! his tall form—Thackeray, be it remembered, stood upwards of 6ft. 2in.—was next seen towering above the crowd, dealing about him right and left with frantic energy in defence of his opponent's partisans and in defiance of his own friends.

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Messrs. Sykes and Rumbold fined and imprisoned for bribery	14 March, 1776
Messrs. Davidson, Parsons, and Hopping, imprisoned for bribery at Ilchester	28 April, 1804
Mr. Swan, M.P. for Penryn, fined and imprisoned, and Sir Manasseh Lopez sentenced to a fine of £10,000 and two years' imprisonment for bribery at Grampound	Oct. 1819
The members for Dublin and Liverpool unseated	1831
The friends of Mr. Knight, candidate for Cambridge, convicted of bribery	20 Feb. 1835
Elections for Ludlow and Cambridge made void	1840
Sudbury disfranchised, 1848; St. Alban's also	1852
Elections at Derby and other places declared void for bribery	1853
Corrupt Practices Act passed	1854
In the case of Cooper versus Slade it was ruled that the payment of travelling expenses was bribery	17 April, 1858
Gross bribery practised at Gloucester, Wakefield, and Berwick	1859
Mr. William H. Leatham convicted of bribery at Wakefield	19 July, 1860

Government commissions of inquiry respecting bribery, sat at Great Yarmouth, Totnes, Lancaster, and Reigate, and disgraceful disclosures were made	Aug.-Nov. 1866
The boroughs were disfranchised by the Reform Bill, passed	5 Aug. 1867
The Parliamentary Elections Act enacted that election petitions should be tried by a court appointed for the purpose, passed	31 July, 1868
First trials under this Act: Mr. Roger Eykyn (at Windsor) was declared duly elected, 15 Jan., and Sir H. Stracey (at Norwich) was unseated	18 Jan. 1869
Dr. Kinglake, Mr. Fenelly, and others, were sentenced to be fined for bribery in parliamentary elections	10 May, 1870
Beverley, Bridgwater, Sligo, and Cashel disfranchised for bribery and corruption	1870
Much corruption during the elections of April. Members for Oxford, Chester, Boston, and other places unseated	1880
Stringent bill against bribery brought in by Sir Henry James, attorney-general	7 Jan. 1881

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FOOTNOTES:

- [1](#) *Vide* Sheridan's election expenses for Stafford.
- [2](#) 1642. "The Inhabitants of the Citie of Bathe express their great greifes in that they have little company this summer, the poor guides are now necessitated to guide one another from the alehouse, lest they should lose their practice. Pluto's cauldron (the hot bath) had never less purboyled fleshe in it to please the palate of his Courtiers. The poor Fiddlers are ready to hang themselves in their strings for a pastime, for want of other employments." (*Certaine Intelligences from Bath*, 1642. Pamphlets. Coll. Geo. III. B.M.)
- [3](#) 1431. "So there is owing to them for their appearance for 73 days 6s. and 8d. for each day" (*i.e.* for two members).

1441-2.—"And it was the same day ordered by assent of the whole congregation that the Burgesses chosen for Parliament shall be allowed each of them two shillings a day, and by no means any more." (Extracts from the Proceedings of the Corporation of Lynn Regis, 1430 to 1731. *Archæologia*, vol. xxiv.)
- [4](#) William Prynne was one of the great authorities upon parliamentary history and statistics. All subsequent compilers, who have written upon the subject of constituencies, quoted from his "Brevia Parliamentaria Rediviva."

5 Andrew Marvell, who was made assistant-secretary to Milton, when he served the Protector, was, by Cromwell's death, thrown out of employment. The burgesses of Hull, with whom he was deservedly popular, elected Marvell their representative to Parliament. The payment, of which so much has been made, for these services did not amount to a munificent retainer, the salary being fixed at two shillings a day for borough members; kindly remembrances in the form of acceptable gifts were, however, sent by constituents to those representatives who won their good wishes. Thus Marvell writes to the friends who sent him to parliament: "We must first give you thanks for the kind present you have pleased to send us, which will give occasion to us to remember you often; but the quantity is so great, that it might make sober men forgetful."

6 Coleridge, "Northern Worthies."

7 Campbell, "Lives of the Lord Chancellors."

8 "DUKE OF BUCKINGHAM'S LITANY.

"From cringing to those we scorn and contemn
In hopes to be made the citizens' Gem,
Who now scorn us more than we e'er did them,

Libera nos Domine.

"From beginning an Execrable Trait'rous health,
To destroy the Parliament, King, and himself,
To be made Ducal Peer of a new Commonwealth,

Libera nos Domine.

"From changing old Friends for rascally new ones;
From taking Wildman and Marvell for true ones;
From wearing Green Ribbons 'gainst him gave us Blue ones,

Libera nos Domine."

“Here’s a Health to the King, and his lawful successors,
 To honest *Tantivies*, and Loyal *Addressors*;
 But a rot take all those that promoted *Petitions*,
 To poison their nation, and stir up seditions.”

(*The Loyal Health*, 1684.)

[10](#) “The *Petitioners*, looking upon their adversaries as entirely devoted to the Court and the popish faction, gave them the name of *Tories*, a title given to the Irish robbers, villains, and cut-throats, since called *Rapparees*. (It will be remembered that James II. convened a Parliament in Dublin which attainted three thousand Protestants).

“The *Abhorrrers* on their side, considering the *Petitioners* as men entirely in the principles of the reprobated parliament of 1640, and as Presbyterians, gave them the name of *Whig*, or ‘Sour-milk,’ formerly appropriated to the Scotch Presbyterians and rigid Covenanters.”

[11](#) A second *Convention* Parliament met January 22, 1689, offered the Crown to William of Orange and Mary, February 13th, and dissolved a year later.

[12](#) Published by the “Ballad Society.”

[13](#) Alleged length of the petition for resummoning parliament.

[14](#) This relates to Lord Shaftesbury’s Protestant Association, and his “green ribbon boys.”

[15](#) H. Mildmay and J. L. Honeywood, members for Essex in Charles II.’s parliaments.

- [16](#) “Murdering Miles” Prance, the silversmith. Prance, the “Renegado,” one of the accusers of the popish Lords, and with Titus Oates, one of the discoverers of the popish conspiracy.
- [17](#) The popish Lords and the secretary of State, Lord Danby.
- [18](#) His name appears to have been Dancer, tanner and bailiff; he was also mayor at the time.
- [19](#) This ballad was written by Charles Blount, a prolific pamphleteer, second son of Sir Henry Blount, who attended Charles I. at Edge Hill.
- [20](#) In reply to the London and Wiltshire petitions against the vexatious prorogations—which Charles justified on the excuse “that the unsettled state of the nation made a longer interval necessary”—the king volunteered an audacious statement which was likely to astonish constitutional minds. He said that “he was the head of the Government, and the only judge of what was fit to be done in such cases, and that he would do that which he thought most for the good of himself and his people, desiring that they would not meddle with a matter that was so essential a part of his prerogative.” This brazen-faced assumption is so coloured by Carolian waggery, that we must fancy the Merry Monarch, if he saw the wit of his speech, making the reply in question with his “tongue in his cheek.”
- [21](#) Sir Thomas Mompesson had sat in the parliament in 1679 for New Sarum, and in the Oxford Parliament he sat for Old Sarum.
- [22](#) “The Presbyters.”
- [23](#) Thomas Thynne, whose estate was £9000 a year. He was an invaluable ally of the Duke of Monmouth. Assassinated by hired bravoës in the pay of Count Königsmarck, who was in love with the rich heiress, a widow, to whom poor Thynne was (by the influence of her friends) betrothed, be it said, against the inclination of the lady herself.

- [24](#) The celebrated Philippe de Comines (1445-1509). “L’on voit dans Comines, mieux que partout ailleurs, ce qu’étaient alors et les droits des rois et les privilèges des peuples. Il témoigne pour les Anglais, qui déjà savaient mieux que tout autre nation maintenir leurs libertés, une grande consideration.”
- [25](#) Frank Smith and Benjamin Harris, publishers of many tracts, satires, and so-called “libels” against the Court.
- [26](#) *Commons Journals*, March 26, 1681.
- [27](#) Lord Keeper and Chancellor.
- [28](#) The scapegoat, Fitz-Harris, who was promptly got rid of, for fear of revelations, being executed June 9, 1681.
- [29](#) That the Lords contested the claim of the Commons to impeach and condemn any one whom they might accuse of a crime was a grievance of the Lower House.
- [30](#) Mr. Samuel Lewen.
- [31](#) His seat was Long Ditton, near Kingston, which town had surrendered its charter to King Charles II. about a month before his death. King James appointed Sir Edward Evelyn one of the new corporation.
- [32](#) A Child was subsequently successful in getting returned for Middlesex. Child died in 1740, and was succeeded by Hugh Smithson, who later became known as the recipient of the honours of the Dukes of Northumberland.
- [33](#) The term “Tacker” was due to the chief member for Oxford University, William Bromley, having, in the session just closed, moved “That the Bill to prevent occasional nonconformity might be *tacked* to the Land Tax Bill.” The practice of tacking was condemned by the Lords, most of whom had signed a resolution to the effect they would never admit a “tack” to a money-bill. The

party in the Commons strove vigorously to carry their point upon two bills being thus conjoined, whence they began to be known as “the Tackers.” In return, they stigmatized their opponents as “Sneakers.”

[34](#) Tacks, otherwise Tackers, *i.e.* High-Church Tories, who were first so called from their efforts to tack the Occasional Conformity Bill on to a money bill, so that it could not be sent back by the Lords.

[35](#) Jacobites.

[36](#) “Memoirs of the Life of Thomas, Marquess of Wharton; to which is added his character by Sir Richard Steele.” London, 1715. 8vo.

[37](#) Lord Grimston’s curious comedy, in five acts and in verse(!), “The Lawyer’s Fortune, or Love in a Hollow Tree,” was first published in 1704, as a quarto; being a foolish attempt, in fact, the merest trash, the author, it is said, suppressed it. The edition printed, as alleged, by the Duchess of Marlborough’s orders, is dated 1736. Besides the heading of an elephant performing on a rope, a satirical frontispiece was engraved, in which Lord Grimston is seen interrogating a sage, ensconced in the “hollow tree” of his play; a jackass is the most conspicuous object in the foreground; the animal wears a coronet, and is intended to typify the doltish author, who is farther ridiculed in a burlesque dedication “To the Right Sensible the Lord Flame.”

[38](#) Queen Anne.

[39](#) The Sacheverell riots.

[40](#) “Catalogue of the Political and Personal Satires in the British Museum,” vol. iii.

[41](#) “The Humours of an Election” seems to have inspired not only artists and balladists, but playwrights and opera composers also. “The Humours of the Town, a Dramatic Interlude,” referring to the contested election of 1774, is of this order. M.P. Andrews

wrote “a new musical Interlude” under this title, 1774. “The Election,” a comedy in three acts, appeared in 1749; and “a new opera, called the Election,” was published in 1817. “The Country Election,” a farce in two acts, is due to D. J. Trusler, 1786; and “The Humours of an Election,” by F. Pilon, was published in 1780. Besides these and other plays, several poems were printed under this title, to some of which we have occasion to refer.

- [42](#) There were several variorum editions of this ballad, mostly amounting in substance to the same thing, “but with differences.” One entitled, “The Downfall of Sundon and Wager,” etc., commences with this verse:—

“Ye Westminster Boys,
By your freedom of choice
Who have shown to your good friends of London
Ye dare to be free,
Reject Pension and Fee,
By throwing out Wager and Sundon.”

- [43](#) “Gentleman Harry” was Henry Pelham, the head of the Administration. He combined the offices of first lord of the treasury and chancellor of the exchequer. His death occurred on the eve of the elections of 1754.
- [44](#) Sir John Soane secured these inimitable pictures from Mrs. Garrick.
- [45](#) Hogarth, in the first state of the engraving, has made the superscription in the youthful candidate’s letter to be Sir Commodity Taxem, Bart. Nichols is not correct in describing this gentleman as Thomas Potter. Lord Wenman and Sir James Dashwood were the Whig candidates; the Tory representatives were Lord Parker and Sir E. Turner.

- [46](#) In the original painting it is, “the Devil.”

- [47](#) Dr. Shebbeare, in his “6th Letter to the People of England,” audaciously abused the reigning dynasty, for which Lord Mansfield condemned him to stand in the pillory, to be imprisoned for three years, etc. Subsequently Lord Bute complimented him with a pension, which Shebbeare enjoyed to his death.
- [48](#) Marked “New Interest” in the original painting, which is necessarily easier to decipher than the engraving.
- [49](#) As concerned Churchill and the artist, they both departed, it may be said, “warring to the very verge of the grave,” in 1764. Less than a month before the painter’s death appeared Churchill’s familiar lines, treating his antagonist as already slain by his satire:—

“Hogarth would draw him (Envy must allow)
E’en to the life, was HOGARTH LIVING NOW.”

Curiously enough, five weeks after these lines appeared, the poet was likewise gathered to those shades to which he had with sportive venom prematurely consigned his antagonist, in all probability without anticipating the literal fulfilment of his prophecy.

- [50](#) John Wilkes, Radical, 1290; George Cooke, Conservative, 827; Sir W. B. Proctor, the unsuccessful Whig candidate, polled 807 votes.
- [51](#) A less dignified view is taken of the lord mayor’s officious intervention, in the *Political Register*, 1768, where it states he had degraded, by his personal interference, “the dignity of his office to that of a petty constable;” and in a letter referring to the royal and ministerial favours conferred in return “for his active and spirited behaviour,” the new state official is, in his capacity of merchant-tailor, thus addressed:—

“And now, my lord, as we are *brother tailors*, how could you be so unkind as not to join *eight of us* to your right honourable self (nine tailors proverbially making one man), when you were dubbed the other day a Privy Councillor.”

[52](#) The “cornuted” effect of these peculiarly fashioned wigs, especially when seen from the back, is, perhaps, accountable—with the pun on the parson’s Christian name of Horne—for the quotation engraved above the plate in question,—“Mine horn shall be exalted, like the horn of an Unicorn (*Psalms* 93).”

[53](#) The Duke of Grafton was first lord of the treasury, 1767 to 1780.

[54](#) John Wilkes.

[55](#) George Fletcher, executed 1746.

[56](#) Samuel Turner and Sir Robert Ladbroke were unstable, and a few months later, “rattled” and becoming subservient to Court influence, did their best to betray the liberties of the citizens confided to their championship.

[57](#) A mark being equivalent to 13s. 4d.

[58](#) According to the return of 1826 there were three hundred voters.

[59](#) Sheridan, according to Lord Byron’s dictum, had produced the three best compositions of his age in their respective lines: the best comedy, “The School for Scandal;” the best parliamentary philippic, the “Begum speech” against Warren Hastings; and pronounced the finest funeral oration, the monody on Garrick.

“The pride of the palace, the bower, and the hall,
The orator, dramatist, minstrel who ran
Through each mode of the lyre and was master of all.”

[60](#) A necessary qualification, members being, by supposition, expected to reside in the places they represented.

[61](#) Wilkes's Address to the Middlesex Electors.

[62](#) Lord Thurlow, who was frequently twitted by the satirists upon his *penchant* for the fair sex.

[63](#) Lord Bute's secretary, the great dispenser of "back-stairs influence," afterwards Lord Liverpool.

[64](#) For the screen of Carlton House Palace, see "Coriolanus addressing the Plebeians," 1820; p. 338.

[65](#) The bard of the "New Chevy Chase," being truly national, makes the descendant of the Russells and his other personages express themselves vernacularly in "Scotticisms" when under the influence of strong emotions.

[66](#) The bishop.

[67](#) "Charles Dix," lately driven from France.

[68](#) Whose ministry caused the Bourbon downfall.

[69](#) Much as Gillray made his royal father scrutinizing and blinking at the presentment of Oliver Cromwell.

[70](#) Mr. J. Calcraft (W) succeeded in distancing Henry Bankes (W), but only lived a few months to enjoy his victory; a fresh election took place in October, 1831, *vice* Calcraft deceased, when Lord Ashley (afterwards Earl of Shaftesbury) secured the vacant seat.

[71](#) Hobhouse was rejected by his Westminster constituents.

[72](#) This is a reprehensible pun, barely to be tolerated even on such occasions, upon the name of Sir John Elley (C), an unsuccessful candidate, who was beaten by eight votes: Sir J. de Beauvoir (W), the second member, polling 239 to Elley's 231. John Ramsbottom

(W), was returned for Windsor at the top of the poll at the general elections of 1832, 1835, and 1837.

[73](#) Sir John de Beauvoir.

[74](#) *i.e.* Napoleon Buonaparte.

[75](#) See “Reform,” page 372.

[76](#) “Radicals” for “rapids.”

Transcriber’s Note:

Inconsistent spelling and hyphenation are as in the original.

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